

ACA Marketplace Shoppers (OEP) — Voices by Theme

Appendix to *ACA-Shoppers-Research*. For every measured theme, the most engaged voices (up to 20) in full, with replies and source links. Live page: <https://vincestars-cloud.github.io/campaign-previews/aca-shoppers/research/>

Tab 1 — Fears

Getting sick and not being able to pay · 16 documents · 16 voices

"My premium increased 590%. Is this normal? I understand without the enhanced subsidies we'd be seeing double or triple premiums next year. However, my premium skyrocketed. In 2025, I paid \$80 and my premiums are set to increase to \$552. The lowest option available was \$300 for catastrophic insurance which wouldn't work for me. I had to go with the \$450 option. I put that my income was \$730 biweekly after deductions. My take home pay is \$1200 a month. My friend in Florida makes the same as me and her premium only increased from \$11 to \$50. My coworker in Wisconsin is also getting a similar low cost option. I am so confused why my premium increased so much. Did anyone else in Illinois experience this? Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level. Edit: also, my parents are helping to pay part of my premiums for now. Otherwise, I'd be out of luck. Even though I'm grateful, it doesn't feel good having to rely on my parents for this. But knowing my health history I could end up in serious trouble if I go uninsured. Update: After a month on the marketplace plan, I was found eligible for Medicaid so it ended up working out at the end. I was worried since I'd been denied for Medicaid in the past. It looks like the increased premiums finally made me eligible."

— r/HealthInsurance · 152 upvotes · None

"The "Medicaid Gap" is a joke. For context, I live in Mississippi. (And honestly that should already tell you everything you need to know.) (And yes, I already posted this but I didn't realized the rant/vent flair would lock the comments. Whoops! So let's try this again) For the past two years, I've been able to get an affordable marketplace plan with Ambetter. It was the first time I was able to get health insurance since I got knocked off my dad's when I turned 26. (I'm now 31) Without this insurance, I wouldn't have been able to get diagnosed with ADHD, get help with my anxiety and depression, treat my Hypothyroidism and Anemia. Like this has been life changing for me. I work for a small business and unfortunately, I didn't make enough money in 2025 to qualify for the tax credit towards insurance premiums like I have the past couple of years. Which means I'm now expected to pay \$650 every single month for health insurance as a single person with no children. I'm absolutely not doing that because that's not something I can afford. And because Mississippi hates poor people (despite us being the poorest state in the country, but yknow whatever I guess), I now fall into the "Medicaid Gap" as if I was ever eligible for Medicaid in the first place. And because of that, it doesn't seem like there's any kind of affordable options. God forbid we expand Medicaid so the poor people can get health care. GOD FORBID. Luckily it seems like I'll at least be able to continue to afford my thyroid medicine and antidepressants still since I was already on the generic. (Ambetter fully covered Generic and GoodRx says between those two, it shouldn't be too much out of pocket.) But now I won't be able to afford my ADHD medicine and my mental health appointments where I also get my antidepressants and it just fucking sucks, man. I just feel so defeated. I was finally taking better care of myself and now it's about to come to a screeching halt. Anyway, thanks for listening to me vent. I know I'm not the only one in this situation. I'm just hoping something changes for us in the future.

💙 "

— r/HealthInsurance · 138 upvotes · None

"Got Cancer, and Long Time Insurance Dropped Me TLDR: Got cancer, insurance terminated, I don't know what to do. I was diagnosed with cancer in May - Chronic Myeloid Leukemia, which is very treatable with expensive meds, but 100% fatal if not treated. I've had CareFirst Blue Cross Coverage through the VA Marketplace from 2022-present. CareFirst saw my diagnosis, and promptly cancelled my coverage with a technicality. I've been digging through the bureaucracy with no success, and don't know if I have legal options to restore my coverage and resume foregone cancer treatment. On July 1st CareFirst (CF) cancelled my coverage, which I first learned of from my oncologist 23 days after termination was apparently complete. My credit card had a fraudulent charge, so I replaced it in May - but forgot my premium payments were on the card, and my premium payment didn't process in June. I received no notification or calls before the letter from CF dated July 15 (although I didn't open it until later). I overnight mailed a check on July 25, and CareFirst (CF) cashed it July 28th. The VA Marketplace sent a eligibility / reinstatement form on July 24th, which CF told me they would process. The CF agents said it was in processing with the enrollment department. I called a total of 16 times between July 23 and this writing. In the 8th-13th calls to CF agents, they repeated the reenrollment was pending with the enrollment department. In my 14th call, they told me that - actually - I have no enrollment request, and that all of the previous agents were just attaching additional notes on the termination file. All previous agents had made an error, and that I needed to restart with the VA Marketplace. The first 13 calls never even started an appeal or reinstatement request. The CareFirst agent informed me that the only way I can restore coverage is to cancel this and reapply. Finally I unenrolled with my VA State Marketplace and applied to reenroll with my same program. Then they did the first clear and quick response of this whole mess: They immediately denied my reenrollment. This doesn't just mean I lost one insurer- they now made me ineligible for other insurance without a qualifying life event. (I've been employed for 3 years employed with a decent salary by a small non-profit that offers only a health reimbursement, thus the VA Marketplace ACA coverage). I cannot access cancer treatments, and am forgoing care. The list price on the cancer drug I need, at my current pharmacy, is far higher than my salary. I found a discount pharmacy that lowers it to about my salary. I will continue paying some things out of pocket, and skipping others, hoping I survive until I can restart 2026 ACA coverage. CareFirst says they sent me one letter in June, but I never received any such letter. They also acknowledge that their billing department never called, emailed, or made any effort to contact me. They cancelled my care without ever confirming I had any notification. Then they made me run a gauntlet of impenetrable bureaucratic mess through confusion and clear, blatant errors (I don't think their agent confusion was intentional deception - just incompetence). CareFirst found I have an expensive disease, and illegally cancelled my coverage. I am at the end of my rope. I am trying every approach possible to get my coverage and cancer treatment restored. Can anyone advise on my options? I see an option to request a written appeal, but that feels like asking the executioner to reconsider, given that they clearly are not acting in good faith already. I talked with some other insurance providers, and they told me I'd be rejected unless it was a Marketplace (ACA) plan that requires acceptance. I can only imagine a few options: * I vacate my condo and move to Maryland to get a 'qualifying life event'. But for various reasons, that would be really hard to deal with while already fighting cancer and trying to keep up with a demanding job. * I have access to a large press contact list, so I could try emailing my story to ~310 reporters, but I feel like that's more vengeful than productive. And I don't have the mental energy to be fielding a ton of media interviews. * I can also get a lawyer, but I'm not sure how much that would change. I don't want to be fighting this forever, I just want to get my health care and live my life. Any advice, especially ideas specific to Virginia? Edit: corrected 'deductible' to 'premium'. Update: I'm doing well now, no thanks to 'Carefirst' Blue Cross Blue Shield. I paid out of pocket for expensive chemotherapy for little while. I also fought and fought, tried to get a lawyer, and eventually realized they had no chance of ever getting me back onto the plan. Ironically, they tried to keep my premium payment that I sent via overnight cashier's check as soon as I realized there was a gap. But restoring my coverage? They wouldn't dream of it. The only way I could get back on coverage was to get married. That was already in the works, but it accelerated a courthouse elopement before our actual wedding. I'm now on my

spouse's coverage, and I am continuing the medications I need, and am relatively healthy. I also feel more comfortable because if they try to drop again it would need to go through a large employer's HR, so theoretically they can't unilaterally drop me. I don't know if this was convenient incompetence, weaponized incompetence, or just an active, unwritten rule to get drop high cost patients however they can. I just know that CareFirst doesn't care, and the system we have in the US sucks. It's more expensive, less dependable, and more difficult to navigate than any other developed country. Thankfully, I'm no longer one of the people this system is leaving without care, but I'm more convinced than ever that this system is the worst."

— r/HealthInsurance · 119 upvotes · None

"Health insurance over 30% of my income It's open enrollment for the ACA right now, and I'm not sure what to do. I applied but the cheapest policy is 200/month more than my current policy. Where's the subsidy? I'm making 17/hr (not being paid over summer - school schedule) my current insurance is over 600/month and the aca is offering over 800/month. I can't afford this. I'm generally panicking because my financial situation changed, and we have a baby on the way. We were expecting to have a higher household income but currently I'm the only one earning. I'm debating canceling the insurance altogether. It won't cover the baby regardless (international stuff - but their healthcare will be covered over there until we bring the baby back). I've got other financial fears I need help figuring out too, but mainly just trying to get my head around the insurance. We don't qualify for medicaid (wtf) we don't qualify to rent an apartment (wtf) I'm debating living in my car if I lose my current housing situation, but when baby arrives it'll need more than a back seat. If I don't have to pay health insurance, then i could do better financially. I have decent savings, but once that's gone, it's gone. If I do cancel, then if something happens where I need care, then I might have to die before the baby is here because I can't afford treatment. I wish I could format my question more directly but I'm kinda overwhelmed and it's hard to write well while I'm all stressed and panicky. I thought when open enrollment came I'd be able to get on a plan that was paid for by the fed, and so I could drop my work coverage. That's turning out not to be the case. Am I missing something? Can someone help me figure out what to do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 32 upvotes · None

"[US] Health insurance as a solo small business owner is killing me financially, how are you handling it? Running a small boutique for a few years now and the one thing that never gets easier is health insurance. Coming from a corporate background where HR handled everything, I had no idea how brutal the individual market was until I was actually in it. Right now I'm paying more per month for my own coverage than I used to pay toward rent. And the deductibles aren't even that good. I looked at marketplace plans, looked at shortterm options, even went down the health sharing ministry rabbit hole for a while before deciding it felt too risky for my situation. What I keep running into is that the options are either expensive and okay, or cheaper and kind of terrifying. There's no middle ground that actually makes sense. For those of you running smaller operations, especially retail or service businesses where you're the only employee or close to it, what have you actually landed on? Did you find something through a professional association or a local chamber? Did you just accept the high premium and build it into your pricing? I track my finances pretty obsessively so I know exactly what this is costing me each year, and it's genuinely one of my biggest line items. Curious what other people have figured out."

— r/selfemployed · 10 upvotes · None

"Living off Cash (for a few years) I'll be 53 next year, and would like to quit my job and live off saved cash for 3-4 years before potentially rejoining the workforce. Since my income would be \$0 for those years, how would I go about getting health insurance? When I enter estimates in the ACA, they tell me to apply for medicaid. I also own a house that has an estimated value of 500k and have over 500k in retirement, but I don't want to touch the retirement until I'm 59. Would getting health insurance for my 3-4 years "off" be problematic because of my assets? And, would I have to receive medicaid or is there a way to still get a private insurance plan even with no income? I'm not trying to get "free healthcare," but if my income is zero for a few years, do I even have a choice? Thanks,"

— r/HealthInsurance · 10 upvotes · None

"Have used a broker to sign up for the last 2 years - why are his prices higher than the ones listed on the healthcare.gov site? TLDR : the copious info is below but 1) worried a broker is trying to up charge me to sign up through him for 2026 insurance (a more expensive plan I wasn't considering from gov site is actually \$50/month cheaper thru him, the cheaper plan I thought I might pick on the gov site is \$30 more a month from the broker) 2) how can I review the answers I put into my gov 2026 application before I got the info from the insurance broker because I can't seem to find a way to review that on healthcare.gov So..... 2 years ago I signed up through a local insurance broker because I was coming off Medicaid and couldn't get the healthcare.gov website to show me what I'd be getting for a subsidy. I assume it wouldn't give me that info till I was determined ineligible by my states dhhs which is a slow process. I even called them and told them to end my coverage through them on the last day of December hoping that would make it so I was able to see my subsidy but it didn't. So I went through this broker and got signed up cheap (\$45) a month on priority. Last year since he had made the process so painless I went through him again but it went up to \$120 a month which hurt a bit but he had said some program had expired making my insurance more expensive for this past year even tho my income only went up a couple thousand dollars. Looking back now I prob should have delved into that huge increase further. I called him again at the end of October and he said to call him back in a week since he didn't have access to the new numbers yet but after seeing all the people shocked by their increases I decided to fill out an application on healthcare.gov just to see what kind of increase I might be in for. My income also went up so I put in a new estimate (which I don't remember what I put) and if I keep my current plan it will go up to \$215. There's also a cheaper plan I could get instead that will likely fulfill my needs for \$159. The insurance broker sent me an email listing 2 plans neither of which is my current one. It lists one for \$208 but the gov site lists the same plan for \$186. The gov site lists another plan I wasn't even considering due to expense for \$239 but from the broker that same plan is \$183. In order to have complete info I wanted to review my gov application because I don't remember exactly what I put for my income info. For the broker I told him \$28k for the year but I either listed \$28k or \$26,600 on my gov application. I was trying to review my application details again but have been clicking round and round on the gov site and it won't let me review those details anywhere as far as I can see. I need to have those details before I can ask this broker what's up with the different prices and make a selection. Low key worried he may be pulling a fast one on me but I thought these brokers didn't charge for their services (that may have been true under Biden but who knows what rule changes Trump may have made allowing for up charging) Phew, any info appreciated 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · None

"Lost my job, I can likely qualify for Medicaid but wondering if it will have bad implications at tax time So I lost my main job this week. I do have a second little 1099 side hustle that's good for about \$400 a month which is only a little over half my mortgage cost and I have some savings I can dip into. My ACA premium ended up being my second highest monthly bill because I estimated my income higher and because of Trump screwing those of us that use the program. My question is can I switch to Medicaid halfway through the without having to worry about paying back the subsidy? I'm applying for Medicaid today but obviously won't have an approval decision before my premium is due on July 1st, so I will probably have to pay my July premium. It would hurt financially to have to keep paying this inflated amount for the premium till the end of the year when I'm no longer making anywhere near that but I don't want to create an even bigger financial headache come tax time. Any insight appreciated thanks 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · None

"I am currently on an ACA Bronze plan and have had this the past two years that I've been retired. I have noticed the Silver plans are quite a bit more in my state. Also Bronze plans (at least for this year) allow for HSA deposits. Not sure if you can do that with Silver. I'm afraid to drop vision and dental because I wear glasses and have had big dental bills in the past. I'll check the math though. And I'm paying about twice as much as you are for one person (health+vision only). At open enrollment I'll look again. Also will see if I can maybe lower my MAGI. I told them \$62K for this year (which is near the max for a single person and still get a subsidy). Lowering this to \$35K or \$40K might be possible but it would require withdrawals from my Roth IRA to make up the difference."

— YouTube · How We Get ACA Health Insurance Before Age 65? · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xVHorMHIYeM&lc=Ugz860t4k73b15uGt_x4AaABAq

↳ @RetireEarlyWithMelanieAndKeith (5): "Yes. your MAGI is very important and if you can control it and keep it lower you will get better pricing."

↳ @sunnybrookfm-75 (3): "The last 5 years I worked before actually retiring I had to provide my own health insurance the first year where I worked. I used the subsidies like you and paid approximately what you are. In my case it was 180 dollars per month since I'm single. I was earning 15 dollars an hour. I was working 2 jobs. I also had really cheap places to live. We were unionized too thank goodness. When the year was up I got the union healthcare for \$5 a week plus I was on part a of Medicare. The employer had a huge amount of employees so you can do what I'm talking about. I am a retired paralegal and nurse. In addition I have vision problems that caused me to have cataract issues. I had to have them removed from both eyes in my late 50s. I also went completely blind in both eyes for 6 weeks. Some vision came back in 1 eye. I was disqualified from disability because 1 eye functions pretty well. At any rate my vision problems are considered a medical condition. The good news is my doctor tells me my condition has stabilized and I now qualify for low vision benefits. Most of those I would have to pay for out of pocket so I just go along the best I can with what I have. I'm allowed to drive and restrict myself to daytime driving. I go to discount eyeglass providers and pay about 50% less than I would if I went to my doctor for eyeglasses. When I retired I went from health insurance plus pt A Medicare to Medicare and a high deductible medigap plan. I was able to keep health insurance plus pt A Medicare until 67 because my store had a huge amount of employees and had somewhat decent health insurance thru the union. Because of this loophole I was entitled to keep my \$5 dollar a week health insurance until I retired at 67. I am now 73. My retirement age was 66. I eventually added dental insurance I figure if I need implants I can be a dental tourist and get them done abroad if I need to. So far my blood pressure has come down into the normal range now that I'm not working as well. And I've not had to take any medication for my blood pressure. Yay! I'm just taking care of myself. Now mind you this is also because I'm exceptionally frugal. I live on 21k and save 5k a year. Furthermore at the age of 72 I came into a nestegg of 325k from 2 individuals in my life and my own savings. My family left me the 325k. I've not had to touch a nickel of it. And since the 21k is technically my only source of income I owe zero dollars in taxes. Bonus for me 😊😊 . I pay 825 dollars a month in rent and have a small 20 pound dog. My best friend bought my house outright and rents it to me. It is 850 sq ft of heaven. I live in a home built in 1950 that is constantly undergoing renovations. And I live a very simple modest lifestyle. My neighborhood is a working class neighborhood in a downtown area. I live in a wealthy county outside a large metropolitan city. My city has a population of 100k approximately. It is peaceful and quiet. Yes when you are pricing out your healthcare check out both federal and state laws."

↳ @richard1113 (0): "@sunnybrookfm-75 Thank you for sharing your story. It sounds like you're doing ok!"

"Does anybody know how ACA considers dividend funds like QQQI - say I buy 10k of it at the beginning of year 1. Then I get that the dividends I take out that year count as income. But with these funds the div are subtracted from initial cost - so in year 2 my cost basis is 10k minus 1500 so 8500. If I decide to sell these in year 2, does the 1500 count as "income" for Aca? It will count as capital gains for taxes (cause they don't tax dividends I think)... anybody in here knows what I'm talking about? I'd like to get 40k of qqqi for div income, but afraid of being stuck with huge "income" on paper that can ruin my ACA premium credits down the road if I ever need to sell..."

— YouTube · How to Get Affordable Health Insurance Before Medicare · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dVyz5Ac7pA&lc=UgzjFs6wDCnH1cDhKXx4AaABAg>

↳ @tachikaze222 (0): "return of capital ia NOT considered income for ACA; check your 1099-DIV, box 3 income doesn't count for ACA"

"I see people talking about HSA in the comments what is that? Is that a health savings plan for mostly PPO insured? If so how would I get on that plan. Currently at a job that makes me unhappy and I'm not fulfilled. Ready to spread my wings but my husband is so worried about me leaving because he got really sick one day. And I have great health insurance now. I work for a hospital now. I live in LA. I want you to do a video about ministry healthy insurance I want to learn more about it. This video really sparked my interest thanks so much."

— YouTube · Health Insurance Options for the Self Employed or Are Leaving Your Job · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ceyE3F7SK1k&lc=UgxHHhLR3Eg0RMRagzZ4AaABAg>

↳ @MaximizingEcommerce (0): "HSA is healthcare spending account. It has tax benefits. There are some key stipulations and only goes with certain types of plans. Best to talk to an agent and/or your accountant."

"I've also got this plan, thinking it's the best option for copays. I started having some serious bleeding issues & after almost 2 months with no relief, was finally able to have surgery scheduled for a hysterectomy next week. I've activated the procedure & they told me that only the portion paid up front applies to my OOP, and the remaining payments won't. So I'll pay \$2k upfront, for the inpatient procedure, and they're going to deduct \$200x26-the \$5200 isn't applied toward my OOP, I was told, because I basically purchased additional insurance for the specific procedure. So it's like a buy-up. I work in insurance too, so I was pretty confident that all would be safe, but today my Dr's office told me that they can't verify my coverage & I need to activate it. I activated the outpatient procedure last week, per the registration department who told me it's scheduled as outpatient. My Dr wants it inpatient, just in case, so they can't verify it. I called Surest, they had to cancel the inpatient & change it to outpatient, (copay went from \$425 to \$2k, and the deductions went from \$125 to \$200.) I'm starting to believe they deliberately complicate this. "Activation" of the procedure should be left to the provider, who has the codes they're using, and every COMPLETE detail of the procedure, instead they leave it on us to guess which procedures we'll need & leave very little room for error- the words "appeal" & "escalation" have been mentioned in every conversation with the company I've had. These aren't comforting words when we're already worried about our health, now we're also worried about our financial well-being, and the insurance industry banks on members losing patience or being too naive or frustrated to appeal. My recommendation, only select this plan if you're certain you won't need major procedures, this plan design is frustratingly flawed. Away-Pizza-3218, I sincerely wish you the best in your health & recovery, and I hope you're able to get past these issues so it doesn't affect your healing. To file an appeal, you can call them & have them send you the forms. If you don't want to wait for the forms, you can just write a letter to them, but call for the right address to send it to & make sure to keep copies & include ALL the information you can. You only have 60 days if you've already had the procedure, usually, so I hope you still have time to get it resolved. <https://www.healthcare.gov/appeal-insurance-company-decision/internal-appeals/> Thanks for letting me rant, I appreciate it."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/12535jd/my_experiencereview_with_surest_bind_health/jqs6zcv/

"And a lot of people are too young to remember pre-ACA healthcare landscape. I remember my mom sobbing because she was uninsurable due to pre-existing conditions and facing a possible cancer diagnosis. My dad had divorced her and she was trying to get back into the workforce after SIXTEEN years as a stay at home wife and mom. She was terrified of spending down all her money and dying and leaving me alone. I was ELEVEN. When I hear people with no memory of how bad the before times were screaming that we should tear down ACA and THEN figure something out, my BP spikes. the lack of education about what ACA was originally designed to be, how it's been eroded, and the absolute NIGHTMARE that it replaced...the ignorance is being weaponized to go back to something much MUCH worse."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1ofm197/is_the_american_healthcare_system_that_bad_and/nld5x31/

"Our ACA Bronze level coverage will be \$2500 a month with a \$7500 deductible. That is equal to our mortgage. There's no way we can carry this cost every month—we are both self-employed. We will never hit our deductible either so essentially paying \$2500 a month for what?! We are healthy but over 50 so you never know what lingers around the corner. I'm seriously thinking we'll go without and hope for the best. This is absolutely insane to be this old, with a successful career, a decent retirement account and suddenly find ourselves in this position. I can't sleep at night. The stress alone from this is going to send me to the ER. Oh the irony."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1o8gdh7/wow_looking_at_my_2026_insurance_its_half_my_rent/njuzl8v/

"I'm freaked out too. I'm self-employed and have been paying for insurance through the ACA since it became available. I've spent the last 2 years fighting aggressive breast cancer and now I have to worry about this. There is no John McCain to save us this time..."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1gkt285/im_terrified_of_losing_my_obamacare/vogeaj/

"Day 2 into November and I've been too scared to log into the marketplace to see the new numbers. I'm in TN and fall into the gap. FFS"

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1omwh0d/so_how_many_people_are_just_dropping_insurance/nmskfm/

The premium they'll see this year · 8 documents · 8 voices

"My premium increased 590%. Is this normal? I understand without the enhanced subsidies we'd be seeing double or triple premiums next year. However, my premium skyrocketed. In 2025, I paid \$80 and my premiums are set to increase to \$552. The lowest option available was \$300 for catastrophic insurance which wouldn't work for me. I had to go with the \$450 option. I put that my income was \$730 biweekly after deductions. My take home pay is \$1200 a month. My friend in Florida makes the same as me and her premium only increased from \$11 to \$50. My coworker in Wisconsin is also getting a similar low cost option. I am so confused why my premium increased so much. Did anyone else in Illinois experience this? Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level. Edit: also, my parents are helping to pay part of my premiums for now. Otherwise, I'd be out of luck. Even though I'm grateful, it doesn't feel good having to rely on my parents for this. But knowing my health history I could end up in serious trouble if I go uninsured. Update: After a month on the marketplace plan, I was found eligible for Medicaid so it ended up working out at the end. I was worried since I'd been denied for Medicaid in the past. It looks like the increased premiums finally made me eligible."

— r/HealthInsurance · 152 upvotes · None

"Rule of thumb for freelancers: if a client's first question is "what's your rate?", walk away if you can. Years ago I sold cars (don't hate me, please. I lived in the US and needed health insurance). One thing which got hammered into the salespeople again and again is that the customers who paid the most for their cars were the happiest. It's true. In economics you learn that the value of a good is whatever someone is willing to pay for it: if there's no demand, prices are low. If a customer wanted to buy a car and they just focused on the lowest possible price, they were always a pain in the rear. Those customers who *loved* the car were willing to pay more and scored us higher in customer satisfaction surveys. Every. Damn. Time. There was no significant difference in what they purchased other than the happy customers were ones who focused on the value they were getting. So I learned to sell the heck out of the car and ignore the price. Today I've worked for years with a successful consulting firm and every time we have a potential client, when their first question is "what's your best rate?", they turn out to be a lousy client. They're focused on cutting costs, not building value. When their first questions are about what we can build together, it's awesome! They're thinking about their customers, too, and the value they can provide. When their first question is about price: * Cutting costs is more important than providing value * They may have a tight budget and struggle to pay you * They tend to argue more about invoices and features * They know you're the cheapest bidder and they'll treat you like it Unless you're absolutely desperate for money, there is almost no upside to working for clients focusing on price and not value. It's an underpaid grind. **Update:** One comment I should stress more: I mean clients who open with "cost" and don't discuss value. If cost is mixed in with a discussion of value, that's fine. If cost is their opener and what they're focused on, they're almost always a waste of time unless you sell on price instead of value."

— r/freelance · 98 upvotes · None

"Have used a broker to sign up for the last 2 years - why are his prices higher than the ones listed on the healthcare.gov site? TLDR : the copious info is below but 1) worried a broker is trying to up charge me to sign up through him for 2026 insurance (a more expensive plan I wasn't considering from gov site is actually \$50/month cheaper thru him, the cheaper plan I thought I might pick on the gov site is \$30 more a month from the broker) 2) how can I review the answers I put into my gov 2026 application before I got the info from the insurance broker because I can't seem to find a way to review that on healthcare.gov So..... 2 years ago I signed up through a local insurance broker because I was coming off Medicaid and couldn't get the healthcare.gov website to show me what I'd be getting for a subsidy. I assume it wouldn't give me that info till I was determined ineligible by my states dhhs which is a slow process. I even called them and told them to end my coverage through them on the last day of December hoping that would make it so I was able to see my subsidy but it didn't. So I went through this broker and got signed up cheap (\$45) a month on priority. Last year since he had made the process so painless I went through him again but it went up to \$120 a month which hurt a bit but he had said some program had expired making my insurance more expensive for this past year even tho my income only went up a couple thousand dollars. Looking back now I prob should have delved into that huge increase further. I called him again at the end of October and he said to call him back in a week since he didn't have access to the new numbers yet but after seeing all the people shocked by their increases I decided to fill out an application on healthcare.gov just to see what kind of increase I might be in for. My income also went up so I put in a new estimate (which I don't remember what I put) and if I keep my current plan it will go up to \$215. There's also a cheaper plan I could get instead that will likely fulfill my needs for \$159. The insurance broker sent me an email listing 2 plans neither of which is my current one. It lists one for \$208 but the gov site lists the same plan for \$186. The gov site lists another plan I wasn't even considering due to expense for \$239 but from the broker that same plan is \$183. In order to have complete info I wanted to review my gov application because I don't remember exactly what I put for my income info. For the broker I told him \$28k for the year but I either listed \$28k or \$26,600 on my gov application. I was trying to review my application details again but have been clicking round and round on the gov site and it won't let me review those details anywhere as far as I can see. I need to have those details before I can ask this broker what's up with the different prices and make a selection. Low key worried he may be pulling a fast one on me but I thought these brokers didn't charge for their services (that may have been true under Biden but who knows what rule changes Trump may have made allowing for up charging) Phew, any info appreciated 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · None

"Lost my job, I can likely qualify for Medicaid but wondering if it will have bad implications at tax time So I lost my main job this week. I do have a second little 1099 side hustle that's good for about \$400 a month which is only a little over half my mortgage cost and I have some savings I can dip into. My ACA premium ended up being my second highest monthly bill because I estimated my income higher and because of Trump screwing those of us that use the program. My question is can I switch to Medicaid halfway through the without having to worry about paying back the subsidy? I'm applying for Medicaid today but obviously won't have an approval decision before my premium is due on July 1st, so I will probably have to pay my July premium. It would hurt financially to have to keep paying this inflated amount for the premium till the end of the year when I'm no longer making anywhere near that but I don't want to create an even bigger financial headache come tax time. Any insight appreciated thanks 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · None

"Does anybody know how ACA considers dividend funds like QQQI - say I buy 10k of it at the beginning of year 1. Then I get that the dividends I take out that year count as income. But with these funds the div are subtracted from initial cost - so in year 2 my cost basis is 10k minus 1500 so 8500. If I decide to sell these in year 2, does the 1500 count as "income" for Aca? It will count as capital gains for taxes (cause they don't tax dividends I think)... anybody in here knows what I'm talking about? I'd like to get 40k of qqqi for div income, but afraid of being stuck with huge "income" on paper that can ruin my ACA premium credits down the road if I ever need to sell..."

— YouTube · How to Get Affordable Health Insurance Before Medicare · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dVywz5Ac7pA&lc=UgzjFs6wDCnH1cDhKXx4AaABAq>

↳ @tachikaze222 (0): "return of capital ia NOT considered income for ACA; check your 1099-DIV, box 3 income doesn't count for ACA"

"I've also got this plan, thinking it's the best option for copays. I started having some serious bleeding issues & after almost 2 months with no relief, was finally able to have surgery scheduled for a hysterectomy next week. I've activated the procedure & they told me that only the portion paid up front applies to my OOP, and the remaining payments won't. So I'll pay \$2k upfront, for the inpatient procedure, and they're going to deduct \$200x26-the \$5200 isn't applied toward my OOP, I was told, because I basically purchased additional insurance for the specific procedure. So it's like a buy-up. I work in insurance too, so I was pretty confident that all would be safe, but today my Dr's office told me that they can't verify my coverage & I need to activate it. I activated the outpatient procedure last week, per the registration department who told me it's scheduled as outpatient. My Dr wants it inpatient, just in case, so they can't verify it. I called Surest, they had to cancel the inpatient & change it to outpatient, (copay went from \$425 to \$2k, and the deductions went from \$125 to \$200.) I'm starting to believe they deliberately complicate this. "Activation" of the procedure should be left to the provider, who has the codes they're using, and every COMPLETE detail of the procedure, instead they leave it on us to guess which procedures we'll need & leave very little room for error- the words "appeal" & "escalation" have been mentioned in every conversation with the company I've had. These aren't comforting words when we're already worried about our health, now we're also worried about our financial well-being, and the insurance industry banks on members losing patience or being too naive or frustrated to appeal. My recommendation, only select this plan if you're certain you won't need major procedures, this plan design is frustratingly flawed. Away-Pizza-3218, I sincerely wish you the best in your health & recovery, and I hope you're able to get past these issues so it doesn't affect your healing. To file an appeal, you can call them & have them send you the forms. If you don't want to wait for the forms, you can just write a letter to them, but call for the right address to send it to & make sure to keep copies & include ALL the information you can. You only have 60 days if you've already had the procedure, usually, so I hope you still have time to get it resolved. <https://www.healthcare.gov/appeal-insurance-company-decision/internal-appeals/> Thanks for letting me rant, I appreciate it."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/12535jd/my_experiencereview_with_surest_bind_health/jqs6zcv/

"Honestly, as someone outside the US system, ACA pricing looks brutal. High premiums + huge deductibles basically means people are paying a lot while still being scared to actually use healthcare. I can see why younger people feel trapped between risking no insurance and paying for coverage they can barely afford."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1t6m2pw/how_is_anyone_able_to_afford_aca_marketplace/okkju6t/

"Yup, bascially my plan too ... keep ACA income at \$50k/yr via living small and maybe strategic HELOC draws for any big expenses that come up that I don't want to pull out of the Roth."

— YouTube · How to Get Affordable Health Insurance Before Medicare · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dVy_wz5Ac7pA&lc=UgwMcou1-AaTNPj7HRR4AaABAg.AOfaGIMHv3HAWa_FCE_IT5

Tab 2 — Hopes & Dreams

A plan they can actually use · 10 documents · 10 voices

"Husband brings home \$5400 a month, health insurance costs \$1300...family of 4. What the hell. It was \$900 a month and I already felt like we were being stretched thin. I am a stay at home mom to two young children, daycare cost more than my paycheck, and I didn't have a career worth staying in. My husband and I both intend on picking up a side gig, probably DoorDash or something, just to get by. But how can we ever get ahead if health insurance keeps rising like crazy? My husbands job does offer health insurance but it's basically the same price with a higher deductible. The plan we are looking at on the Marketplace has a \$0 health deductible and a \$1500 drug deductible, with max OOP of \$19500 for my family. His health insurance as a \$6000 deductible per person, \$12000 for family and the max OOP is the same. So really the biggest question is do we want a lower deductible or lower max OOP, since the premiums are roughly the same...and we think we want the lower deductible. If 96K a year isn't enough for a family of 4 in Ohio now....then the middle class is fuckin dead."

— r/HealthInsurance · 664 upvotes · None

"Former employer canceled COBRA health insurance policy without notifying me I just found out my former employer in the state of Washington canceled my COBRA health insurance policy. Not because they notified me, but because my pharmacy called me and said my policy was no longer valid. WTF COBRA is supposed to be valid for 18-36 months and I am fully paid up. I just had major surgery and have PT scheduled in 4 days that has already been deferred for 2 weeks (because I was at my yearly limit of PT) if I don't make the appointment I may never correctly recover and regain full use of my arm. Apparently, my former employer is getting rid of Aetna and getting a new Health Insurance plan from a different provider. So my Aetna policy terminated at the beginning of 2025. Neither my former employer nor Aetna notified me about this, is that even legal? My COBRA provider told me over the phone that my coverage is supposed to switch to the new policy, but my former employer didn't send them the correct documents and that plan is not active for me so now I am stuck with no Health Insurance in need of immediate healthcare. What are my options? UPDATE: I contacted my former employer, who didn't have a good answer for why I wasn't notified. But did state that they had gotten a new health insurance policy with a different company. They then gave me a plan number and group number and told me to use that info to create an account on the website on the new insurance provider. I attempted to do so and the web form said that wasn't a valid policy and refused to let me create an account. After an additional back and forth with HR from my old company they said to call the new Health Insurance provider. So after 30 minutes of being on hold with them, they told me the policy number I had been given was for a different person who happened to have a different first name, same last name, different birthday and different address. Apparently that incorrect info was given to the HR lady at my company by their insurance vendor. After contacting four different companies, and spending more than an hour on the phone I am still without health insurance while needing PT to recover from a major surgery and unable to renew my prescriptions. For those that said this was a simple issue that I could clear up with a quick call to my former employer, I'm calling you on your BS. It's not, and there is incompetence up and down the chain of everyone involved here. FURTHER CONTEXT: I have accepted an offer for a new job (one with better health insurance) and should be starting at the end of the month. I only need my COBRA health plan for another month to get through all the post surgery PT, maybe get a Flu and COVID shot and get my prescriptions for this month. And however long it takes to get the new health insurance actually functional. As such it doesn't feel worth it to sign up for an ACA plan for less than a month of coverage and then have to deal with the overhead of cancelling that plan and setting up another new one. I just want the COBRA coverage they told me would be available for a whole year to actually work. UPDATE 2: I got a different (supposedly correct) policy number from my former employers HR, tried to use that to create an account on Regence's website and it still failed. I called Regence (was on hold for a whole hour) gave them the new policy number and was told over the phone I am actually in their system and I SHOULD have an active policy. I also read back the group # I had been given by HR and found out that was also incorrect (way to go former employer 0/2). I have no way to verify it's functional other than going to PT tomorrow and seeing if they can bill Regence. UPDATE 3: I filled a complaint with the state insurance commissioner, not just for the recent fiasco but also for the situation that caused me to quit my job in the first place where I believe the company may have actually acted illegally. I don't expect anything to come if it but maybe future me will be pleasantly surprised."

— r/HealthInsurance · 273 upvotes · None

"Got Cancer, and Long Time Insurance Dropped Me TLDR: Got cancer, insurance terminated, I don't know what to do. I was diagnosed with cancer in May - Chronic Myeloid Leukemia, which is very treatable with expensive meds, but 100% fatal if not treated. I've had CareFirst Blue Cross Coverage through the VA Marketplace from 2022-present. CareFirst saw my diagnosis, and promptly cancelled my coverage with a technicality. I've been digging through the bureaucracy with no success, and don't know if I have legal options to restore my coverage and resume foregone cancer treatment. On July 1st CareFirst (CF) cancelled my coverage, which I first learned of from my oncologist 23 days after termination was apparently complete. My credit card had a fraudulent charge, so I replaced it in May - but forgot my premium payments were on the card, and my premium payment didn't process in June. I received no notification or calls before the letter from CF dated July 15 (although I didn't open it until later). I overnight mailed a check on July 25, and CareFirst (CF) cashed it July 28th. The VA Marketplace sent a eligibility / reinstatement form on July 24th, which CF told me they would process. The CF agents said it was in processing with the enrollment department. I called a total of 16 times between July 23 and this writing. In the 8th-13th calls to CF agents, they repeated the reenrollment was pending with the enrollment department. In my 14th call, they told me that - actually - I have no enrollment request, and that all of the previous agents were just attaching additional notes on the termination file. All previous agents had made an error, and that I needed to restart with the VA Marketplace. The first 13 calls never even started an appeal or reinstatement request. The CareFirst agent informed me that the only way I can restore coverage is to cancel this and reapply. Finally I unenrolled with my VA State Marketplace and applied to reenroll with my same program. Then they did the first clear and quick response of this whole mess: They immediately denied my reenrollment. This doesn't just mean I lost one insurer- they now made me ineligible for other insurance without a qualifying life event. (I've been employed for 3 years employed with a decent salary by a small non-profit that offers only a health reimbursement, thus the VA Marketplace ACA coverage). I cannot access cancer treatments, and am forgoing care. The list price on the cancer drug I need, at my current pharmacy, is far higher than my salary. I found a discount pharmacy that lowers it to about my salary. I will continue paying some things out of pocket, and skipping others, hoping I survive until I can restart 2026 ACA coverage. CareFirst says they sent me one letter in June, but I never received any such letter. They also acknowledge that their billing department never called, emailed, or made any effort to contact me. They cancelled my care without ever confirming I had any notification. Then they made me run a gauntlet of impenetrable bureaucratic mess through confusion and clear, blatant errors (I don't think their agent confusion was intentional deception - just incompetence). CareFirst found I have an expensive disease, and illegally cancelled my coverage. I am at the end of my rope. I am trying every approach possible to get my coverage and cancer treatment restored. Can anyone advise on my options? I see an option to request a written appeal, but that feels like asking the executioner to reconsider, given that they clearly are not acting in good faith already. I talked with some other insurance providers, and they told me I'd be rejected unless it was a Marketplace (ACA) plan that requires acceptance. I can only imagine a few options: * I vacate my condo and move to Maryland to get a 'qualifying life event'. But for various reasons, that would be really hard to deal with while already fighting cancer and trying to keep up with a demanding job. * I have access to a large press contact list, so I could try emailing my story to ~310 reporters, but I feel like that's more vengeful than productive. And I don't have the mental energy to be fielding a ton of media interviews. * I can also get a lawyer, but I'm not sure how much that would change. I don't want to be fighting this forever, I just want to get my health care and live my life. Any advice, especially ideas specific to Virginia? Edit: corrected 'deductible' to 'premium'. Update: I'm doing well now, no thanks to 'Carefirst' Blue Cross Blue Shield. I paid out of pocket for expensive chemotherapy for little while. I also fought and fought, tried to get a lawyer, and eventually realized they had no chance of ever getting me back onto the plan. Ironically, they tried to keep my premium payment that I sent via overnight cashier's check as soon as I realized there was a gap. But restoring my coverage? They wouldn't dream of it. The only way I could get back on coverage was to get married. That was already in the works, but it accelerated a courthouse elopement before our actual wedding. I'm now on my

spouse's coverage, and I am continuing the medications I need, and am relatively healthy. I also feel more comfortable because if they try to drop again it would need to go through a large employer's HR, so theoretically they can't unilaterally drop me. I don't know if this was convenient incompetence, weaponized incompetence, or just an active, unwritten rule to get drop high cost patients however they can. I just know that CareFirst doesn't care, and the system we have in the US sucks. It's more expensive, less dependable, and more difficult to navigate than any other developed country. Thankfully, I'm no longer one of the people this system is leaving without care, but I'm more convinced than ever that this system is the worst."

— r/HealthInsurance · 119 upvotes · None

"Have used a broker to sign up for the last 2 years - why are his prices higher than the ones listed on the healthcare.gov site? TLDR : the copious info is below but 1) worried a broker is trying to up charge me to sign up through him for 2026 insurance (a more expensive plan I wasn't considering from gov site is actually \$50/month cheaper thru him, the cheaper plan I thought I might pick on the gov site is \$30 more a month from the broker) 2) how can I review the answers I put into my gov 2026 application before I got the info from the insurance broker because I can't seem to find a way to review that on healthcare.gov So..... 2 years ago I signed up through a local insurance broker because I was coming off Medicaid and couldn't get the healthcare.gov website to show me what I'd be getting for a subsidy. I assume it wouldn't give me that info till I was determined ineligible by my states dhhs which is a slow process. I even called them and told them to end my coverage through them on the last day of December hoping that would make it so I was able to see my subsidy but it didn't. So I went through this broker and got signed up cheap (\$45) a month on priority. Last year since he had made the process so painless I went through him again but it went up to \$120 a month which hurt a bit but he had said some program had expired making my insurance more expensive for this past year even tho my income only went up a couple thousand dollars. Looking back now I prob should have delved into that huge increase further. I called him again at the end of October and he said to call him back in a week since he didn't have access to the new numbers yet but after seeing all the people shocked by their increases I decided to fill out an application on healthcare.gov just to see what kind of increase I might be in for. My income also went up so I put in a new estimate (which I don't remember what I put) and if I keep my current plan it will go up to \$215. There's also a cheaper plan I could get instead that will likely fulfill my needs for \$159. The insurance broker sent me an email listing 2 plans neither of which is my current one. It lists one for \$208 but the gov site lists the same plan for \$186. The gov site lists another plan I wasn't even considering due to expense for \$239 but from the broker that same plan is \$183. In order to have complete info I wanted to review my gov application because I don't remember exactly what I put for my income info. For the broker I told him \$28k for the year but I either listed \$28k or \$26,600 on my gov application. I was trying to review my application details again but have been clicking round and round on the gov site and it won't let me review those details anywhere as far as I can see. I need to have those details before I can ask this broker what's up with the different prices and make a selection. Low key worried he may be pulling a fast one on me but I thought these brokers didn't charge for their services (that may have been true under Biden but who knows what rule changes Trump may have made allowing for up charging) Phew, any info appreciated 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · None

"Get government OUT of healthcare and insurance! Back when Obumer first messed with it and caused premiums to start to rise (both ACA and non ACA plans as the new costs for new required benefits, legal and regulatory compliance, etc has to be absorbed via any and all health insurance plans regardless of an ACA plan or not). We went from 3 people being covered on what would be about a "silver" on the ACA or a mid plan was \$238 per month. Today for two people it is over \$1,300 per month and there are areas that are even higher than the state and county / area that we live in. On a per covered basis our health insurance premiums are up 410%. Even a few years ago when we moved from one state to another we paid around \$492 per month....four years later, just over \$1,300. thank you government. Just the insurance premiums and rent (no power, water, food, gas, car insurance or any other expenses) costs me \$40,200 per year and that gets paid with after tax dollars so you do the math. just the fixed cost of a roof and insurance with nothing else and we need to earn around \$47,000 before taxes to cover that. God forbid we want to eat, have car insurance and other insurance, fuel for the car, car repairs, clothing, phone service, etc. Again, great work to the tick in Congress for screwing everyone over rather than just helping the few that need, ACTUALLY need the help. All the fraud out there so far should give everyone some idea of the money we flush down the drain. I wager if it was totaled up it would be around \$500 billion per year or more and that is already after the gubment makes so many other things artificially expensive....college tuition anyone? Nothing my insurance agent loves more than sitting across the table from me as we review the plans that, even after I spend \$16,000 per year on premiums for I still have very high deductibles making it really cost me around \$25,000 before insurance does anything when you add premiums and deductibles together (and no I don't count \$15 off some pharma scrip as mattering). What they need to do is allow, the law prevents this for most people - that's right the government is making it illegal for you to purchase certain types of plans less you fall into a small criteria. what am I ranting about? Disaster style policies. Everyone needs to be able to get those but for most plans you have to be under a certain income or under 30 years of age or just unemployed and need a bridge. My spouse and I don't need all the "benefits" we just want emergency coverage and disease treatment type stuff. There is so much that pad plans, even in hers (and she is almost 50!) still has all this child birthing stuff, breast feeding classes, etc. all for "free" even though she is almost 50 and also can't even have kids in the first place but, same risk pool as everyone else rather than being prices as an individual like with your car insurance."

— YouTube · \$ How MUCH ACA Marketplace PREMIUMS Are Going UP In 2027 · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hOGTkeTtK0Y&lc=UgzNhfDE0RdaDEBn28x4AaABAg>

↳ @bookmark692 (0): "The Messiah picked winners and losers with health insurance. F'D everyone, except the politicians."

"@HowToRetire I agree.Had my " moment of clarity " (I'm Irish)as an RN in Trauma ICU one day ,after a doctor ticked me off. Put in my papers ,retired,called out the last two weeks .Received all my monies due:pension,vacation,sick,comp time,extended illness,and pretax 457 B money. Glad I left,it saved my life.Got myself healthy.Have been receiving my pension since 2014, and claimed Social Security benefits at 62 last year. I was informed that I was missed by former coworkers.It's important to know when it's time to leave as 4 former coworkers died over the last 2 years. I realize I digressed,sorry. The first year post retirement at age 55, my monthly premium was & 663/ month which rose to \$ 677/ month. They wanted to jack it up to \$ 913/month when I turned 58.Went without health insurance for 5 yrs and am fortunate nothing catastrophic happened to me. However ,I used that money saved to get out of debt. I finally obtained a decent premium price for \$ 673/month ,after turning 62 and claiming Social Security. So it's a bit of a hit,but easier to withstand."

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement - Here Are 4 Options · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pjR3wlGOZsc&lc=UgxuDqz0nO2tXhXUNd4AaABAg.9Q3ovSLSXIZ9R1tiYo8C3j>

"Please help! Best insurance in NJ for someone disabled with chronic illness and schizophrenia ASAP!! **NJ FamilyCare, or state Medicaid, is very different from federal Medicaid and I'm looking for people who have understanding of NJ STATE resources rather than federal insurance.** I'm 25F, have a diagnosis of schizoaffective disorder, opioid use disorder on MAT injections and fibromyalgia, and I see multiple providers every month including weekly therapy, bi-weekly medication, zero to 2-3 hospitalizations or inpatient psych treatments a year, monthly suboxone injections, monthly pain management/rheumatology and physical therapy, and like 6-7 monthly medications and bloodwork every 3-6 months for those meds. My insurance migrated to a plan that doesn't have mental health care, so I'm looking for a new insurance on very short notice. I am unemployed and my income is under 23k, but my parents (who make >150k) have agreed to help me financially for the next 6-12 months, so reasonably my budget is a hundred or couple hundred dollars a month. So, I can either go NJ FamilyCare Horizon BCBS, or a private insurance like Aetna PPO or Horizon BCBS PPO or HMO. I have had private, family based top or silver tier PPOs usually Aetna or BCBS sometimes through a third-party employer plan since I was diagnosed years ago, and the provider network is large with the care excellent but it is very expensive, too expensive to reasonably use it the amount I'd like to if money wasn't an issue. Wide network, but extremely pricey, too pricey to fully utilize, and difficult to navigate when claims are denied by the company. Services known as first-line treatments for SMIs such as schizophrenia like ACT, CSC CI and ICMS, case management, day programs or psychiatric rehabilitation are generally off the table and Medicaid/NJFC only. Terrible, TERRIBLE customer service network with no case management, healthcare consolidation, or help when things go wrong with services or coverage and you try to call their phone line. I called a broker through Health Benefits 360 who recommended NJ Family Care as I am in the income bracket and said it's the best fit for my situation with chronic illness, frequent healthcare use, SMI (serious mental illness) and other mental health and substance abuse recovery resources for the most affordable price. However, I've done some research and the network seems much much smaller and I don't know if the quality of these providers is great, good or poor, I had a friend on Medicaid during college who received very poor quality of services, though they were free, and she had chronic conditions, but I don't know if she was on the state or federal coverage. Based on my situation above, can you recommend which insurance would be the best fit for me, even if it's not something that I have mentioned? More than anything, please understand I want to receive good quality care as first priority and have the financial means to not have to compromise on that. It needs to be a widely accepted insurance, either Aetna or BCBS preferably so that my current providers will migrate over, and a plan that CAN be used frequently well and not in a way that rips me off. But in terms of the exact best plan, I could really use some help and ASAP. I need to be ready to switch within this week so that I can start my coverage on October 1st. Also, feel free to recommend websites where I can get connected to a good broker that will help. I need a broker as I am too disabled to complete a long application alone. Specifically, brokers that understand my situation and do both private insurance and Medicaid. COBRA is not an option unless someone knows a cheaper way to receive it. Edit: Just spoke to broker and another option is ObamaCare or ACA-capped insurance. Thank you very much."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · None

"@HowToRetire I had a consultant co-worker who decided not to have health insurance. Then one day he had chest pains and went to the doctor.... OUCH!"

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement - Here Are 4 Options · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pjR3wlGOZsc&lc=UgyOjuOkcaM0z6bK5g94AaABAg.9XwB8pr8CYV9f6AiikU9By>

"The primary drawbacks and problems with ACA plans are: 1. ACA plans are not accepted and the leading cancer centers (MD Anderson) and clinics (Mayo, etc.). 93% of the best clinics and speciality hospitals in the US do not accept any ACA plans --so you better hope you don't get seriously ill and need a leading specialist. 2. The ACA tax credits (subsidies) are subverted in some states by "junk insurance" companies who offer dirt cheap plans with no networks, and tons of limitations, such as Ambetter. If a junk carrier offers a plan for \$300 a month, and everyone else (BCBS, Aetna, etc.) charge \$1200 a month, you will be forced to cover the difference. Most people on the exchange in my state get very little in terms of subsidies because of this. 3. ACA plans have sky-high deductibles"

— YouTube · The Pros and Cons of Obamacare · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-VR66gt_AqA&lc=UgxliwEf_hL9hKKIxG_x4AaABAg

"My income is about 38K and my premiums went from \$30/mo to \$290/mo. I'm in CA. I had to downgrade from the Silver plan to the Bronze plan because I can't afford those premiums. Let's hope I don't need to use it."

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=UgxFOClgepeTH-OzV4J4AaABAg>

↳ @DrJoshGuitar (0): "@Startingoveragain1234 isn't the bronze plan deductible like 4 or 5k per year?"

↳ @HappyonMonday (0): "That's crazy!! At least you can use a HSA with the bronze plan! 😊 "

↳ @HappyonMonday (0): "@DrJoshGuitar It can be!"

Affordable coverage that lets them be self-employed or retire early · 5 documents · 5 voices

"The ACA was not ever intended for early retirement, so the pain of the enhanced subsidies going away is really self inflicted. Having said that I was really hoping the enhanced subsidies would be extended for the current early retirees but also the ACA was my plan. Now I will just think of another way!"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgzNb723lBr-pBKrcyJ4AaABAg

↳ @chrisforker7487 (1): "Or live on less than 85k a year!"

"Unsubsidized Health Insurance Premiums Ramp Up I know I can just change my age on [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) from now until 64 to get this and adjust for inflation, but does anyone know if the unsubsidized health insurance premium "ramp up" rate is available anywhere? I tried to Google it, but couldn't find any information. I'd like to use this information to estimate health insurance premium for the retirement software for scenarios where I continue to work my self-employed job earning way more than the subsidy "cliff" but also being able to contribute more into my retirement accounts, while my husband retires early."

— r/HealthInsurance · 2 upvotes · None

"Another government program that keeps people poor. I know so many people who won't start working full time because it would cost them more in 'benefits' than the increase in hours would gain them. So they just sit there, barely scraping by, sucking off the taxpayer teet for their whole life. I grew up in poverty and the cycle is atrocious. These programs are awful, the ACA is awful, every government program is fraught with fraud. The number of people I know on disability for 'headaches/migraines' and other made up crap is insane. The entire socialist system is godawful. You can try to convince me that I'm wrong, but you won't. I grew up around it and I've seen it my whole life and I decided to get out of that joke of a system. Now I just pay like 40% of my income to support the BS system. I was self employed when the ACA came out and my premium more than tripled. The only positive to the ACA is pre-existing conditions, which could be a standalone law. The health insurance companies benefited, not the people. Even if I do retire early, hell if I want hardworking taxpayers subsidizing my healthcare when I clearly don't need it."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgyqLrllbAGmgEm0rb14AaABAg

">For someone that is working full time for someone else I would love to hear your suggestions on steamrolling one's work to be able to flip from an employee to being a freelancer. Learn and read as much as you can. Ask for training courses, and study heard. Identify the areas and niches you really care about. Look for commonalities between those subjects. WRT healthcare and taxes - I hear you! For the first couple of years, the ACA was a lifeline, as I could get insurance that wasn't exorbitant. But, as income increases, discounts decrease, so now I pay full price through the business. For taxes, to get a60K take home, you'll likely need \$80K to \$85K pre-tax."

— r/freelance · https://www.reddit.com/r/freelance/comments/k06s12/behind_the_scenes_of_a_small_freelance_editing/gdhpkiX/

"I haven't really heard too much about how the ACA works as a freelancer so I would love to learn more + research as much as I can. Also that 80K figure makes sense, I just assume that you get 1/3 of your paycheck taken out for tax purposes anyways. I feel like the longer you stay in the freelance world the more you realize that there are ways to write business expenses off and try to save on as much as you can in taxes."

— r/freelance · https://www.reddit.com/r/freelance/comments/k06s12/behind_the_scenes_of_a_small_freelance_editing/gdhrhuw/

Tab 3 — Relationship Fears

Children and dependents on the plan · 49 documents · 20 voices

"ACA \$1,900 per month on \$5,000 per month income? Is this normal? My husband was laid off last week during the mass tech layoffs. Our insurance was through his company. I own my own business, and net after expenses and taxes \$5,000/month on average. I have variable income. I went onto the ACA marketplace today, entered all of our info, my income, his income zero, our two young children, and I was given a price of \$1,900/month for the cheapest plan with a \$16,000 deductible. How is this affordable on an income of \$5,000? I am not understanding. Should I call? Editing to add that a lot of people responding to my post seem to think I am oblivious to the political situation related to this. Yes, I did write to my representatives weeks ago (but it obviously did nothing because I live in the red state of Kansas. I vote blue and always have because I am a woman who prefers bodily autonomy to the alternative.) I am one person who has zero political power or sway. I am sharing my numbers to see what is happening with others, who are powerless to do anything as well at the federal level to make this better. Just thought I would clarify that for everyone. Also, COBRA for us would be \$3,500/month for a high deductible plan for those who thought this would be a cheaper option."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,646 upvotes · None

"UHC Denial My son was scheduled to have surgery to correct his pectum excavatum in 2022. His surgeon said he met all the medically required criteria. Two days before the surgery UHC denied the surgery. This was incredibly stressful. Apparently their reasoning was that my 22 year old son had 82% lung capacity based upon th tests due this chronic condition and they only approve patients 80% or less. My son was don't worry mom we'll be ok. He is not angry he was just concerned about me. Later that year my husband lost his job and with it UHC medical insurance. My son(student) and I got coverage through the ACA. The next year with his new insurance ,same doctor he was able to get the surgery. We are blessed. However I still feel traumatized every time I think about the denial from UHC. There are probably lots of other people in the same boat as me. Only a patients doctor should be able to make these life altering decisions not insurance companies."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,523 upvotes · None

"My daughter is a surg/tech student. The doctor stuck her with a needle during a procedure. My daughter has insurance but not for that hospital. Now she owes \$1800 for getting treated at the hospital where she got stuck. Not sure what to do. My daughter is a surgical tech student. During one of her procedures in February, the doctor accidentally stuck her with a dirty needle. The doctor told her to go down to the triage so she could get the proper care for sticks, which included a blood test (plus a follow-up test 2 weeks later). My daughter has healthcare thru the government (Obamacare, basically). She got a bill from her teaching hospital for her medical care for \$1800. Her insurance is denying it because she isn't covered at the hospital where she works. What should she do? This is such an unusual situation, and I can't find advice anywhere (other than 'call an attorney', which would cost more than the \$1800). Suggestions? (on a good note, the patient was tested for any diseases and came back clean, so no worries on that front)"

— r/HealthInsurance · 929 upvotes · None

"WOW! Looking at my 2026 insurance, its half my rent! I was covered thru work previously, just looked at 2026 for california with parital subsidy and for a single person, my monthly premium is \$1300! (cheapest was \$1100 - up to \$1800) that's half my already very expensive rent! Estimated income of \$80k Its a hit, but i don't know how people affords this! All the people getting new premiums in the mail in 2 weeks are in for a rude awakening as i was"

— r/HealthInsurance · 777 upvotes · None

"Husband brings home \$5400 a month, health insurance costs \$1300...family of 4. What the hell. It was \$900 a month and I already felt like we were being stretched thin. I am a stay at home mom to two young children, daycare cost more than my paycheck, and I didn't have a career worth staying in. My husband and I both intend on picking up a side gig, probably DoorDash or something, just to get by. But how can we ever get ahead if health insurance keeps rising like crazy? My husbands job does offer health insurance but it's basically the same price with a higher deductible. The plan we are looking at on the Marketplace has a \$0 health deductible and a \$1500 drug deductible, with max OOP of \$19500 for my family. His health insurance as a \$6000 deductible per person, \$12000 for family and the max OOP is the same. So really the biggest question is do we want a lower deductible or lower max OOP, since the premiums are roughly the same...and we think we want the lower deductible. If 96K a year isn't enough for a family of 4 in Ohio now....then the middle class is fuckin dead."

— r/HealthInsurance · 664 upvotes · None

"2026 ACA prices are live on Healthcare.gov. Here's our household's official ACA pricing for next year. **Special disclaimer for 2026: Everything in this post assumes that Congress does not extend the COVID subsidy enhancements and that the default ACA subsidy rules return for 2026.** Anyone can now see the 2026 prices and plans in their area with some anonymous data (age/zip/income/etc) in about three minutes at <https://www.healthcare.gov/see-plans/#/>. If you have a local state-run exchange, then you'll be redirected. State exchanges all update on their own schedule, so 2026 prices may or may not be live just yet. For those who may not be familiar with the ACA, below is an actual real-world example of what being on the ACA can be like with the default subsidy systems. The prices below are for a married couple with an average age of 52 and with MAGI under 133% of the Federal Poverty Level (FPL), which qualifies us for the maximum possible amount of ACA subsidies from both the premium tax credit (PTC) subsidy system and cost-sharing reduction (CSR) subsidy system. We have three dependent children as well, one of which will be on our ACA policy, and we live in a non-expansion state, so expansion Medicaid does not apply to us. Keep in mind that the premiums below would be much higher for a couple if they were in their 60s rather than in their 40s/50s like us. Tobacco users can expect to pay up to 50% additional premium on top of the age-rating. If we were both 62, then the unsubsidized Bronze premium below would rise from \$19,140 to \$27,168. Prices also can vary incredibly between states. If we were both 62 and living in West Virginia instead of Texas, then our Bronze premium would rise from \$27,168 to \$49,584. If instead we were living in Minnesota, then our Bronze premium would fall from \$27,168 to \$21,696. I have also included the policy options we would likely take if we were either eligible only for premium subsidies and not also cost-sharing reductions, as well as the plan we would likely take if we were ineligible for any subsidies at all. People who are over 200% FPL should generally avoid Silver plans due to the way states have elected to deal with the loss of federal funding for the cost-sharing reduction subsidy system, so while I have provided the full market price of our Silver plan, please note that almost nobody would want to ever buy that plan at that price as better Bronze and Gold options are available. ____ Our 2026 Silver plan with subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (based purely on MAGI): * \$84 in annual premium * \$0/\$0 deductible (individual/family) * \$0 PCP * \$10 specialist * \$5 urgent care * \$0/\$15 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$2,200/\$4,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ Our 2026 Silver plan without subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (full market price): * \$26,892 in annual premium * \$6,000/\$12,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$40 PCP * \$80 specialist * \$60 urgent care * \$20/\$40 tier1/tier2 scripts * 40% ER coinsurance * \$8,900/\$17,800 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 Gold plan we would pick if our MAGI was just above 200% FPL (no meaningful CSRs): * \$2,952 in annual premium * \$2,000/\$4,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$30 PCP * \$60 specialist * \$45 urgent care * \$15/\$30 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$8,200/\$16,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 HSA-compatible Bronze plan we would pick if we qualified for zero subsidies/CSRs (MAGI above 400% FPL, factoring in max MAGI-reducing HSA contributions) * \$19,140 in annual premium * \$7,500/\$15,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$50 PCP * \$100 specialist * \$75 urgent care * \$25/\$50 tier1/tier2 scripts * 50% ER coinsurance * \$10,000/\$20,000 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____"

— r/obamacare · 571 upvotes · None

"What you can do if your marketplace premiums for 2026 are too high I've seen this topic come up in recent weeks and want to offer some advice for folks on marketplace plans with premium hikes. This could also work for folks with employer group plans. I realize that this won't work for everyone in every situation but if you've come to a place where you need to consider alternative ways to approach your healthcare costs, this may be helpful. 1. switch to the least expensive marketplace ACA-compliant bronze-level high deductible HSA-eligible insurance plan to cover only catastrophic events like hospitalization. Use this the way you would use your car insurance: sparingly or not at all. Note that going without insurance is a very, very bad idea for reasons that are covered in this sub on a regular basis. 2. Open and contribute to an HSA to get tax savings on money you'll spend toward medical expenses. 3. SKIP DENTAL AND VISION INSURANCE. Honestly this applies to everyone on marketplace plans but dental and vision "insurance" are just glorified payment plans. They are not regulated the same way as ACA health insurance plans so insurers are allowed to charge premiums on those products that guarantee profit margins > 20%. Instead, work with your favorite local dentist and optometrist to pay directly for all your services, and put the money you would have spent on these premiums into your HSA. 4. If you need care: 4a. If you are someone who needs more than 1-3 office visits a year, shop around for a direct primary care provider in your area. Memberships for these are generally pretty reasonable when you factor in what you might have spent toward premiums on a silver or gold tier marketplace plan. 4b. Google specialty care options. For example, Cove offers a monthly membership for treatment of migraines that, when you add it up, is less expensive than a single trip to the neurologist plus a monthly RX from Walgreens. Companies like this exist for nearly everything. 4c. Become a smart shopper for your rxs. There are so many options outside of traditional insurance that can help you save money: GoodRx, Mark Cuban Cost Plus, LillyDirect, Hers/Hims, Nurx. 4d: Think of memberships you may already have that come with pharmacy or healthcare benefits: Costco is an obvious one but comb through other areas of your life. For example, my electric company is a co-op and offers members a discount program for dental, prescriptions, and gym memberships. 4e. Ask your current providers about direct pay arrangements. If you're paying \$200/month in premiums so that your therapist is in-network, but your therapist will happily take \$150 cash per monthly session, you'll come out \$50/month ahead by paying directly. If anyone has other suggestions, because I'm sure I've missed plenty, add them!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 372 upvotes · None

"Turns out my ACA compliant plan is a phantom/shell company Canceling my family health insurance today- turns out it was a total scam Imperial Health Insurance It turns out the insurance provider I have is essentially a ghost network, a shell plan, a phantom policy. 15,000 deductible. Bought through the official marketplace, supposedly fully 'ACA compliant', a bronze plan. First I discovered the doctors that are listed on our cards do not take our insurance. They said I have to call around and try to convince a doctor for husband and I or a pediatrician to take it. NONE have offered or even entertained this. I cannot take my children to get seen at a pediatrician. They both have ADHD. They had ONE provider listed as a child psychiatrist in their network and it essentially does not exist except on a screen. They have three numbers that all route to a voicemail that never calls back. I looked the doctor up and the practice does not exist. The 'cherry on top'? My son broke his arm and they refused to pay for a dime of it because it turns out there are no emergency providers in my county that take our insurance. WTF?! I asked if there were perhaps some in another county? They said no that would be out of network. WTF again?! The hospital/ER took our insurance card and looked at us like we were trying to pull a fast one or something. Like we were presenting a Monopoly or UNO card perhaps. NO medications are covered, except through a supposed online pharmacy that does not answer phones and has a PO Box for a physical address. Why the HELL was I paying \$600 a month for NOTHING? I feel so STUPID. I feel I have failed my family for making such a stupid decision, but I thought it was the RIGHT thing to do. I could've been saving all that and paying out of pocket for services. I want my money back, can I sue them?! TLDR; it turns out my ACA plan is a complete shell plan, a phantom policy, a ghost network that does NOT exist except to collect premiums. Canceling it TODAY. I WISH our employer covered healthcare. Any advice on how to report these fraudsters? It CAN'T be legal what they are doing. It just can't."

— r/HealthInsurance · 299 upvotes · None

"Health Insurance 101 - Start here! Hi All! We've put together the following wiki as an attempt to help out with general questions as we approach open enrollment. Topics: * What is the ACA * What is Open Enrollment? * Why Do We Have Open Enrollment? * Why Do You Need Health Insurance * What is the marketplace? * Who is in my household? * What is the APTC And who is eligible? * What is FPL? * FPL and the APTC * How do I know if my state expanded medicaid? * What happens if I don't enroll in health insurance? * What about the tax penalty? * Let's talk about plan structures * What is a Deductible? * Coinsurance? * Copayment * Out of Pocket Maximum * How to pay for your deductible * Short Term Health Plans **What is the ACA?** The comprehensive health care reform law enacted in March 2010 (sometimes known as ACA, PPACA, or "Obamacare"). The law has 3 primary goals: 1) Make affordable health insurance available to more people. The law provides consumers with subsidies ("premium tax credits") that lower costs for households with incomes between 100% and 400% of the federal poverty level. 2) Expand the Medicaid program to cover all adults with income below 138% of the federal poverty level. (Not all states have expanded their Medicaid programs.) 3) Support innovative medical care delivery methods designed to lower the costs of health care generally. With regard to your employer, if your employer has over 50 employees, they are required to provide you compliant insurance that meets Minimum Essential Coverage and Minimum Value standards. Your employer also must subsidize at least 50% of the premium to enroll the employees. **What is Open Enrollment?** <https://www.healthcare.gov/quick-guide/dates-and-deadlines> <https://www.healthcare.gov/glossary/open-enrollment-period/> The yearly period when people can enroll in a health insurance plan. Open Enrollment for 2021 runs from November 1 through December 15, 2020. Insurance plans elected during Open Enrollment will start as early as Jan 1, 2021. Outside the Open Enrollment Period, you generally can enroll in a health insurance plan only if you qualify for a Special Enrollment Period. You're eligible if you have certain life events, like getting married, having a baby, or losing other health coverage. The follow states have permanently adopted expanded enrollment periods: California: November 1 to January 31 Colorado: November 1 to January 15 District of Columbia: November 1 to January 31 Massachusetts: November 1, 2020 to January 23, 2021. Minnesota: November 1 to December 22, 2020. New Jersey: November 1, 2020 to January 31, 2021. New York: November 1, 2020 to January 31, 2021. Nevada: November 1, 2020, to January 15, 2021. Pennsylvania: November 1, 2020, to January 15, 2021 Rhode Island: November 1, 2020 to January 23, 2021. Washington: November 1, 2020, to January 15, 2021. **Why do we have Open Enrollment (OE)?** OE is designed for anyone eligible to purchase on the marketplace to make their elections for 2021. With the introduction of the ACA legislation, you cannot buy insurance whenever you want – this prevents people from enrolling only when they know they need the health insurance, which drives up prices for everyone. **Why do you need health insurance?** Medical costs are the leading cause for bankruptcy in the US, and everyone is always healthy until they are not. By enrolling in an ACA compliant healthcare plan, you receive the benefits of a provider network, contracted negotiated rates on services, an out of pocket max which caps your personal spending each year, and other state/federal protections on your healthcare experience. **What is the marketplace and who can use it?** Any US citizen or qualifying immigration status (<https://www.healthcare.gov/immigrants/immigration-status/>) may purchase off of the marketplace, even if you have employer insurance. **Who is in my Household?** Household = you, spouse, tax dependents. It is not necessarily who you physically live with. **What is the APTC and who is eligible?** The APTC stands for Advanced Premium Tax Credit and is a subsidy provided to people with incomes between 100 – 400% FPL if your state has not expanded Medicaid or 138 – 400% FPL if your state has expanded Medicaid. You are eligible for the APTC if your income falls in this range and you have no employer insurance available. If you are Medicaid eligible, you should apply there as you will not qualify for the APTC; however, you are welcome to purchase a full price marketplace plan instead if you prefer. **What is FPL?** A measure of income issued every year by the Department of Health and Human Services (HHS). Federal poverty levels are used to determine your eligibility for certain programs and benefits, including savings on Marketplace health insurance, and Medicaid and CHIP coverage. The 2020 federal poverty level (FPL) income numbers below are used to calculate eligibility for Medicaid and the Children's Health Insurance

Program (CHIP). Household Size 100% 138% 250% 400% Income ranges: \$12,760-\$17,609 | \$31,900-\$51,040 | \$17,240-\$23,792 | \$43,100-\$68,960 | \$21,720-\$29,974 | \$54,300-\$86,880 | \$26,200-\$36,156 | \$65,500-\$104,800 | \$30,680-\$42,339 | \$76,700-\$122,720 | \$35,160-\$48,521 | \$87,900-\$140,640

FPL and the APTC: Income between 100% and 400% FPL: If your income is in this range, in all states you qualify for premium tax credits that lower your monthly premium for a Marketplace health insurance plan. Income below 138% FPL: If your income is below 138% FPL and your state has expanded Medicaid coverage, you qualify for Medicaid based only on your income. Income below 100% FPL: If your income falls below 100% FPL, you probably won't qualify for savings on a Marketplace health insurance plan or for income-based Medicaid. "Income" above refers to "modified adjusted gross income" (MAGI). For most people, it's the same or very similar to "adjusted gross income" (AGI). MAGI isn't a number on your tax return. If your income is between 100%/138% to 250%, you may qualify for additional Cost Saving Reduction credits if you enroll in a Silver Tier plan.

How do I know if my state expanded medicaid? To date, 39 states (including DC) have adopted the Medicaid expansion and 12 states have not adopted the expansion. The following states have not adopted a Medicaid expansion: Wyoming, South Dakota, Wisconsin, Kansas, Texas, Tennessee, North Carolina, South Carolina, Georgia, Alabama, Missouri, Florida.

***Special notes:**
 Wisconsin: Although Wisconsin has not expanded Medicaid under the guidelines laid out in the Affordable Care Act (ACA), the state's Medicaid program (which is called BadgerCare) does cover all legally present residents with incomes under the poverty level. Wisconsin is the only non-Medicaid-expansion state that does not have a coverage gap; all low-income residents either have access to Medicaid or subsidies to help them purchase private coverage in the exchange.
 Missouri: Missouri voters approved a ballot measure on August 4, 2020 which adds Medicaid expansion to the state's constitution. The amendment requires the state to submit all SPAs necessary to implement expansion to CMS no later than March 1, 2021 and for expansion coverage to begin July 1, 2021. Language in the amendment prohibits the imposition of any additional burdens or restrictions on eligibility or enrollment for the expansion population.
 Oklahoma: Oklahoma voters approved a ballot measure on June 30, 2020 which adds Medicaid expansion to the state's Constitution. The amendment requires the Oklahoma Health Care Authority to submit a SPA and other necessary documents to CMS within 90 days of the ballot measure's approval, and for expansion coverage to begin no later than July 1, 2021. Language in the approved measure prohibits the imposition of any additional burdens or restrictions on eligibility or enrollment for the expansion population.

What happens if I don't enroll in a plan during open enrollment? If you don't enroll in an ACA-compliant health insurance plan by the end of open enrollment (December 15 in most states), your buying options will likely be very limited for the coming year. Open enrollment won't come around again until November 2021, with coverage effective the first of the following year. But depending on the circumstances, you might still be able to get coverage after open enrollment ends: * Medicaid and CHIP enrollment are available year-round for those who qualify. * Native Americans can enroll year-round * Special enrollment period if you have a qualifying event

What about the tax penalty? There is no federal government penalty for being uninsured in 2021. People who are uninsured will not face a penalty, unless they're in a state that has its own individual mandate and a penalty for non-compliance. Four states and DC impose tax penalties for not having h"

— r/HealthInsurance · 269 upvotes · None

"Insurance carriers increased rates on ACA plans with based off the expectation of lower enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are put back in, what happens to the now jacked up rates that were already approved by states and sold during open-enrollment? Carriers have increased full cost rates ahead of schedule because they expect a drop in enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are reinstated, what happens to the already inflated rates? Each insurance carrier must get its rate increase approved by the state annually, often months before open enrollment. This year, carriers justified rate hikes primarily by citing: 1. Lower projected enrollment numbers due to expiring ACA subsidies 2. The rising cost of GLP-1 weight loss drugs (even though most ACA marketplace plans don't cover these) I'm re-emphasizing because I fear people will still confuse the question. I am not talking about increases people are seeing based off loss of their personal subsidy, I am talking about the plan's actual cost. Aka, what someone would pay if they didn't receive subsidy. My state approved my insurance company for a 27% increase for 2026. They have again applied that increase disproportionately, increasing the individual plans more than their group plans. My personal non-subsidized cheapest HSA eligible ACA plan went up 40% on just the premium, with increases in the cost-sharing amounts as well. This is about average across my local market. Their group rate plans only went up by single digit amounts. Even if the government reinstates subsidies, I'm not hearing anyone addressing the issue of rate increases that relied on inaccurate enrollment projections. Open enrollment has already begun. Will these companies be forced to rework their approved plans retroactively? Are we going to get refunds? I don't see it happening. If they don't, the insurance companies will profit even more from this political situation. This event has allowed them to quickly raise plan costs beyond their actual expenses. If it's too late for 2026, what's the chances they'll actually lower rates even for 2027?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 229 upvotes · None

"My employer dropped me from health insurance About a year and a half ago I became eligible for health insurance at my new job (one of the reasons I accepted position was for the benefits). After about a month or so of coverage I was asked to come in for a meeting. Our insurance broker was there along with the director of operations. The broker explained that if I continued coverage my coworker's premiums would go up so high that no one could afford them. He said that they could no longer cover me and he would send in someone to help me sign up for coverage on the marketplace (which someone did). I questioned if all this was legal and was told that because their policy is under-written then, yes, it is legal for them to drop me. I should also add that I am a breast cancer survivor. I still get preventative treatment monthly at a local cancer center. It was after the first claim was submitted by the center that this all went down. Was this legal?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 206 upvotes · None

"HDHPs suck if you actually need them. Because our subsidy expired, we are now paying \$1200 a month for 2 people for a bronze plan with an \$8000 deductible per person. CO, both 52, \$160k income. We went from \$1200 buying us great gold coverage to \$1200 and paying for our own care literally overnight. As it happens, for a bit of uterine bleeding, I actually need the insurance this year. All of the procedures I need – ultrasound, biopsy, and hysteroscopy – are subject to the deductible. And after the deductible, they're only covered at 40% by Select Health. What kind of insurance is this? We're basically paying high premiums for the privilege of paying for our own healthcare. This was the cheapest Obamacare option we could find. Where are all the HDHPs with lower premiums? We worked with a broker, and there weren't any. The contract company that employs my husband had an HDHP where the premium was even higher. At these prices, we can't even afford to fund an HSA. We didn't see any HDHPs on the exchange with premium is less than \$1000 a month. How are people affording this? HDHPs are not a bargain anymore, it seems. We make well over six figures, but since so much of our income is going to healthcare premiums, we have to drain our savings over any healthcare we need. And if you have HDHP insurance, you can't even pay a lower cash price to the facility. You have to pay the higher insurance negotiated price, even if you're paying 100% of the cost. And if I want sedation for these procedures (don't even get me started about how painful in office gynecology is), it's even more expensive. So basically, anything between a well-woman visit (free) and cancer (chemo meets that deductible pretty quick) is going to give you medical debt. This is indescribably unbelievable. Wow, this sucks."

— r/HealthInsurance · 199 upvotes · None

"Health insurance will cost us almost \$18,000 this year. Please help! My job offers insurance via Aetna and I found out today it's going up again, to almost \$1500/mo for just me, my husband, and my infant. And they already cover 75% of my personal plan, the rest is the family portion. The problem is my husband is self-employed and receives no tax credits or help in the marketplace because a plan is offered through my work. The cheapest crappy plan wouldn't save us all that much, if he were to go get his own plan and leave me and the baby on my work plan. I don't know what to do. That's crippling, it costs more than our mortgage. Should I go down to part time and sacrifice my other job benefits so I'm "no longer eligible" and we can try to get credits/cheaper plan? Do I go without insurance and try to save the money to "cash price" at the doctor? My husband owns a small business so it's not as simple as him just getting another job for the insurance. I have to make a decision in the next two days and I'm so stressed. Location : Georgia, USA Income : \$90,000 UPDATE : if anyone would like an update - we got our health insurance cost down, thankfully. The insurance broker we were working with wasn't as helpful as I expected and told us to mark "no" for tax credits/subsidies. When I did more research (thanks everyone), if it was over 9% of our income, we were eligible for about \$350 credit plus a cheaper plan. When I reached out to the broker to confirm she acted like she didn't realize we'd be eligible 😊 It's only going to cost a little over half what we were looking at after our applications. Moral of the story - do your own research."

— r/HealthInsurance · 165 upvotes · None

"Help! Husband lost his job and we can't afford insurance through my employer! UPDATE: It is MUCH less expensive to insure all 3 of us instead of just me and my daughter through the marketplace! I can get insurance for all 3 for closer to 450 a month by adding him on the policy. Who knew? Thank you everyone for your suggestions! My husband lost his job yesterday. Our insurance will end on April 1. We are both 44 and we have a 13 year old daughter. He starts his new job next week BUT his new employer will not offer any benefits assistance. We live in Missouri. I checked with my employer and it will cost 840 a month on our plan. I tried Healthcare.gov and it was going to be 930 for the cheapest plan (for just me and my daughter, my husband is going to go without insurance. We are not eligible for Medicaid. Where can we find affordable insurance?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 159 upvotes · None

"The "Medicaid Gap" is a joke. For context, I live in Mississippi. (And honestly that should already tell you everything you need to know.) (And yes, I already posted this but I didn't realized the rant/vent flair would lock the comments. Whoops! So let's try this again) For the past two years, I've been able to get an affordable marketplace plan with Ambetter. It was the first time I was able to get health insurance since I got knocked off my dad's when I turned 26. (I'm now 31) Without this insurance, I wouldn't have been able to get diagnosed with ADHD, get help with my anxiety and depression, treat my Hypothyroidism and Anemia. Like this has been life changing for me. I work for a small business and unfortunately, I didn't make enough money in 2025 to qualify for the tax credit towards insurance premiums like I have the past couple of years. Which means I'm now expected to pay \$650 every single month for health insurance as a single person with no children. I'm absolutely not doing that because that's not something I can afford. And because Mississippi hates poor people (despite us being the poorest state in the country, but yknow whatever I guess), I now fall into the "Medicaid Gap" as if I was ever eligible for Medicaid in the first place. And because of that, it doesn't seem like there's any kind of affordable options. God forbid we expand Medicaid so the poor people can get health care. GOD FORBID. Luckily it seems like I'll at least be able to continue to afford my thyroid medicine and antidepressants still since I was already on the generic. (Ambetter fully covered Generic and GoodRx says between those two, it shouldn't be too much out of pocket.) But now I won't be able to afford my ADHD medicine and my mental health appointments where I also get my antidepressants and it just fucking sucks, man. I just feel so defeated. I was finally taking better care of myself and now it's about to come to a screeching halt. Anyway, thanks for listening to me vent. I know I'm not the only one in this situation. I'm just hoping something changes for us in the future.



— r/HealthInsurance · 138 upvotes · None

"My healthcare.gov insurance went from \$120 a month in 2025 to \$340 in 2026 because I got a \$1/hour raise... what do I do? 27F, entry level job after graduating college, trying to buy a house and start a family. Bit of a rant here... You saw the title. My healthcare.gov insurance went from \$120 a month in 2025 to \$340 in 2026 because I got a \$1/hour raise. I am flabbergasted. I can't afford to pay over \$200/month more for my health insurance because I make an extra \$160/month?!?! In what world does that make sense?! There is a PCP in my area that does not take insurance, but provides most of the services I require for a \$90/month subscription. It's what I want to go with. They suggested I go with a catastrophic health plan in case of car wreck, etc. He said it should be about \$90/month. When I researched catastrophic health plans, the lowest premium is over \$200/month. I can't afford this AND pay rent AND pay car payment AND pay car insurance AND pay all my other bills AND save money for house/ children/ emergencies. It's safe to say I'm panicking. I payed the insurance for January but I couldn't save anything. I can't keep this plan. I'm currently feeling very defeated by a system that seems to be set up to keep the majority down... I'm so tired of this. Where is universal healthcare? What should I do? Where can I find a catastrophic health plan for around \$100 a month?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 137 upvotes · None

"Got Cancer, and Long Time Insurance Dropped Me TLDR: Got cancer, insurance terminated, I don't know what to do. I was diagnosed with cancer in May - Chronic Myeloid Leukemia, which is very treatable with expensive meds, but 100% fatal if not treated. I've had CareFirst Blue Cross Coverage through the VA Marketplace from 2022-present. CareFirst saw my diagnosis, and promptly cancelled my coverage with a technicality. I've been digging through the bureaucracy with no success, and don't know if I have legal options to restore my coverage and resume foregone cancer treatment. On July 1st CareFirst (CF) cancelled my coverage, which I first learned of from my oncologist 23 days after termination was apparently complete. My credit card had a fraudulent charge, so I replaced it in May - but forgot my premium payments were on the card, and my premium payment didn't process in June. I received no notification or calls before the letter from CF dated July 15 (although I didn't open it until later). I overnight mailed a check on July 25, and CareFirst (CF) cashed it July 28th. The VA Marketplace sent a eligibility / reinstatement form on July 24th, which CF told me they would process. The CF agents said it was in processing with the enrollment department. I called a total of 16 times between July 23 and this writing. In the 8th-13th calls to CF agents, they repeated the reenrollment was pending with the enrollment department. In my 14th call, they told me that - actually - I have no enrollment request, and that all of the previous agents were just attaching additional notes on the termination file. All previous agents had made an error, and that I needed to restart with the VA Marketplace. The first 13 calls never even started an appeal or reinstatement request. The CareFirst agent informed me that the only way I can restore coverage is to cancel this and reapply. Finally I unenrolled with my VA State Marketplace and applied to reenroll with my same program. Then they did the first clear and quick response of this whole mess: They immediately denied my reenrollment. This doesn't just mean I lost one insurer- they now made me ineligible for other insurance without a qualifying life event. (I've been employed for 3 years employed with a decent salary by a small non-profit that offers only a health reimbursement, thus the VA Marketplace ACA coverage). I cannot access cancer treatments, and am forgoing care. The list price on the cancer drug I need, at my current pharmacy, is far higher than my salary. I found a discount pharmacy that lowers it to about my salary. I will continue paying some things out of pocket, and skipping others, hoping I survive until I can restart 2026 ACA coverage. CareFirst says they sent me one letter in June, but I never received any such letter. They also acknowledge that their billing department never called, emailed, or made any effort to contact me. They cancelled my care without ever confirming I had any notification. Then they made me run a gauntlet of impenetrable bureaucratic mess through confusion and clear, blatant errors (I don't think their agent confusion was intentional deception - just incompetence). CareFirst found I have an expensive disease, and illegally cancelled my coverage. I am at the end of my rope. I am trying every approach possible to get my coverage and cancer treatment restored. Can anyone advise on my options? I see an option to request a written appeal, but that feels like asking the executioner to reconsider, given that they clearly are not acting in good faith already. I talked with some other insurance providers, and they told me I'd be rejected unless it was a Marketplace (ACA) plan that requires acceptance. I can only imagine a few options: * I vacate my condo and move to Maryland to get a 'qualifying life event'. But for various reasons, that would be really hard to deal with while already fighting cancer and trying to keep up with a demanding job. * I have access to a large press contact list, so I could try emailing my story to ~310 reporters, but I feel like that's more vengeful than productive. And I don't have the mental energy to be fielding a ton of media interviews. * I can also get a lawyer, but I'm not sure how much that would change. I don't want to be fighting this forever, I just want to get my health care and live my life. Any advice, especially ideas specific to Virginia? Edit: corrected 'deductible' to 'premium'. Update: I'm doing well now, no thanks to 'Carefirst' Blue Cross Blue Shield. I paid out of pocket for expensive chemotherapy for little while. I also fought and fought, tried to get a lawyer, and eventually realized they had no chance of ever getting me back onto the plan. Ironically, they tried to keep my premium payment that I sent via overnight cashier's check as soon as I realized there was a gap. But restoring my coverage? They wouldn't dream of it. The only way I could get back on coverage was to get married. That was already in the works, but it accelerated a courthouse elopement before our actual wedding. I'm now on my

spouse's coverage, and I am continuing the medications I need, and am relatively healthy. I also feel more comfortable because if they try to drop again it would need to go through a large employer's HR, so theoretically they can't unilaterally drop me. I don't know if this was convenient incompetence, weaponized incompetence, or just an active, unwritten rule to get drop high cost patients however they can. I just know that CareFirst doesn't care, and the system we have in the US sucks. It's more expensive, less dependable, and more difficult to navigate than any other developed country. Thankfully, I'm no longer one of the people this system is leaving without care, but I'm more convinced than ever that this system is the worst."

— r/HealthInsurance · 119 upvotes · None

"My employer fired me after I challenged them of taking me off the health care insurance Hey everyone. I don't normally post stuff like this, but this whole situation has been insane and I could really use some outside perspective. I also want people to know how easily something like this can happen to them and the. The outcome of having health issues later. I worked for a company called Diamond Blade Warehouse (main office in Vernon Hills, IL, with multiple locations around the country). I was with them for almost three years. I left a different job to work there because I thought it'd be a good fit. Like any job, there were parts I liked good people on the sales side, some solid customers, but behind the curtain, it was a mess. I was a commission-based W-2 employee, meaning if I didn't hit commissions, I didn't get paid. No hourly, no base, no nothing. Just straight commission on a W-2... which already didn't sit right, but I needed the income. Earlier this year, out of nowhere, I was told I'd be switched to 1099. No paperwork, no conversation, no explanation. Just "you're 1099. "They just wanted the "benefits" of a contractor without actually making me one. Then on September 3rd, 2025, I got an email from accounting saying my health insurance coverage would end because they weren't applying my wages to the premium anymore. I replied, politely, that I wanted to keep my coverage and would pay out of pocket. I even jokingly said " I think you'd have to fire me to take away my benefits like that." Within ONE HOUR, my company email was disabled and I got a text message saying I was being terminated for "low sales." Convenient timing, right? And here's where it gets even worse. That same day, the COBRA plan administrator sent me a COBRA election notice that looked like it was printed off Google Images, wrong dates, wrong termination info, wrong deadlines. I tried responding, but their spam blocker was set so strict that my replies bounced. I literally had to switch email accounts just to contact them. They sent me a second COBRA notice the same day, also wrong. I asked for a corrected one and the administrator replied in ALL CAPS, basically yelling at me, demanding multiple months of payment upfront... even though the dates were wrong. Instead of fixing the spam blocker so I could communicate normally, management started relaying messages through my sales manager via text. It was like a weird game of corporate telephone. Completely unprofessional and honestly, absolutely ridiculous. Then comes the cherry on top: Months earlier, my manager texted me saying that the CFO, Bronwyn Jacobson, "didn't want me on the company's insurance" and was sweating him about it. In mid-August, she asked again if it was "ok to take me off." I never agreed. Two weeks later... terminated. I've already filed a complaint with the U.S. Department of Labor (EBSA) for COBRA violations, ERISA interference, retaliation, and misclassification. They're reviewing everything. I'm physically exhausted, financially strained, and emotionally worn down from dealing with this, but I'm speaking up because people deserve to know what companies pull when they think no one's looking. If any Redditors have advice, legal, emotional, or just practical, on navigating this, please drop it below. And if anyone's been through something similar, you're not alone. This one messed me up, and I don't want it happening to someone else."

— r/HealthInsurance · 105 upvotes · None

"A positive anecdote of using American/ACA health insurance We often hear mostly negative things regarding US health insurance online, particularly in regards to the ACA, so I thought I'd offer up a positive personal experience. Our daughter met with her new rheumatologist less than two weeks ago. Today we got the approval authorization for a year of her biologic infusion, which is off-formulary and medical exemption only. No arguing post-denial or justification to get insurance to pony up for an expensive drug that could easily make us net loss customers for them. Copay program from the manufacturer should bring our out-of-pocket cost down to \$0, but even without it our script-biased insurance would hold the drug copay to just \$300/year. This is also with a new insurer starting as a brand new patient. Took one week for her to get in to see her new PCP, took a few days for the referral to process, then three weeks for her to see the rheumatologist. This insurer and policy are also the absolute cheapest Silver in our market, meaning premium cost is significantly lower than even the benchmark plan. I appreciate more and more each year just how good of a healthcare/ACA market Austin has ended up being. Wife and I both needed to find a new PCP this year too due to switching insurance carriers and it only took a few weeks for us to get in as new patients. I hear people talk all the time about waiting months in other markets. Our new PCP was lovely too and didn't rush our new patient appointments at all despite us not really needing anything other than to establish service."

— r/obamacare · 46 upvotes · None

"No longer eligible for medicaid I've (26m) had illinois medicaid for the past 3/4ish years. My redetermination period was to be completed by Aug 2025. I've submitted the redetermination letter through mail last month and called the automated number today to check the status for them to tell my benefits have ended because of exceeding income. I've always done the medicaid application/redetermination including my parents in my household with their income (retirement, neither of them work anymore). Prior to this year, only my father had income through retirement. However, this/last year my mother also started getting retirement benefits which apparently pushed the household income past the medicaid income cap for 3 people. So now I am no longer eligible for medicaid. Have I been fucking up this whole time when doing the redetermination including them in my household? They don't have to file taxes because their total income from unemployment benefits is still low enough where they don't have to so I'm not claimed as a dependent or anything. What do I do moving forward? Do I start an entirely new application on the website with only my information and none of my parents'? Or am I screwed now and have to buy health insurance through marketplace now? Edit: Thanks for the replies/help; I'll reapply without their information. Also, I guess I didn't really specify my financial situation in the original post like I thought I did. I left my job a couple months prior to this whole thing. I then moved back in with my parents shortly after and have been living very modestly though my savings. I don't have an income as of this very moment."

— r/Medicaid · 30 upvotes · None

A spouse's job, health or income deciding the coverage · 37 documents · 20 voices

"UHC Denial My son was scheduled to have surgery to correct his pectum excavatum in 2022. His surgeon said he met all the medically required criteria. Two days before the surgery UHC denied the surgery. This was incredibly stressful. Apparently their reasoning was that my 22 year old son had 82% lung capacity based upon th tests due this chronic condition and they only approve patients 80% or less. My son was don't worry mom we'll be ok. He is not angry he was just concerned about me. Later that year my husband lost his job and with it UHC medical insurance. My son(student) and I got coverage through the ACA. The next year with his new insurance ,same doctor he was able to get the surgery. We are blessed. However I still feel traumatized every time I think about the denial from UHC. There are probably lots of other people in the same boat as me. Only a patients doctor should be able to make these life altering decisions not insurance companies."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,523 upvotes · None

"Husband brings home \$5400 a month, health insurance costs \$1300...family of 4. What the hell. It was \$900 a month and I already felt like we were being stretched thin. I am a stay at home mom to two young children, daycare cost more than my paycheck, and I didn't have a career worth staying in. My husband and I both intend on picking up a side gig, probably DoorDash or something, just to get by. But how can we ever get ahead if health insurance keeps rising like crazy? My husbands job does offer health insurance but it's basically the same price with a higher deductible. The plan we are looking at on the Marketplace has a \$0 health deductible and a \$1500 drug deductible, with max OOP of \$19500 for my family. His health insurance as a \$6000 deductible per person, \$12000 for family and the max OOP is the same. So really the biggest question is do we want a lower deductible or lower max OOP, since the premiums are roughly the same...and we think we want the lower deductible. If 96K a year isn't enough for a family of 4 in Ohio now....then the middle class is fuckin dead."

— r/HealthInsurance · 664 upvotes · None

"Just looked at ACA premiums for 2026. There's no way. My husband (28m) and I (26f) are opting to go without health insurance at this time. If by some miracle the federal government decides to extend tax credits in 2026, then we will reconsider, but with the current outlook for premiums we just can't do it. I feel like crying honestly. We both work so hard and make fine money for our age and where we live. But between a mortgage we were forced into entering (long story, had to do with a landlord going bankrupt) and just general expenses, we can't afford even a base insurance plan. The lowest we were eligible for was \$650 a month and a \$20,000 deductible. The math just doesn't work. I see everyone raising alarm bells about going without insurance, having something catastrophic happen, and then going bankrupt. But honestly? Bankruptcy doesn't sound that bad comparatively. We'd go bankrupt with or without health insurance with those deductibles. I'm trying to have a positive outlook here, and I was really banking on being able to get us a catastrophic plan, but even that is not financially feasible for us. I am honestly in disbelief at the way healthcare in this country is handled. I can't even imagine how it is for people who have it so much worse than us."

— r/HealthInsurance · 660 upvotes · None

"Someone please explain why I (or anyone) should pay a premium that costs more than the oop max The maths aren't mathing. Someone help me understand what I am missing here. We live in NY. I am a self-employed general contractor. Wife is an attorney and recently left her job to open her own firm so we lost great health insurance through her previous employer. Cobra would cost us around \$7k/ month for 2 healthy adults and our 8yo healthy son. Now we're shopping on the marketplace in what appears to be the worst time in history to be doing so. We make too much for any subsidies, so a silver plan is coming in around \$3k/month. Catastrophic is coming in around \$750/month. After a lot of research I can't understand why I would buy anything other than catastrophic. All ACA plans include the same preventive care at no cost. All ACA plans have the same out of pocket maximum limit. Aside from a catastrophe, we would maybe spend \$1k/ year at most seeking care that isn't covered under ACA preventive care. So why would I pay \$36k/year for a silver plan when I could just buy catastrophic for 1/4 the price and pay out of pocket for everything else, knowing I have the same oop cap as the silver \$36k/year plan?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 577 upvotes · None

"Please explain the Vance/Oz announcement yesterday about 700,000+ people being kicked off ACA Since my husband and I will need an ACA plan starting January, to bridge us from current expensive ex-employer COBRA to Medicare in November 2027. What the hell do they mean, people who never made a claim are being cancelled? It's literally the entire model insurance runs on: people paying their premiums but not needing to make claims! - that's the money needed to pay for the really expensive patients and of course to pay the C-suite execs and investors. Does anybody here have more information or insight into this latest news?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 409 upvotes · None

"Health Insurance 101 - Start here! Hi All! We've put together the following wiki as an attempt to help out with general questions as we approach open enrollment. Topics: * What is the ACA * What is Open Enrollment? * Why Do We Have Open Enrollment? * Why Do You Need Health Insurance * What is the marketplace? * Who is in my household? * What is the APTC And who is eligible? * What is FPL? * FPL and the APTC * How do I know if my state expanded medicaid? * What happens if I don't enroll in health insurance? * What about the tax penalty? * Let's talk about plan structures * What is a Deductible? * Coinsurance? * Copayment * Out of Pocket Maximum * How to pay for your deductible * Short Term Health Plans

What is the ACA? The comprehensive health care reform law enacted in March 2010 (sometimes known as ACA, PPACA, or "Obamacare"). The law has 3 primary goals: 1) Make affordable health insurance available to more people. The law provides consumers with subsidies ("premium tax credits") that lower costs for households with incomes between 100% and 400% of the federal poverty level. 2) Expand the Medicaid program to cover all adults with income below 138% of the federal poverty level. (Not all states have expanded their Medicaid programs.) 3) Support innovative medical care delivery methods designed to lower the costs of health care generally. With regard to your employer, if your employer has over 50 employees, they are required to provide you compliant insurance that meets Minimum Essential Coverage and Minimum Value standards. Your employer also must subsidize at least 50% of the premium to enroll the employees.

What is Open Enrollment? <https://www.healthcare.gov/quick-guide/dates-and-deadlines> <https://www.healthcare.gov/glossary/open-enrollment-period/> The yearly period when people can enroll in a health insurance plan. Open Enrollment for 2021 runs from November 1 through December 15, 2020. Insurance plans elected during Open Enrollment will start as early as Jan 1, 2021. Outside the Open Enrollment Period, you generally can enroll in a health insurance plan only if you qualify for a Special Enrollment Period. You're eligible if you have certain life events, like getting married, having a baby, or losing other health coverage. The follow states have permanently adopted expanded enrollment periods: California: November 1 to January 31 Colorado: November 1 to January 15 District of Columbia: November 1 to January 31 Massachusetts: November 1, 2020 to January 23, 2021. Minnesota: November 1 to December 22, 2020. New Jersey: November 1, 2020 to January 31, 2021. New York: November 1, 2020 to January 31, 2021. Nevada: November 1, 2020, to January 15, 2021. Pennsylvania: November 1, 2020, to January 15, 2021 Rhode Island: November 1, 2020 to January 23, 2021. Washington: November 1, 2020, to January 15, 2021.

Why do we have Open Enrollment (OE)? OE is designed for anyone eligible to purchase on the marketplace to make their elections for 2021. With the introduction of the ACA legislation, you cannot buy insurance whenever you want – this prevents people from enrolling only when they know they need the health insurance, which drives up prices for everyone.

Why do you need health insurance? Medical costs are the leading cause for bankruptcy in the US, and everyone is always healthy until they are not. By enrolling in an ACA compliant healthcare plan, you receive the benefits of a provider network, contracted negotiated rates on services, an out of pocket max which caps your personal spending each year, and other state/federal protections on your healthcare experience.

What is the marketplace and who can use it? Any US citizen or qualifying immigration status (<https://www.healthcare.gov/immigrants/immigration-status/>) may purchase off of the marketplace, even if you have employer insurance.

Who is in my Household? Household = you, spouse, tax dependents. It is not necessarily who you physically live with.

What is the APTC and who is eligible? The APTC stands for Advanced Premium Tax Credit and is a subsidy provided to people with incomes between 100 – 400% FPL if your state has not expanded Medicaid or 138 – 400% FPL if your state has expanded Medicaid. You are eligible for the APTC if your income falls in this range and you have no employer insurance available. If you are Medicaid eligible, you should apply there as you will not qualify for the APTC; however, you are welcome to purchase a full price marketplace plan instead if you prefer.

What is FPL? A measure of income issued every year by the Department of Health and Human Services (HHS). Federal poverty levels are used to determine your eligibility for certain programs and benefits, including savings on Marketplace health insurance, and Medicaid and CHIP coverage. The 2020 federal poverty level (FPL) income numbers below are used to calculate eligibility for Medicaid and the Children's Health Insurance

Program (CHIP). Household Size 100% 138% 250% 400% Income ranges: \$12,760-\$17,609 | \$31,900-\$51,040 | \$17,240-\$23,792 | \$43,100-\$68,960 | \$21,720-\$29,974 | \$54,300-\$86,880 | \$26,200-\$36,156 | \$65,500-\$104,800 | \$30,680-\$42,339 | \$76,700-\$122,720 | \$35,160-\$48,521 | \$87,900-\$140,640

FPL and the APTC: Income between 100% and 400% FPL: If your income is in this range, in all states you qualify for premium tax credits that lower your monthly premium for a Marketplace health insurance plan. Income below 138% FPL: If your income is below 138% FPL and your state has expanded Medicaid coverage, you qualify for Medicaid based only on your income. Income below 100% FPL: If your income falls below 100% FPL, you probably won't qualify for savings on a Marketplace health insurance plan or for income-based Medicaid. "Income" above refers to "modified adjusted gross income" (MAGI). For most people, it's the same or very similar to "adjusted gross income" (AGI). MAGI isn't a number on your tax return. If your income is between 100%/138% to 250%, you may qualify for additional Cost Saving Reduction credits if you enroll in a Silver Tier plan.

How do I know if my state expanded medicaid? To date, 39 states (including DC) have adopted the Medicaid expansion and 12 states have not adopted the expansion. The following states have not adopted a Medicaid expansion: Wyoming, South Dakota, Wisconsin, Kansas, Texas, Tennessee, North Carolina, South Carolina, Georgia, Alabama, Missouri, Florida.

***Special notes:**

- Wisconsin: Although Wisconsin has not expanded Medicaid under the guidelines laid out in the Affordable Care Act (ACA), the state's Medicaid program (which is called BadgerCare) does cover all legally present residents with incomes under the poverty level. Wisconsin is the only non-Medicaid-expansion state that does not have a coverage gap; all low-income residents either have access to Medicaid or subsidies to help them purchase private coverage in the exchange.
- Missouri: Missouri voters approved a ballot measure on August 4, 2020 which adds Medicaid expansion to the state's constitution. The amendment requires the state to submit all SPAs necessary to implement expansion to CMS no later than March 1, 2021 and for expansion coverage to begin July 1, 2021. Language in the amendment prohibits the imposition of any additional burdens or restrictions on eligibility or enrollment for the expansion population.
- Oklahoma: Oklahoma voters approved a ballot measure on June 30, 2020 which adds Medicaid expansion to the state's Constitution. The amendment requires the Oklahoma Health Care Authority to submit a SPA and other necessary documents to CMS within 90 days of the ballot measure's approval, and for expansion coverage to begin no later than July 1, 2021. Language in the approved measure prohibits the imposition of any additional burdens or restrictions on eligibility or enrollment for the expansion population.

What happens if I don't enroll in a plan during open enrollment? If you don't enroll in an ACA-compliant health insurance plan by the end of open enrollment (December 15 in most states), your buying options will likely be very limited for the coming year. Open enrollment won't come around again until November 2021, with coverage effective the first of the following year. But depending on the circumstances, you might still be able to get coverage after open enrollment ends:

- * Medicaid and CHIP enrollment are available year-round for those who qualify.
- * Native Americans can enroll year-round
- * Special enrollment period if you have a qualifying event

What about the tax penalty? There is no federal government penalty for being uninsured in 2021. People who are uninsured will not face a penalty, unless they're in a state that has its own individual mandate and a penalty for non-compliance. Four states and DC impose tax penalties for not having h

— r/HealthInsurance · 269 upvotes · None

"Health insurance will cost us almost \$18,000 this year. Please help! My job offers insurance via Aetna and I found out today it's going up again, to almost \$1500/mo for just me, my husband, and my infant. And they already cover 75% of my personal plan, the rest is the family portion. The problem is my husband is self-employed and receives no tax credits or help in the marketplace because a plan is offered through my work. The cheapest crappy plan wouldn't save us all that much, if he were to go get his own plan and leave me and the baby on my work plan. I don't know what to do. That's crippling, it costs more than our mortgage. Should I go down to part time and sacrifice my other job benefits so I'm "no longer eligible" and we can try to get credits/cheaper plan? Do I go without insurance and try to save the money to "cash price" at the doctor? My husband owns a small business so it's not as simple as him just getting another job for the insurance. I have to make a decision in the next two days and I'm so stressed. Location : Georgia, USA Income : \$90,000 UPDATE : if anyone would like an update - we got our health insurance cost down, thankfully. The insurance broker we were working with wasn't as helpful as I expected and told us to mark "no" for tax credits/subsidies. When I did more research (thanks everyone), if it was over 9% of our income, we were eligible for about \$350 credit plus a cheaper plan. When I reached out to the broker to confirm she acted like she didn't realize we'd be eligible 😬 It's only going to cost a little over half what we were looking at after our applications. Moral of the story - do your own research."

— r/HealthInsurance · 165 upvotes · None

"Help! Husband lost his job and we can't afford insurance through my employer! UPDATE: It is MUCH less expensive to insure all 3 of us instead of just me and my daughter through the marketplace! I can get insurance for all 3 for closer to 450 a month by adding him on the policy. Who knew? Thank you everyone for your suggestions! My husband lost his job yesterday. Our insurance will end on April 1. We are both 44 and we have a 13 year old daughter. He starts his new job next week BUT his new employer will not offer any benefits assistance. We live in Missouri. I checked with my employer and it will cost 840 a month on our plan. I tried Healthcare.gov and it was going to be 930 for the cheapest plan (for just me and my daughter, my husband is going to go without insurance. We are not eligible for Medicaid. Where can we find affordable insurance?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 159 upvotes · None

"A positive anecdote of using American/ACA health insurance We often hear mostly negative things regarding US health insurance online, particularly in regards to the ACA, so I thought I'd offer up a positive personal experience. Our daughter met with her new rheumatologist less than two weeks ago. Today we got the approval authorization for a year of her biologic infusion, which is off-formulary and medical exemption only. No arguing post-denial or justification to get insurance to pony up for an expensive drug that could easily make us net loss customers for them. Copay program from the manufacturer should bring our out-of-pocket cost down to \$0, but even without it our script-biased insurance would hold the drug copay to just \$300/year. This is also with a new insurer starting as a brand new patient. Took one week for her to get in to see her new PCP, took a few days for the referral to process, then three weeks for her to see the rheumatologist. This insurer and policy are also the absolute cheapest Silver in our market, meaning premium cost is significantly lower than even the benchmark plan. I appreciate more and more each year just how good of a healthcare/ACA market Austin has ended up being. Wife and I both needed to find a new PCP this year too due to switching insurance carriers and it only took a few weeks for us to get in as new patients. I hear people talk all the time about waiting months in other markets. Our new PCP was lovely too and didn't rush our new patient appointments at all despite us not really needing anything other than to establish service."

— r/obamacare · 46 upvotes · None

"Suggestions for ACA shopping: My process 2026 will be the third year my husband and I are on an ACA plan and the first year without enhanced subsidies. Because of ongoing marketplace changes, we will also be changing insurance companies for the third year in a row. I wanted to share my process for shopping in case this is helpful. I've done most of my research through Health Sherpa and some through healthcare.gov since window shopping opened. 1. After opening the portal, make a list in a notebook of insurance companies in your zip code. 2. Input your list of providers (and hospitals, if you want) into the website, which will then tell you who's in which plan. 3. Go back to your written list and write down which of your providers are contracted with each company. If you don't want to switch providers, you'll likely cross some plans off the list based on their networks. 4. Now go back to the portal and start sorting by whatever is most important to you - lowest premium, lowest deductible, etc. I find it helpful to only look at one insurance company at a time and sort by premium. I was able to eliminate more companies because their lowest premiums were too high. 5. Also look at star ratings. I wasn't going to choose a plan with only two stars. (I'm looking at you, Molina!) 6. Keep jotting down notes on insurance companies - not enough providers, premiums too high, low ratings, this one looks good, etc. 7. If you find a company that looks promising, run some comparisons. Health Sherpa allows you to compare up to, I believe, four plans at a time. Print out those reports, usually just a page or two. 8. Rinse and repeat for any other insurance companies that look promising. 9. Review your printouts, marking important details on each comparison report with a highlighter. 10. Jot down any more notes in your notebook - "four star ratings, but OOP max is high," etc. 11. At this point, you can hopefully narrow it down to one or two companies. 12. Go back to the most promising plans within your top two insurance companies. Look up the summary of benefits and coverage for each plan. You can print them, download them or both. These will provide you with additional details beyond what the "plan details" pages show. I suggest you also print out those plan details as well. 13. Bonus round: You can also input your medications to see what's covered. 14. At this point, a few plans should rise to the top. Then you can start weighing differences in premiums, deductibles, copays, OOP max, etc. I hope this helps! Within about 90 minutes, I was able to narrow down our options to three plans within a single company. Now we just need to choose a particular plan."

— r/obamacare · 34 upvotes · None

"As a 59 years old retiree, I pay \$2264 per month for COBRA health insurance for me and my wife. I just checked ACA rates for us, it was over \$1000 per month more. I don't qualify for subsidies. Something is wrong with the ACA when its so much more costly without government subsidies."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 29 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgzxjuSyfTqcBbN1kp4AaABAg

↳ @beautyandplay (3): "probably better with private plans."

↳ @nata3467 (0): "how much are you and your wife making ?"

↳ @acevers (0): "That's because you were a productive person before retirement. Only bums and disabled people get deals and freebies, and your taxes pay for it. Sucks."

"Insurance Bill I Never Signed Up For So I just did my 2025 taxes, and when I first submitted them they got rejected for not including a 1095. I have insurance through my husband's job so this was weird, but I did check my Marketplace eligibility but never signed up for a plan. I ended up including a letter in my taxes that said I checked my eligibility but did not receive coverage from the marketplace. Fast forward to last night. I went to dinner with my mom and she brought me some mail I got from her house. They were bills and delinquency notices from the insurance company Ambetter. Somehow I was signed up for this insurance and these bills were sent to my mom's house, I have not lived there for 6 years. I did some googling and I'm not the only person that has been signed up for insurance without my consent. My question is what the hell do I do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 27 upvotes · None

"Does choosing not to renew marketplace coverage count as a QLE for joining my wife's employer plan outside of open enrollment? My wife's job is a small business that offers a subsidized plan for employees and children of employees. They offer a plan for spouses as well, but it isn't subsidized, so in the past it has been a little more expensive than what I can find on the marketplace. Her open enrollment is in October and when I saw prices this year I assumed I would still be able to find it cheaper through the marketplace. However, marketplace prices were higher this time, but I didn't discover this until after open enrollment closed through her employer. So now I'm trying to figure out if choosing not to renew my marketplace plan would qualify me for a special enrollment period through her employer. I know many of the answers will be "you need to talk to her employer," which unfortunately is easier said than done. Since it is a small business, there is no HR department, there is only her boss (the general manager and one of the owners), and in the past her boss has dragged her feet on answering any insurance related questions until we were practically begging her to reach out to her agent the day before my daughter was going to lose coverage. So I'm trying to avoid asking her boss unless I absolutely need to. It is a BCBS of TN plan if that helps answer my question."

— r/HealthInsurance · 20 upvotes · None

"Oscar health: who TF are they I'm in Missouri, had CVS Aetna through marketplace, they pulled out of the state and was auto switched to Oscar Gold EPO for 2026 if I want. Premium is about the same as my old plan but higher deductible and max oop. Never heard of Oscar, from what I gathered they are a tech forward company, and I'd have access to 24/7 telehealth. Anyone have experience with them? I'm self employed and so is wife, I don't use any of the credits as I did that one year and had to pay it all back, I hate this time of year and always end up fighting with the wife over this shit. Any information would be appreciated."

— r/HealthInsurance · 14 upvotes · None

"Looking to possibly leave my job to start an in home daycare with my wife. The plan is to have my wife start off first while I still work and analyze if the income coming in makes sense and if leaving my current position will boost our income if I help her full time by bringing in more children. The only way I leave is if we work numbers and the amount at the end of every month is more than what I am making right now at a steady consistent rate. The biggest fear factor I have is that I have health/dental/vision insurance for all of my family. Leaving hurts my gut because while I was shopping around for healthcare for my family the least expensive one I found was around 805/month and that was just for HEALTH insurance."

— YouTube · Health Insurance Options for the Self Employed or Are Leaving Your Job · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ceyE3F7SK1k&lc=UgwaUBI9OyGnjyDellN4AaABAg>

↳ @MaximizingEcommerce (3): "Thank you for sharing your story. Depending on your beliefs (and health background), you may want to look into a cost sharing ministry as opposed to traditional health insurance. Regarding the risk, the question I would ask myself in your shoes is whether or not this opens doors to potentially additional profit/income opportunities..."

↳ @thehealthinsuranceguide (0): "Hi Manchester - How is the home daycare working out? Depending on your situation now (since it has been two years) your options may vary, and yes, health coverage can be pricey on the private side compared to a company plan that pays a lot of the cost for you. First check would be to see if you'd qualify for a significant subsidy. If not, or the subsidy is minimal, I'd check out the private underwritten plans. There are a couple that are available with lower premiums and better benefits because you have to be healthy enough to qualify to get on them. Did you get the health coverage all figured out? What did you end up going with?"

"I am retiring in Jan 2027 from a long career in Nursing. I will be 60 yrs old , I plan to use the ACA also. My husband will be 66 so he'll just switch from my insurance to Medicare. Can't wait! Only 3 months and 16 days left! But who's counting 😊 "

— YouTube · How We Get ACA Health Insurance Before Age 65? · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xVHorMHIYeM&lc=UgzFTra6Yla0rRPEE-N4AaABAg.AazcOMGavnUAb-1TK0Di1d>

"If he's losing 1800 because he hasn't filed yet and he didn't pay what he should for the plan he had, then that's on him. He needed to update his plan. Did he think it was free?! He got insurance. He ostensibly used insurance. If he wanted to cancel it, he could have done that. Up to him. I mean, if they're gonna complain, then they're going to complain, but auto-renewal is pretty standard for ACA plans - My own did it and I had to walk that back myself when we got our work-based plan again. Also, because I am a small business owner and my husband was the one who qualified us for special enrollment, we got a subsidy that we shouldn't have had because I wrote the entire premium off our taxes while we had the plan. It was awkward, but I couldn't do anything to turn down the subsidy on our marketplace. It's just something I knew was coming. Between that and a large-ish annuity withdrawal that we made because of our addition, our tax bill was just about as expected, and it's not losing money - it's paying money we owed but had no other way to pay or even know how much we were paying until now."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1c7go61/possible_complaint_being_filed_against_me/l096mdw/

"Unsubsidized Health Insurance Premiums Ramp Up I know I can just change my age on [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) from now until 64 to get this and adjust for inflation, but does anyone know if the unsubsidized health insurance premium "ramp up" rate is available anywhere? I tried to Google it, but couldn't find any information. I'd like to use this information to estimate health insurance premium for the retirement software for scenarios where I continue to work my self-employed job earning way more than the subsidy "cliff" but also being able to contribute more into my retirement accounts, while my husband retires early."

— r/HealthInsurance · 2 upvotes · None

"I am self-employed and we just lost the insurance that we had through my husband's work because he's gonna work for a business full-time. It does not make sense to get insurance by our self cobra is out of the question it's outrageous and we are a family of three we have a daughter that's in college and we told them we wanted insurance that was comparable to what we had which was United healthcare and it was a PPO, which was pretty decent insurance. The only thing I could find that was even close to that was gonna run us \$2200 a month! That is just asinine. We have decided to go without insurance and pay our Dr. bills as we go."

— YouTube · How to Get Health Insurance When Self-Employed · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G eUdFzjUKcw&lc=UgxMbjRicce5YKnjQNR4AaABAq>

"I see people talking about HSA in the comments what is that? Is that a health savings plan for mostly PPO insured? If so how would I get on that plan. Currently at a job that makes me unhappy and I'm not fulfilled. Ready to spread my wings but my husband is so worried about me leaving because he got really sick one day. And I have great health insurance now. I work for a hospital now. I live in LA. I want you to do a video about ministry healthy insurance I want to learn more about it. This video really sparked my interest thanks so much."

— YouTube · Health Insurance Options for the Self Employed or Are Leaving Your Job · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ceyE3F7SK1k&lc=UgxHHhLR3Eg0RMRaqzZ4AaABAq>

↳ @MaximizingEcommerce (0): "HSA is healthcare spending account. It has tax benefits. There are some key stipulations and only goes with certain types of plans. Best to talk to an agent and/or your accountant."

Parents or relatives they help with coverage · 13 documents · 13 voices

"UHC Denial My son was scheduled to have surgery to correct his pectum excavatum in 2022. His surgeon said he met all the medically required criteria. Two days before the surgery UHC denied the surgery. This was incredibly stressful. Apparently their reasoning was that my 22 year old son had 82% lung capacity based upon th tests due this chronic condition and they only approve patients 80% or less. My son was don't worry mom we'll be ok. He is not angry he was just concerned about me. Later that year my husband lost his job and with it UHC medical insurance. My son(student) and I got coverage through the ACA. The next year with his new insurance ,same doctor he was able to get the surgery. We are blessed. However I still feel traumatized every time I think about the denial from UHC. There are probably lots of other people in the same boat as me. Only a patients doctor should be able to make these life altering decisions not insurance companies."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,523 upvotes · None

"ACA Subsidies ending Hey all, my mom is losing her insurance at the end of 2025 due to the new bill ending ACA subsidies, raising her monthly payments from \$500 to \$1300 if she loses all the subsidies, which she cannot afford, she can't really afford to lose any of it. Does anyone have any suggestions or weird loopholes on what to do? For some context we are all born in the U.S., we live in Texas, she is in her 50s and is divorced from my father, income less than 62k"

— r/HealthInsurance · 531 upvotes · None

"Former employer canceled COBRA health insurance policy without notifying me I just found out my former employer in the state of Washington canceled my COBRA health insurance policy. Not because they notified me, but because my pharmacy called me and said my policy was no longer valid. WTF COBRA is supposed to be valid for 18-36 months and I am fully paid up. I just had major surgery and have PT scheduled in 4 days that has already been deferred for 2 weeks (because I was at my yearly limit of PT) if I don't make the appointment I may never correctly recover and regain full use of my arm. Apparently, my former employer is getting rid of Aetna and getting a new Health Insurance plan from a different provider. So my Aetna policy terminated at the beginning of 2025. Neither my former employer nor Aetna notified me about this, is that even legal? My COBRA provider told me over the phone that my coverage is supposed to switch to the new policy, but my former employer didn't send them the correct documents and that plan is not active for me so now I am stuck with no Health Insurance in need of immediate healthcare. What are my options? UPDATE: I contacted my former employer, who didn't have a good answer for why I wasn't notified. But did state that they had gotten a new health insurance policy with a different company. They then gave me a plan number and group number and told me to use that info to create an account on the website on the new insurance provider. I attempted to do so and the web form said that wasn't a valid policy and refused to let me create an account. After an additional back and forth with HR from my old company they said to call the new Health Insurance provider. So after 30 minutes of being on hold with them, they told me the policy number I had been given was for a different person who happened to have a different first name, same last name, different birthday and different address. Apparently that incorrect info was given to the HR lady at my company by their insurance vendor. After contacting four different companies, and spending more than an hour on the phone I am still without health insurance while needing PT to recover from a major surgery and unable to renew my prescriptions. For those that said this was a simple issue that I could clear up with a quick call to my former employer, I'm calling you on your BS. It's not, and there is incompetence up and down the chain of everyone involved here. FURTHER CONTEXT: I have accepted an offer for a new job (one with better health insurance) and should be starting at the end of the month. I only need my COBRA health plan for another month to get through all the post surgery PT, maybe get a Flu and COVID shot and get my prescriptions for this month. And however long it takes to get the new health insurance actually functional. As such it doesn't feel worth it to sign up for an ACA plan for less than a month of coverage and then have to deal with the overhead of cancelling that plan and setting up another new one. I just want the COBRA coverage they told me would be available for a whole year to actually work. UPDATE 2: I got a different (supposedly correct) policy number from my former employers HR, tried to use that to create an account on Regence's website and it still failed. I called Regence (was on hold for a whole hour) gave them the new policy number and was told over the phone I am actually in their system and I SHOULD have an active policy. I also read back the group # I had been given by HR and found out that was also incorrect (way to go former employer 0/2). I have no way to verify it's functional other than going to PT tomorrow and seeing if they can bill Regence. UPDATE 3: I filled a complaint with the state insurance commissioner, not just for the recent fiasco but also for the situation that caused me to quit my job in the first place where I believe the company may have actually acted illegally. I don't expect anything to come if it but maybe future me will be pleasantly surprised."

— r/HealthInsurance · 273 upvotes · None

"The "Medicaid Gap" is a joke. For context, I live in Mississippi. (And honestly that should already tell you everything you need to know.) (And yes, I already posted this but I didn't realized the rant/vent flair would lock the comments. Whoops! So let's try this again) For the past two years, I've been able to get an affordable marketplace plan with Ambetter. It was the first time I was able to get health insurance since I got knocked off my dad's when I turned 26. (I'm now 31) Without this insurance, I wouldn't have been able to get diagnosed with ADHD, get help with my anxiety and depression, treat my Hypothyroidism and Anemia. Like this has been life changing for me. I work for a small business and unfortunately, I didn't make enough money in 2025 to qualify for the tax credit towards insurance premiums like I have the past couple of years. Which means I'm now expected to pay \$650 every single month for health insurance as a single person with no children. I'm absolutely not doing that because that's not something I can afford. And because Mississippi hates poor people (despite us being the poorest state in the country, but yknow whatever I guess), I now fall into the "Medicaid Gap" as if I was ever eligible for Medicaid in the first place. And because of that, it doesn't seem like there's any kind of affordable options. God forbid we expand Medicaid so the poor people can get health care. GOD FORBID. Luckily it seems like I'll at least be able to continue to afford my thyroid medicine and antidepressants still since I was already on the generic. (Ambetter fully covered Generic and GoodRx says between those two, it shouldn't be too much out of pocket.) But now I won't be able to afford my ADHD medicine and my mental health appointments where I also get my antidepressants and it just fucking sucks, man. I just feel so defeated. I was finally taking better care of myself and now it's about to come to a screeching halt. Anyway, thanks for listening to me vent. I know I'm not the only one in this situation. I'm just hoping something changes for us in the future.



— r/HealthInsurance · 138 upvotes · None

"How is anyone able to afford ACA marketplace insurance currently? I'm 25, I'll be aging out of my parent's health insurance in April 2027, so I've been doing my research on ACA Marketplace plans in case I'll have to apply for it. I've been trying to look for a full-time job with benefits for quite a while but the job market is so bad right now for everyone. It has me wondering how are others getting by at all? Layoffs are happening in the thousands at every company and sector so lots of people are off their employer's coverage. And ACA monthly premiums are so high with deductibles nearing 10K just for a single individual. Plus im sure others have additional monthly payments to cover like cars, groceries, and mortgages. How is ANYONE able to pay for the marketplace currently? Are people just rawdogging it and hoping nothing bad happens? Will marketplace premiums go down?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 125 upvotes · None

"Turning 26, being dropped coverage and can't do State Medicaid I'm turning 26 years old, and I'm being dropped from my parent's health plan. I live in PA and have no income. I'm still in Medical School for 1 more year, and they offer no SHIP/healthcare plans of their own. I qualify for PA State Medicaid, but I will be doing several out of state hospital rotations, and they will not accept that I only have a State Medicaid. What are my options? I went to HealthCare.gov, and as soon as I say I have no income, all they do is redirect me to sign up with State Medicaid?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 44 upvotes · None

"Insurance Bill I Never Signed Up For So I just did my 2025 taxes, and when I first submitted them they got rejected for not including a 1095. I have insurance through my husband's job so this was weird, but I did check my Marketplace eligibility but never signed up for a plan. I ended up including a letter in my taxes that said I checked my eligibility but did not receive coverage from the marketplace. Fast forward to last night. I went to dinner with my mom and she brought me some mail I got from her house. They were bills and delinquency notices from the insurance company Ambetter. Somehow I was signed up for this insurance and these bills were sent to my mom's house, I have not lived there for 6 years. I did some googling and I'm not the only person that has been signed up for insurance without my consent. My question is what the hell do I do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 27 upvotes · None

"Need clarification on underestimating income I plan on enrolling my mother in law for 2026 but not sure how to approach her income. I had spoken to broker and I was informed she should show 22k before deductions to get tax credit for 2026. Before I was able to show her income as 2400 a year and get the aca credits. I read posts saying that the repayments of credits are for those who overestimate income not underestimate. Also read the other way around. If I were to sign her up saying her income projected is 22k but let's say at end of 2026 it's 3k. Since the income was underestimated will she need to payback the subsidies? she doesn't qualify for medicaid because she been in USA 2.5 years and you need to be living 5 years to qualify for that"

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · None

"I'm an early retiree and HAD a great plan, until my Mom passed away. She had a chunk of money in Traditional IRA/401k which became an Inherited IRA for me. The "Secure Act" requiring this to be liquidated within 10 yrs along with annual RMD, was not part of my plan. To add, at the 10yr mark I will hit 64, so all the added MAGI will take place prior to Medicare. So now it's a decision between 3 paths 1) Liquidate it all in 1yr. Major tax and health insurance hit for that year. But could keep low ACA for (or even Medicaid) the remaining years. Additional bonus is growth after move (if simply doing "in kind" move for liquidation) is now capital gains instead of income. Also taking it early minimizes likelihood of having IRMA for 2 yrs once on Medicare. 2) Spread it out over remaining years, being careful to not hit the ACA cliff. Will still pay more for ACA, but keeps taxes on Inherited IRA in lower brackets. 3) Some combo of the above. Especially since ACA and Healthcare options may change over the next 8 years. Of course my Roth conversion plans are on hold as of now."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgzszM-kZkW4HY0w2Ox4AaABAq

"Need help understanding ACA Subsidies My parents immigrated to nj a few months ago and I am trying to buy some insurance for them, they will have cash jobs and will be filing tax returns. One broker told me the horizon bronze is about 2300 per month and another one said 55 per month Oscar. And my understanding is Trump has taken away the subsidies, so how can it be \$55 per month. Too good to be true. Can anyone help explain?"

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · None

".... I'm trying very hard not to erupt. 20k. I assume that your husband's plan is an employer plan based on how you framed this. So they are also paying thousands. I guess maybe it is reasonable if you have 50 kids. You do have 50 kids don't you? My ACA which is a decent hmo is \$6k a year for just me. Deductible is 12k and I can reasonably expect to hit it every year. After MUCH consternation they couldn't find a way to avoid paying for an rx for me that runs about 90k a year. I was on it with great results keeping me out of the hospital (mostly) for a year. Then they decided they approved it by mistake and canceled the approval. I got really sick after that and wound up hospitalized repeatedly which they paid tens of thousands for. So that was dumb. My dr did not like seeing me hospitalized repeatedly just to prove to insurance I'm sick so he started giving me pharma samples. We did that for 6 months. So 45k of shots. Eventually the rep said they couldn't keep doing it, which was my greatest fear. I knew it would happen I just didn't know when. It took another few months to get approved for the pharma's 'charity' program. So now they give me the drug for free. I live in constant fear of losing access. There is something very strange that I experienced when they first yanked the approvals where I knew I was going to get very sick and there was not much I could do because the drug was out of reach. I was literally planning to be much sicker. Family wants to see me for Tday and I'm like, well I'm probably going to be a whole lot sicker then, probably not doable to get on a plane. I don't spend much time feeling sorry for myself but I ABSOLUTELY think about a parent that has a child that needs a drug they simply can't afford, and so instead having to watch them struggle. The drug exists. We paid to develop it with tax dollars. We sell it abroad at a competitive price. But it's too expensive for a child in the US to benefit. This disgusts me. At some point, we will decide we have had enough of this system. But I wish we were a lot closer to that point than I think we are."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1jkr7v3/health_insurance_will_cost_us_almost_18000_this/mjzd9dd/

"I've gotten 400 calls and texts in a week. And thats for fake insurance. Not ACA Iowa. I've been unemployed to take care of my sick dad. I'm 59 I never thought I wouldn't be not not get a job I guess I won't get insurance and use Good RX for my meds. I'm literally crying and devastated. Ageism it real. The non ACA is still \$500 plus most of medication not covered. MY doctors wont accept non ACA ll the way. I don't trust non ACA. I'm gonna have a heart attack if i can't find a web site where I don't get 40 calls and texts. I've been on cobra \$1000 per month so burnt \$18k I'm healthy."

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=UgzSolhmdmdGTu0UPvF4AaABAq>

↳ @HappyonMonday (0): "I'm so sorry you are going through this! If you go through an agent it might work better."

"It's not Obamacare it's healthcare.gov in case someone is trying to search for it If you're getting on it for the first time I would go through the phone rather than use the computer. Less confusing. My sister, who was born with health issues, was going to be unable to qualify for any medical insurance until healthcare.gov came around. I'm sure she'd be dead by now It's not perfect but it's better than things were. I get \$900 a month from healthcare.gov. making my insurance only \$485 a month"

— r/Obamacare · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lgmq56/you_will_kill_me_disabled_people_c_all_bs_on/mz8wavm/

Tab 4 — Relationship Soundbites

'Use a broker, it costs nothing' · 7 documents · 7 voices

"Health insurance will cost us almost \$18,000 this year. Please help! My job offers insurance via Aetna and I found out today it's going up again, to almost \$1500/mo for just me, my husband, and my infant. And they already cover 75% of my personal plan, the rest is the family portion. The problem is my husband is self-employed and receives no tax credits or help in the marketplace because a plan is offered through my work. The cheapest crappy plan wouldn't save us all that much, if he were to go get his own plan and leave me and the baby on my work plan. I don't know what to do. That's crippling, it costs more than our mortgage. Should I go down to part time and sacrifice my other job benefits so I'm "no longer eligible" and we can try to get credits/cheaper plan? Do I go without insurance and try to save the money to "cash price" at the doctor? My husband owns a small business so it's not as simple as him just getting another job for the insurance. I have to make a decision in the next two days and I'm so stressed. Location : Georgia, USA Income : \$90,000 UPDATE : if anyone would like an update - we got our health insurance cost down, thankfully. The insurance broker we were working with wasn't as helpful as I expected and told us to mark "no" for tax credits/subsidies. When I did more research (thanks everyone), if it was over 9% of our income, we were eligible for about \$350 credit plus a cheaper plan. When I reached out to the broker to confirm she acted like she didn't realize we'd be eligible 🙄 It's only going to cost a little over half what we were looking at after our applications. Moral of the story - do your own research."

— r/HealthInsurance · 165 upvotes · None

"Got Cancer, and Long Time Insurance Dropped Me TLDR: Got cancer, insurance terminated, I don't know what to do. I was diagnosed with cancer in May - Chronic Myeloid Leukemia, which is very treatable with expensive meds, but 100% fatal if not treated. I've had CareFirst Blue Cross Coverage through the VA Marketplace from 2022-present. CareFirst saw my diagnosis, and promptly cancelled my coverage with a technicality. I've been digging through the bureaucracy with no success, and don't know if I have legal options to restore my coverage and resume foregone cancer treatment. On July 1st CareFirst (CF) cancelled my coverage, which I first learned of from my oncologist 23 days after termination was apparently complete. My credit card had a fraudulent charge, so I replaced it in May - but forgot my premium payments were on the card, and my premium payment didn't process in June. I received no notification or calls before the letter from CF dated July 15 (although I didn't open it until later). I overnight mailed a check on July 25, and CareFirst (CF) cashed it July 28th. The VA Marketplace sent a eligibility / reinstatement form on July 24th, which CF told me they would process. The CF agents said it was in processing with the enrollment department. I called a total of 16 times between July 23 and this writing. In the 8th-13th calls to CF agents, they repeated the reenrollment was pending with the enrollment department. In my 14th call, they told me that - actually - I have no enrollment request, and that all of the previous agents were just attaching additional notes on the termination file. All previous agents had made an error, and that I needed to restart with the VA Marketplace. The first 13 calls never even started an appeal or reinstatement request. The CareFirst agent informed me that the only way I can restore coverage is to cancel this and reapply. Finally I unenrolled with my VA State Marketplace and applied to reenroll with my same program. Then they did the first clear and quick response of this whole mess: They immediately denied my reenrollment. This doesn't just mean I lost one insurer- they now made me ineligible for other insurance without a qualifying life event. (I've been employed for 3 years employed with a decent salary by a small non-profit that offers only a health reimbursement, thus the VA Marketplace ACA coverage). I cannot access cancer treatments, and am forgoing care. The list price on the cancer drug I need, at my current pharmacy, is far higher than my salary. I found a discount pharmacy that lowers it to about my salary. I will continue paying some things out of pocket, and skipping others, hoping I survive until I can restart 2026 ACA coverage. CareFirst says they sent me one letter in June, but I never received any such letter. They also acknowledge that their billing department never called, emailed, or made any effort to contact me. They cancelled my care without ever confirming I had any notification. Then they made me run a gauntlet of impenetrable bureaucratic mess through confusion and clear, blatant errors (I don't think their agent confusion was intentional deception - just incompetence). CareFirst found I have an expensive disease, and illegally cancelled my coverage. I am at the end of my rope. I am trying every approach possible to get my coverage and cancer treatment restored. Can anyone advise on my options? I see an option to request a written appeal, but that feels like asking the executioner to reconsider, given that they clearly are not acting in good faith already. I talked with some other insurance providers, and they told me I'd be rejected unless it was a Marketplace (ACA) plan that requires acceptance. I can only imagine a few options: * I vacate my condo and move to Maryland to get a 'qualifying life event'. But for various reasons, that would be really hard to deal with while already fighting cancer and trying to keep up with a demanding job. * I have access to a large press contact list, so I could try emailing my story to ~310 reporters, but I feel like that's more vengeful than productive. And I don't have the mental energy to be fielding a ton of media interviews. * I can also get a lawyer, but I'm not sure how much that would change. I don't want to be fighting this forever, I just want to get my health care and live my life. Any advice, especially ideas specific to Virginia? Edit: corrected 'deductible' to 'premium'. Update: I'm doing well now, no thanks to 'Carefirst' Blue Cross Blue Shield. I paid out of pocket for expensive chemotherapy for little while. I also fought and fought, tried to get a lawyer, and eventually realized they had no chance of ever getting me back onto the plan. Ironically, they tried to keep my premium payment that I sent via overnight cashier's check as soon as I realized there was a gap. But restoring my coverage? They wouldn't dream of it. The only way I could get back on coverage was to get married. That was already in the works, but it accelerated a courthouse elopement before our actual wedding. I'm now on my

spouse's coverage, and I am continuing the medications I need, and am relatively healthy. I also feel more comfortable because if they try to drop again it would need to go through a large employer's HR, so theoretically they can't unilaterally drop me. I don't know if this was convenient incompetence, weaponized incompetence, or just an active, unwritten rule to get drop high cost patients however they can. I just know that CareFirst doesn't care, and the system we have in the US sucks. It's more expensive, less dependable, and more difficult to navigate than any other developed country. Thankfully, I'm no longer one of the people this system is leaving without care, but I'm more convinced than ever that this system is the worst."

— r/HealthInsurance · 119 upvotes · None

"Told it's fraud to have Marketplace and ACA-compliant Employer Insurance at the same time. Is this correct? I'm like a 5 year old when it comes to insurance things. So apologies if this is obvious. I currently have employer-offered health insurance. Per ACA it's considered affordable and it meets the minimum standards. I want to purchase an insurance plan through the Illinois marketplace exchange and have both at the same time. I do not qualify, nor was I trying to get, subsidies, tax credits or discounts. I would be paying whatever is considered full price on the exchange. In trying to get more details from a broker, explaining what I said above, he said that it'd be fraud to have both. A customer service agent through the chat on getcoveredillinois told me that I could only get secondary insurance. That all they offered in the marketplace was primary insurance, and since I had my employer-offered health insurance, and it met the ACA requirements, I could not take on another primary insurance, only secondary. And well they don't offer secondary. Is secondary insurance a different type of insurance? I thought what made it secondary is that I had another plan that was primary, not that it was a specific type of insurance. Is it correct that marketplace insurance plans are primary only? Can I get individual health insurance outside of the marketplace while still having my employer-provided insurance? The enrollment period ends today and have been going back and forth for weeks about this. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 28 upvotes · None

"Medi-Cal vs. Covered California / Medi-Cal eligibility I am a working-age California resident. In the first quarter of last year, I left a job voluntarily. Because it was voluntary I did not bother to apply for unemployment. I did not have another job lined up. As I had coverage with Kaiser through my employer, my first call was to them to ask about Cobra. I was pretty quickly transferred to a Kaiser agent who wanted to work through a Covered California application with me. We did that, but at the end of the process they had some technical failure with regard to me verifying my SSN, so they gave up and transferred me to a Covered California agent. I did not quite know how to answer their question about income, because my answer was basically, "I expect to be employed again at some point this year, but it's hard to say when, and so anything I tell you will only be a guesstimate." So the CC agent concluded that since my total 2022 income from the job I just left fell under the limit, and since I did not have any other income, I was eligible for Medi-Cal. This seemed odd to me since my occupation pays fairly well and I did expect to be employed again at some point that year. "Can't I just get subsidies through CC and then pay them back once I'm working again?" I asked. Their answer was that with Medi-Cal, so long as I advise them of any changes to income, I don't actually have to pay anything back. I didn't really expect to use the plan anyway, i.e. I just wanted catastrophic coverage, and so I agreed to do that. So for the past 11 months, I've been on Medi-Cal. I have not used the plan in any way, have not seen a doctor, have not called anyone about anything with the exception of the initial application process. It is time to renew my eligibility, and here is my concern: When I went through the application process last year, they asked about "cash on hand." Now, at the time I did have some money in the bank, but that money was set aside for living expenses like rent and food, which I considered to be priorities that came before health insurance. It felt like the question was more about "disposable cash" and so I reported that no, I did not have cash on hand. Looking back, that was probably the wrong answer. There was zero intent to deceive on my part, however I'm now concerned that I've basically been enrolled in Medi-Cal fraudulently. As it turns out, I am still unemployed. I am very close to being out of cash, am living on credit card advances, and I have a traditional IRA that I will tap into as a last resort. So, unlike last year, I'm pretty sure that I am now legitimately eligible for Medi-Cal. (I don't think my IRA counts as an asset but please correct me if I'm wrong.) Let's say I renew and at some point thereafter I obtain services. Might they do some digging and discover that I did actually have some cash in 2022? My understanding is that if I am eligible for Medi-Cal then I am NOT eligible for CC subsidies, so even though at this point I would feel better about reversing course and getting myself on a CC plan, that may not be financially feasible for me. I would like to have a conversation with someone from Medi-Cal about this, but not sure how wise it would be for me to share what I have shared here. Maybe it would be better to just return my renewal docs and proceed as if I've been eligible all along? Does it even matter since I haven't actually obtained any services? Am I just being paranoid? Apologies for the long-winded post. Just wanted to provide some context so that hopefully someone might have some valuable insight and/or advice. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 18 upvotes · None

"Have used a broker to sign up for the last 2 years - why are his prices higher than the ones listed on the healthcare.gov site? TLDR : the copious info is below but 1) worried a broker is trying to up charge me to sign up through him for 2026 insurance (a more expensive plan I wasn't considering from gov site is actually \$50/month cheaper thru him, the cheaper plan I thought I might pick on the gov site is \$30 more a month from the broker) 2) how can I review the answers I put into my gov 2026 application before I got the info from the insurance broker because I can't seem to find a way to review that on healthcare.gov So..... 2 years ago I signed up through a local insurance broker because I was coming off Medicaid and couldn't get the healthcare.gov website to show me what I'd be getting for a subsidy. I assume it wouldn't give me that info till I was determined ineligible by my states dhhs which is a slow process. I even called them and told them to end my coverage through them on the last day of December hoping that would make it so I was able to see my subsidy but it didn't. So I went through this broker and got signed up cheap (\$45) a month on priority. Last year since he had made the process so painless I went through him again but it went up to \$120 a month which hurt a bit but he had said some program had expired making my insurance more expensive for this past year even tho my income only went up a couple thousand dollars. Looking back now I prob should have delved into that huge increase further. I called him again at the end of October and he said to call him back in a week since he didn't have access to the new numbers yet but after seeing all the people shocked by their increases I decided to fill out an application on healthcare.gov just to see what kind of increase I might be in for. My income also went up so I put in a new estimate (which I don't remember what I put) and if I keep my current plan it will go up to \$215. There's also a cheaper plan I could get instead that will likely fulfill my needs for \$159. The insurance broker sent me an email listing 2 plans neither of which is my current one. It lists one for \$208 but the gov site lists the same plan for \$186. The gov site lists another plan I wasn't even considering due to expense for \$239 but from the broker that same plan is \$183. In order to have complete info I wanted to review my gov application because I don't remember exactly what I put for my income info. For the broker I told him \$28k for the year but I either listed \$28k or \$26,600 on my gov application. I was trying to review my application details again but have been clicking round and round on the gov site and it won't let me review those details anywhere as far as I can see. I need to have those details before I can ask this broker what's up with the different prices and make a selection. Low key worried he may be pulling a fast one on me but I thought these brokers didn't charge for their services (that may have been true under Biden but who knows what rule changes Trump may have made allowing for up charging) Phew, any info appreciated 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · None

"Questions about how to file taxes with premium tax credits for a dependent? My taxes have always been super simple and straightforward. I work full time and have 2 kids, but I don't have employer health benefits and have had Medicaid for all 3 of us since my divorce. My 19 year old son was dropped from Medicaid coverage and I signed him up for an ACA policy through a broker who told me it wouldn't affect my taxes. My son is autistic and is a full time college student. He lives at home and I've always claimed him as a dependent. He doesn't have a job, but did have a little income from a summer internship. But since he has this policy does he have to file taxes? He didn't make enough money last year to meet the FPL for an individual and I didn't earn enough to meet the FPL for a family of 3. I think as far as the federal government is concerned he should still have Medicaid, but we live in a red state that didn't expand Medicaid, so there's no coverage for 18-24 year old students who don't have children. Do I file my taxes as usual with my children as dependents and then file taxes for him with his 1095-a and put that he can be claimed as a dependent? Do I not claim him as a dependent even though he is most definitely a dependent? He's the only one with an ACA policy and I do not know what I'm doing and I'm afraid since he didn't make enough money that he'll have to pay back thousands of dollars in subsidies. Thanks for any advice!"

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · None

"Need help understanding ACA Subsidies My parents immigrated to nj a few months ago and I am trying to buy some insurance for them, they will have cash jobs and will be filing tax returns. One broker told me the horizon bronze is about 2300 per month and another one said 55 per month Oscar. And my understanding is Trump has taken away the subsidies, so how can it be \$55 per month. Too good to be true. Can anyone help explain?"

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · None

'Watch your income' · 6 documents · 6 voices

"Health insurance will cost us almost \$18,000 this year. Please help! My job offers insurance via Aetna and I found out today it's going up again, to almost \$1500/mo for just me, my husband, and my infant. And they already cover 75% of my personal plan, the rest is the family portion. The problem is my husband is self-employed and receives no tax credits or help in the marketplace because a plan is offered through my work. The cheapest crappy plan wouldn't save us all that much, if he were to go get his own plan and leave me and the baby on my work plan. I don't know what to do. That's crippling, it costs more than our mortgage. Should I go down to part time and sacrifice my other job benefits so I'm "no longer eligible" and we can try to get credits/cheaper plan? Do I go without insurance and try to save the money to "cash price" at the doctor? My husband owns a small business so it's not as simple as him just getting another job for the insurance. I have to make a decision in the next two days and I'm so stressed. Location : Georgia, USA Income : \$90,000 UPDATE : if anyone would like an update - we got our health insurance cost down, thankfully. The insurance broker we were working with wasn't as helpful as I expected and told us to mark "no" for tax credits/subsidies. When I did more research (thanks everyone), if it was over 9% of our income, we were eligible for about \$350 credit plus a cheaper plan. When I reached out to the broker to confirm she acted like she didn't realize we'd be eligible 😊 It's only going to cost a little over half what we were looking at after our applications. Moral of the story - do your own research."

— r/HealthInsurance · 165 upvotes · None

"Turning 26, being dropped coverage and can't do State Medicaid I'm turning 26 years old, and I'm being dropped from my parent's health plan. I live in PA and have no income. I'm still in Medical School for 1 more year, and they offer no SHIP/healthcare plans of their own. I qualify for PA State Medicaid, but I will be doing several out of state hospital rotations, and they will not accept that I only have a State Medicaid. What are my options? I went to HealthCare.gov, and as soon as I say I have no income, all they do is redirect me to sign up with State Medicaid?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 44 upvotes · None

"Medi-Cal vs. Covered California / Medi-Cal eligibility I am a working-age California resident. In the first quarter of last year, I left a job voluntarily. Because it was voluntary I did not bother to apply for unemployment. I did not have another job lined up. As I had coverage with Kaiser through my employer, my first call was to them to ask about Cobra. I was pretty quickly transferred to a Kaiser agent who wanted to work through a Covered California application with me. We did that, but at the end of the process they had some technical failure with regard to me verifying my SSN, so they gave up and transferred me to a Covered California agent. I did not quite know how to answer their question about income, because my answer was basically, "I expect to be employed again at some point this year, but it's hard to say when, and so anything I tell you will only be a guesstimate." So the CC agent concluded that since my total 2022 income from the job I just left fell under the limit, and since I did not have any other income, I was eligible for Medi-Cal. This seemed odd to me since my occupation pays fairly well and I did expect to be employed again at some point that year. "Can't I just get subsidies through CC and then pay them back once I'm working again?" I asked. Their answer was that with Medi-Cal, so long as I advise them of any changes to income, I don't actually have to pay anything back. I didn't really expect to use the plan anyway, i.e. I just wanted catastrophic coverage, and so I agreed to do that. So for the past 11 months, I've been on Medi-Cal. I have not used the plan in any way, have not seen a doctor, have not called anyone about anything with the exception of the initial application process. It is time to renew my eligibility, and here is my concern: When I went through the application process last year, they asked about "cash on hand." Now, at the time I did have some money in the bank, but that money was set aside for living expenses like rent and food, which I considered to be priorities that came before health insurance. It felt like the question was more about "disposable cash" and so I reported that no, I did not have cash on hand. Looking back, that was probably the wrong answer. There was zero intent to deceive on my part, however I'm now concerned that I've basically been enrolled in Medi-Cal fraudulently. As it turns out, I am still unemployed. I am very close to being out of cash, am living on credit card advances, and I have a traditional IRA that I will tap into as a last resort. So, unlike last year, I'm pretty sure that I am now legitimately eligible for Medi-Cal. (I don't think my IRA counts as an asset but please correct me if I'm wrong.) Let's say I renew and at some point thereafter I obtain services. Might they do some digging and discover that I did actually have some cash in 2022? My understanding is that if I am eligible for Medi-Cal then I am NOT eligible for CC subsidies, so even though at this point I would feel better about reversing course and getting myself on a CC plan, that may not be financially feasible for me. I would like to have a conversation with someone from Medi-Cal about this, but not sure how wise it would be for me to share what I have shared here. Maybe it would be better to just return my renewal docs and proceed as if I've been eligible all along? Does it even matter since I haven't actually obtained any services? Am I just being paranoid? Apologies for the long-winded post. Just wanted to provide some context so that hopefully someone might have some valuable insight and/or advice. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 18 upvotes · None

"Have used a broker to sign up for the last 2 years - why are his prices higher than the ones listed on the healthcare.gov site? TLDR : the copious info is below but 1) worried a broker is trying to up charge me to sign up through him for 2026 insurance (a more expensive plan I wasn't considering from gov site is actually \$50/month cheaper thru him, the cheaper plan I thought I might pick on the gov site is \$30 more a month from the broker) 2) how can I review the answers I put into my gov 2026 application before I got the info from the insurance broker because I can't seem to find a way to review that on healthcare.gov So..... 2 years ago I signed up through a local insurance broker because I was coming off Medicaid and couldn't get the healthcare.gov website to show me what I'd be getting for a subsidy. I assume it wouldn't give me that info till I was determined ineligible by my states dhhs which is a slow process. I even called them and told them to end my coverage through them on the last day of December hoping that would make it so I was able to see my subsidy but it didn't. So I went through this broker and got signed up cheap (\$45) a month on priority. Last year since he had made the process so painless I went through him again but it went up to \$120 a month which hurt a bit but he had said some program had expired making my insurance more expensive for this past year even tho my income only went up a couple thousand dollars. Looking back now I prob should have delved into that huge increase further. I called him again at the end of October and he said to call him back in a week since he didn't have access to the new numbers yet but after seeing all the people shocked by their increases I decided to fill out an application on healthcare.gov just to see what kind of increase I might be in for. My income also went up so I put in a new estimate (which I don't remember what I put) and if I keep my current plan it will go up to \$215. There's also a cheaper plan I could get instead that will likely fulfill my needs for \$159. The insurance broker sent me an email listing 2 plans neither of which is my current one. It lists one for \$208 but the gov site lists the same plan for \$186. The gov site lists another plan I wasn't even considering due to expense for \$239 but from the broker that same plan is \$183. In order to have complete info I wanted to review my gov application because I don't remember exactly what I put for my income info. For the broker I told him \$28k for the year but I either listed \$28k or \$26,600 on my gov application. I was trying to review my application details again but have been clicking round and round on the gov site and it won't let me review those details anywhere as far as I can see. I need to have those details before I can ask this broker what's up with the different prices and make a selection. Low key worried he may be pulling a fast one on me but I thought these brokers didn't charge for their services (that may have been true under Biden but who knows what rule changes Trump may have made allowing for up charging) Phew, any info appreciated 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · None

"I am currently on an ACA Bronze plan and have had this the past two years that I've been retired. I have noticed the Silver plans are quite a bit more in my state. Also Bronze plans (at least for this year) allow for HSA deposits. Not sure if you can do that with Silver. I'm afraid to drop vision and dental because I wear glasses and have had big dental bills in the past. I'll check the math though. And I'm paying about twice as much as you are for one person (health+vision only). At open enrollment I'll look again. Also will see if I can maybe lower my MAGI. I told them \$62K for this year (which is near the max for a single person and still get a subsidy). Lowering this to \$35K or \$40K might be possible but it would require withdrawals from my Roth IRA to make up the difference."

— YouTube · How We Get ACA Health Insurance Before Age 65? · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xVHorMHIYeM&lc=Ugz860t4k73b15uGt_x4AaABAq

↳ @RetireEarlyWithMelanieAndKeith (5): "Yes. your MAGI is very important and if you can control it and keep it lower you will get better pricing."

↳ @sunnybrookfm-75 (3): "The last 5 years I worked before actually retiring I had to provide my own health insurance the first year where I worked. I used the subsidies like you and paid approximately what you are. In my case it was 180 dollars per month since I'm single. I was earning 15 dollars an hour. I was working 2 jobs. I also had really cheap places to live. We were unionized too thank goodness. When the year was up I got the union healthcare for \$5 a week plus I was on part a of Medicare. The employer had a huge amount of employees so you can do what I'm talking about. I am a retired paralegal and nurse. In addition I have vision problems that caused me to have cataract issues. I had to have them removed from both eyes in my late 50s. I also went completely blind in both eyes for 6 weeks. Some vision came back in 1 eye. I was disqualified from disability because 1 eye functions pretty well. At any rate my vision problems are considered a medical condition. The good news is my doctor tells me my condition has stabilized and I now qualify for low vision benefits. Most of those I would have to pay for out of pocket so I just go along the best I can with what I have. I'm allowed to drive and restrict myself to daytime driving. I go to discount eyeglass providers and pay about 50% less than I would if I went to my doctor for eyeglasses. When I retired I went from health insurance plus pt A Medicare to Medicare and a high deductible medigap plan. I was able to keep health insurance plus pt A Medicare until 67 because my store had a huge amount of employees and had somewhat decent health insurance thru the union. Because of this loophole I was entitled to keep my \$5 dollar a week health insurance until I retired at 67. I am now 73. My retirement age was 66. I eventually added dental insurance I figure if I need implants I can be a dental tourist and get them done abroad if I need to. So far my blood pressure has come down into the normal range now that I'm not working as well. And I've not had to take any medication for my blood pressure. Yay! I'm just taking care of myself. Now mind you this is also because I'm exceptionally frugal. I live on 21k and save 5k a year. Furthermore at the age of 72 I came into a nestegg of 325k from 2 individuals in my life and my own savings. My family left me the 325k. I've not had to touch a nickel of it. And since the 21k is technically my only source of income I owe zero dollars in taxes. Bonus for me 😊😊 . I pay 825 dollars a month in rent and have a small 20 pound dog. My best friend bought my house outright and rents it to me. It is 850 sq ft of heaven. I live in a home built in 1950 that is constantly undergoing renovations. And I live a very simple modest lifestyle. My neighborhood is a working class neighborhood in a downtown area. I live in a wealthy county outside a large metropolitan city. My city has a population of 100k approximately. It is peaceful and quiet. Yes when you are pricing out your healthcare check out both federal and state laws."

↳ @richard1113 (0): "@sunnybrookfm-75 Thank you for sharing your story. It sounds like you're doing ok!"

"Health insurance is HORRENDOUS this year. Its more dangerous than you stated, so listen up (and so far its not getting better next year): 1. The Cliffs of subsidies, oh the cliffs: Make too much (around 85k GROSS household) and you owe FULL amount of insurance (usually around 21-25k for two people. Thats 25%+ extra "tax" for health insurance!! on top of taxes!!!)... make too little and you owe the FULL amount too. As you know, self employment can be somewhat unpredictable so playing with the tiny financial window for subsidy assistance is nuts. One penny under you owe like 1200 for two for the year... one penny over? you owe 25k. make it make sense! WRITE YOUR REPS! We need at LEAST a Solo small biz option for better and more affordable group health insurance, and the subsidies NOT to have cliffs. 2) Most have access to some better group plans. Solo biz owners are not. We are expected to pay FULL employment taxes on our wages/earnings instead of just HALF if you work for the man, and we dont get access to more favorable group plans. This needs to stop as it is CUTTING to small biz working harder than most (or at least riskier). 3) Middle class is essentially subsidizing poor (ok) and ultra rich (not okay). The richer you get, the less overall cost burden you have. Don't believe me? Lets do the math for a second. if you make 100k as a couple, you'll pay around 22% as highest bracket. Then you also owe roughly 25k of health insurance. **So your overall cost burden for LOWER middle class is 47% of GROSS income.** If you make 25 million dollars a year, your highest tax bracket is around 37%... and your health insurance still costs about 25k. Same same. but that factors into being about .1%. **So ultra rich earners overall cost burden for health insurance we are basically forced to have is drumroll please. 37.1% . LOWER overall COST BURDEN THAN MIDDLE CLASS! at highest bracket. And The richer you get, the less overall cost burden in percent you have.** (Not even mentioning tax breaks and legit loopholes of course. what i said is enough) Sure you pay more dollars, but you pay LESS PERCENT of your income. 25k means very little to a person making 25 million, but it means a TON to the person making 85k. That is NOT fair. **I propose we change it with having everyone just pay a flat tax towards health care. 8%.** We can subsidize the truly poor but definitely not the ultra rich. Thats gotta end of we are essentially forced into the bad health care system we have... **the only thing not universal about our healthcare is that its not universally paid for - the middle class pay overwhelmingly more in cost percent burden than ANYONE else. Facts. WRITE YOUR REPS** 4) short term insurance fine prints: in networks, out of networks... you MUST read it. Agents overwhelmingly do not care or do not know. - or sell fraud insurance. When the rubber hits your road, you may not want an organ transplant cap of 10k, or a emergency airlift of 500 dollars. And you may not even qualify - almost any preexisting disqualifies you. Sure your agent can sign u up but they arent left picking up the pieces when things go wrong. (VERY LITTLE HEALTH AGENT ACCOUNTABILITY) Also once you get sick, you wont get renewed and youre forced back into ACA cesspool. TL:DR **Everyone in the middle class is getting very screwed around health insurance, but solo entrepreneurs are the canary in the coal mine.** We see it first hand how messed up it is, especially this year and next year. Some of us realize it early. The rest will cry at tax time (or when medical bills hit the fan). WRITE YOUR REPS! We need at LEAST 1) Solo small biz option for better and more affordable group health insurance, 2) subsidies NOT to have hard cliffs 3) Maybe most importantly long term reform: We need a fair flat rate where EVERYONE including bezos, pays a flat 8% (or something) of their income towards health insurance. **Right now, it's middle class paying 25% of their income while billionaires pay .00000001% of their income towards it** \- if they even buy our peasant insurance haha. **Effectively we all subsidize the ultra rich too, and have to play the health insurance hunger games.** Its INSANE."

— r/selfemployed · https://www.reddit.com/r/selfemployed/comments/1vk17ni/us_health_insurance_as_a_solo_small_business/p9z8x1m/

Tab 5 — Frustrations

Insurance companies and the system as a scam · 43 documents · 20 voices

"The scariest part... from someone who works at a health insurance company I work at a large health insurance company, and lately all I hear about is the potential end of ACA subsidies, rising premiums, and skyrocketing healthcare costs. But the part no one's talking about? This could become the new normal. When has any industry ever raised prices and then actually brought them back down once people got used to paying more? Even if healthcare costs drop (and that's a big if), what incentive do insurers have to lower premiums when people are already paying the higher rates? It's like gas... people used to complain about \$2.50 a gallon. Now we celebrate it. That's the scary part. Prices rise, we adapt, and eventually we forget what "reasonable" even looked like. Unless wages start catching up, we're all in serious trouble."

— r/HealthInsurance · 2,664 upvotes · None

"UHC Denial My son was scheduled to have surgery to correct his pectum excavatum in 2022. His surgeon said he met all the medically required criteria. Two days before the surgery UHC denied the surgery. This was incredibly stressful. Apparently their reasoning was that my 22 year old son had 82% lung capacity based upon th tests due this chronic condition and they only approve patients 80% or less. My son was don't worry mom we'll be ok. He is not angry he was just concerned about me. Later that year my husband lost his job and with it UHC medical insurance. My son(student) and I got coverage through the ACA. The next year with his new insurance ,same doctor he was able to get the surgery. We are blessed. However I still feel traumatized every time I think about the denial from UHC. There are probably lots of other people in the same boat as me. Only a patients doctor should be able to make these life altering decisions not insurance companies."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,523 upvotes · None

"Turns out my ACA compliant plan is a phantom/shell company Canceling my family health insurance today- turns out it was a total scam Imperial Health Insurance It turns out the insurance provider I have is essentially a ghost network, a shell plan, a phantom policy. 15,000 deductible. Bought through the official marketplace, supposedly fully 'ACA compliant', a bronze plan. First I discovered the doctors that are listed on our cards do not take our insurance. They said I have to call around and try to convince a doctor for husband and I or a pediatrician to take it. NONE have offered or even entertained this. I cannot take my children to get seen at a pediatrician. They both have ADHD. They had ONE provider listed as a child psychiatrist in their network and it essentially does not exist except on a screen. They have three numbers that all route to a voicemail that never calls back. I looked the doctor up and the practice does not exist. The 'cherry on top'? My son broke his arm and they refused to pay for a dime of it because it turns out there are no emergency providers in my county that take our insurance. WTF?! I asked if there were perhaps some in another county? They said no that would be out of network. WTF again?! The hospital/ER took our insurance card and looked at us like we were trying to pull a fast one or something. Like we were presenting a Monopoly or UNO card perhaps. NO medications are covered, except through a supposed online pharmacy that does not answer phones and has a PO Box for a physical address. Why the HELL was I paying \$600 a month for NOTHING? I feel so STUPID. I feel I have failed my family for making such a stupid decision, but I thought it was the RIGHT thing to do. I could've been saving all that and paying out of pocket for services. I want my money back, can I sue them?! TLDR; it turns out my ACA plan is a complete shell plan, a phantom policy, a ghost network that does NOT exist except to collect premiums. Canceling it TODAY. I WISH our employer covered healthcare. Any advice on how to report these fraudsters? It CAN'T be legal what they are doing. It just can't."

— r/HealthInsurance · 299 upvotes · None

"Insurance carriers increased rates on ACA plans with based off the expectation of lower enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are put back in, what happens to the now jacked up rates that were already approved by states and sold during open-enrollment? Carriers have increased full cost rates ahead of schedule because they expect a drop in enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are reinstated, what happens to the already inflated rates? Each insurance carrier must get its rate increase approved by the state annually, often months before open enrollment. This year, carriers justified rate hikes primarily by citing: 1. Lower projected enrollment numbers due to expiring ACA subsidies 2. The rising cost of GLP-1 weight loss drugs (even though most ACA marketplace plans don't cover these) I'm re-emphasizing because I fear people will still confuse the question. I am not talking about increases people are seeing based off loss of their personal subsidy, I am talking about the plan's actual cost. Aka, what someone would pay if they didn't receive subsidy. My state approved my insurance company for a 27% increase for 2026. They have again applied that increase disproportionately, increasing the individual plans more than their group plans. My personal non-subsidized cheapest HSA eligible ACA plan went up 40% on just the premium, with increases in the cost-sharing amounts as well. This is about average across my local market. Their group rate plans only went up by single digit amounts. Even if the government reinstates subsidies, I'm not hearing anyone addressing the issue of rate increases that relied on inaccurate enrollment projections. Open enrollment has already begun. Will these companies be forced to rework their approved plans retroactively? Are we going to get refunds? I don't see it happening. If they don't, the insurance companies will profit even more from this political situation. This event has allowed them to quickly raise plan costs beyond their actual expenses. If it's too late for 2026, what's the chances they'll actually lower rates even for 2027?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 229 upvotes · None

"Why all of the "I can't believe how much health insurance costs" comments are misguided With recent increases in both the cost of employer sponsored health insurance and ACA plans, especially for those who lose the enhanced subsidies, this sub has been flooded with people shocked and frustrated with the impact. Understandably so. But all of the comments that this is caused by the existence of health insurers or the profit model completely miss the point. Those same posters claiming that universal healthcare, single payer or Medicare for all is the solution equally miss the larger point. That point is that healthcare is and has increasingly gotten more (too) expensive. The US healthcare spend is about \$5 trillion. That equates to about \$15,000 per person per year. Or \$1250 per individual per month. Think \$2500 a month for a couple for health insurance is expensive? That's actually the average of what it costs to deliver healthcare services. So let's get rid of health insurance companies- I'm certainly not a big fan of them. By law they have to spend 85% on actual care. So 15% goes to administration (and those hated executive salaries). So get rid of that admin expense and the \$2500 for the couple drops to \$2125. Feel affordable all of the sudden? Of course not. So how about some form of universal healthcare? All that does is change who pays for it. And definitely not what's paid. We already have some universal healthcare between Medicaid and Medicare. A significant portion of the US insured population uses these programs. And guess what, costs are going up. The government hasn't demonstrated any ability to manage or control costs. Now it's fair to argue that some taxpayers should pay more so that others have to pay less for healthcare but let's at least have an honest discussion about that instead of pretending that if the government pays for it is free. Employers and ACA utilize insurance companies to manage costs. The track record of cost management there isn't really any better. The core issue is that there is a virtually unlimited demand for healthcare. And it's impossible to supply that without spending more and more. "Let the decision on treatment be between the doctors and their patients" - uh sure. Except that whoever actually pays is going to want to weigh in. Pretty logically. Even the successful universal healthcare countries are struggling to fund the efforts and the complaints are often attributed to underfunding. Because fully funding is impossible- demand is too unlimited. You will never change demand. That's human nature (though changing behaviors over time like smoking cessation can help). So someone is going to be in charge of rationing the care people get. Might be the government (Medicare/Medicaid) or might be a private insurer. Unless you are willing to pay directly for your own care, someone else is going to be in a position to say yes or no to it. Uncomfortable fact of life. So what can be done to corral the untenable rise in costs? The providers of care - physicians, facilities, pharmaceutical companies must be driven to charge less (and this may be the best argument for single payer as this best enables the government to dictate what will be paid). And perhaps some of the "innovative but costly treatments" must be foregone (rationed away). But make no mistake, unless we have the political will to pay providers less and ration care more (something the US population has never exhibited), we will continue to have this problem and have to find a new bogeyman after solving the last bogeyman."

— r/HealthInsurance · 131 upvotes · None

"Is my therapist scamming me? (updated below) First of all I am in therapy partly for trust issues and paranoia with women. So keep that in mind. I have Anthem bronze pathway epo in California. (I just chose the cheapest possible plan. \$741 😊) The insurance only covers in network providers. I met my out of pocket max and the EOBs say I owe \$0 now. I just realized that my credit card has also been getting charged \$200 per session by the therapist. Based on the emails I agreed to her billing plan. I wasn't absorbing it though. I was thinking sure, whatever, I'll meet my OOPM soon and then it will be \$0, like everything else. I chose her because she's in network. This situation fits what I've read about balance billing. I have a hard time believing that my 50+ yo therapist would do something illegal like this. I can't believe she wouldn't know the laws. I don't trust her but she's smart. Rationally this seems far fetched. From anthem: "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secure message. We understand how concerning it is to be billed when your Explanation of Benefits (EOB) shows no member responsibility, and we appreciate you bringing this to our attention. Upon reviewing your 2026 claims submitted by x, most of the claims indicate no member responsibility, which means you should not owe anything for those services. We found only two claims where a member responsibility was applied: Claim number x (Date of Service: 03/05/2026-03/09/2026) Member responsibility: \$180.00 Claim number x (Date of Service: 02/24/2026) - Member responsibility: \$60.00 If you have already made payments that correspond to these two claims, then any additional charges from this provider may not be accurate. For the other claims that show \$0.00 member responsibility, we recommend that you share a copy of your EOB with your provider, as it reflects how the claims were processed. Sincerely, Elaine S. Customer Service Representative" What should I do? We are supposed to meet on Tuesday. **UPDATE:** I cancelled our appointment and asked for a breakdown of charges, in a neutral way, implying anthem must have messed up. Anthem again confirmed she should not be charging me. Her stated rate is \$235. Anthem has been giving her \$97.87 per session. So she's taking home \$297.87?? she wants me to believe that anthem only gives her \$35, and that balance billing is ok? I can't believe this. does she think I'm dumb and rich? is she dumb, or a thief? she was kind of a decent therapist! My claims history shows that she has submitted 10claims. Each claim shows multiple sessions each day. totaling 19 sessions. She charged me \$198 the first 3 charges and \$200 the last 2. 5 total charges to my credit card which aligns with the number of times I remember seeing her. I have not seen her 19times and I've definitely never seen her 3x in one day. I never got any kind of receipt with the charges. I just noticed them. Is it common to not send a receipt? **UPDATE 2:** a lot of her claims were on dates I was gone on a trip for a month taking care of a dying family member. The very first claim for a 60 minute therapy session for which Anthem paid her \$97.87 was actually our 14m48s introductory phone consult (she had flaked twice. She was 9th on my list and no one else was available. Should I just keep seeing her...? 😊) **UPDATE 3:** I sent Anthem screenshots of texts, emails, and phone history showing her first claim was a lie, and that I was out of the country during a majority of her other claims. I cannot believe I was out of the country with my dying mother, with no return date, and this woman was using my name to make hundreds of dollars. What the flipping fuck. I want to be HER therapist and analyze her pathology. Also, she gave away my time slot while I was gone with no conversation, and I was hurt but I decided to respect that I couldn't expect her to hold a spot for me when I left and stopped communicating. Ha! I wonder if I had never reached back out, how long she would have kept pretending we were having sessions. **UPDATE 4:** Sent by: Anthem Support "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secured message. I'm really sorry you're going through this, it can be very upsetting and confusing to see charges and visit records that don't match your recollection, especially when it involves multiple charges to your card. We understand your concern, and we appreciate you bringing this to our attention. Please be advised that we process claims exactly as they are billed and submitted by your provider. Claims are reviewed based on the information received, your plan benefits, and the provider's network status. Anthem also follows the provider's contract to determine the allowed amount and how much is applied to your responsibility, such as deductible, copayment, or coinsurance. For specific details about the billing codes used and the charges submitted, we recommend contacting your provider or facility directly, as they can explain how the claim was filed and the

amounts billed for each service. If you believe your claims were not processed correctly, you have the right to request a review by filing an appeal, and we'll be happy to guide you through that process. Appeals must be submitted within 180 calendar days of the last processing date. Please include your member identification number, the claim number in question, the details of your appeal and any additional medical information or documentation supporting your appeal. For a standard appeal, a decision will be made within 30 calendar days after the receipt of the documentation. You can send appeals by mail to the following address:..." Sounds like Anthem wants me to do a load of paperwork when I've already submitted evidence of fraud. :(I asked them to forward to their fraud department. TBD. **UPDATE 6** From therapist responding to me asking for a breakdown of her charges: "Hi x, Thank you for sending this, and thank you for following up with Anthem. Yes, it's completely fine to skip tomorrow. I'm going to look into the insurance issue on my end and see what I can find out about why Anthem is showing \$0. Once I have more clarity, I'll get back to you. Warmly, x" 😊 me: "Thanks x. Can you send me a superbill today explaining the details of the \$198 and \$200 charges?" I just read her reflections email on our last session and it was so insightful and helpful. Maybe we can both compartmentalize her fraud... 😊 **UPDATE 7** Sent by: Anthem Support "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secure message. I'm really sorry you're going through this—what you're describing sounds incredibly frustrating and concerning. Thank you for clearly outlining the dates and your experience, especially noting when you were out of the country and had no communication or sessions with X. I completely understand why this situation doesn't feel right. To help ensure this is properly reviewed and investigated, the best next step is to report the situation directly to our Special Investigations Unit (SIU). They are specifically trained to handle cases like this and can take the appropriate actions to protect you and review any questionable billing activity. You may contact the Special Investigations Unit (SIU) at 888-231-5044 to report the concern. Reaching out to them will allow a dedicated team to look into the details you've shared and work toward a resolution. If you have any supporting documents—such as dates of service, billing statements, or records of your absence—having those ready can also be helpful during the review." I'm waiting to see whether the therapist will send the requested breakdown of the costs. kind of for sick entertainment purposes at this point tbh. She didn't send yesterday as requested. I keep thinking about the good parts of our dynamic and thinking about maybe making things work. A bit like the toxic relationships I wanted her to help me with, actually ... I'm back to sending a hundred exhausting , failed emails to therapists on psychology today, like the good old days. **UPDATE 8** From therapist: "Hi x, Thank you for your patience on this. I've been talking with Anthem and it turns out there was coverage confusion on their side that made your benefits show up in a really confusing way on my end. Bottom line: I overcharged you. Your copay is \$60 per session, and you should only have been paying \$60 each time. Based on the payments showing on your end (5 sessions: \$200, \$200, \$198, \$198, \$198), you paid a total of \$994. You should have paid \$300 total (\$60 x 5). That means I owe you a refund of \$694. I'm really sorry for the confusion. I appreciate you catching this; it would have turned into a big accounting discrepancy for my books too. Whew! Can you tell me what you prefer for the refund, Zelle or Venmo? Once you confirm, I can send it right away. Warmly, x" I actually met my deductible after 3 sessions. She's still lying. Wow. I said yes an"

— r/HealthInsurance · 122 upvotes · None

"My employer fired me after I challenged them of taking me off the health care insurance Hey everyone. I don't normally post stuff like this, but this whole situation has been insane and I could really use some outside perspective. I also want people to know how easily something like this can happen to them and the. The outcome of having health issues later. I worked for a company called Diamond Blade Warehouse (main office in Vernon Hills, IL, with multiple locations around the country). I was with them for almost three years. I left a different job to work there because I thought it'd be a good fit. Like any job, there were parts I liked good people on the sales side, some solid customers , but behind the curtain, it was a mess. I was a commission-based W-2 employee, meaning if I didn't hit commissions, I didn't get paid. No hourly, no base, no nothing. Just straight commission on a W-2... which already didn't sit right, but I needed the income. Earlier this year, out of nowhere, I was told I'd be switched to 1099. No paperwork, no conversation, no explanation. Just "you're 1099. "They just wanted the "benefits" of a contractor without actually making me one. Then on September 3rd, 2025, I got an email from accounting saying my health insurance coverage would end because they weren't applying my wages to the premium anymore. I replied, politely, that I wanted to keep my coverage and would pay out of pocket. I even jokingly said " I think you'd have to fire me to take away my benefits like that." Within ONE HOUR, my company email was disabled and I got a text message saying I was being terminated for "low sales." Convenient timing, right? And here's where it gets even worse. That same day, the COBRA plan administrator sent me a COBRA election notice that looked like it was printed off Google Images, wrong dates, wrong termination info, wrong deadlines. I tried responding, but their spam blocker was set so strict that my replies bounced. I literally had to switch email accounts just to contact them. They sent me a second COBRA notice the same day, also wrong. I asked for a corrected one and the administrator replied in ALL CAPS, basically yelling at me, demanding multiple months of payment upfront... even though the dates were wrong. Instead of fixing the spam blocker so I could communicate normally, management started relaying messages through my sales manager via text. It was like a weird game of corporate telephone. Completely unprofessional and honestly, absolutely ridiculous. Then comes the cherry on top: Months earlier, my manager texted me saying that the CFO, Bronwyn Jacobson, "didn't want me on the company's insurance" and was sweating him about it. In mid-August, she asked again if it was "ok to take me off." I never agreed. Two weeks later... terminated. I've already filed a complaint with the U.S. Department of Labor (EBSA) for COBRA violations, ERISA interference, retaliation, and misclassification. They're reviewing everything. I'm physically exhausted, financially strained, and emotionally worn down from dealing with this, but I'm speaking up because people deserve to know what companies pull when they think no one's looking. If any Redditors have advice, legal, emotional, or just practical, on navigating this, please drop it below. And if anyone's been through something similar, you're not alone. This one messed me up, and I don't want it happening to someone else."

— r/HealthInsurance · 105 upvotes · None

"When I dropped my health insurance, the health system I use now offers me half off on visits. Why could they not do that when I had insurance? So I live in a crappy red state that doesn't support its citizens. When the ACA subsidies were dropped with the help of the clown in the White House, my health insurance went from \$200 a month to almost \$700. I ended up dropping it as work was a little slow and this was a lot of money for something that didn't help much. I had a \$8000 yearly deductible, office visits were higher than they should have been, and almost no drugs were reduced more than the discount card I used at the pharmacy. Basically a lot of money for crappy coverage. Now that I don't have insurance, doctors's visits are half off. Some other visits like urgent care and blood work are half off the full price. Why couldn't I get that price with insurance? It would have lowered the cost of insurance by (I guess) half and I may have ended up keeping it. Why are we being charged an inflated cost with insurance. I feel like I paid more in the end for doctors appointments and such with insurance when you take the high deductible in consideration. It just all sounds like a scam to be and the doctors and insurance companies are in on it together."

— r/HealthInsurance · 77 upvotes · None

"Suggestions for ACA shopping: My process 2026 will be the third year my husband and I are on an ACA plan and the first year without enhanced subsidies. Because of ongoing marketplace changes, we will also be changing insurance companies for the third year in a row. I wanted to share my process for shopping in case this is helpful. I've done most of my research through Health Sherpa and some through healthcare.gov since window shopping opened. 1. After opening the portal, make a list in a notebook of insurance companies in your zip code. 2. Input your list of providers (and hospitals, if you want) into the website, which will then tell you who's in which plan. 3. Go back to your written list and write down which of your providers are contracted with each company. If you don't want to switch providers, you'll likely cross some plans off the list based on their networks. 4. Now go back to the portal and start sorting by whatever is most important to you - lowest premium, lowest deductible, etc. I find it helpful to only look at one insurance company at a time and sort by premium. I was able to eliminate more companies because their lowest premiums were too high. 5. Also look at star ratings. I wasn't going to choose a plan with only two stars. (I'm looking at you, Molina!) 6. Keep jotting down notes on insurance companies - not enough providers, premiums too high, low ratings, this one looks good, etc. 7. If you find a company that looks promising, run some comparisons. Health Sherpa allows you to compare up to, I believe, four plans at a time. Print out those reports, usually just a page or two. 8. Rinse and repeat for any other insurance companies that look promising. 9. Review your printouts, marking important details on each comparison report with a highlighter. 10. Jot down any more notes in your notebook - "four star ratings, but OOP max is high," etc. 11. At this point, you can hopefully narrow it down to one or two companies. 12. Go back to the most promising plans within your top two insurance companies. Look up the summary of benefits and coverage for each plan. You can print them, download them or both. These will provide you with additional details beyond what the "plan details" pages show. I suggest you also print out those plan details as well. 13. Bonus round: You can also input your medications to see what's covered. 14. At this point, a few plans should rise to the top. Then you can start weighing differences in premiums, deductibles, copays, OOP max, etc. I hope this helps! Within about 90 minutes, I was able to narrow down our options to three plans within a single company. Now we just need to choose a particular plan."

— r/obamacare · 34 upvotes · None

"Insurance Bill I Never Signed Up For So I just did my 2025 taxes, and when I first submitted them they got rejected for not including a 1095. I have insurance through my husband's job so this was weird, but I did check my Marketplace eligibility but never signed up for a plan. I ended up including a letter in my taxes that said I checked my eligibility but did not receive coverage from the marketplace. Fast forward to last night. I went to dinner with my mom and she brought me some mail I got from her house. They were bills and delinquency notices from the insurance company Ambetter. Somehow I was signed up for this insurance and these bills were sent to my mom's house, I have not lived there for 6 years. I did some googling and I'm not the only person that has been signed up for insurance without my consent. My question is what the hell do I do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 27 upvotes · None

"Total healthcare coverage for everyone would be simple. Just switch everyone to Medicare with Plan G. Charge a flat rate and the money would be there and the insurance companies would be cut off at the knees from their current theivery of our money and our tax money thru subsidies. They currently get BILLIONS of dollars in subsidies to cover people. Thru the ACA AND thru the Medicare Advantage plans. That money would be better spent just covering everyone and cut out the damn middle man. The flat fee could be something very small like maybe 50 dollars. Or if that sounds too simple, put it on a sliding scale. or Use the IRMA rule. But this has been so obvious to me since I started getting coverage thru the marketplace and found out that my subsidy is about 1400 a MONTH that taxes are being paid to these scammers. And I have to jump thru all sorts of hoops to just get a damn test."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 25 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgwKReZ8eEKFhxX5ehx4AaABAq>

↳ @wtmayhew (4): "I had to buy Obamacare for two years because I retired before I turned 65. The red stste where I lived decided to do nothing on its own and took the default government site. There were only two silver plans available which had over 1000/month premiums just for myself. I had to get back surgery and even with the silver plan I had there was still a 5000 hospitalization deductible. I'm glad I had a silver plan or it would have been a lot worse. Still, my health care bills for that year were almost 20K. That year federal subsidies cut off completely if your AGI was one penny over 49K the prior year. Affordable Health Care Act, my foot!"

↳ @TheJetstream10 (2): "You can thank the Republican Senate and Orin Hatch for pushing this through Congress--Medicare Advantage--they wanted a slice for private industry to get and they got it, guaranteed government subsidies for coverage and death panels for people who need care."

↳ @bugsy2902 (0): "The subsidies are great if you are poor! But once you make over 400% of poverty you are cut off entirely and good luck getting health insurance then. Mine increased from around \$800 monthly to over \$1300 monthly when I turned 60. Luckily, I'm able to keep my taxable income low thru using a Roth Ira, HSA and have low expenses. Plus, I have a HELOC for emergencies I got before I retired."

"If I tell my doctor's office I don't have insurance, can they look up whether that's true or not? Context: I've been on Medicaid (in Illinois) for the last few years. I filled out my redetermination in September as usual, then got a letter at the very end of November that I no longer qualify (my income went up and I'm now at around ~\$25,000/year, before I was hovering right around the cut off, which is about \$21,000 I believe). So now I'm looking at Marketplace plans and man....they are all so so awful!! The deductibles are crazy, and it's basically a choice between paying hundreds a month in order to maybe pay \$20-40 each time you go to the doctor, or paying \$10-\$30 a month but paying \$100-\$300 every time to go to the doctor. I take psychiatric medications that I rely on. I've been stable on the same ones for a few years now. I only see my doctor (psychiatrist) four times a year, and it's basically just as a requirement for her to be able to approve my refills. My psychiatrist's office offers sliding scale for uninsured patients, and I would only need to pay about \$35 per visit with them (plus about \$13/month for my meds with GoodRx coupons). This is a setup I could afford, so I was leaning towards just not buying health insurance at all for the coming year and paying for my care out of pocket this way. HOWEVER. I'm 29 years old, and this year two people I know who are even younger than I am were diagnosed with cancer. My parents got in a very scary car accident about two weeks ago (they rolled down a mountain but are miraculously fine because my dad's car is basically a tank). My point being, life has been reminding me a lot recently that no one knows what's going to happen tomorrow, and I feel like having SOME kind of coverage for if things go horribly horribly wrong would probably be in my best interest. I've also read a lot of reddit horror stories of otherwise 'healthy' young people deciding to forego insurance and regretting it after developing unexpected and expensive illnesses. So. I went back to the Marketplace website to look at the plans again. Found one that's \$6/month, has a \$7500 deductible, and covers almost nothing, *but* would be an affordable fail-safe if, god forbid, something really terrible and/or expensive were to happen. My psychiatrist's office does not take this plan. I called them and basically asked, 'If I hypothetically had insurance that you all don't take, would I still be eligible for the sliding scale cash price?' They told me no, that I would have to pay the full cost of the visit, which would be \$300 each time. This finally brings me to my question (thank for for sticking with me if you've read this far lol): **is there anyway for my doctor's office to *know* whether or not I actually have insurance, if I tell them that I don't?** I don't want to come across as if I'm trying to scam the system (although the healthcare system in the US is a nightmare and tbh I wouldn't judge anyone for doing so). But I just literally can't afford to keep seeing my doctor if it's going to be \$300 an appointment. But I also don't want to forego coverage completely. My ideal way to move forward would be to buy the \$6/month plan for emergencies, and just tell my psych that I don't have coverage so I could pay the sliding scale cost for the appointments. Is this something anyone has experience with?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · None

"Health insurance Canceled Me I am seeking urgent legal assistance regarding a serious issue with my health insurance coverage through the Marketplace and Oscar Health. I maintained active health insurance coverage throughout 2025 with Oscar Health and paid all monthly premiums on time without any lapse. In May 2025, I also reported a salary change to the Marketplace, and no issues were identified at that time. On December 31, 2025, I was unexpectedly charged \$529 after already paying my premium. When I contacted the insurance company, I was told this was due to a failure to apply my premium tax credit through HealthCare.gov. I was later informed that this was an error and that my correct monthly premium should have been approximately \$35. I was told the overcharge would be refunded. Shortly after, I had a medically necessary procedure scheduled related to a prior kidney condition and surgery. During that same week, I was informed by the provider that my insurance was inactive. I immediately contacted the insurer and explained the billing error. The following day, I was instructed to pay \$157 to reinstate my coverage, which I did in good faith because I required ongoing medical care. I was told the issue had been resolved. However, shortly thereafter, I began receiving notifications that my claims including hospital care, surgery, and procedures were denied. I was then informed that my coverage for 2025 had been retroactively voided. Additionally, my Form 1095-A has been marked as voided, creating significant tax implications. I have now been dealing with this issue for nearly 30 days. I am receiving medical bills and collection calls stating that I had no insurance coverage for all of 2025, despite having paid premiums consistently and followed all instructions given to me. At no point did I provide false or misleading information. The issue appears to stem from a subsidy/tax credit error that was acknowledged and supposedly corrected. Despite this, my coverage has been retroactively terminated, and I am now facing substantial financial and medical consequences. They are saying I didn't have coverage on 2025. Speaking with marketplace and Oscar they don't know the answers...."

— r/HealthInsurance · 19 upvotes · None

"Medi-Cal vs. Covered California / Medi-Cal eligibility I am a working-age California resident. In the first quarter of last year, I left a job voluntarily. Because it was voluntary I did not bother to apply for unemployment. I did not have another job lined up. As I had coverage with Kaiser through my employer, my first call was to them to ask about Cobra. I was pretty quickly transferred to a Kaiser agent who wanted to work through a Covered California application with me. We did that, but at the end of the process they had some technical failure with regard to me verifying my SSN, so they gave up and transferred me to a Covered California agent. I did not quite know how to answer their question about income, because my answer was basically, "I expect to be employed again at some point this year, but it's hard to say when, and so anything I tell you will only be a guesstimate." So the CC agent concluded that since my total 2022 income from the job I just left fell under the limit, and since I did not have any other income, I was eligible for Medi-Cal. This seemed odd to me since my occupation pays fairly well and I did expect to be employed again at some point that year. "Can't I just get subsidies through CC and then pay them back once I'm working again?" I asked. Their answer was that with Medi-Cal, so long as I advise them of any changes to income, I don't actually have to pay anything back. I didn't really expect to use the plan anyway, i.e. I just wanted catastrophic coverage, and so I agreed to do that. So for the past 11 months, I've been on Medi-Cal. I have not used the plan in any way, have not seen a doctor, have not called anyone about anything with the exception of the initial application process. It is time to renew my eligibility, and here is my concern: When I went through the application process last year, they asked about "cash on hand." Now, at the time I did have some money in the bank, but that money was set aside for living expenses like rent and food, which I considered to be priorities that came before health insurance. It felt like the question was more about "disposable cash" and so I reported that no, I did not have cash on hand. Looking back, that was probably the wrong answer. There was zero intent to deceive on my part, however I'm now concerned that I've basically been enrolled in Medi-Cal fraudulently. As it turns out, I am still unemployed. I am very close to being out of cash, am living on credit card advances, and I have a traditional IRA that I will tap into as a last resort. So, unlike last year, I'm pretty sure that I am now legitimately eligible for Medi-Cal. (I don't think my IRA counts as an asset but please correct me if I'm wrong.) Let's say I renew and at some point thereafter I obtain services. Might they do some digging and discover that I did actually have some cash in 2022? My understanding is that if I am eligible for Medi-Cal then I am NOT eligible for CC subsidies, so even though at this point I would feel better about reversing course and getting myself on a CC plan, that may not be financially feasible for me. I would like to have a conversation with someone from Medi-Cal about this, but not sure how wise it would be for me to share what I have shared here. Maybe it would be better to just return my renewal docs and proceed as if I've been eligible all along? Does it even matter since I haven't actually obtained any services? Am I just being paranoid? Apologies for the long-winded post. Just wanted to provide some context so that hopefully someone might have some valuable insight and/or advice. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 18 upvotes · None

"ACA healthcare made it possible for me to retire. I keep my taxable income low and receive Gov subsidies on premiums. I consider the subsidies getting back some of the taxes I paid into the systems for the last 48 years. I had employer healthcare insurance for 30 years and never used one penny of it. Insurance companies made a mint off of my employer and me for decades. I never went to the Doctor until I turned 60 when I got Covid."

— YouTube · How to Get Affordable Health Insurance Before Medicare · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dVyzw5Ac7pA&lc=UgzT3TgVH2azwWzdsxx4AaABAq>

↳ @DonaldSharpe-u9o (3): "I completely relate! It's amazing how planning your income and using the ACA effectively can make early retirement feasible. I went through a similar path, keeping taxable income low while investing in a few index funds and it helped me feel secure financially while also getting affordable healthcare coverage."

↳ @drcornelius8275 (0): "Well great for you that has little income but ACA is killing my family. Not only did we pay the same or more taxes than you have over the years, now we get to pay for your insurance too because ACA sticks us with huge premiums. Do you think that's fair? Why don't I just give you some of my belongs too while we're talking Communism."

↳ @bestieswladys251 (0): "@drcornelius8275 I thought that depended on the states. Some states chose to expand their Medicaid, which helps supplement the tax breaks for the ACA and some states decided not to. Are you paying an insurance directly or does it come from your employer (i'm not asking for anything personal or specific. I'm just curious in the broad sense of the word). I'm open to correction if I'm wrong!!!"

"Is this a good ACA health care plan? I know the subsidy is huge, but it seems like great coverage for really cheap price, but wanted to make sure I wasn't missing anything. Two of my regular prescriptions are tier 1 and generic so should be free. Another one is tier 2 so I'm unclear if it will be \$15 or \$50, but I have a manufacturer coupon that should make it free. My current doctor is in network, but I'm willing to switch doctors if necessary. I guess the wild card is Oscar could be a terrible company to deal with. Reviews are terrible but every insurance company in OH on ACA have terrible reviews. Thoughts? Anything watchouts to look for?"

— r/obamacare · 12 upvotes · None

"@Shadow_Banned_ConservativeBefore ACA, I tried to get health care, and the cost for me was infinity dollars. Because I had pre-existing condition and no insurance company would offer me a plan. So I would disagree with your little assessment there."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgxbKTpUxHIAEi5KMYJ4AaABAq.ARNIp2Pmc7PARRj9Gg3D7o

"Imperial Health on ACA I just wanted to post about my experience with Imperial which I purchased on the exchange. I have used "Obamacare" since it first started. I was without insurance before that as I hired a broker to find me insurance while I was self employed and because of a medication I took at the time .. no one would cover me so ACA was a god send. Until about 2 years ago .. I never really had medical issues. I visit a doctor 4 times a year maybe and used teladoc but about 2 years ago I got very sick which required emergency room care, paddles to the chest to get my heart working right and 5 days in the hospital. Bill before insurance came to just about \$80,000. Add to that some additional aftercare added later. Insurance did their part and I averted financial catastrophe. Yay ACA!!!!!!!!!!!!!! This year selections on ACA in Arizona seemed far less than usual and the company I had been using was priced out of reach so I selected Imperial Health Gold Standard. It costs me just \$200 less than what my rent does a month but .. When you need it the cost pales in comparison to hospital costs. About a week or so after choosing the plan I got the bill. Paid on November 24. Then .. nothing. I got a receipt but didnt hear anything else From Imperial Health Insurance for weeks. Wasn't even sure I was going to have insurance since I received no confirmation. Nothing. Second week of December I start looking around on the net for information and many of their links dont work. The links that do work point you at websites that look like they haven't been updated since 1990. A little nervous but I figure "hey if removing polished (functioning) websites and extra paper helps keep the cost down cool" Finally I find a number and call only to do the phone chase through different people out of country trying to find out if I am indeed covered for the coming year. I do get my membership number and am assured I will be covered. This took about 3 hours. With it I find my online membership card. I am now HOURS into this. I discover the pcp they picked for me is 60 miles from where I live. I do not live in some remote area. I live in Mesa AZ so I know there must be closer doctors. Problem is, while my last insurance company allowed you to change PCP online .. there was no provision for doing so with Imperial health so back to the phones. A primary reason I selected Imperial Insurance is because on ACA it stated that Imperial health Insurance covered my PCP who I used for 5 years+ and the hospital my doctor was associated with. I got it changed and was told to expect a packet from them with my card and that the first card would have the Assigned PCP and a little later I would get the card with my chosen PCP. The company was a little behind and was just sending out "Packages" And I waited. it was nerve racking as I had always received at least a welcome to the company letter/email something but nothing .. just ghost. No "packet" no nothing. Comes Jan1 .. still no card. Now I already downloaded the card from the site I found but .. not everyone knows how to dig through internet garbage to get to that point and had I indeed needed doctoring on the 1st .. I would have been unable to prove I had insurance. I paid for insurance that would begin on the 1st and had no way of proving I had insurance on the 1st. On Jan 2nd .. I try to call to find out where the "Packet and card were. Automated service said would I like a call back .. Nope I will wait .. Great you are number 250 on line. I guess a bunch of other people were wondering where their card was as well!?!? The morning of the 3rd I picked up my card at the mail. There was a single sheet. at the bottom was a paper thin card. Fine we are saving money. The letter had a brief three sentences that said here is your card and if you want to know anything go to Imperial health . com. There is virtually no useful information at the site they direct you to. You will have to do long term digging from there. Personal .. here is your plan and here is what is covered is not available at that site or its links Had I not started to chase this down earlier I would have had to submit a request to change pcp and wait 24 hrs plus or use the one they gave me which was 60 miles away. No snap shot of coverage no nothing .. here is your card 2 days late and if you want to know anything .. go to our shitty website and try and find out. Luckily I take care of my health so hope to have a year like last year where I used insurance 4 times but if this is their level of organization up front .. I am very concerned what will happen if an emergency arises .. I am not two weeks into Insurance with Imperial Health, cant afford to go without insurance and cant change it but .. If your still selecting for Feb1 start .. I would look elsewhere. This company does not seem to have its shit together and trust me .. when the medical bills start flying .. you need a company that has their shit together. We learned that with my Emergency and with my wifes cancer diagnosis and treatment. I do not feel confident with Imperial health but

wont go without insurance so now I am stuck Edited to add I have been trying this website since I received my membership number so about 3 weeks. This is what I get .. a spinning wheel that says Processing and this will spin forever. Tried it in Brave, Firefox and Edge. None of them can open this page. It contains information about my plan .. I cant see it!? I have been trying for almost a month. I think the site servers are overwhelmed so I cant arrange autopay, see my policy or .. anything but that spinning circle. <https://preview.redd.it/cokxg0a9jkcg1.jpg?width=3060&format=pjpg&auto=webp&s=83258471e1a05666f536b5fd6d325b744f7507d6>";

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · None

"Love this topic! You answered my question to when to Roth convert. We are on ACA now ages 60 and 61. We pay zero for bronze plan up to 65k of income. We withdraw 50k from Traditional IRA and the rest from brokerage account. Just requires good bookkeeping. Dividends , interest, and capital gains creep up quickly for income. Taking SS at age 67. Will Roth convert up to 22 percent bracket at age 66. Love your work!!"

— YouTube · Healthcare Before 65: In-Depth ACA vs. Roth Conversion Analysis · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gUjrNm-VLF8&lc=UgwXJ4XevSHcyYmgQet4AaABAg>

↳ @user-ph-f5c (2): "That is almost exactly what I am doing as well. 👍 "

"Please help! Best insurance in NJ for someone disabled with chronic illness and schizophrenia ASAP!! **NJ FamilyCare, or state Medicaid, is very different from federal Medicaid and I'm looking for people who have understanding of NJ STATE resources rather than federal insurance.** I'm 25F, have a diagnosis of schizoaffective disorder, opioid use disorder on MAT injections and fibromyalgia, and I see multiple providers every month including weekly therapy, bi-weekly medication, zero to 2-3 hospitalizations or inpatient psych treatments a year, monthly suboxone injections, monthly pain management/rheumatology and physical therapy, and like 6-7 monthly medications and bloodwork every 3-6 months for those meds. My insurance migrated to a plan that doesn't have mental health care, so I'm looking for a new insurance on very short notice. I am unemployed and my income is under 23k, but my parents (who make >150k) have agreed to help me financially for the next 6-12 months, so reasonably my budget is a hundred or couple hundred dollars a month. So, I can either go NJ FamilyCare Horizon BCBS, or a private insurance like Aetna PPO or Horizon BCBS PPO or HMO. I have had private, family based top or silver tier PPOs usually Aetna or BCBS sometimes through a third-party employer plan since I was diagnosed years ago, and the provider network is large with the care excellent but it is very expensive, too expensive to reasonably use it the amount I'd like to if money wasn't an issue. Wide network, but extremely pricey, too pricey to fully utilize, and difficult to navigate when claims are denied by the company. Services known as first-line treatments for SMIs such as schizophrenia like ACT, CSC CI and ICMS, case management, day programs or psychiatric rehabilitation are generally off the table and Medicaid/NJFC only. Terrible, TERRIBLE customer service network with no case management, healthcare consolidation, or help when things go wrong with services or coverage and you try to call their phone line. I called a broker through Health Benefits 360 who recommended NJ Family Care as I am in the income bracket and said it's the best fit for my situation with chronic illness, frequent healthcare use, SMI (serious mental illness) and other mental health and substance abuse recovery resources for the most affordable price. However, I've done some research and the network seems much much smaller and I don't know if the quality of these providers is great, good or poor, I had a friend on Medicaid during college who received very poor quality of services, though they were free, and she had chronic conditions, but I don't know if she was on the state or federal coverage. Based on my situation above, can you recommend which insurance would be the best fit for me, even if it's not something that I have mentioned? More than anything, please understand I want to receive good quality care as first priority and have the financial means to not have to compromise on that. It needs to be a widely accepted insurance, either Aetna or BCBS preferably so that my current providers will migrate over, and a plan that CAN be used frequently well and not in a way that rips me off. But in terms of the exact best plan, I could really use some help and ASAP. I need to be ready to switch within this week so that I can start my coverage on October 1st. Also, feel free to recommend websites where I can get connected to a good broker that will help. I need a broker as I am too disabled to complete a long application alone. Specifically, brokers that understand my situation and do both private insurance and Medicaid. COBRA is not an option unless someone knows a cheaper way to receive it. Edit: Just spoke to broker and another option is ObamaCare or ACA-capped insurance. Thank you very much."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · None

Politics deciding their premium · 29 documents · 20 voices

"My daughter is a surg/tech student. The doctor stuck her with a needle during a procedure. My daughter has insurance but not for that hospital. Now she owes \$1800 for getting treated at the hospital where she got stuck. Not sure what to do. My daughter is a surgical tech student. During one of her procedures in February, the doctor accidentally stuck her with a dirty needle. The doctor told her to go down to the triage so she could get the proper care for sticks, which included a blood test (plus a follow-up test 2 weeks later). My daughter has healthcare thru the government (Obamacare, basically). She got a bill from her teaching hospital for her medical care for \$1800. Her insurance is denying it because she isn't covered at the hospital where she works. What should she do? This is such an unusual situation, and I can't find advice anywhere (other than 'call an attorney', which would cost more than the \$1800). Suggestions? (on a good note, the patient was tested for any diseases and came back clean, so no worries on that front)"

— r/HealthInsurance · 929 upvotes · None

"Girlfriend had \$0 monthly premium; now will be \$890. She doesn't make \$700 a month... We're in Alabama. She has BCBS Blue Standardized Silver EPO. I'm not knowledgeable enough to know why, but I'm assuming her premium shot up because of the ACA subsidy cuts. Apparently she is in the "Medicaid gap"... Not entirely sure what to do except tell her to drop it until we can find a better solution, as much as I hate saying that. We weren't planning on getting married, but I'm beginning to consider it so my employer can get her on family coverage under my policy... Next November...."

— r/HealthInsurance · 780 upvotes · None

"2026 ACA prices are live on Healthcare.gov. Here's our household's official ACA pricing for next year. **Special disclaimer for 2026: Everything in this post assumes that Congress does not extend the COVID subsidy enhancements and that the default ACA subsidy rules return for 2026.** Anyone can now see the 2026 prices and plans in their area with some anonymous data (age/zip/income/etc) in about three minutes at <https://www.healthcare.gov/see-plans/#/>. If you have a local state-run exchange, then you'll be redirected. State exchanges all update on their own schedule, so 2026 prices may or may not be live just yet. For those who may not be familiar with the ACA, below is an actual real-world example of what being on the ACA can be like with the default subsidy systems. The prices below are for a married couple with an average age of 52 and with MAGI under 133% of the Federal Poverty Level (FPL), which qualifies us for the maximum possible amount of ACA subsidies from both the premium tax credit (PTC) subsidy system and cost-sharing reduction (CSR) subsidy system. We have three dependent children as well, one of which will be on our ACA policy, and we live in a non-expansion state, so expansion Medicaid does not apply to us. Keep in mind that the premiums below would be much higher for a couple if they were in their 60s rather than in their 40s/50s like us. Tobacco users can expect to pay up to 50% additional premium on top of the age-rating. If we were both 62, then the unsubsidized Bronze premium below would rise from \$19,140 to \$27,168. Prices also can vary incredibly between states. If we were both 62 and living in West Virginia instead of Texas, then our Bronze premium would rise from \$27,168 to \$49,584. If instead we were living in Minnesota, then our Bronze premium would fall from \$27,168 to \$21,696. I have also included the policy options we would likely take if we were either eligible only for premium subsidies and not also cost-sharing reductions, as well as the plan we would likely take if we were ineligible for any subsidies at all. People who are over 200% FPL should generally avoid Silver plans due to the way states have elected to deal with the loss of federal funding for the cost-sharing reduction subsidy system, so while I have provided the full market price of our Silver plan, please note that almost nobody would want to ever buy that plan at that price as better Bronze and Gold options are available. ____ Our 2026 Silver plan with subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (based purely on MAGI): * \$84 in annual premium * \$0/\$0 deductible (individual/family) * \$0 PCP * \$10 specialist * \$5 urgent care * \$0/\$15 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$2,200/\$4,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ Our 2026 Silver plan without subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (full market price): * \$26,892 in annual premium * \$6,000/\$12,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$40 PCP * \$80 specialist * \$60 urgent care * \$20/\$40 tier1/tier2 scripts * 40% ER coinsurance * \$8,900/\$17,800 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 Gold plan we would pick if our MAGI was just above 200% FPL (no meaningful CSRs): * \$2,952 in annual premium * \$2,000/\$4,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$30 PCP * \$60 specialist * \$45 urgent care * \$15/\$30 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$8,200/\$16,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 HSA-compatible Bronze plan we would pick if we qualified for zero subsidies/CSRs (MAGI above 400% FPL, factoring in max MAGI-reducing HSA contributions) * \$19,140 in annual premium * \$7,500/\$15,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$50 PCP * \$100 specialist * \$75 urgent care * \$25/\$50 tier1/tier2 scripts * 50% ER coinsurance * \$10,000/\$20,000 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____"

— r/obamacare · 571 upvotes · None

"ACA Subsidies ending Hey all, my mom is losing her insurance at the end of 2025 due to the new bill ending ACA subsidies, raising her monthly payments from \$500 to \$1300 if she loses all the subsidies, which she cannot afford, she can't really afford to lose any of it. Does anyone have any suggestions or weird loopholes on what to do? For some context we are all born in the U.S., we live in Texas, she is in her 50s and is divorced from my father, income less than 62k"

— r/HealthInsurance · 531 upvotes · None

"Insurance carriers increased rates on ACA plans with based off the expectation of lower enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are put back in, what happens to the now jacked up rates that were already approved by states and sold during open-enrollment? Carriers have increased full cost rates ahead of schedule because they expect a drop in enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are reinstated, what happens to the already inflated rates? Each insurance carrier must get its rate increase approved by the state annually, often months before open enrollment. This year, carriers justified rate hikes primarily by citing: 1. Lower projected enrollment numbers due to expiring ACA subsidies 2. The rising cost of GLP-1 weight loss drugs (even though most ACA marketplace plans don't cover these) I'm re-emphasizing because I fear people will still confuse the question. I am not talking about increases people are seeing based off loss of their personal subsidy, I am talking about the plan's actual cost. Aka, what someone would pay if they didn't receive subsidy. My state approved my insurance company for a 27% increase for 2026. They have again applied that increase disproportionately, increasing the individual plans more than their group plans. My personal non-subsidized cheapest HSA eligible ACA plan went up 40% on just the premium, with increases in the cost-sharing amounts as well. This is about average across my local market. Their group rate plans only went up by single digit amounts. Even if the government reinstates subsidies, I'm not hearing anyone addressing the issue of rate increases that relied on inaccurate enrollment projections. Open enrollment has already begun. Will these companies be forced to rework their approved plans retroactively? Are we going to get refunds? I don't see it happening. If they don't, the insurance companies will profit even more from this political situation. This event has allowed them to quickly raise plan costs beyond their actual expenses. If it's too late for 2026, what's the chances they'll actually lower rates even for 2027?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 229 upvotes · None

"HDHPs suck if you actually need them. Because our subsidy expired, we are now paying \$1200 a month for 2 people for a bronze plan with an \$8000 deductible per person. CO, both 52, \$160k income. We went from \$1200 buying us great gold coverage to \$1200 and paying for our own care literally overnight. As it happens, for a bit of uterine bleeding, I actually need the insurance this year. All of the procedures I need – ultrasound, biopsy, and hysteroscopy – are subject to the deductible. And after the deductible, they're only covered at 40% by Select Health. What kind of insurance is this? We're basically paying high premiums for the privilege of paying for our own healthcare. This was the cheapest Obamacare option we could find. Where are all the HDHPs with lower premiums? We worked with a broker, and there weren't any. The contract company that employs my husband had an HDHP where the premium was even higher. At these prices, we can't even afford to fund an HSA. We didn't see any HDHPs on the exchange with premium is less than \$1000 a month. How are people affording this? HDHPs are not a bargain anymore, it seems. We make well over six figures, but since so much of our income is going to healthcare premiums, we have to drain our savings over any healthcare we need. And if you have HDHP insurance, you can't even pay a lower cash price to the facility. You have to pay the higher insurance negotiated price, even if you're paying 100% of the cost. And if I want sedation for these procedures (don't even get me started about how painful in office gynecology is), it's even more expensive. So basically, anything between a well-woman visit (free) and cancer (chemo meets that deductible pretty quick) is going to give you medical debt. This is indescribably unbelievable. Wow, this sucks."

— r/HealthInsurance · 199 upvotes · None

"As a 59 years old retiree, I pay \$2264 per month for COBRA health insurance for me and my wife. I just checked ACA rates for us, it was over \$1000 per month more. I don't qualify for subsidies. Something is wrong with the ACA when its so much more costly without government subsidies."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 29 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgznxjuSyfTqcBbN1kp4AaABAg

↳ @beautyandplay (3): "probably better with private plans."

↳ @nata3467 (0): "how much are you and your wife making ?"

↳ @acevers (0): "That's because you were a productive person before retirement. Only bums and disabled people get deals and freebies, and your taxes pay for it. Sucks."

"If I submit ACA application now and enhanced subsidies come back in the coming weeks, can I still get them? I want to see what my updated pricing would be under current circumstances. I've updated my application, but I just want to make sure that if the subsidies come back before open enrollment ends, that I haven't ruled myself out of getting them. I won't actually sign up for a plan yet, just want to submit my application so I can get an idea what I'm working with. Does anybody know whether that's ok without putting myself at risk of missing out if they come back?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 28 upvotes · None

"Crazy idea - what do you think? Hi, there. Without being too wordy (happy to elaborate if needed), I wanted to ask for input on this idea I have. We make too much money to qualify for ANY subsidies next year (we're not "rich", but we're above the cutoff). Because of this, our health insurance is going to go from \$900 a month for the two of us (already outrageously expensive for the high deductible, bronze plan we have) to \$3,500 PER MONTH. Yes, per month. That comes to \$42,000 per year. And again, that's before paying for any of the actual medical expenses we may incur. I have confirmed this with an insurance agent so it's not just me miscalculating (and yes, I plan to discuss this with the agent as well, but I love the Reddit forums so here I am). I'm thinking there might be something I'm not understanding, but here's my idea - couldn't we just not have health insurance and if something catastrophic comes up (cancer diagnosis, for example), we could move (we have the option to change residency because we do own a home in another state) and then use the special enrollment period to get insurance? I mean, remember - we're talking \$42,000 per year otherwise - and that's before anything even happens. Thanks for your input."

— r/HealthInsurance · 24 upvotes · None

"ACA plans versus just enrolling through private insurer I cannot seem to find an answer to this anywhere I estimate my MAGI to be around ~40k next year. I am not offered health insurance through employer bc I work part time. I have decent amount of assets so I don't have trouble paying higher premiums each month (it also makes my income less predictable with dividends, capital gains etc but i try to keep it as close to 40k as possible with 401k contributions, trad IRA etc.) My question is -- If I go with [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) and get a plan there with a subsidy, at the end of the year does it all even out if I were to just pay the higher premium and get the tax rebate when I file taxes? My accountant complains about [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) plans when I file taxes and recommends I just get it directly with the insurer. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 20 upvotes · None

"Journalist seeking NYers concerned about ACA subsidies Hi I'm Caroline Lewis, a health care reporter with the NYC public radio station WNYC. I'm working on a story about how ACA insurance subsidies will be reduced if enhanced tax credits are allowed to expire at the end of this year. I'm looking to speak with NYC residents who have insurance through the state's ACA exchange (known here as New York State of Health) and who are concerned about their plans becoming less affordable. If you are interested in speaking with me, please send me a message here or email me at clewis@wnyc.org. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 14 upvotes · None

"I wasn't anticipating making a lot when I quit my job. So I got the government subsidized health insurance and then towards the end of the year I got a new client and made a lot of money and did not make any changes. Low and behold, I owe the government approximately \$2500 back when I filed my taxes"

— YouTube · How To Get Better Health Insurance If You're Self Employed I TIPS TO SAVE ON YOUR MEDICAL · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0eQnHCaWhT8&lc=UgwC9G5F_HnwoQXN6ih4AaABAq

↳ @chadwickcameron (2): "That's a great problem to have. You kept your money and hopefully, YOU made interest on it for a few months. Well done!"

↳ @VictoriaDorsano (1): "Yeah, that's usually what will happen! But I typically like to preserve cash flow initially, then if I need to pay back the subsidy later, oh well. But in either case, it's an unpleasant bill. Congrats on the new client though!"

↳ @jamesphillips7283 (0): "Find 2500 in tax write offs"

"I retired at 42, and went without health insurance until two years after the ACA was passed. For 8 years until this year I had excellent insurance at a reasonable cost *to me*. About \$3,600 to \$5,500. I received \$90,000 in subsidies in those 8 years - I think the premium in the last year was \$17,500. My income was under 400% of FPL every year - a max of \$48,000 of dividend and interest income. The extended subsidies that are expiring are what controlled my share of premiums the last 3 years I was on it - otherwise due to the fact the cost of the policy keeps increasing, my cost would likely have gone up another \$1,000 per year. The ACA did a great thing, but it was not designed to address the cost of healthcare, only the out of pocket cost of health insurance. I feel bad for the those who have the uncertainty of what their premiums will be."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 6 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgzDakFFzQQVR62t9hJ4AaABAq

↳ @Bill_Woo (5): "You're welcome for the \$90,000. I paid for it - while not drawing one penny since the law was passed. The only "certainty" is that our cost of living and price inflation suffer impoverishingly due to the subsidies."

↳ @cjlopez2803 (0): "@Bill_Wooyou likely have workplace coverage where both you and your employer are getting a tax break by paying for your healthcare coverage with pretax dollars which I'm subsidizing...you're welcome 😂"

"The ACA was not ever intended for early retirement, so the pain of the enhanced subsidies going away is really self inflicted. Having said that I was really hoping the enhanced subsidies would be extended for the current early retirees but also the ACA was my plan. Now I will just think of another way!"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgzNb723lBr-pBKrcyJ4AaABAg

↳ @chrisforker7487 (1): "Or live on less than 85k a year!"

"Interesting since every subsidy calculator I have tried out, there is a cutoff 85,000 for household of 2. I get \$0 subsidy after 85,000"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgymMvC-lcDLydeumgR4AaABAg

↳ @Factsmatter626 (0): "Same here by less than \$1000."

"If the premium subsidies expire, does the cliff apply to tax year 2025? I'm currently receiving an ACA subsidy of approximately 1100 a month. It looks like this year my modified adjusted gross income is going to be slightly over the 400% of the fpl. If the premium subsidies are not renewed and expires at the end of 2025, does the cliff apply to the 2025 tax year? If so, then I would be on the hook to pay it all back?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · None

"I know it's legal, but am I the only one who has a problem with a couple that have enough assets to live on \$100,000 per year and receive an annual \$17,000 government (our tax dollars) subsidy?"

— YouTube · Healthcare Before 65: In-Depth ACA vs. Roth Conversion Analysis · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gUjrNm-VLF8&lc=UgzEylF6CmaqZEsQB0N4AaABAg>

↳ @Bill-vk7fh (3): "I feel the same way, but do you pay more taxes than you need to ?"

↳ @user-ph-f5c (3): "@SchmittycocoPop Problem is private insurance companies don't want to insure anyone with preexisting conditions, which most people do as they get older, at least the ACA solved that problem."

↳ @dakkon74 (2): "@Bill-vk7fh I don't think he is blaming the couple for taking advantage of the subsidy. More so that the subsidy for high net worth people exists. I kind of feel he has a point."

"Is income too high to qualify through CHIP or SSI? Have you checked the Medicaid waivers? Have you actually talked to a social worker through the children's hospital to see if they have any ideas? Other than that your options are to pay the premium, move to a state with a Medicaid Waiver with no waitlists she will qualify for (every waiver and state is different) or find a job that will offer health insurance for dependents. Maybe if you are lucky the congressional fight over ACA subsidies will be won and the government will resume marketplace subsidies next year although I wouldn't hold my breath on that one. If you run out of options and can't afford the OOP medical expenses touch base with the hospital's social worker to find out about applying for charity care for her. My son is 21 years old with two genetic syndromes and has significant medical needs. I always tried to keep as many eligibility pathways to Medicaid open as possible. That way if they yank one path you can go down the other path. Most parents do this by keeping SSI and a Medicaid Waiver on their child which are both pathways to Medicaid. My son has both SSI and a Medicaid Waiver but both qualifications are based on severity of his disabilities. To give you an idea my son has an abnormal heart and we never even discuss the issue when qualifying for these programs because they aren't the focus."

— r/Medicaid · https://www.reddit.com/r/Medicaid/comments/1o1fcqi/nc_losing_medicaid_for_medically_complex_child/nig75la/

"I'm surprised you got any subsidy whatsoever with that income. You're well over the 400% of the federal poverty level and that's where the ACA subsidies are ending if they aren't extended by congress. People will start needing to get jobs that offer benefits at an affordable price (I know, easier said than done, believe me) . Large employers have an obligation to make the benefits affordable- or they pay a 4K fine per person that gets benefits from the Marketplace (with a subsidy) This is why employers typically offer at least 1 plan that meets those affordability standards. It might be a crap plan with a high ded/oomp, but it still has to have an actuarial value that meets minimum value (covers at least 60%) And, if it's a company that has lower paid staff as well, they have to make it affordable for them too- so many stick to the \$105 per month or so threshold for employee only coverage. IN 2026, using \$20 per hour and 130 hours per month, the employer has to offer at least 1 plan that's at 129.90 per month or less for employee only."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1o8gdh7/wow_looking_at_my_2026_insurance_its_half_my_rent/njw2oju/

">I haven't really heard too much about how the ACA works as a freelancer I don't *think* it's any different to buying health insurance yourself on the marketplace - you get subsidies depending on how much you earn, and you just use your total earnings to determine how much the insurance costs. If you end up earning more or less than predicted, that gets taken care of in your EOY filings, and you'll either pay or refund the difference. 30% is a good rule of thumb for total tax, assuming your state levies one in addition to self-employment and federal. I have problems with finding things to write off, but the big one is choosing to be taxed as an S Corp. Doing that means you can avoid paying self-employment tax on some of your income, but it only really becomes worthwhile if you earn \$60K + in a year. If you're interested in that, talk to a CPA."

— r/freelance · https://www.reddit.com/r/freelance/comments/k06s12/behind_the_scenes_of_a_small_freelance_editing/gdhskd3/

Premiums that doubled or tripled · 26 documents · 20 voices

"The scariest part... from someone who works at a health insurance company I work at a large health insurance company, and lately all I hear about is the potential end of ACA subsidies, rising premiums, and skyrocketing healthcare costs. But the part no one's talking about? This could become the new normal. When has any industry ever raised prices and then actually brought them back down once people got used to paying more? Even if healthcare costs drop (and that's a big if), what incentive do insurers have to lower premiums when people are already paying the higher rates? It's like gas... people used to complain about \$2.50 a gallon. Now we celebrate it. That's the scary part. Prices rise, we adapt, and eventually we forget what "reasonable" even looked like. Unless wages start catching up, we're all in serious trouble."

— r/HealthInsurance · 2,664 upvotes · None

"My family's health insurance is set to go from \$170 per month in 2025 to \$1560 in 2026 due to expiring ACA credits. A few clarifying points: - I earn approx \$125k as the sole provider for my family of 4 - I am self employed - This is the cheapest possible plan I could find anywhere - Coverage for this plan is terrible and helps me exactly \$0 with our family's actual health expenses I don't even know how I'm supposed to form thoughts around this. I can barely breathe let alone wrap my mind around this. How the hell am I supposed to survive in this country the way it is now? It seems like the world is actively punishing people who have families, or anyone who is not a multimillionaire. This is just one problem in a cornucopia of financial disasters handed to me as a millennial parent. This is not even mentioning how the new student loan rulings will add hundreds of dollars per month of financial burden, nor how I will forever be priced out of the housing market and am doomed to ever increasing rent month after month, or how food costs have practically doubled for my family over the past 5 years. How bad is it to go without health insurance in the new year? I literally have no idea what else to do..."

— r/HealthInsurance · 776 upvotes · None

"Virginia ACA Rates Posted Today: Share Your Increase In Virginia and rates came up today. Self employed couple 59 & 61. This year our premium was \$1187/month. Same plan next year \$2,109/month. This is more than my mortgage payment and a \$922/month increase brings the total yearly cost to \$50,616. We will have to switch to a high deductible low quality Bronze plan with a \$7,500 deductible EACH with a monthly premium of \$1452/month. This is beyond belief. Continue contacting your elected officials people 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 584 upvotes · None

"Healthcare Premiums to Skyrocket (Who Can Afford it?) Premium tax credits are set to expire at the end of 2025, which means premiums will be skyrocketing. How can anyone afford this? Premiums are already so high that so many families have trouble affording them, now they will be even higher? Who here can afford an increase in their premiums? All that this will mean is less people will be insured because they can't afford premiums. Subsidies will be reduced a great deal as well for those at or near the poverty line. The subsidies were allowing folks to be insured because premiums were discounted. Remove or reduce the discount, and those people won't be able to be insured. Healthcare is prohibitively expensive already, and it's about to become even more expensive. How can anyone afford this? My guess is that most people can't. Does the gov know what this will do to families' bottom lines? Concerned,"

— r/HealthInsurance · 293 upvotes · None

"Insurance carriers increased rates on ACA plans with based off the expectation of lower enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are put back in, what happens to the now jacked up rates that were already approved by states and sold during open-enrollment? Carriers have increased full cost rates ahead of schedule because they expect a drop in enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are reinstated, what happens to the already inflated rates? Each insurance carrier must get its rate increase approved by the state annually, often months before open enrollment. This year, carriers justified rate hikes primarily by citing: 1. Lower projected enrollment numbers due to expiring ACA subsidies 2. The rising cost of GLP-1 weight loss drugs (even though most ACA marketplace plans don't cover these) I'm re-emphasizing because I fear people will still confuse the question. I am not talking about increases people are seeing based off loss of their personal subsidy, I am talking about the plan's actual cost. Aka, what someone would pay if they didn't receive subsidy. My state approved my insurance company for a 27% increase for 2026. They have again applied that increase disproportionately, increasing the individual plans more than their group plans. My personal non-subsidized cheapest HSA eligible ACA plan went up 40% on just the premium, with increases in the cost-sharing amounts as well. This is about average across my local market. Their group rate plans only went up by single digit amounts. Even if the government reinstates subsidies, I'm not hearing anyone addressing the issue of rate increases that relied on inaccurate enrollment projections. Open enrollment has already begun. Will these companies be forced to rework their approved plans retroactively? Are we going to get refunds? I don't see it happening. If they don't, the insurance companies will profit even more from this political situation. This event has allowed them to quickly raise plan costs beyond their actual expenses. If it's too late for 2026, what's the chances they'll actually lower rates even for 2027?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 229 upvotes · None

"Thinking of going uninsured for 2026 and paying the penalty.. Thoughts? Im 26 in California, I qualified for medical with my previous job but with this new job I make too much so I was looking at Covered California. For 2026 the CHEAPEST BRONZE plan I could qualify for will cost me \$340 with subsidies included and an insane deductible of \$7000. I think its ridiculous that a healthy 26 year old that eats right and goes to the doctors once a year just for consultation will pay that. Im Seriously considering going uninsured and I understand the potential risks. One bad injury or emergency hospital trip could cost me thousands. But if I get a high hospital bill I could work it out with their financial services department. based on my obligatory expenses I could justify I dont have money to pay this hypothetical bill. My question is: What do you guys recommend? Am I doing the math right? How much would I pay in tax penalties if I make 52k year. Edit*** Thank you guys for all the advice — a lot of you were right to point out how easy it is to underestimate how expensive and financially destructive a single hospital visit can be. That's exactly why I made this post, and I really appreciate the reality check. I ended up finding a catastrophic plan that meets California's standards and has zero deductible, which honestly feels like the best of the worst options right now. This doesn't mean I'm happy about it — I just made the most practical choice I could. We should never have to accept a system that makes people feel lucky just to afford to get sick. But we already normalized this."

— r/HealthInsurance · 222 upvotes · None

"My premium increased 590%. Is this normal? I understand without the enhanced subsidies we'd be seeing double or triple premiums next year. However, my premium skyrocketed. In 2025, I paid \$80 and my premiums are set to increase to \$552. The lowest option available was \$300 for catastrophic insurance which wouldn't work for me. I had to go with the \$450 option. I put that my income was \$730 biweekly after deductions. My take home pay is \$1200 a month. My friend in Florida makes the same as me and her premium only increased from \$11 to \$50. My coworker in Wisconsin is also getting a similar low cost option. I am so confused why my premium increased so much. Did anyone else in Illinois experience this? Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level. Edit: also, my parents are helping to pay part of my premiums for now. Otherwise, I'd be out of luck. Even though I'm grateful, it doesn't feel good having to rely on my parents for this. But knowing my health history I could end up in serious trouble if I go uninsured. Update: After a month on the marketplace plan, I was found eligible for Medicaid so it ended up working out at the end. I was worried since I'd been denied for Medicaid in the past. It looks like the increased premiums finally made me eligible."

— r/HealthInsurance · 152 upvotes · None

""Get Covered Illinois"--2026 premium notices sent out today. This year, Illinois switched over to its own program, rather than using Healthcare.gov. 2026 premiums hit the street today. The unsubsidized premium for me and my wife (both in our early to mid-60s) is \$2,915.99. This represents a 17% premium increase from 2025. In Illinois, my carrier, Blue Cross/Blue Shield, had gotten approved for an average 27% premium increase across all of its policy forms; I'm not sure why we got the smaller percentage increase. I had thought that people our age would have been hit with the highest percentage increase in premiums. The automatic renewal letter that I got described my projected monthly subsidy, and my "monthly premium" (in other words, the subsidized premium). I figured out the total unsubsidized premium by adding those figures together. Because of the way that the numbers were laid out in the letter, it appears that the people who run the Illinois program believe that Federal subsidies will be renewed for 2026."

— r/HealthInsurance · 131 upvotes · None

"Georgia - just got my estimate on rate increase. Guess I'll be doing without. I've been using Ambetter for a few years with a few hiccups but overall it worked. Make around 23k per year. Had a Silver plan for around \$150.00. Just got my notice via the GA marketplace. Similar plan that no longer includes the vision and dental I had in the old plan, will be \$479.00. Guess I'll be doing without this year and hope for the best. Multiple health issues and prescriptions. Can't get Medicaid here. Welcome to the new world."

— r/HealthInsurance · 82 upvotes · None

"I'm confused why the same plan my girlfriend and I choose went up for her, but stayed the same for me? We both signed up for Oscar Gold Elite last year and each have our incomes which are unfortunately low. Same jobs and same income for this year... But for some reason my premium for the same plan stayed at the exact same price of \$40, but hers more than doubled to \$100. We use our premium tax credits but she uses the insurance more than I do because she had asthma but does that have anything to do with it? I'm a bit confused because I don't understand this stuff very well despite watching many videos on it. Any help is greatly appreciated."

— r/HealthInsurance · 7 upvotes · None

"Well this isnt the case for me. My premiums increased by \$900 a month thanks to the changes made in the new bill passed"

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=Ugw7er9470USJbsd5cx4AaABAg>

↳ @HappyonMonday (2): "Yikes! I'm so sorry to hear that. 😞 "

"ACA income estimation How does ACA premium tax credits work relative to income estimation? I have never had insurance through ACA. I was terminated a few months ago and unable to COBRA. We are a family of 5. Both my wife and I will try to pick up work/gigs where we can. However with uncertain times, who knows how much money will come in. So when looking at ACA income estimation for 2026, it looks like below a certain amount (for my state of SC) of 37.8k, it has our family ineligible for premium tax credits (but kids would qualify for Medicaid). If I raise income by 2,000 per year, the premium tax credit jumps to 1822 per month from zero for my wife and I. Going from 38 to 40 to 50k, it stays around 1800. Going to 60K it drops to 1656. 70k 1543, 80k 1417, then 90K jumps up to 2465, then starts trickling down again. At 150,601 it drops from 1818 to zero. Can someone ELI5 me the logic of that jump in premium tax credit when going from 80K to 90K? What happens at tax time if I overestimate the income? If I underestimate the income? What happens at re-enrollment next year in those cases? Not looking for debate in the issue, but now I hear that subsidies may not be renewed for next year. But this morning, I read it may only apply to something called a subsidy cliff, and that subsidies will be paid as before 2020. My head is spinning with trying to grasp this."

— r/HealthInsurance · 4 upvotes · None

"Thanks Joe. Been retired for 1.5 years now and went on the ACA in California. Was paying \$900/month for Kaiser HSA plan. Looks like our premiums are going to jump to \$2000/month on the same plan with the ACA subsidies going away. Definitely going to check out Move Health and see if they may have something that will work for us. Appreciate the information you provide and I hope you get that affiliate link! :)"

— YouTube · How to Get Affordable Health Insurance Before Medicare · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dVyzw5Ac7pA&lc=UgxM5fBHJOEY45zQLv54AaABAg>

↳ @keithwiebe1787 (5): "If you get something else be aware that you may not have protections that the ACA plan does and you could risk your entire nest egg if not careful. That's what I see with the "Christian" health plans. Why would someone risk their entire nest egg to that?"

↳ @michaellindsay955 (1): "@keithwiebe1787 - Agreed. Pretty happy with what we have and we would not do one of the Christian plans you mentioned. Looked into them a bit and, for our situation, they have too much risk. Thanks for the feedback."

↳ @tachikaze222 (1): "@EJJ-EvArms yes, this is the answer. The "ACA Cliff" really ain't no joke for Gen X now. Hit 400% FPL + \$1 and you get exposed to the full glory of the US Health system right when you're most expensive an insurance customer. I'm thinking of moving to Japan for a year before age 65, partially to escape this trap LOL"

"My ACA premiums will make a huge jump in '26 (percentage-wise) due to the end of extended ACA benefits - from \$4 to \$124/mo. Additionally, there are no longer plans available without co-pays or co-insurance, and the out-of-pocket max is also increasing significantly. I find it pretty much impossible to complain about that, though - incredibly grateful for this truly affordable health insurance."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=Ugyhoe7QYX42h_ByAt14AaABAg

↳ @dking1362 (0): "@robnunurbiznezz7618 Mine was a sarcastic " huge jump", but yours is for real. Ouch! Obviously a much higher income than me; maybe a private pay plan would work better? I had expected to pay about \$1k/mo. for insurance when I retired, so the ACA has been fantastic for me."

"I'm in MN. My premium for a silver plan will be double next year...that's with my higher ACA credits. Luckily I work with someone who can help me look for something more affordable."

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=UgxzwMByYvpo08TW-Jt4AaABAg>

↳ @HappyonMonday (0): "Yikes!! I'm glad you have someone who can help you find something else! 😊"

"I would like to drop Medicare all together. My premium went up 80%. I am not getting good Healthcare anyway, so why not keep the money so I can keep a roof over my head."

— YouTube · Health insurance premiums set to soar as ACA subsidies expire · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zWP4luZpu4&lc=UgyE7-6jRJM8rcIf5kt4AaABAg>

"@brandonbakhtiar7451 Thank you for sharing your knowledge of how health insurance companies work. I have a question, have you ever heard of any health insurance monthly premium costing \$4,600, again, per month ? My husband needed to retire slightly early, 2 years ago, and we are paying BC/BS of TN on a individual plan, for our son, and the two of us. I have arthritis, but no surgeries, no cancer or other major illnesses that you'd think, they would be having to pay out huge costs for. We can't understand why it's so much, and on top of the enormous monthly premium, they keep hassling us, the doctor and pharmacists. For example, not letting an already prior approved medicine last month, and the month before, and another example is that they require an assessment with a physical therapy place, before approving to have, ok we did that, then after doing that, BC/BS send us a bill for the assessment \$1,800 saying they don't cover the assessment! Every month it's costing so much, it's ridiculous and eating away our finances, and we're not eligible for social security or Medicare/Medicaid... Hence my question, have you heard of any other insurance companies charging this much? I appreciate anything you might be able to share, any ideas on how we can get a different policy that is more reasonably affordable. Thank you in advance if you do see this, since I see your comment was almost a year ago."

— YouTube · How To Get Better Health Insurance If You're Self Employed I TIPS TO SAVE ON YOUR MEDICAL · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0eQnHCaWhT8&lc=Ugw9ei59q56oHOf5MQ94AaABAg.9n7KqDD5hD8A18HmH-qod1>

"Another government program that keeps people poor. I know so many people who won't start working full time because it would cost them more in 'benefits' than the increase in hours would gain them. So they just sit there, barely scraping by, sucking off the taxpayer teet for their whole life. I grew up in poverty and the cycle is atrocious. These programs are awful, the ACA is awful, every government program is fraught with fraud. The number of people I know on disability for 'headaches/migraines' and other made up crap is insane. The entire socialist system is godawful. You can try to convince me that I'm wrong, but you won't. I grew up around it and I've seen it my whole life and I decided to get out of that joke of a system. Now I just pay like 40% of my income to support the BS system. I was self employed when the ACA came out and my premium more than tripled. The only positive to the ACA is pre-existing conditions, which could be a standalone law. The health insurance companies benefited, not the people. Even if I do retire early, hell if I want hardworking taxpayers subsidizing my healthcare when I clearly don't need it."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgyqLrllbAGmgEm0rb14AaABAg

"This, exactly this 🙄 . And it's not just the ACA portal, I've been seeing some business paid premiums more than doubling and with ridiculously high deductibles. I keep reading that it's just a subsidy thing and it absolutely is NOT, it's a combination of a shit show of greed. The premiums have skyrocketed since the extended subsidies were put in place, taking those extra subsidies away makes health insurance unattainable for many since they will have rates so high that it just isn't affordable. This entire health care situation, both ACA and employer supported, is completely unsustainable. Any halfassed system we did have is completely and irreparably broken. There is only so much money the working class has left, the billionaires have the majority and still want more but there's nothing left to give."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1onppcm/the_healthcare_system_in_this_us_is_an_abomination/nmz0ucv/

"She's wrong on one of her points. I AM sick but couldn't afford insurance before the rates went up. The reason I had to drop my health insurance is because I'm also unemployed for 3 years and given my age and disability I may not find work. Result, I will get sick but won't have the money to pay any bills so at least some of my illness will fall on the taxpayers. Let me correct that almost all of my hospital stay will fall on the taxpayers because even if they come after me for payment, I won't have the money and will die homeless and in medical debt."

— YouTube · Millions of Americans drop Affordable Care Act coverage after premiums spike · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wakcL0IHxuA&lc=UgygwgiO5LDHvbt7RMJ4AaABAg>

Deductibles so high the plan is useless · 18 documents · 18 voices

"Husband brings home \$5400 a month, health insurance costs \$1300...family of 4. What the hell. It was \$900 a month and I already felt like we were being stretched thin. I am a stay at home mom to two young children, daycare cost more than my paycheck, and I didn't have a career worth staying in. My husband and I both intend on picking up a side gig, probably DoorDash or something, just to get by. But how can we ever get ahead if health insurance keeps rising like crazy? My husbands job does offer health insurance but it's basically the same price with a higher deductible. The plan we are looking at on the Marketplace has a \$0 health deductible and a \$1500 drug deductible, with max OOP of \$19500 for my family. His health insurance as a \$6000 deductible per person, \$12000 for family and the max OOP is the same. So really the biggest question is do we want a lower deductible or lower max OOP, since the premiums are roughly the same...and we think we want the lower deductible. If 96K a year isn't enough for a family of 4 in Ohio now....then the middle class is fuckin dead."

— r/HealthInsurance · 664 upvotes · None

"Virginia ACA Rates Posted Today: Share Your Increase In Virginia and rates came up today. Self employed couple 59 & 61. This year our premium was \$1187/month. Same plan next year \$2,109/month. This is more than my mortgage payment and a \$922/month increase brings the total yearly cost to \$50,616. We will have to switch to a high deductible low quality Bronze plan with a \$7,500 deductible EACH with a monthly premium of \$1452/month. This is beyond belief. Continue contacting your elected officials people 🙄 "

— r/obamacare · 584 upvotes · None

"My new ACA premiums and deductible - considering just not having health insurance for a few years. So I had a life event last month that required me to get ACA. My monthly premium was \$485 and my deductible was \$7600. Just got an email saying my current health insurance will not be offered next year. Instead my new premium will be about \$560 and my deductible will be about \$11000. Also it seems many of my co-insurance will be higher by about \$70. And I'm not sure what else has changed for the worse. At this point I'm seriously considering not having health insurance for a few years. It seems cheaper to just plan a 3-week trip overseas and get better healthcare for much cheaper. You heard me - better! I just don't want to enable this defunct healthcare system anymore. If I'm in an accident I hope EMTALA saves my broke behind - in both senses of the phrase. I'll pay what I can then declare bankruptcy. If not life threatening, I'll take it overseas. A roundtrip ticket to India costs \$1500, \$1000 if you wait a month or so. That's less than three months premium. Over a year I can save up \$7000 in premiums. Saving up for one year buys me a full check up and a vacation trip. What do you think? Anyone considering the same thing? For those with kids - you have my sympathies."

— r/HealthInsurance · 574 upvotes · None

"\$2600/mth, \$6k deductible for wife and I Blue Shield Bronze HSA PPO w/ \$6k deductible is looking like \$2650/mth for 2026, for wife and I (middle aged, in good health). This is a CoveredCA ACA plan, and I'm self-employed. This is completely unaffordable. Having already cut all our costs to the bone, I only have one option, which is to raise my rates, and hope that my competitors will also be raising theirs too so mine aren't extortionate. The only other thing I could do it seems is to become younger, which I'll try and organize, but seems to have some complex issues. This is going to massively, massively spike inflation."

— r/HealthInsurance · 357 upvotes · None

"Thinking of going uninsured for 2026 and paying the penalty.. Thoughts? Im 26 in California, I qualified for medical with my previous job but with this new job I make too much so I was looking at Covered California. For 2026 the CHEAPEST BRONZE plan I could qualify for will cost me \$340 with subsidies included and an insane deductible of \$7000. I think its ridiculous that a healthy 26 year old that eats right and goes to the doctors once a year just for consultation will pay that. Im Seriously considering going uninsured and I understand the potential risks. One bad injury or emergency hospital trip could cost me thousands. But if I get a high hospital bill I could work it out with their financial services department. based on my obligatory expenses I could justify I dont have money to pay this hypothetical bill. My question is: What do you guys recommend? Am I doing the math right? How much would I pay in tax penalties if I make 52k year. Edit*** Thank you guys for all the advice — a lot of you were right to point out how easy it is to underestimate how expensive and financially destructive a single hospital visit can be. That's exactly why I made this post, and I really appreciate the reality check. I ended up finding a catastrophic plan that meets California's standards and has zero deductible, which honestly feels like the best of the worst options right now. This doesn't mean I'm happy about it — I just made the most practical choice I could. We should never have to accept a system that makes people feel lucky just to afford to get sick. But we already normalized this."

— r/HealthInsurance · 222 upvotes · None

"Going back to school for student medical insurance Many of us have increasing insurance costs, in my case it went from \$660/month last year with enhanced subsidies to \$1425/month this year with no subsidies so if retired or underemployed it becomes difficult to justify the costs. In my case I am a few years away from 65 but not wanting to work full-time (I am fortunate) due to my volunteer work I started looking for part time jobs with benefits. I was chasing a rabbit down a hole and found that as a part-time student within the UNC system I was eligible to also get student coverage. Some of the rules \-Have to be in a degree program \-Must attend on Campus \-Part-time = 6 credits Some numbers Not a student- ACA \$17,100/annual, \$2000 deductible max OOP \$8200 As a student \-Tuition/fees annually \$3872 (6 credits/semester) \-Medical insurance \$3168 (12-months) \$500 deductible max OOP \$4000 , campus clinic use unlimited with \$0 co-pay Total annual = \$7040 Additional student benefits (mandatory fees) \-Access to fitness center/pool \-Access to library \-Student discounts By going back to school I will save just under \$10k/annually So I enrolled and was accepted into a GIS program starting in Aug 26, not only will I be saving money but for me the structure of a schedule will help me fill in my week. Even if I became a full-time my annual costs would be \$11k/annual which would still be a savings over ACA only. I am fortunate to not need to work so YMMV, but thought I would share my adventure."

— r/HealthInsurance · 92 upvotes · None

"When I dropped my health insurance, the health system I use now offers me half off on visits. Why could they not do that when I had insurance? So I live in a crappy red state that doesn't support its citizens. When the ACA subsidies were dropped with the help of the clown in the White House, my health insurance went from \$200 a month to almost \$700. I ended up dropping it as work was a little slow and this was a lot of money for something that didn't help much. I had a \$8000 yearly deductible, office visits were higher than they should have been, and almost no drugs were reduced more than the discount card I used at the pharmacy. Basically a lot of money for crappy coverage. Now that I don't have insurance, doctors's visits are half off. Some other visits like urgent care and blood work are half off the full price. Why couldn't I get that price with insurance? It would have lowered the cost of insurance by (I guess) half and I may have ended up keeping it. Why are we being charged an inflated cost with insurance. I feel like I paid more in the end for doctors appointments and such with insurance when you take the high deductible in consideration. It just all sounds like a scam to be and the doctors and insurance companies are in on it together."

— r/HealthInsurance · 77 upvotes · None

"If I tell my doctor's office I don't have insurance, can they look up whether that's true or not? Context: I've been on Medicaid (in Illinois) for the last few years. I filled out my redetermination in September as usual, then got a letter at the very end of November that I no longer qualify (my income went up and I'm now at around ~\$25,000/year, before I was hovering right around the cut off, which is about \$21,000 I believe). So now I'm looking at Marketplace plans and man....they are all so so awful!! The deductibles are crazy, and it's basically a choice between paying hundreds a month in order to maybe pay \$20-40 each time you go to the doctor, or paying \$10-\$30 a month but paying \$100-\$300 every time to go to the doctor. I take psychiatric medications that I rely on. I've been stable on the same ones for a few years now. I only see my doctor (psychiatrist) four times a year, and it's basically just as a requirement for her to be able to approve my refills. My psychiatrist's office offers sliding scale for uninsured patients, and I would only need to pay about \$35 per visit with them (plus about \$13/month for my meds with GoodRx coupons). This is a setup I could afford, so I was leaning towards just not buying health insurance at all for the coming year and paying for my care out of pocket this way. HOWEVER. I'm 29 years old, and this year two people I know who are even younger than I am were diagnosed with cancer. My parents got in a very scary car accident about two weeks ago (they rolled down a mountain but are miraculously fine because my dad's car is basically a tank). My point being, life has been reminding me a lot recently that no one knows what's going to happen tomorrow, and I feel like having SOME kind of coverage for if things go horribly horribly wrong would probably be in my best interest. I've also read a lot of reddit horror stories of otherwise 'healthy' young people deciding to forego insurance and regretting it after developing unexpected and expensive illnesses. So. I went back to the Marketplace website to look at the plans again. Found one that's \$6/month, has a \$7500 deductible, and covers almost nothing, *but* would be an affordable fail-safe if, god forbid, something really terrible and/or expensive were to happen. My psychiatrist's office does not take this plan. I called them and basically asked, 'If I hypothetically had insurance that you all don't take, would I still be eligible for the sliding scale cash price?' They told me no, that I would have to pay the full cost of the visit, which would be \$300 each time. This finally brings me to my question (thank for for sticking with me if you've read this far lol): **is there anyway for my doctor's office to *know* whether or not I actually have insurance, if I tell them that I don't?** I don't want to come across as if I'm trying to scam the system (although the healthcare system in the US is a nightmare and tbh I wouldn't judge anyone for doing so). But I just literally can't afford to keep seeing my doctor if it's going to be \$300 an appointment. But I also don't want to forego coverage completely. My ideal way to move forward would be to buy the \$6/month plan for emergencies, and just tell my psych that I don't have coverage so I could pay the sliding scale cost for the appointments. Is this something anyone has experience with?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · None

"I'm a single person, age 60, using the ACA without subsidies, because I don't "qualify"... for just medical it costs me \$1000 per month with a \$6000 annual deductible... which means, I have to spend \$18,000 a year to just utilize the insurance. Totally unsustainable and unacceptable for a "first-world" country."

— YouTube · Early Retirement Health Insurance Before Medicare: A Step-by-Step Framework · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NAYG0yvzBI8&lc=Ugzy4GSnFfdMqg7huXR4AaABAq.AVBMLSYyqO-AVBbxqPVAdU>

"Get government OUT of healthcare and insurance! Back when Obumer first messed with it and caused premiums to start to rise (both ACA and non ACA plans as the new costs for new required benefits, legal and regulatory compliance, etc has to be absorbed via any and all health insurance plans regardless of an ACA plan or not). We went from 3 people being covered on what would be about a "silver" on the ACA or a mid plan was \$238 per month. Today for two people it is over \$1,300 per month and there are areas that are even higher than the state and county / area that we live in. On a per covered basis our health insurance premiums are up 410%. Even a few years ago when we moved from one state to another we paid around \$492 per month....four years later, just over \$1,300. thank you government. Just the insurance premiums and rent (no power, water, food, gas, car insurance or any other expenses) costs me \$40,200 per year and that gets paid with after tax dollars so you do the math. just the fixed cost of a roof and insurance with nothing else and we need to earn around \$47,000 before taxes to cover that. God forbid we want to eat, have car insurance and other insurance, fuel for the car, car repairs, clothing, phone service, etc. Again, great work to the tick in Congress for screwing everyone over rather than just helping the few that need, ACTUALLY need the help. All the fraud out there so far should give everyone some idea of the money we flush down the drain. I wager if it was totaled up it would be around \$500 billion per year or more and that is already after the gubment makes so many other things artificially expensive....college tuition anyone? Nothing my insurance agent loves more than sitting across the table from me as we review the plans that, even after I spend \$16,000 per year on premiums for I still have very high deductibles making it really cost me around \$25,000 before insurance does anything when you add premiums and deductibles together (and no I don't count \$15 off some pharma scrip as mattering). What they need to do is allow, the law prevents this for most people - that's right the government is making it illegal for you to purchase certain types of plans less you fall into a small criteria. what am I ranting about? Disaster style policies. Everyone needs to be able to get those but for most plans you have to be under a certain income or under 30 years of age or just unemployed and need a bridge. My spouse and I don't need all the "benefits" we just want emergancy coverage and disease treatment type stuff. There is so much that pad plans, even in hers (and she is almost 50!) still has all this child birthing stuff, breast feeding classes, etc. all for "free" even though she is almost 50 and also can't even have kids in the first place but, same risk pool as everyone else rather than being prices as an individual like with your car insurance."

— YouTube · \$ How MUCH ACA Marketplace PREMIUMS Are Going UP In 2027 · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hOGTkeTtK0Y&lc=UgzNhfDE0RdaDEBn28x4AaABAg>

↳ @bookmark692 (0): "The Messiah picked winners and losers with health insurance. F'D everyone, except the politicians."

"What about employer marketplaces? My premium is \$489, my deductible is \$5000, and my out of pocket maximum is \$6550."

— YouTube · Health care premiums expected to rise for Affordable Care Act enrollees · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Bpict0tiNg&lc=UgxGESnkCcsxQ2uipFJ4AaABAg>

↳ @mactastic144 (1): "@Ortho-GI have been thinking about dropping medical coverage entirely. I'm spending a little over \$8000 per year just for myself on health care. I can cut that in half by dropping medical insurance."

↳ @DarthOpinion (1): "@mactastic144That is crazy expensive i can't believe it"

↳ @Ortho-G (0): "@mactastic144I must tell you that I already pay a couple of my doctors out of pocket. Some physicians are creating lower flat rates for patients that pay in cash."

"My cobra is \$809/mo for health, vision and dental. The unaffordable care act was over \$1200 just for health. To make it even more unaffordable, the deductible was almost twice as high and the out of pocket maximum was also twice as high. I didn't qualify for subsidies but if I did, and got a new job or passed the subsidy income limit, I'd have to payback all the subsidies backdated to the beginning of the year. The unaffordable care act is a joke and is holding Americans back."

— YouTube · Early Retirement Health Insurance Before Medicare: A Step-by-Step Framework · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NAYG0yvyzBI8&lc=UgwK9AXqESWLWO9-PyN4AaABAq>

"Started my LLC a few weeks ago and just signed up for private insurance for 2024. It's not HSA-eligible because it's a PPO, but the deductible is \$7,500. This whole HSA concept was started to help with high deductibles, so I don't see why it matters whether it's a PPO/HDHP/HMO/whatever. My deductible is HIGH, I should be allowed to contribute to an HSA."

— YouTube · How to Get Health Insurance When Self-Employed · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G eUdFzjUKcw&lc=UgxROfxKc0RkKNA8xo54AaABAq>

"If you're a woman - do NOT get Ambetter. . I'm self-employed and paying for Ambetter from the marketplace, which is commercial insurance and supposed to be decent for the co-pay about \$400. Everything about this insurance is bad. 1. ZocDoc, the largest online scheduling system for doctors, doesn't even recognise Ambetter in my state and I can't use the convenient website to schedule any of the appointments. I can't overstate how inconvenient that is. 2. Impossible to find providers - the website doesn't update them frequently, you have to call multiple times to find someone who actual is in network. The number of providers is so tiny you have to wait for weeks to get an appointment. 3. Doesn't cover anything! Refused to cover my yearly mammograms (prescribed by my doctor based on my personal medical history!) and covers literary ZERO of anything fertility-related. Not a single fertility test is covered. This insurance is a punishment for women, please stay away. I'm leaving 2 stars because customer service actually was trying to help me and I was able to reach a human being relative easy."

— TrustPilot · ambetterhealth.com · 2★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/69039842f7718f8c00735d85>

"We need single-payer healthcare/ Medicare for All. My partner and I are both going to be self-employed and we will both use the Marketplace. We will each spend a crap ton of money on health insurance, because neither of us want to work for an employer (we both want to be self-employed). It is sooooo expensive. Hopefully we will each make enough money to be able to pay for it in the long run. This health insurance issue is a major reason why people do not create their own business... If more people could afford healthcare, I'm convinced more people would become self-employed. Each of us will have a very very high deductible (something like \$13-14k) and spend a little under \$500 per month or almost \$500 per month EACH on our health care premium. It is insane. Other countries provide free healthcare— sure they may have to pay more in taxes but it just seems to make more sense than what is happening here. People shouldn't have to get married to someone who works for a regular employer to be able to afford health insurance."

— r/selfemployed · https://www.reddit.com/r/selfemployed/comments/w3xbi0/what_do_you_do_for_health_insurance/ihapuo1/

"Our ACA Bronze level coverage will be \$2500 a month with a \$7500 deductible. That is equal to our mortgage. There's no way we can carry this cost every month—we are both self-employed. We will never hit our deductible either so essentially paying \$2500 a month for what?! We are healthy but over 50 so you never know what lingers around the corner. I'm seriously thinking we'll go without and hope for the best. This is absolutely insane to be this old, with a successful career, a decent retirement account and suddenly find ourselves in this position. I can't sleep at night. The stress alone from this is going to send me to the ER. Oh the irony."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1o8gdh7/wow_looking_at_my_2026_insurance_its_half_my_rent/njuzl8v/

"...and the portion of it where consumers start looking at the premium / deductible combination and decide to put the money in the bank and "go bare" instead of paying for insurance. For mid-silver ACA in my state, a middle aged single consumer would pay \$1100/month with a \$3k deductible and a \$10k MOOP. Thats \$23k in potential costs, and only the unlucky hit that. Folks are gonna start banking the cash instead of buying insurance."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1o23iys/the_scariest_part_from_so_meone_who_works_at_a/nil6jfs/

"@kitcatmeowpurr745 I have had Kaiser Permanente for three years. Kaiser is one of the best health organizations in the US. Although my ACA coverage had a fairly high yearly deductible (\$6,000) that's not unusual anymore. Next month I switch to Kaiser's Medicare Advantage plan. The coverage and cost is nearly identical."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgwGTCcYJclKFIDKljt4AaABA9.9ZCToYPEvkm9auZuUFsttC>

Tab 6 — Previous Solutions

Managing income to keep the subsidy · 41 documents · 20 voices

"ACA \$1,900 per month on \$5,000 per month income? Is this normal? My husband was laid off last week during the mass tech layoffs. Our insurance was through his company. I own my own business, and net after expenses and taxes \$5,000/month on average. I have variable income. I went onto the ACA marketplace today, entered all of our info, my income, his income zero, our two young children, and I was given a price of \$1,900/month for the cheapest plan with a \$16,000 deductible. How is this affordable on an income of \$5,000? I am not understanding. Should I call? Editing to add that a lot of people responding to my post seem to think I am oblivious to the political situation related to this. Yes, I did write to my representatives weeks ago (but it obviously did nothing because I live in the red state of Kansas. I vote blue and always have because I am a woman who prefers bodily autonomy to the alternative.) I am one person who has zero political power or sway. I am sharing my numbers to see what is happening with others, who are powerless to do anything as well at the federal level to make this better. Just thought I would clarify that for everyone. Also, COBRA for us would be \$3,500/month for a high deductible plan for those who thought this would be a cheaper option."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,646 upvotes · None

"My health insurance just went to \$60,000 a year for a silver PPO Prepare for sticker shock. Just checked the IL exchange today, and my BCBS HDHP went from \$1200 a month after subsidies to \$2925 after subsidies (**the plan cost is 60k per year**) the reasons for this are two-fold 1. Expiration of enhanced subsidies 2. The site allowing junk insurers to claim SLC status (benchmark) with plans no one can use. For my area it is an OSCAR HMO which virtually no hospital system or doctor accepts. OSCAR has a 1 star rating from the BBB and dozens of lawsuits against it for failure to pay claims. so I now have to hunt around for a HMO, and my family will lose its doctors. The PPACA as originally passed prevented insurance premiums from eating up more than a certain percentage of your annual income. At 84k for a family of 4, I would pay 42% of my total income in premium payments so I will lose my doctor(s) at the very least and pay way beyond what the law said I was going to. pretty sure I am seeing why some politicians are saying we should tear up the PPACA altogether, because it clearly isn't working, and made a bad situation worse"

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,000 upvotes · None

"Fuck this country's health insurance I've dislocated both my kneecaps, now they're loose and unstable. I genuinely cannot mentally or emotionally go through that type of pain again. I've been desperately trying to buy health insurance, I missed the united healthcare deadline to enroll for 2025 because I didn't have the fucking money, I don't qualify for medicaid, I have health insurance offered through my job but didn't accept it because the insurance is \$240 (9.02% of my income) at the cheapest, and i'm barely scraping by as it is. But that gives me the kicker of not qualifying for tax credits for healthcare marketplace insurances. I genuinely have not taken my knee braces off for more than 20 minutes in three days, I cry nearly every night because of this shit. I feel like i have no choice or the ones i have are absolute shit. Pay \$300+ in health insurance, pay out of pocket for all healthcare costs and go into medical debt that i can't pay, or wait over six months and just let my knee issues get worse before i can enroll into my jobs health insurance again. I am 20 years old and have done no sports, nothing, absolutely nothing, to cause issues in my knees. And now, i live in constant fucking fear that i will end up screaming on the ground again and apparently can't do shit about it. What in the actual fuck is america"

— r/HealthInsurance · 614 upvotes · None

"ACA isn't so affordable Long story short, we'll be losing our healthcare come June. My wife has inherited a long list of health issues, and has been hospitalized 5x since January, anywhere from a week to 2 at a time. Essentially she's been hospitalized for 2 of the last 3 months in total. There's no end in sight for this. I make 62,500 a year, and she made 70,000 a year prior to this, providing insurance from her job as well. She'll be down to whatever SSDI is come June, and has made 60% of her normal wages thus far. I estimate our income at about 90k per year after this. My job is for a semi small family company, and our insurance is ok, but asks about pre-existing conditions. I tried marketplace which said if our income was below 108k per year we qualified for discounts! Yeah no. It's at a minimum \$12k per year in premiums, plus \$18k max out of pockets. I don't know about you, but it's a bit difficult paying 30 grand per year on a 90k income BEFORE taxes. And she will absolutely max the out of pocket week one. These stays are ICU stays, we're already in the millions. If you factor out taxes, we're left with about \$70k, giving me 40k for her, myself, and our 1 year old. This sucks. My only other option would be a divorce, and since her only income would be social security she would then qualify for Medicaid, but I guess that takes 2 years after you have a disability."

— r/HealthInsurance · 323 upvotes · None

"HDHPs suck if you actually need them. Because our subsidy expired, we are now paying \$1200 a month for 2 people for a bronze plan with an \$8000 deductible per person. CO, both 52, \$160k income. We went from \$1200 buying us great gold coverage to \$1200 and paying for our own care literally overnight. As it happens, for a bit of uterine bleeding, I actually need the insurance this year. All of the procedures I need – ultrasound, biopsy, and hysteroscopy – are subject to the deductible. And after the deductible, they're only covered at 40% by Select Health. What kind of insurance is this? We're basically paying high premiums for the privilege of paying for our own healthcare. This was the cheapest Obamacare option we could find. Where are all the HDHPs with lower premiums? We worked with a broker, and there weren't any. The contract company that employs my husband had an HDHP where the premium was even higher. At these prices, we can't even afford to fund an HSA. We didn't see any HDHPs on the exchange with premium is less than \$1000 a month. How are people affording this? HDHPs are not a bargain anymore, it seems. We make well over six figures, but since so much of our income is going to healthcare premiums, we have to drain our savings over any healthcare we need. And if you have HDHP insurance, you can't even pay a lower cash price to the facility. You have to pay the higher insurance negotiated price, even if you're paying 100% of the cost. And if I want sedation for these procedures (don't even get me started about how painful in office gynecology is), it's even more expensive. So basically, anything between a well-woman visit (free) and cancer (chemo meets that deductible pretty quick) is going to give you medical debt. This is indescribably unbelievable. Wow, this sucks."

— r/HealthInsurance · 199 upvotes · None

"Turning 26, being dropped coverage and can't do State Medicaid I'm turning 26 years old, and I'm being dropped from my parent's health plan. I live in PA and have no income. I'm still in Medical School for 1 more year, and they offer no SHIP/healthcare plans of their own. I qualify for PA State Medicaid, but I will be doing several out of state hospital rotations, and they will not accept that I only have a State Medicaid. What are my options? I went to HealthCare.gov, and as soon as I say I have no income, all they do is redirect me to sign up with State Medicaid?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 44 upvotes · None

"IF they extend the subsidies and get rid of the 400% cliff am I better off to overestimate next year's income if I am close to the 400%??? What about this year, can I make changes? I read Hakeem Jeffries said they may pass an extension..I realize thats a big IF. We may be close to the 400% next year and if we go over we will owe all the subsidy back. If they continue subsidies beyond the 400% would I be better to estimate my income at 450% next year so I don't owe back 100% if I do hit 450%? If I don't reach that amount will I get a refund for having overestimated? We may have to do a large withdrawal from IRA as we have an issue that may come up requiring extra \$ next year. Along the same line, I underestimated this year. I still have 10 days to change my income for 2025. Will I save any \$ if I raise my estimated income for this year ? Is it too late?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 26 upvotes · None

"ACA plans versus just enrolling through private insurer I cannot seem to find an answer to this anywhere I estimate my MAGI to be around ~40k next year. I am not offered health insurance through employer bc I work part time. I have decent amount of assets so I don't have trouble paying higher premiums each month (it also makes my income less predictable with dividends, capital gains etc but i try to keep it as close to 40k as possible with 401k contributions, trad IRA etc.) My question is -- If I go with [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) and get a plan there with a subsidy, at the end of the year does it all even out if I were to just pay the higher premium and get the tax rebate when I file taxes? My accountant complains about [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) plans when I file taxes and recommends I just get it directly with the insurer. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 20 upvotes · None

"Medi-Cal vs. Covered California / Medi-Cal eligibility I am a working-age California resident. In the first quarter of last year, I left a job voluntarily. Because it was voluntary I did not bother to apply for unemployment. I did not have another job lined up. As I had coverage with Kaiser through my employer, my first call was to them to ask about Cobra. I was pretty quickly transferred to a Kaiser agent who wanted to work through a Covered California application with me. We did that, but at the end of the process they had some technical failure with regard to me verifying my SSN, so they gave up and transferred me to a Covered California agent. I did not quite know how to answer their question about income, because my answer was basically, "I expect to be employed again at some point this year, but it's hard to say when, and so anything I tell you will only be a guesstimate." So the CC agent concluded that since my total 2022 income from the job I just left fell under the limit, and since I did not have any other income, I was eligible for Medi-Cal. This seemed odd to me since my occupation pays fairly well and I did expect to be employed again at some point that year. "Can't I just get subsidies through CC and then pay them back once I'm working again?" I asked. Their answer was that with Medi-Cal, so long as I advise them of any changes to income, I don't actually have to pay anything back. I didn't really expect to use the plan anyway, i.e. I just wanted catastrophic coverage, and so I agreed to do that. So for the past 11 months, I've been on Medi-Cal. I have not used the plan in any way, have not seen a doctor, have not called anyone about anything with the exception of the initial application process. It is time to renew my eligibility, and here is my concern: When I went through the application process last year, they asked about "cash on hand." Now, at the time I did have some money in the bank, but that money was set aside for living expenses like rent and food, which I considered to be priorities that came before health insurance. It felt like the question was more about "disposable cash" and so I reported that no, i did not have cash on hand. Looking back, that was probably the wrong answer. There was zero intent to deceive on my part, however I'm now concerned that I've basically been enrolled in Medi-Cal fraudulently. As it turns out, I am still unemployed. I am very close to being out of cash, am living on credit card advances, and I have a traditional IRA that I will tap into as a last resort. So, unlike last year, I'm pretty sure that I am now legitimately eligible for Medi-Cal. (I don't think my IRA counts as an asset but please correct me if I'm wrong.) Let's say I renew and at some point thereafter I obtain services. Might they do some digging and discover that I did actually have some cash in 2022? My understanding is that if I am eligible for Medi-Cal then I am NOT eligible for CC subsidies, so even though at this point I would feel better about reversing course and getting myself on a CC plan, that may not be financially feasible for me. I would like to have a conversation with someone from Medi-Cal about this, but not sure how wise it would be for me to share what I have shared here. Maybe it would be better to just return my renewal docs and proceed as if I've been eligible all along? Does it even matter since I haven't actually obtained any services? Am I just being paranoid? Apologies for the long-winded post. Just wanted to provide some context so that hopefully someone might have some valuable insight and/or advice. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 18 upvotes · None

"Medicaid nightmare So I have Missouri Medicaid for my wife and daughter (1 year old). When my daughter was born, we decided it was best for my wife to stay home. So we needed insurance. I went to Marketplace to look, and told me I had to apply for chip/medicaid before proceeding. So I called, spent 7 hours on hold, got ahold of someone, they asked me all the questions and I gave them all our information and income info they needed. Two months later, I received a letter saying they're accepted. Fast forward to July, I get a small raise. I go to my local DSS office and report an income change within 10 days, filled it out in the buy and turned it in before leaving. Never hear anything so I assumed it was still within the limit. Get a letter a couple weeks ago saying we make too much and my wife and daughters plans were being changed. I always expected that but never understood how they qualified to begin with while I always made over \$65k/yr. Turns out when I called to get the details on their new plan, they tell me they only have 1 job out of three jobs I have, only making \$409 a month? They didn't even have any records of my full time job despite filling out an income increase form in office TWICE. Plus they only put down the first letter of my first name so identity issues was always a problem also. So now I'm scared they will think I committed fraud when I've been nothing but upfront with them from the beginning. Them over the phone and in the office haven't been documenting my info properly or at all."

— r/Medicaid · 18 upvotes · None

"NY has it's own exchange as well. One problem I have getting an estimate is, if my income is below 250% FPL (about \$39k), they don't exactly tell you what you get because instead of a subsidy for a 'qualified plan', you get put on the 'Essential Plan'....basically a co-pay version of Medicaid. But w/ the new Medicaid eligibility rules - like working 80 hrs/mo - I technically won't qualify. So not sure if that means I get a bigger subsidy towards a 'qualified plan' or what happens. It's almost like when the passed ACA - you have to apply to find out what you get. Either way, I am looking at about \$35k, so I'll just have to put it in and see what it comes up with."

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · 17 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=UgxxgNqdW1muZXeoJsaN4AaABAq>

↳ @Dave_D. (1): "@HappyonMonday If I put in \$40k, the low end where subsidies start, it will be fine, I've already played around w/ it a bunch - just drives me nuts that they can't tell you what happens below that level until you 'send it'."

↳ @HappyonMonday (0): "It's crazy how different each state is! Fingers crossed for you that you get a good deal! 🍀 "

↳ @Dave_D. (0): "@TaishaKirkendall I could just say \$40k and know what I'll pay for a qualified plan....but I think I will go lower (I can control my income so that's not a problem) and just see what happens if they put me on essential but I don't qualify due to the new medicaid qualifications. I figure worst case, it would be the same subsidy as \$40k, best case it's free w/ co-pay, or, somewhere in the middle (bigger subsidy)."

"Yep; retired at 61 and controlled my MAGI such that I paid \$0 for a Silver plan. Benefit of being conservative over many years and having enough in brokerage / savings to cover expenses, vacations, etc. for four years before Medicare kicked in. (So now I actually pay more (~\$300/mo) for Medicare + plan premium than when on ACA. 🙄)"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 12 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgyB34wMc6xvo5jGBWJ4AaABAg

↳ @u8805a8cee (3): "I retired before the ACA, very young. Males in my family don't live long lives, so I shifted "retirement" to occur earlier, before I expect to die. I "retired" before the ACA existed, so it wasn't part of any planning. OTOH, my prior health insurance was \$150/month before the ACA started making it double almost every year. I still had cash savings in the first few years after the ACA was passed, which meant my income/MAGI was below the FPL and full payment for ACA plans was the rule. After a few years of paying \$500, \$600, \$700, then \$800/month for the cheapest ACA Marketplace coverage, finally figured out that my annual income/MAGI needed to appear to be at least the poverty level and had to pick a more expensive plan. After fixing those 2 issues, health insurance became affordable again. The full monthly premium is over \$1200 now, but about \$1150 of that is paid by the Feds, because I control the MAGI. I expect to pay my fair share of taxes, but not 1 penny more. I'm not looking forward to being forced off the ACA and onto Medicare at age 65. Monthly health insurance premiums will raise about 6x, it appears now and that's not counting MediGAP insurance. Definitely need to use the ACA as part of your early retirement plans. Wish I'd realized it a few years earlier before paying tens of thousands to health insurance unnecessarily."

"Living off Cash (for a few years) I'll be 53 next year, and would like to quit my job and live off saved cash for 3-4 years before potentially rejoining the workforce. Since my income would be \$0 for those years, how would I go about getting health insurance? When I enter estimates in the ACA, they tell me to apply for medicaid. I also own a house that has an estimated value of 500k and have over 500k in retirement, but I don't want to touch the retirement until I'm 59. Would getting health insurance for my 3-4 years "off" be problematic because of my assets? And, would I have to receive medicaid or is there a way to still get a private insurance plan even with no income? I'm not trying to get "free healthcare," but if my income is zero for a few years, do I even have a choice? Thanks,"

— r/HealthInsurance · 10 upvotes · None

"I'm confused why the same plan my girlfriend and I choose went up for her, but stayed the same for me? We both signed up for Oscar Gold Elite last year and each have our incomes which are unfortunately low. Same jobs and same income for this year... But for some reason my premium for the same plan stayed at the exact same price of \$40, but hers more than doubled to \$100. We use our premium tax credits but she uses the insurance more than I do because she had asthma but does that have anything to do with it? I'm a bit confused because I don't understand this stuff very well despite watching many videos on it. Any help is greatly appreciated."

— r/HealthInsurance · 7 upvotes · None

"Question about tax credit Excuse some of my ignorance because I only switched to ACA plan for my family of 3 about six months ago after switching employers. I didn't pay a lot of attention to it before because I was on a workplace health plan for 10+ years, so I've been playing catch up. My wife and I are both commission workers so I had to estimate our income when first applying. It came out to about 102k/year, and it seemed that I was told that we did not qualify for the APTC, although now I see that the limit is 106k. Our final gross income from 2025 may end up being lower than my estimation. It's possible that I was confused but I'm currently paying 700\$/mo right now, and my plan is going up to around 840\$/mo next year, but the eligibility summary is telling me that I actually am eligible for up to 247\$/mo from the APTC (as well as currently eligible, I think?). So I guess my question is, I am I think understanding now that the tax credit is only going away for those making over 400% of the federal poverty line, does that mean that I could still claim the 247\$/mo next year, as was as retroactively claim it for the previous 6 months or so when I do my taxes next year? I currently am not receiving any advanced payments. Thanks, sorry if this is a dumb basic question I should know already, but just trying to understand better."

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · None

"Finally someone covers this topic. Although your explanations are a bit scattered, confusing and rushed. My wife and I spent our 40yr career in the healthcare field. We can tell you without question, never go cheap on healthcare. One bad diagnosis like cancer can bankrupt or severely hamper your retirement plans in a heartbeat. Also, we live in FL. Healthcare is very expensive because of the number of retired people who live here. With all our number crunching it will never pay to do roth conversions while on ACA. I have 2 yrs left on ACA, my wife is on Medicare and SS. People must remember that you are PREDICTING your income for the year ahead of time. If you go over, you will pay more. If you are under, ACA gives you a refund(credit) on taxes. The system is very confusing for seniors and I have spent many hours researching all the ACA rules and how it applies to taxes, income and roth conversions."

— YouTube · Healthcare Before 65: In-Depth ACA vs. Roth Conversion Analysis · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gUjrNm-VLF8&lc=UgwDMADRL27zUJcPdc14AaABAq>

↳ @Wayneman50 (1): "@ No. For example, when you sign up for coverage in Nov 2025 for the year 2026. You have to guess your income for that year(2026). Your subsidy is based on the income you are predicting for the year 2026."

↳ @andre-l3j (1): "@larryjones9773I think you're thinking of IRMAA income rather than ACA income prediction."

↳ @gdb5843 (0): "I totally agree with you on "never go cheap on healthcare" but I wish I did larger Roth Conversion when I was on ACA."

"I retired before the ACA, very young. Males in my family don't live long lives, so I shifted "retirement" to occur earlier, before I expect to die. I "retired" before the ACA existed, so it wasn't part of any planning. OTOH, my prior health insurance was \$150/month before the ACA started making it double almost every year. I still had cash savings in the first few years after the ACA was passed, which meant my income/MAGI was below the FPL and full payment for ACA plans was the rule. After a few years of paying \$500, \$600, \$700, then \$800/month for the cheapest ACA Marketplace coverage, finally figured out that my annual income/MAGI needed to appear to be at least the poverty level and had to pick a more expensive plan. After fixing those 2 issues, health insurance became affordable again. The full monthly premium is over \$1200 now, but about \$1150 of that is paid by the Feds, because I control the MAGI. I expect to pay my fair share of taxes, but not 1 penny more. I'm not looking forward to being forced off the ACA and onto Medicare at age 65. Monthly health insurance premiums will raise about 6x, it appears now and that's not counting MediGAP insurance. Definitely need to use the ACA as part of your early retirement plans. Wish I'd realized it a few years earlier before paying tens of thousands to health insurance unnecessarily."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgyB34wMc6xvo5jGBWJ4AaABAg.ARR7yTlcvr6AUGJypnLdby

"MAGI calculation help Never have had an HSA until this year and I want to make sure I understand its effect on MAGI. I'm over 55 on an ACA bronze plan so that means I can contribute \$5400 per year. To retain my subsidy I have to keep my MAGI at 400% or less of the FPL for a single person. This would be of \$62,600. Lets say my MAGI for 2026 is \$68,000. By my understanding I would take $\$68,000 - \$5400 = \$62,600$ so I would keep my subsidy. If MAGI were $\$68,001 - \$5400 = \$62,601$ and I would fall off of the subsidy cliff... Am I understanding this correctly? I ask all of this because I am shuffling around investment accounts aiming for a MAGI of \$65,000, leaving wiggle room to steer clear of the cliff if I am understanding how this works. Thanks."

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · None

"ACA question I have a family of 5. I have self employment and investment income that is going to be close to the 400% ACA cliff of 150,500. Working frantically to maximize business deductions and control the money coming in. I might not make it. So currently my premiums are about \$10,000 w subsidy vs. \$32,000 without subsidy. A difference of \$22,000. But I was thinking about it some more. If I don't make it, that extra \$22,000 now can be a business deduction. Hence the true cost is reduced by, say, 24%. Am I thinking correctly on this?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · None

"Retired at 59-3/4. Stayed on my employer's COBRA, so for about 5 years we paid \$15K per year. We used IRA distribution for two years. Then when the mortgage was paid, that stopped. Pensions cover everything else. MEDICARE then SS at 66 were bonuses. 🇺🇸 "

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=Ugxawh1OgO6LjGPkdNd4AaABAg

↳ @takeitasacompliment. (4): "I thought Cobra was 18 months max. 36 with special exceptions. But 5 years?"

↳ @takeitasacompliment. (2): "@jameschaves5723 Yes you can. Where did you hear that you can't? It's federal law. If you lose your job or leave your job or your hours get cut below the amount needed for the company to give you health insurance, then it's 18 months. The only exception to the federal law is if the company size is smaller than 20 people. But then most states have a mini Cobra law."

↳ @jameschaves5723 (1): "You can't stay on COBRA for 18 months!!"

Bronze, silver or gold: picking the tier · 37 documents · 20 voices

"Virginia ACA Rates Posted Today: Share Your Increase In Virginia and rates came up today. Self employed couple 59 & 61. This year our premium was \$1187/month. Same plan next year \$2,109/month. This is more than my mortgage payment and a \$922/month increase brings the total yearly cost to \$50,616. We will have to switch to a high deductible low quality Bronze plan with a \$7,500 deductible EACH with a monthly premium of \$1452/month. This is beyond belief. Continue contacting your elected officials people 🙄 "

— r/obamacare · 584 upvotes · None

"Someone please explain why I (or anyone) should pay a premium that costs more than the oop max The maths aren't mathing. Someone help me understand what I am missing here. We live in NY. I am a self-employed general contractor. Wife is an attorney and recently left her job to open her own firm so we lost great health insurance through her previous employer. Cobra would cost us around \$7k/ month for 2 healthy adults and our 8yo healthy son. Now we're shopping on the marketplace in what appears to be the worst time in history to be doing so. We make too much for any subsidies, so a silver plan is coming in around \$3k/month. Catastrophic is coming in around \$750/month. After a lot of research I can't understand why I would buy anything other than catastrophic. All ACA plans include the same preventive care at no cost. All ACA plans have the same out of pocket maximum limit. Aside from a catastrophe, we would maybe spend \$1k/ year at most seeking care that isn't covered under ACA preventive care. So why would I pay \$36k/year for a silver plan when I could just buy catastrophic for 1/4 the price and pay out of pocket for everything else, knowing I have the same oop cap as the silver \$36k/year plan?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 577 upvotes · None

"2026 ACA prices are live on Healthcare.gov. Here's our household's official ACA pricing for next year. **Special disclaimer for 2026: Everything in this post assumes that Congress does not extend the COVID subsidy enhancements and that the default ACA subsidy rules return for 2026.** Anyone can now see the 2026 prices and plans in their area with some anonymous data (age/zip/income/etc) in about three minutes at <https://www.healthcare.gov/see-plans/#/>. If you have a local state-run exchange, then you'll be redirected. State exchanges all update on their own schedule, so 2026 prices may or may not be live just yet. For those who may not be familiar with the ACA, below is an actual real-world example of what being on the ACA can be like with the default subsidy systems. The prices below are for a married couple with an average age of 52 and with MAGI under 133% of the Federal Poverty Level (FPL), which qualifies us for the maximum possible amount of ACA subsidies from both the premium tax credit (PTC) subsidy system and cost-sharing reduction (CSR) subsidy system. We have three dependent children as well, one of which will be on our ACA policy, and we live in a non-expansion state, so expansion Medicaid does not apply to us. Keep in mind that the premiums below would be much higher for a couple if they were in their 60s rather than in their 40s/50s like us. Tobacco users can expect to pay up to 50% additional premium on top of the age-rating. If we were both 62, then the unsubsidized Bronze premium below would rise from \$19,140 to \$27,168. Prices also can vary incredibly between states. If we were both 62 and living in West Virginia instead of Texas, then our Bronze premium would rise from \$27,168 to \$49,584. If instead we were living in Minnesota, then our Bronze premium would fall from \$27,168 to \$21,696. I have also included the policy options we would likely take if we were either eligible only for premium subsidies and not also cost-sharing reductions, as well as the plan we would likely take if we were ineligible for any subsidies at all. People who are over 200% FPL should generally avoid Silver plans due to the way states have elected to deal with the loss of federal funding for the cost-sharing reduction subsidy system, so while I have provided the full market price of our Silver plan, please note that almost nobody would want to ever buy that plan at that price as better Bronze and Gold options are available. ____ Our 2026 Silver plan with subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (based purely on MAGI): * \$84 in annual premium * \$0/\$0 deductible (individual/family) * \$0 PCP * \$10 specialist * \$5 urgent care * \$0/\$15 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$2,200/\$4,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ Our 2026 Silver plan without subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (full market price): * \$26,892 in annual premium * \$6,000/\$12,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$40 PCP * \$80 specialist * \$60 urgent care * \$20/\$40 tier1/tier2 scripts * 40% ER coinsurance * \$8,900/\$17,800 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 Gold plan we would pick if our MAGI was just above 200% FPL (no meaningful CSRs): * \$2,952 in annual premium * \$2,000/\$4,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$30 PCP * \$60 specialist * \$45 urgent care * \$15/\$30 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$8,200/\$16,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 HSA-compatible Bronze plan we would pick if we qualified for zero subsidies/CSRs (MAGI above 400% FPL, factoring in max MAGI-reducing HSA contributions) * \$19,140 in annual premium * \$7,500/\$15,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$50 PCP * \$100 specialist * \$75 urgent care * \$25/\$50 tier1/tier2 scripts * 50% ER coinsurance * \$10,000/\$20,000 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____"

— r/obamacare · 571 upvotes · None

"Just canceled my 2026 health insurance through Covered CA My situation is i made more money this year than i expected and now my insurance is about 450 \$ for the bronze plan the problem is everything went up for me, my car insurance went from 280 to 400 this year, my rent went up by 100 \$, my utilities went absolutely crazy, i am living in the studio apartment and used to pay 80-100 \$ max, but now every month is more and more, this month it got to 250 \$...and my apt manager said it's shared so it's not me lol So yeah, even tho i made more money than i expected, i don't have more money on hands, i used to pay 100 \$ per month for insurance and it was ok, but 450 \$ for bronze plan ??? I just can't do it.. Can you guys recommend any other good alternatives in LA ? i have good health, nothing chronic and don't take any meds ? Thanks"

— r/HealthInsurance · 307 upvotes · None

"HDHPs suck if you actually need them. Because our subsidy expired, we are now paying \$1200 a month for 2 people for a bronze plan with an \$8000 deductible per person. CO, both 52, \$160k income. We went from \$1200 buying us great gold coverage to \$1200 and paying for our own care literally overnight. As it happens, for a bit of uterine bleeding, I actually need the insurance this year. All of the procedures I need – ultrasound, biopsy, and hysteroscopy – are subject to the deductible. And after the deductible, they're only covered at 40% by Select Health. What kind of insurance is this? We're basically paying high premiums for the privilege of paying for our own healthcare. This was the cheapest Obamacare option we could find. Where are all the HDHPs with lower premiums? We worked with a broker, and there weren't any. The contract company that employs my husband had an HDHP where the premium was even higher. At these prices, we can't even afford to fund an HSA. We didn't see any HDHPs on the exchange with premium is less than \$1000 a month. How are people affording this? HDHPs are not a bargain anymore, it seems. We make well over six figures, but since so much of our income is going to healthcare premiums, we have to drain our savings over any healthcare we need. And if you have HDHP insurance, you can't even pay a lower cash price to the facility. You have to pay the higher insurance negotiated price, even if you're paying 100% of the cost. And if I want sedation for these procedures (don't even get me started about how painful in office gynecology is), it's even more expensive. So basically, anything between a well-woman visit (free) and cancer (chemo meets that deductible pretty quick) is going to give you medical debt. This is indescribably unbelievable. Wow, this sucks."

— r/HealthInsurance · 199 upvotes · None

"Is my therapist scamming me? (updated below) First of all I am in therapy partly for trust issues and paranoia with women. So keep that in mind. I have Anthem bronze pathway epo in California. (I just chose the cheapest possible plan. \$741 😊) The insurance only covers in network providers. I met my out of pocket max and the EOBs say I owe \$0 now. I just realized that my credit card has also been getting charged \$200 per session by the therapist. Based on the emails I agreed to her billing plan. I wasn't absorbing it though. I was thinking sure, whatever, I'll meet my OOPM soon and then it will be \$0, like everything else. I chose her because she's in network. This situation fits what I've read about balance billing. I have a hard time believing that my 50+ yo therapist would do something illegal like this. I can't believe she wouldn't know the laws. I don't trust her but she's smart. Rationally this seems far fetched. From anthem: "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secure message. We understand how concerning it is to be billed when your Explanation of Benefits (EOB) shows no member responsibility, and we appreciate you bringing this to our attention. Upon reviewing your 2026 claims submitted by x, most of the claims indicate no member responsibility, which means you should not owe anything for those services. We found only two claims where a member responsibility was applied: Claim number x (Date of Service: 03/05/2026-03/09/2026) Member responsibility: \$180.00 Claim number x (Date of Service: 02/24/2026) - Member responsibility: \$60.00 If you have already made payments that correspond to these two claims, then any additional charges from this provider may not be accurate. For the other claims that show \$0.00 member responsibility, we recommend that you share a copy of your EOB with your provider, as it reflects how the claims were processed. Sincerely, Elaine S. Customer Service Representative" What should I do? We are supposed to meet on Tuesday. **UPDATE:** I cancelled our appointment and asked for a breakdown of charges, in a neutral way, implying anthem must have messed up. Anthem again confirmed she should not be charging me. Her stated rate is \$235. Anthem has been giving her \$97.87 per session. So she's taking home \$297.87?? she wants me to believe that anthem only gives her \$35, and that balance billing is ok? I can't believe this. does she think I'm dumb and rich? is she dumb, or a thief? she was kind of a decent therapist! My claims history shows that she has submitted 10claims. Each claim shows multiple sessions each day. totaling 19 sessions. She charged me \$198 the first 3 charges and \$200 the last 2. 5 total charges to my credit card which aligns with the number of times I remember seeing her. I have not seen her 19times and I've definitely never seen her 3x in one day. I never got any kind of receipt with the charges. I just noticed them. Is it common to not send a receipt? **UPDATE 2:** a lot of her claims were on dates I was gone on a trip for a month taking care of a dying family member. The very first claim for a 60 minute therapy session for which Anthem paid her \$97.87 was actually our 14m48s introductory phone consult (she had flaked twice. She was 9th on my list and no one else was available. Should I just keep seeing her...? 😊) **UPDATE 3:** I sent Anthem screenshots of texts, emails, and phone history showing her first claim was a lie, and that I was out of the country during a majority of her other claims. I cannot believe I was out of the country with my dying mother, with no return date, and this woman was using my name to make hundreds of dollars. What the flipping fuck. I want to be HER therapist and analyze her pathology. Also, she gave away my time slot while I was gone with no conversation, and I was hurt but I decided to respect that I couldn't expect her to hold a spot for me when I left and stopped communicating. Ha! I wonder if I had never reached back out, how long she would have kept pretending we were having sessions. **UPDATE 4:** Sent by: Anthem Support "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secured message. I'm really sorry you're going through this, it can be very upsetting and confusing to see charges and visit records that don't match your recollection, especially when it involves multiple charges to your card. We understand your concern, and we appreciate you bringing this to our attention. Please be advised that we process claims exactly as they are billed and submitted by your provider. Claims are reviewed based on the information received, your plan benefits, and the provider's network status. Anthem also follows the provider's contract to determine the allowed amount and how much is applied to your responsibility, such as deductible, copayment, or coinsurance. For specific details about the billing codes used and the charges submitted, we recommend contacting your provider or facility directly, as they can explain how the claim was filed and the

amounts billed for each service. If you believe your claims were not processed correctly, you have the right to request a review by filing an appeal, and we'll be happy to guide you through that process. Appeals must be submitted within 180 calendar days of the last processing date. Please include your member identification number, the claim number in question, the details of your appeal and any additional medical information or documentation supporting your appeal. For a standard appeal, a decision will be made within 30 calendar days after the receipt of the documentation. You can send appeals by mail to the following address:..." Sounds like Anthem wants me to do a load of paperwork when I've already submitted evidence of fraud. :(I asked them to forward to their fraud department. TBD. **UPDATE 6** From therapist responding to me asking for a breakdown of her charges: "Hi x, Thank you for sending this, and thank you for following up with Anthem. Yes, it's completely fine to skip tomorrow. I'm going to look into the insurance issue on my end and see what I can find out about why Anthem is showing \$0. Once I have more clarity, I'll get back to you. Warmly, x" 😊 me: "Thanks x. Can you send me a superbill today explaining the details of the \$198 and \$200 charges?" I just read her reflections email on our last session and it was so insightful and helpful. Maybe we can both compartmentalize her fraud... 😊 **UPDATE 7** Sent by: Anthem Support "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secure message. I'm really sorry you're going through this—what you're describing sounds incredibly frustrating and concerning. Thank you for clearly outlining the dates and your experience, especially noting when you were out of the country and had no communication or sessions with X. I completely understand why this situation doesn't feel right. To help ensure this is properly reviewed and investigated, the best next step is to report the situation directly to our Special Investigations Unit (SIU). They are specifically trained to handle cases like this and can take the appropriate actions to protect you and review any questionable billing activity. You may contact the Special Investigations Unit (SIU) at 888-231-5044 to report the concern. Reaching out to them will allow a dedicated team to look into the details you've shared and work toward a resolution. If you have any supporting documents—such as dates of service, billing statements, or records of your absence—having those ready can also be helpful during the review." I'm waiting to see whether the therapist will send the requested breakdown of the costs. kind of for sick entertainment purposes at this point tbh. She didn't send yesterday as requested. I keep thinking about the good parts of our dynamic and thinking about maybe making things work. A bit like the toxic relationships I wanted her to help me with, actually ... I'm back to sending a hundred exhausting , failed emails to therapists on psychology today, like the good old days. **UPDATE 8** From therapist: "Hi x, Thank you for your patience on this. I've been talking with Anthem and it turns out there was coverage confusion on their side that made your benefits show up in a really confusing way on my end. Bottom line: I overcharged you. Your copay is \$60 per session, and you should only have been paying \$60 each time. Based on the payments showing on your end (5 sessions: \$200, \$200, \$198, \$198, \$198), you paid a total of \$994. You should have paid \$300 total (\$60 x 5). That means I owe you a refund of \$694. I'm really sorry for the confusion. I appreciate you catching this; it would have turned into a big accounting discrepancy for my books too. Whew! Can you tell me what you prefer for the refund, Zelle or Venmo? Once you confirm, I can send it right away. Warmly, x" I actually met my deductible after 3 sessions. She's still lying. Wow. I said yes an"

— r/HealthInsurance · 122 upvotes · None

"When I dropped my health insurance, the health system I use now offers me half off on visits. Why could they not do that when I had insurance? So I live in a crappy red state that doesn't support its citizens. When the ACA subsidies were dropped with the help of the clown in the White House, my health insurance went from \$200 a month to almost \$700. I ended up dropping it as work was a little slow and this was a lot of money for something that didn't help much. I had a \$8000 yearly deductible, office visits were higher than they should have been, and almost no drugs were reduced more than the discount card I used at the pharmacy. Basically a lot of money for crappy coverage. Now that I don't have insurance, doctors's visits are half off. Some other visits like urgent care and blood work are half off the full price. Why couldn't I get that price with insurance? It would have lowered the cost of insurance by (I guess) half and I may have ended up keeping it. Why are we being charged an inflated cost with insurance. I feel like I paid more in the end for doctors appointments and such with insurance when you take the high deductible in consideration. It just all sounds like a scam to be and the doctors and insurance companies are in on it together."

— r/HealthInsurance · 77 upvotes · None

"Crazy idea - what do you think? Hi, there. Without being too wordy (happy to elaborate if needed), I wanted to ask for input on this idea I have. We make too much money to qualify for ANY subsidies next year (we're not "rich", but we're above the cutoff). Because of this, our health insurance is going to go from \$900 a month for the two of us (already outrageously expensive for the high deductible, bronze plan we have) to \$3,500 PER MONTH. Yes, per month. That comes to \$42,000 per year. And again, that's before paying for any of the actual medical expenses we may incur. I have confirmed this with an insurance agent so it's not just me miscalculating (and yes, I plan to discuss this with the agent as well, but I love the Reddit forums so here I am). I'm thinking there might be something I'm not understanding, but here's my idea - couldn't we just not have health insurance and if something catastrophic comes up (cancer diagnosis, for example), we could move (we have the option to change residency because we do own a home in another state) and then use the special enrollment period to get insurance? I mean, remember - we're talking \$42,000 per year otherwise - and that's before anything even happens. Thanks for your input."

— r/HealthInsurance · 24 upvotes · None

"Yep; retired at 61 and controlled my MAGI such that I paid \$0 for a Silver plan. Benefit of being conservative over many years and having enough in brokerage / savings to cover expenses, vacations, etc. for four years before Medicare kicked in. (So now I actually pay more (~\$300/mo) for Medicare + plan premium than when on ACA. 🤔)"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpcfE&lc=UgyB34wMc6xvo5jGBWJ4AaABAg>

↳ @u8805a8cee (3): "I retired before the ACA, very young. Males in my family don't live long lives, so I shifted "retirement" to occur earlier, before I expect to die. I "retired" before the ACA existed, so it wasn't part of any planning. OTOH, my prior health insurance was \$150/month before the ACA started making it double almost every year. I still had cash savings in the first few years after the ACA was passed, which meant my income/MAGI was below the FPL and full payment for ACA plans was the rule. After a few years of paying \$500, \$600, \$700, then \$800/month for the cheapest ACA Marketplace coverage, finally figured out that my annual income/MAGI needed to appear to be at least the poverty level and had to pick a more expensive plan. After fixing those 2 issues, health insurance became affordable again. The full monthly premium is over \$1200 now, but about \$1150 of that is paid by the Feds, because I control the MAGI. I expect to pay my fair share of taxes, but not 1 penny more. I'm not looking forward to being forced off the ACA and onto Medicare at age 65. Monthly health insurance premiums will raise about 6x, it appears now and that's not counting MediGAP insurance. Definitely need to use the ACA as part of your early retirement plans. Wish I'd realized it a few years earlier before paying tens of thousands to health insurance unnecessarily."

"What do you do for Health Insurance? As someone who is self employed, how do you cover insurance? I have a High Deductible Health Plan through the marketplace. My plan this year is over \$1k a month and has a household out of pocket of \$11k before the insurance pays out anything. That means I pay a minimum of \$12k per year. I would have to spend \$23k before any help for medical bills would be provided. 😬 I don't have a PCP because I'm super healthy & 30 years old and almost never see a doctor. If I do have a reason to visit, I run by a walk in clinic and pay out of pocket. I keep the insurance in case of an emergency, but that is SOOO MUCH MONEY just in case of an emergency. Does anyone have any better options?"

— r/selfemployed · 10 upvotes · None

"I'm confused why the same plan my girlfriend and I choose went up for her, but stayed the same for me? We both signed up for Oscar Gold Elite last year and each have our incomes which are unfortunately low. Same jobs and same income for this year... But for some reason my premium for the same plan stayed at the exact same price of \$40, but hers more than doubled to \$100. We use our premium tax credits but she uses the insurance more than I do because she had asthma but does that have anything to do with it? I'm a bit confused because I don't understand this stuff very well despite watching many videos on it. Any help is greatly appreciated."

— r/HealthInsurance · 7 upvotes · None

"Get government OUT of healthcare and insurance! Back when Obumer first messed with it and caused premiums to start to rise (both ACA and non ACA plans as the new costs for new required benefits, legal and regulatory compliance, etc has to be absorbed via any and all health insurance plans regardless of an ACA plan or not). We went from 3 people being covered on what would be about a "silver" on the ACA or a mid plan was \$238 per month. Today for two people it is over \$1,300 per month and there are areas that are even higher than the state and county / area that we live in. On a per covered basis our health insurance premiums are up 410%. Even a few years ago when we moved from one state to another we paid around \$492 per month....four years later, just over \$1,300. thank you government. Just the insurance premiums and rent (no power, water, food, gas, car insurance or any other expenses) costs me \$40,200 per year and that gets paid with after tax dollars so you do the math. just the fixed cost of a roof and insurance with nothing else and we need to earn around \$47,000 before taxes to cover that. God forbid we want to eat, have car insurance and other insurance, fuel for the car, car repairs, clothing, phone service, etc. Again, great work to the tick in Congress for screwing everyone over rather than just helping the few that need, ACTUALLY need the help. All the fraud out there so far should give everyone some idea of the money we flush down the drain. I wager if it was totaled up it would be around \$500 billion per year or more and that is already after the gubment makes so many other things artificially expensive....college tuition anyone? Nothing my insurance agent loves more than sitting across the table from me as we review the plans that, even after I spend \$16,000 per year on premiums for I still have very high deductibles making it really cost me around \$25,000 before insurance does anything when you add premiums and deductibles together (and no I don't count \$15 off some pharma scrip as mattering). What they need to do is allow, the law prevents this for most people - that's right the government is making it illegal for you to purchase certain types of plans less you fall into a small criteria. what am I ranting about? Disaster style policies. Everyone needs to be able to get those but for most plans you have to be under a certain income or under 30 years of age or just unemployed and need a bridge. My spouse and I don't need all the "benefits" we just want emergancy coverage and disease treatment type stuff. There is so much that pad plans, even in hers (and she is almost 50!) still has all this child birthing stuff, breast feeding classes, etc. all for "free" even though she is almost 50 and also can't even have kids in the first place but, same risk pool as everyone else rather than being prices as an individual like with your car insurance."

— YouTube · \$ How MUCH ACA Marketplace PREMIUMS Are Going UP In 2027 · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hOGTkeTtK0Y&lc=UgzNhfDE0RdaDEBn28x4AaABAg>

↳ @bookmark692 (0): "The Messiah picked winners and losers with health insurance. F'D everyone, except the politicians."

"Imperial Health on ACA I just wanted to post about my experience with Imperial which I purchased on the exchange. I have used "Obamacare" since it first started. I was without insurance before that as I hired a broker to find me insurance while I was self employed and because of a medication I took at the time .. no one would cover me so ACA was a god send. Until about 2 years ago .. I never really had medical issues. I visit a doctor 4 times a year maybe and used teladoc but about 2 years ago I got very sick which required emergency room care, paddles to the chest to get my heart working right and 5 days in the hospital. Bill before insurance came to just about \$80,000. Add to that some additional aftercare added later. Insurance did their part and I averted financial catastrophe. Yay ACA!!!!!!!!!!!!!! This year selections on ACA in Arizona seemed far less than usual and the company I had been using was priced out of reach so I selected Imperial Health Gold Standard. It costs me just \$200 less than what my rent does a month but .. When you need it the cost pales in comparison to hospital costs. About a week or so after choosing the plan I got the bill. Paid on November 24. Then .. nothing. I got a receipt but didnt hear anything else From Imperial Health Insurance for weeks. Wasn't even sure I was going to have insurance since I received no confirmation. Nothing. Second week of December I start looking around on the net for information and many of their links dont work. The links that do work point you at websites that look like they haven't been updated since 1990. A little nervous but I figure "hey if removing polished (functioning) websites and extra paper helps keep the cost down cool" Finally I find a number and call only to do the phone chase through different people out of country trying to find out if I am indeed covered for the coming year. I do get my membership number and am assured I will be covered. This took about 3 hours. With it I find my online membership card. I am now HOURS into this. I discover the pcp they picked for me is 60 miles from where I live. I do not live in some remote area. I live in Mesa AZ so I know there must be closer doctors. Problem is, while my last insurance company allowed you to change PCP online .. there was no provision for doing so with Imperial health so back to the phones. A primary reason I selected Imperial Insurance is because on ACA it stated that Imperial health Insurance covered my PCP who I used for 5 years+ and the hospital my doctor was associated with. I got it changed and was told to expect a packet from them with my card and that the first card would have the Assigned PCP and a little later I would get the card with my chosen PCP. The company was a little behind and was just sending out "Packages" And I waited. it was nerve racking as I had always received at least a welcome to the company letter/email something but nothing .. just ghost. No "packet" no nothing. Comes Jan1 .. still no card. Now I already downloaded the card from the site I found but .. not everyone knows how to dig through internet garbage to get to that point and had I indeed needed doctoring on the 1st .. I would have been unable to prove I had insurance. I paid for insurance that would begin on the 1st and had no way of proving I had insurance on the 1st. On Jan 2nd .. I try to call to find out where the "Packet and card were. Automated service said would I like a call back .. Nope I will wait .. Great you are number 250 on line. I guess a bunch of other people were wondering where their card was as well!?!? The morning of the 3rd I picked up my card at the mail. There was a single sheet. at the bottom was a paper thin card. Fine we are saving money. The letter had a brief three sentences that said here is your card and if you want to know anything go to Imperial health . com. There is virtually no useful information at the site they direct you to. You will have to do long term digging from there. Personal .. here is your plan and here is what is covered is not available at that site or its links Had I not started to chase this down earlier I would have had to submit a request to change pcp and wait 24 hrs plus or use the one they gave me which was 60 miles away. No snap shot of coverage no nothing .. here is your card 2 days late and if you want to know anything .. go to our shitty website and try and find out. Luckily I take care of my health so hope to have a year like last year where I used insurance 4 times but if this is their level of organization up front .. I am very concerned what will happen if an emergency arises .. I am not two weeks into Insurance with Imperial Health, cant afford to go without insurance and cant change it but .. If your still selecting for Feb1 start .. I would look elsewhere. This company does not seem to have its shit together and trust me .. when the medical bills start flying .. you need a company that has their shit together. We learned that with my Emergency and with my wifes cancer diagnosis and treatment. I do not feel confident with Imperial health but

wont go without insurance so now I am stuck Edited to add I have been trying this website since I received my membership number so about 3 weeks. This is what I get .. a spinning wheel that says Processing and this will spin forever. Tried it in Brave, Firefox and Edge. None of them can open this page. It contains information about my plan .. I cant see it!? I have been trying for almost a month. I think the site servers are overwhelmed so I cant arrange autopay, see my policy or .. anything but that spinning circle. <https://preview.redd.it/cokxg0a9kcg1.jpg?width=3060&format=pjpg&auto=webp&s=83258471e1a05666f536b5fd6d325b744f7507d6>";

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · None

"I am currently on an ACA Bronze plan and have had this the past two years that I've been retired. I have noticed the Silver plans are quite a bit more in my state. Also Bronze plans (at least for this year) allow for HSA deposits. Not sure if you can do that with Silver. I'm afraid to drop vision and dental because I wear glasses and have had big dental bills in the past. I'll check the math though. And I'm paying about twice as much as you are for one person (health+vision only). At open enrollment I'll look again. Also will see if I can maybe lower my MAGI. I told them \$62K for this year (which is near the max for a single person and still get a subsidy). Lowering this to \$35K or \$40K might be possible but it would require withdrawals from my Roth IRA to make up the difference."

— YouTube · How We Get ACA Health Insurance Before Age 65? · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xVHorMHIYeM&lc=Ugz860t4k73b15uGt_x4AaABAq

↳ @RetireEarlyWithMelanieAndKeith (5): "Yes. your MAGI is very important and if you can control it and keep it lower you will get better pricing."

↳ @sunnybrookfm-75 (3): "The last 5 years I worked before actually retiring I had to provide my own health insurance the first year where I worked. I used the subsidies like you and paid approximately what you are. In my case it was 180 dollars per month since I'm single. I was earning 15 dollars an hour. I was working 2 jobs. I also had really cheap places to live. We were unionized too thank goodness. When the year was up I got the union healthcare for \$5 a week plus I was on part a of Medicare. The employer had a huge amount of employees so you can do what I'm talking about. I am a retired paralegal and nurse. In addition I have vision problems that caused me to have cataract issues. I had to have them removed from both eyes in my late 50s. I also went completely blind in both eyes for 6 weeks. Some vision came back in 1 eye. I was disqualified from disability because 1 eye functions pretty well. At any rate my vision problems are considered a medical condition. The good news is my doctor tells me my condition has stabilized and I now qualify for low vision benefits. Most of those I would have to pay for out of pocket so I just go along the best I can with what I have. I'm allowed to drive and restrict myself to daytime driving. I go to discount eyeglass providers and pay about 50% less than I would if I went to my doctor for eyeglasses. When I retired I went from health insurance plus pt A Medicare to Medicare and a high deductible medigap plan. I was able to keep health insurance plus pt A Medicare until 67 because my store had a huge amount of employees and had somewhat decent health insurance thru the union. Because of this loophole I was entitled to keep my \$5 dollar a week health insurance until I retired at 67. I am now 73. My retirement age was 66. I eventually added dental insurance I figure if I need implants I can be a dental tourist and get them done abroad if I need to. So far my blood pressure has come down into the normal range now that I'm not working as well. And I've not had to take any medication for my blood pressure. Yay! I'm just taking care of myself. Now mind you this is also because I'm exceptionally frugal. I live on 21k and save 5k a year. Furthermore at the age of 72 I came into a nestegg of 325k from 2 individuals in my life and my own savings. My family left me the 325k. I've not had to touch a nickel of it. And since the 21k is technically my only source of income I owe zero dollars in taxes. Bonus for me 😊😊 . I pay 825 dollars a month in rent and have a small 20 pound dog. My best friend bought my house outright and rents it to me. It is 850 sq ft of heaven. I live in a home built in 1950 that is constantly undergoing renovations. And I live a very simple modest lifestyle. My neighborhood is a working class neighborhood in a downtown area. I live in a wealthy county outside a large metropolitan city. My city has a population of 100k approximately. It is peaceful and quiet. Yes when you are pricing out your healthcare check out both federal and state laws."

↳ @richard1113 (0): "@sunnybrookfm-75 Thank you for sharing your story. It sounds like you're doing ok!"

"Love this topic! You answered my question to when to Roth convert. We are on ACA now ages 60 and 61. We pay zero for bronze plan up to 65k of income. We withdraw 50k from Traditional IRA and the rest from brokerage account. Just requires good bookkeeping. Dividends , interest, and capital gains creep up quickly for income. Taking SS at age 67. Will Roth convert up to 22 percent bracket at age 66. Love your work!!"

— YouTube · Healthcare Before 65: In-Depth ACA vs. Roth Conversion Analysis · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gUjrNm-VLF8&lc=UgwXJ4XevSHcyYmgQet4AaABAg>

↳ @user-ph-f5c (2): "That is almost exactly what I am doing as well. 👍 "

"We had to look at this after getting laid off. Private insurance would have cost about \$1200 per month in TX. With ACA insurance was \$2700. We got a subsidy and it will cost us \$0 with a bronze plan costing \$2100. So we left some on the table. I like Trumps idea of giving everyone \$2000 to spend on a plan as we see fit. In our case it would have saved the govt money."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgxKznSrWvTJQXZO4Gd4AaABAg

↳ @jdeang3531 (1): "@kiwimelt6667he proposed \$2000 from tariffs to be used to buy insurance rather than send money directly to insurance companies from govt It would require congressional approval though"

↳ @kiwimelt6667 (0): "Trump plan was to give everyone 2k per month?"

↳ @re14437 (0): "@jdeang3531 and he is proposing a one-time check...not a monthly check. So, in the case of a Bronze plan costing \$24,000 per year, this proposed \$2,000 check would cover 1/12 of the annual cost. Obviously nowhere near as generous as the expiring ACA subsidies. I won't get either, so it doesn't matter to me."

"I have an ACA Bronze plan. My deductible is 10k. Since my income is so low I don't have a premium. I save for the deductible. Thos year i was treated for cancer. I paid out my deductible. Its a matter of planning."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgyQuxsBPHJn-s6V9vJ4AaABAg.ARNSP1cymbARSghYOR_ib

"Please help! Best insurance in NJ for someone disabled with chronic illness and schizophrenia ASAP!! **NJ FamilyCare, or state Medicaid, is very different from federal Medicaid and I'm looking for people who have understanding of NJ STATE resources rather than federal insurance.** I'm 25F, have a diagnosis of schizoaffective disorder, opioid use disorder on MAT injections and fibromyalgia, and I see multiple providers every month including weekly therapy, bi-weekly medication, zero to 2-3 hospitalizations or inpatient psych treatments a year, monthly suboxone injections, monthly pain management/rheumatology and physical therapy, and like 6-7 monthly medications and bloodwork every 3-6 months for those meds. My insurance migrated to a plan that doesn't have mental health care, so I'm looking for a new insurance on very short notice. I am unemployed and my income is under 23k, but my parents (who make >150k) have agreed to help me financially for the next 6-12 months, so reasonably my budget is a hundred or couple hundred dollars a month. So, I can either go NJ FamilyCare Horizon BCBS, or a private insurance like Aetna PPO or Horizon BCBS PPO or HMO. I have had private, family based top or silver tier PPOs usually Aetna or BCBS sometimes through a third-party employer plan since I was diagnosed years ago, and the provider network is large with the care excellent but it is very expensive, too expensive to reasonably use it the amount I'd like to if money wasn't an issue. Wide network, but extremely pricey, too pricey to fully utilize, and difficult to navigate when claims are denied by the company. Services known as first-line treatments for SMIs such as schizophrenia like ACT, CSC CI and ICMS, case management, day programs or psychiatric rehabilitation are generally off the table and Medicaid/NJFC only. Terrible, TERRIBLE customer service network with no case management, healthcare consolidation, or help when things go wrong with services or coverage and you try to call their phone line. I called a broker through Health Benefits 360 who recommended NJ Family Care as I am in the income bracket and said it's the best fit for my situation with chronic illness, frequent healthcare use, SMI (serious mental illness) and other mental health and substance abuse recovery resources for the most affordable price. However, I've done some research and the network seems much much smaller and I don't know if the quality of these providers is great, good or poor, I had a friend on Medicaid during college who received very poor quality of services, though they were free, and she had chronic conditions, but I don't know if she was on the state or federal coverage. Based on my situation above, can you recommend which insurance would be the best fit for me, even if it's not something that I have mentioned? More than anything, please understand I want to receive good quality care as first priority and have the financial means to not have to compromise on that. It needs to be a widely accepted insurance, either Aetna or BCBS preferably so that my current providers will migrate over, and a plan that CAN be used frequently well and not in a way that rips me off. But in terms of the exact best plan, I could really use some help and ASAP. I need to be ready to switch within this week so that I can start my coverage on October 1st. Also, feel free to recommend websites where I can get connected to a good broker that will help. I need a broker as I am too disabled to complete a long application alone. Specifically, brokers that understand my situation and do both private insurance and Medicaid. COBRA is not an option unless someone knows a cheaper way to receive it. Edit: Just spoke to broker and another option is ObamaCare or ACA-capped insurance. Thank you very much."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · None

"Thanks for this video! After watching I immediately went and found my plan. Last year I worked with a broker but this year did on my own. It's so easy to do after my broker helped me year one. I was over insured last year on a silver plan (I never go to the doctor), so changed to a bronze plan for a cost of \$20 more than I paid last year. I do get dental and vision insurance from a part time job which I'm grateful for as I use those. I'm really hopeful this administration can fix our horrible medical system but I think the medical system is just too corrupt for it to be change."

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=UgyABLAHg_JE2KKUUZ94AaABAg

↳ @HappyonMonday (1): "You're welcome! That's awesome! ☺Yes it needs revamping for sure."

"I have a very good broker I've worked with since 2021. For 2026 I went with an Ambetter higher deductible bronze plan with a lower monthly premium then purchased a gap plan from UBA to cover the high deductible should something happen. I am generally healthy and do wellness visits that are covered. So my monthly expense went up from 7.50 a month in 2025 for my Silver plan to 40.00 per month for this selection in 2026. It also has better prescription coverage than I've had in 2025."

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=UgxjMpss4oRZv7Vk8qt4AaABAg>

↳ @HappyonMonday (0): "That's awesome! With the bronze plan you can now use an HSA too! ☺"

HealthCare.gov or the state exchange on their own · 32 documents · 20 voices

"ACA isn't so affordable Long story short, we'll be losing our healthcare come June. My wife has inherited a long list of health issues, and has been hospitalized 5x since January, anywhere from a week to 2 at a time. Essentially she's been hospitalized for 2 of the last 3 months in total. There's no end in sight for this. I make 62,500 a year, and she made 70,000 a year prior to this, providing insurance from her job as well. She'll be down to whatever SSDI is come June, and has made 60% of her normal wages thus far. I estimate our income at about 90k per year after this. My job is for a semi small family company, and our insurance is ok, but asks about pre-existing conditions. I tried marketplace which said if our income was below 108k per year we qualified for discounts! Yeah no. It's at a minimum \$12k per year in premiums, plus \$18k max out of pockets. I don't know about you, but it's a bit difficult paying 30 grand per year on a 90k income BEFORE taxes. And she will absolutely max the out of pocket week one. These stays are ICU stays, we're already in the millions. If you factor out taxes, we're left with about \$70k, giving me 40k for her, myself, and our 1 year old. This sucks. My only other option would be a divorce, and since her only income would be social security she would then qualify for Medicaid, but I guess that takes 2 years after you have a disability."

— r/HealthInsurance · 323 upvotes · None

"Help! Husband lost his job and we can't afford insurance through my employer! UPDATE: It is MUCH less expensive to insure all 3 of us instead of just me and my daughter through the marketplace! I can get insurance for all 3 for closer to 450 a month by adding him on the policy. Who knew? Thank you everyone for your suggestions! My husband lost his job yesterday. Our insurance will end on April 1. We are both 44 and we have a 13 year old daughter. He starts his new job next week BUT his new employer will not offer any benefits assistance. We live in Missouri. I checked with my employer and it will cost 840 a month on our plan. I tried Healthcare.gov and it was going to be 930 for the cheapest plan (for just me and my daughter, my husband is going to go without insurance. We are not eligible for Medicaid. Where can we find affordable insurance?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 159 upvotes · None

"My healthcare.gov insurance went from \$120 a month in 2025 to \$340 in 2026 because I got a \$1/hour raise... what do I do? 27F, entry level job after graduating college, trying to buy a house and start a family. Bit of a rant here... You saw the title. My healthcare.gov insurance went from \$120 a month in 2025 to \$340 in 2026 because I got a \$1/hour raise. I am flabbergasted. I can't afford to pay over \$200/month more for my health insurance because I make an extra \$160/month?!?! In what world does that make sense?! There is a PCP in my area that does not take insurance, but provides most of the services I require for a \$90/month subscription. It's what I want to go with. They suggested I go with a catastrophic health plan in case of car wreck, etc. He said it should be about \$90/month. When I researched catastrophic health plans, the lowest premium is over \$200/month. I can't afford this AND pay rent AND pay car payment AND pay car insurance AND pay all my other bills AND save money for house/ children/ emergencies. It's safe to say I'm panicking. I payed the insurance for January but I couldn't save anything. I can't keep this plan. I'm currently feeling very defeated by a system that seems to be set up to keep the majority down... I'm so tired of this. Where is universal healthcare? What should I do? Where can I find a catastrophic health plan for around \$100 a month?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 137 upvotes · None

"Got Cancer, and Long Time Insurance Dropped Me TLDR: Got cancer, insurance terminated, I don't know what to do. I was diagnosed with cancer in May - Chronic Myeloid Leukemia, which is very treatable with expensive meds, but 100% fatal if not treated. I've had CareFirst Blue Cross Coverage through the VA Marketplace from 2022-present. CareFirst saw my diagnosis, and promptly cancelled my coverage with a technicality. I've been digging through the bureaucracy with no success, and don't know if I have legal options to restore my coverage and resume foregone cancer treatment. On July 1st CareFirst (CF) cancelled my coverage, which I first learned of from my oncologist 23 days after termination was apparently complete. My credit card had a fraudulent charge, so I replaced it in May - but forgot my premium payments were on the card, and my premium payment didn't process in June. I received no notification or calls before the letter from CF dated July 15 (although I didn't open it until later). I overnight mailed a check on July 25, and CareFirst (CF) cashed it July 28th. The VA Marketplace sent a eligibility / reinstatement form on July 24th, which CF told me they would process. The CF agents said it was in processing with the enrollment department. I called a total of 16 times between July 23 and this writing. In the 8th-13th calls to CF agents, they repeated the reenrollment was pending with the enrollment department. In my 14th call, they told me that - actually - I have no enrollment request, and that all of the previous agents were just attaching additional notes on the termination file. All previous agents had made an error, and that I needed to restart with the VA Marketplace. The first 13 calls never even started an appeal or reinstatement request. The CareFirst agent informed me that the only way I can restore coverage is to cancel this and reapply. Finally I unenrolled with my VA State Marketplace and applied to reenroll with my same program. Then they did the first clear and quick response of this whole mess: They immediately denied my reenrollment. This doesn't just mean I lost one insurer- they now made me ineligible for other insurance without a qualifying life event. (I've been employed for 3 years employed with a decent salary by a small non-profit that offers only a health reimbursement, thus the VA Marketplace ACA coverage). I cannot access cancer treatments, and am forgoing care. The list price on the cancer drug I need, at my current pharmacy, is far higher than my salary. I found a discount pharmacy that lowers it to about my salary. I will continue paying some things out of pocket, and skipping others, hoping I survive until I can restart 2026 ACA coverage. CareFirst says they sent me one letter in June, but I never received any such letter. They also acknowledge that their billing department never called, emailed, or made any effort to contact me. They cancelled my care without ever confirming I had any notification. Then they made me run a gauntlet of impenetrable bureaucratic mess through confusion and clear, blatant errors (I don't think their agent confusion was intentional deception - just incompetence). CareFirst found I have an expensive disease, and illegally cancelled my coverage. I am at the end of my rope. I am trying every approach possible to get my coverage and cancer treatment restored. Can anyone advise on my options? I see an option to request a written appeal, but that feels like asking the executioner to reconsider, given that they clearly are not acting in good faith already. I talked with some other insurance providers, and they told me I'd be rejected unless it was a Marketplace (ACA) plan that requires acceptance. I can only imagine a few options: * I vacate my condo and move to Maryland to get a 'qualifying life event'. But for various reasons, that would be really hard to deal with while already fighting cancer and trying to keep up with a demanding job. * I have access to a large press contact list, so I could try emailing my story to ~310 reporters, but I feel like that's more vengeful than productive. And I don't have the mental energy to be fielding a ton of media interviews. * I can also get a lawyer, but I'm not sure how much that would change. I don't want to be fighting this forever, I just want to get my health care and live my life. Any advice, especially ideas specific to Virginia? Edit: corrected 'deductible' to 'premium'. Update: I'm doing well now, no thanks to 'Carefirst' Blue Cross Blue Shield. I paid out of pocket for expensive chemotherapy for little while. I also fought and fought, tried to get a lawyer, and eventually realized they had no chance of ever getting me back onto the plan. Ironically, they tried to keep my premium payment that I sent via overnight cashier's check as soon as I realized there was a gap. But restoring my coverage? They wouldn't dream of it. The only way I could get back on coverage was to get married. That was already in the works, but it accelerated a courthouse elopement before our actual wedding. I'm now on my

spouse's coverage, and I am continuing the medications I need, and am relatively healthy. I also feel more comfortable because if they try to drop again it would need to go through a large employer's HR, so theoretically they can't unilaterally drop me. I don't know if this was convenient incompetence, weaponized incompetence, or just an active, unwritten rule to get drop high cost patients however they can. I just know that CareFirst doesn't care, and the system we have in the US sucks. It's more expensive, less dependable, and more difficult to navigate than any other developed country. Thankfully, I'm no longer one of the people this system is leaving without care, but I'm more convinced than ever that this system is the worst."

— r/HealthInsurance · 119 upvotes · None

"Is It Better to not Have Health Insurance or Choose a Very Expensive Plan? So these are the issues that we're facing if we have to choose a marketplace plan. Would you guys rather risk it and go without, or pay a lot for a plan? Here's my potential plan with a 50k income: BCBS PPO, 700/month, 9800 deductible, 11000 max oop. It would eat up my income, but if I don't have any major surgeries or a trip to the ER, then I'd be fine without. However, I'd hate to be uninsured if something happens. Realistically, what would you do? Can hospitals negotiate the price down if a bill is very expensive?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 47 upvotes · None

"Turning 26, being dropped coverage and can't do State Medicaid I'm turning 26 years old, and I'm being dropped from my parent's health plan. I live in PA and have no income. I'm still in Medical School for 1 more year, and they offer no SHIP/healthcare plans of their own. I qualify for PA State Medicaid, but I will be doing several out of state hospital rotations, and they will not accept that I only have a State Medicaid. What are my options? I went to HealthCare.gov, and as soon as I say I have no income, all they do is redirect me to sign up with State Medicaid?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 44 upvotes · None

"ACA rates went down for us?? My wife and I have used healthcare.gov for 4 years now. This past year our rates were \$620 a month. We just Checked and according to healthcare.gov our new rates for the same insurance (ambetter gold tier) is \$295 a month. I was expecting it to rise substantially. We are in Arkansas, 63 and 61 yrs old. Anyone else see a decrease???"

— r/HealthInsurance · 30 upvotes · None

"Told it's fraud to have Marketplace and ACA-compliant Employer Insurance at the same time. Is this correct? I'm like a 5 year old when it comes to insurance things. So apologies if this is obvious. I currently have employer-offered health insurance. Per ACA it's considered affordable and it meets the minimum standards. I want to purchase an insurance plan through the Illinois marketplace exchange and have both at the same time. I do not qualify, nor was I trying to get, subsidies, tax credits or discounts. I would be paying whatever is considered full price on the exchange. In trying to get more details from a broker, explaining what I said above, he said that it'd be fraud to have both. A customer service agent through the chat on getcoveredillinois told me that I could only get secondary insurance. That all they offered in the marketplace was primary insurance, and since I had my employer-offered health insurance, and it met the ACA requirements, I could not take on another primary insurance, only secondary. And well they don't offer secondary. Is secondary insurance a different type of insurance? I thought what made it secondary is that I had another plan that was primary, not that it was a specific type of insurance. Is it correct that marketplace insurance plans are primary only? Can I get individual health insurance outside of the marketplace while still having my employer-provided insurance? The enrollment period ends today and have been going back and forth for weeks about this. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 28 upvotes · None

"Insurance Bill I Never Signed Up For So I just did my 2025 taxes, and when I first submitted them they got rejected for not including a 1095. I have insurance through my husband's job so this was weird, but I did check my Marketplace eligibility but never signed up for a plan. I ended up including a letter in my taxes that said I checked my eligibility but did not receive coverage from the marketplace. Fast forward to last night. I went to dinner with my mom and she brought me some mail I got from her house. They were bills and delinquency notices from the insurance company Ambetter. Somehow I was signed up for this insurance and these bills were sent to my mom's house, I have not lived there for 6 years. I did some googling and I'm not the only person that has been signed up for insurance without my consent. My question is what the hell do I do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 27 upvotes · None

"Medicaid nightmare So I have Missouri Medicaid for my wife and daughter (1 year old). When my daughter was born, we decided it was best for my wife to stay home. So we needed insurance. I went to Marketplace to look, and told me I had to apply for chip/medicaid before proceeding. So I called, spent 7 hours on hold, got ahold of someone, they asked me all the questions and I gave them all our information and income info they needed. Two months later, I received a letter saying they're accepted. Fast forward to July, I get a small raise. I go to my local DSS office and report an income change within 10 days, filled it out in the buy and turned it in before leaving. Never hear anything so I assumed it was still within the limit. Get a letter a couple weeks ago saying we make too much and my wife and daughters plans were being changed. I always expected that but never understood how they qualified to begin with while I always made over \$65k/yr. Turns out when I called to get the details on their new plan, they tell me they only have 1 job out of three jobs I have, only making \$409 a month? They didn't even have any records of my full time job despite filling out an income increase form in office TWICE. Plus they only put down the first letter of my first name so identity issues was always a problem also. So now I'm scared they will think I committed fraud when I've been nothing but upfront with them from the beginning. Them over the phone and in the office haven't been documenting my info properly or at all."

— r/Medicaid · 18 upvotes · None

"NC - Can't find a provider through Medicaid; is it fraud to seek medical treatment as a self-pay patient?? Hi Everyone, I'm in NC and recently switched to Medicaid when the expanded coverage went into effect last year. Before that I had BCBS through the insurance marketplace. While covered under BCBS I had a birthmark removed and biopsied (Nevus Sabaceus of Jadassohn) and was advised that if the surrounding area had any changes to size/shape/color post removal to seek treatment immediately. I noticed two days ago the birthmark area had darkened and raised into a small bump. So, naturally, I called my dermatologist to schedule another consultation. When I spoke to them they let me know they don't take Medicaid, so of course my next question was if I can come in as a self-pay/cash patient just for the initial assessment. The nurse/MA I spoke to told me this was considered insurance fraud and I could lose coverage if I do this. So, I spent an hour calling every dermatologist within 50 miles (I live in western North Carolina) that accepted my insurance. ONE of them is accepting new patients, but only with a PCP referral. Okay, progress, so I call my PCP to get one. Nobody picks up. Next I decide to reach out to UHC to see if I can change PCP's since my current one (that was automatically assigned to me) was unavailable. The dude I've been on the phone with for 30 minutes, a member services advocate, and I have now called about 10 PCP's to get set up with a new patient appointment, just so I can get a referral for an issue I know exists, so I can beg the only dermatologist available within a 2 hour drive to please see me as a new patient. Even if it is illegal/fraud to pay cash for medical treatment that could prevent a more serious issue, wouldn't there be some kind of exception for a situation like this? Like, I would take out a loan if I had to since removing it now wouldn't be too crazy, but if I wait until UHC can find me a PCP to GIVE ME A REFERRAL ONLY it would be months, close to a year from now. Additionally I have no issue breaking the law if it comes down to it in the quest to not die of melanoma, I was just wondering if this is actually a thing."

— r/Medicaid · 16 upvotes · None

"Health Insurance Carrier strongly recommending that I don't purchase insurance through healthcare.gov I just got off the phone with sales agent of the largest health insurance carrier in my state. I had previously applied through healthcare.gov and confirmed that I was ineligible for any tax credits/subsidies but found a plan I like. I then contact the health insurer directly to see if there was any difference in premiums by applying directly through them. The price is identical but I was told to purchase the plan directly anyway because there could be "miscommunication" between the marketplace exchange and the insurer. That seemed odd to me. As someone who supports the ACA and wants to ensure it lasts and improves, I would like to enroll through healthcare.gov. My thinking is that the program's success is measured in part by the number of users who shop/purchase through healthcare.gov. Is there any real downside to using the marketplace exchange?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 16 upvotes · None

"2 Month Review of Ambetter Fidelis Insurance (NY State of Health/ACA) Hey r/HealthInsurance, I wanted to leave a review of the Ambetter Fidelis Insurance, which I got through the NY State of Health marketplace (ACA). I figured this was useful, because anyone facing the daunting task of finding health insurance when not employed by a traditional employer, knows that this is a very confusing and terrible place to be in. TLDR, I expected it to be TERRIBLE, but it's just "bad". Perhaps the "least bad" among the NY ACA options. Which is actually better than I expected, and thus I'm overall pleasantly satisfied with it. Background: \- I switched from employer insurance to self-employed \~2 years ago, and have been on COBRA until \~2 months ago \- I'm on a specialty injection medication (Dupixent). And it was really important to get this covered, because it'd be \$40K/yr out of pocket otherwise. I reviewed all the available plans in NY State of Health, looking for the cheapest option that did list Dupixent in its formulary, which would be a strong positive signal that I *could* get covered under the plan. Ambetter Fidelis was the cheapest option when I considered the low monthly premium (\~\$700), plus the relatively lower max out-of-pocket (\~\$8K, which I would max out since Dupixent is expensive), and the HSA tax savings benefit (-\~\$1700), and it listed Dupixent on its [formulary](<https://www.fideliscare.org/Portals/0/Formularies/QHP-2025-formulary-Fidelis-Care.pdf>). I was a bit leery of Ambetter Fidelis, because it has [atrocious](<https://www.yelp.com/biz/fidelis-care-new-york-new-york>) [reviews](<https://www.bbb.org/us/ny/long-island-city/profile/health-insurance/ambetter-from-fidelis-care-0121-66199/customer-reviews>). But... pretty much all the insurances have atrocious reviews. So going with a different plan would be more expensive without any stronger guarantee. At first, I was pretty turned off by Ambetter Fidelis: \- their website is TERRIBLE. Slow, unintuitive, broken, down, their voice line tells you to check the website, and the website tells you to call the voice line for more information. \- when you try to call them, you're put through a ringer of TERRIBLE automated voice robots. I've done this so many times, that if you need to talk to a person, here's what you do: call 1-888-343-3547, press: 1122270 (slowly) \- none of my pre-existing doctors offices took them, so I had to pay out of pocket per visit (\$300+) \- after my doctor/pharmacy submitted the prescription request for Dupixent, of course they deny it. But even worse, it's this confusing hell, because the customer service says they have no record of a prior auth from my doctor's office. It turns out the prior auth is handled between my pharmacy and Ambetter Fidelis, but the Ambetter Fidelis reps can't see it? So I was blaming my doctor's office for awhile, when it wasn't their fault. But over time, I've actually become relatively satisfied with them: 1) I had an elbow injury, and through their terrible website I found a sports specialist doctor that is covered by Ambetter. The doctor is quite good, and the co-pay was only like \$25 per visit. The doctor wanted an MRI, but he knows ambetter requires Xrays before MRI's, which is slightly annoying, but whatever. 2) I had an X-ray done, copay was \$30 3) It was a bit of a 2 week song & dance to get ambetter to approve the MRI, but it was approved, and I got an MRI, copay was \$193 at the office. And then Fidelis charged me an additional \$675, since there's a large deductible. This kinda sucks, especially since it's already the end of the year, so this won't go towards my yearly OOP max. But I need this, so whatever. 4) Dupixent was just "approved" today. Have to complain that they called me telling me there's an important message for me, and to call them back. And I need to call them back and spend 15 minutes in a robot answering machine hell before getting to anyone. But whatever, I'm happy that Dupixent was approved. So just waiting another few days for my pharmacy to actually ship Dupixent to me, and see what the deductible will be. So... lots of friction, lots of annoyances, lots of unexpected costs. But healthcare is expensive. And this is the cheapest option I could find. And Dupixent is covered, which is like \$40K/yr on its own, and that's basically all I care about. It was a plus that I could actually find a sports specialty doctors office that is in network with them. Which gives me confidence I can find some decent other doctors that I need. Presumably I won't have such crazy copays/deductibles in the future, since I'll already be paying the max OOP. Anyway, hope that helps. Happy to answer any questions!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 14 upvotes · None

"What do you do for Health Insurance? As someone who is self employed, how do you cover insurance? I have a High Deductible Health Plan through the marketplace. My plan this year is over \$1k a month and has a household out of pocket of \$11k before the insurance pays out anything. That means I pay a minimum of \$12k per year. I would have to spend \$23k before any help for medical bills would be provided. 🙄 I don't have a PCP because I'm super healthy & 30 years old and almost never see a doctor. If I do have a reason to visit, I run by a walk in clinic and pay out of pocket. I keep the insurance in case of an emergency, but that is SOOO MUCH MONEY just in case of an emergency. Does anyone have any better options?"

— r/selfemployed · 10 upvotes · None

"Ambetter admitting to missing three P2P's and recording inaccurate data I have Ambetter through the ACA marketplace and have been trying since March to get ivabradine (Corlanor) 5 mg approved for Inappropriate Sinus Tachycardia (IST). The medication was denied, so my cardiologist and I started the appeal process. We submitted multiple documents and were repeatedly told some variation of, "We just need one more document and you should be approved." Over the next few months, I received conflicting information from different representatives. One rep told me my doctor never submitted an appeal, while another confirmed that the appeal had been received. I was also repeatedly transferred to an offshore team that often couldn't locate my account or case information and could only read from a script. Eventually, Ambetter told us a peer-to-peer (P2P) review was needed. My doctor scheduled and waited for three separate P2P calls. On each occasion, they reserved two hours of their time and never received a call from Ambetter. When I questioned this, I was initially told that my physician likely missed the calls. After pushing for escalation, I was given a complaint number and promised a callback. No one ever called. I later reached someone on the escalation team who seemed genuinely helpful. He reviewed the case notes and stated that he could see all three missed P2P reviews. He also found documentation indicating that my physician's office had supposedly been contacted before a P2P had even been approved, which didn't make sense chronologically. He told me he had rarely seen a case file this disorganized and said he would immediately contact the pharmacy medical director. After I was on hold for approximately 90 minutes, the call disconnected. The next day, I called back with all of my reference numbers and complaint information. The escalation team transferred me back to the main customer service line. Pharmacy transferred me back to escalation. Escalation then sent me back to the main line again. At one point, the pharmacy representative called for me and was literally transferred back into his own department. To make matters worse, I ended up in the ER during this process and nearly lost my job because my symptoms remained uncontrolled while I fought through these delays. At this point, I'm preparing to file a complaint with my states Department of Insurance. My physician's office has documentation of the missed P2P appointments. Has anyone dealt with anything similar with their insurance? Beyond filing with the state and pursuing external review, is there anything else I should be doing? I pay \$550 a month for just me. TL:DR: My insurance has no internal workflow/communication, recorded inaccurate data, and has no actual escalation team. I'm at a loss of how to navigate other than filing with the state."

— r/HealthInsurance · 8 upvotes · None

"Have used a broker to sign up for the last 2 years - why are his prices higher than the ones listed on the healthcare.gov site? TLDR : the copious info is below but 1) worried a broker is trying to up charge me to sign up through him for 2026 insurance (a more expensive plan I wasn't considering from gov site is actually \$50/month cheaper thru him, the cheaper plan I thought I might pick on the gov site is \$30 more a month from the broker) 2) how can I review the answers I put into my gov 2026 application before I got the info from the insurance broker because I can't seem to find a way to review that on healthcare.gov So..... 2 years ago I signed up through a local insurance broker because I was coming off Medicaid and couldn't get the healthcare.gov website to show me what I'd be getting for a subsidy. I assume it wouldn't give me that info till I was determined ineligible by my states dhhs which is a slow process. I even called them and told them to end my coverage through them on the last day of December hoping that would make it so I was able to see my subsidy but it didn't. So I went through this broker and got signed up cheap (\$45) a month on priority. Last year since he had made the process so painless I went through him again but it went up to \$120 a month which hurt a bit but he had said some program had expired making my insurance more expensive for this past year even tho my income only went up a couple thousand dollars. Looking back now I prob should have delved into that huge increase further. I called him again at the end of October and he said to call him back in a week since he didn't have access to the new numbers yet but after seeing all the people shocked by their increases I decided to fill out an application on healthcare.gov just to see what kind of increase I might be in for. My income also went up so I put in a new estimate (which I don't remember what I put) and if I keep my current plan it will go up to \$215. There's also a cheaper plan I could get instead that will likely fulfill my needs for \$159. The insurance broker sent me an email listing 2 plans neither of which is my current one. It lists one for \$208 but the gov site lists the same plan for \$186. The gov site lists another plan I wasn't even considering due to expense for \$239 but from the broker that same plan is \$183. In order to have complete info I wanted to review my gov application because I don't remember exactly what I put for my income info. For the broker I told him \$28k for the year but I either listed \$28k or \$26,600 on my gov application. I was trying to review my application details again but have been clicking round and round on the gov site and it won't let me review those details anywhere as far as I can see. I need to have those details before I can ask this broker what's up with the different prices and make a selection. Low key worried he may be pulling a fast one on me but I thought these brokers didn't charge for their services (that may have been true under Biden but who knows what rule changes Trump may have made allowing for up charging) Phew, any info appreciated 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · None

"Imperial problems and ACA So my dermatologist has been unable to communicate with my ACA insurance (Imperial) to get the necessary approval to biopsy some spots. The doctor's office basically came back to me saying they have done all they can do and are giving up and i was "welcome to self pay". I have called imperial to get answers to other questions and have gotten false information or "We don't know and we don't have a department either we or you can talk to to find out". I requested a manager callback and received none. Any suggestions on how to deal with this? Is there some kind of oversight organization or patient advocate organization I can go to to complain? Is there a path to being able to switch insurance via marketplace mid year? I tried calling the marketplace today, but they are closed for the holiday....I intend to follow up there but wanted to also cast a net here in case people have info that can help. Thank you in advance!"

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · None

"I make \$400 over the limit for free health insurance I have 2 kids a fiancé we live on our own with a car payment and car insurance we're already stretched thin. We went to the hospital for a simple iv because we had a stomach bug and couldn't stop puking so we were extremely dehydrated to the point where we were confused and dizzy. I got a \$2000 hospital bill for a SIMPLE IV that i was only hooked up to for an hour and then we left. The cheapest plan I found had a \$8400 deductible which I absolutely cannot afford. I was just trying to get insurance to pay for my \$2000 iv but in my case the monthly payment for the 2k hospital bill would cost me less than having to pay for the cheapest insurance i could find."

— YouTube · How to Buy Health Insurance on HealthCare.gov (or your State's Marketplace) · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=fND9DallI2Y&lc=Ugw8cl6lZWVLHEtzpfF4AaABAg>

↳ @SelfEmploymentSidekick (2): "Ugh. I really hate how this works. I remember finding a \$200 line item on a doctor's bill for "Ear wax extraction" because the pediatrician used a cotton swab in my kid's ear real quick during his regular check up. And then there are cases like yours where it would be cheaper to just pay the ridiculous bill rather than pay a ridiculous premium and STILL have to pay the ridiculous bill. Unfortunately, I don't know the best solution for this. I'm just doing my best to help people understand the different options that are available. But I realize the available options aren't good enough."

↳ @pinkorganichorse (0): "When you get free Healthcare, my young son and I can't get any because our premium is too high directly because we are supplementing your subsidy."

"Plan A should be maximizing the ACA subsidy if at all possible. During our 2 lowest years the premiums were \$0/mo. This is our highest year and the premiums are \$45/mo. The insurance on our Utah marketplace has been better than anything I had during my career. The ACA subsidy has dropped over \$20K/year to our bottom line in each of the last 5 years."

— YouTube · How to Get Affordable Health Insurance Before Medicare · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dVyzw5Ac7pA&lc=UgxqiohE_W9_nnZO6o14AaABAg

"I've been freelancing for 11 years, 2020 was my best year yet. Every invoice that comes in, I pay myself first: 25% goes to taxes, 10% goes to retirement, 5% goes towards vacation/PTO, and I have two other 5% savings goals (for example, building up e-fund, saving for new car, saving up for new computer equipment when I need it, etc. - could be anything). I am extremely disciplined about that, and it feels good to have that money in the bank. (It's hard to write out a big check for taxes, but it's way easier when they money's in your account already!) The other 50% pays for any business overhead expenses (for me, it tends to be ~\$2500 a year no matter what my gross income is) and pays me. I keep my business and personal bank accounts separate, but I'm a sole proprietor and practically, this means I have two checking accounts and two savings accounts at my bank. For the actual retirement account, I have a Traditional IRA that I do my best to max out every year, and it's in a Target Retirement Date fund at Vanguard. Simple. If I have more than the max, I put that money into the market, too - just in non-retirement accounts. If you plan to be making a lot more money, then I think there are some better vehicles for retirement savings, but my accountant said to just go for a Traditional IRA for now, and that's working for me. Getting \$6000 into that account each year is a challenge, and the way to do it is one step at a time! Practically, this means I have retirement savings in a bucket and I put it in the market \$500 at a time. Whatever works for you, what's important is just getting that money working for you. I can't help too much with health insurance, as I have another job (not my primary source of income, the freelancing is) but that pays for my healthcare. It's been a long time, but think I just bought off the marketplace. [Freelancers Union](<https://www.freelancersunion.org/>) has some good resources about that."

— r/freelance · https://www.reddit.com/r/freelance/comments/lb2j90/in_2021_how_do_all_of_you_manage_health_insurance/gls0vxi/

Medicaid, CHIP or going without · 32 documents · 20 voices

"Fuck this country's health insurance I've dislocated both my kneecaps, now they're loose and unstable. I genuinely cannot mentally or emotionally go through that type of pain again. I've been desperately trying to buy health insurance, I missed the united healthcare deadline to enroll for 2025 because I didn't have the fucking money, I don't qualify for medicaid, I have health insurance offered through my job but didn't accept it because the insurance is \$240 (9.02% of my income) at the cheapest, and i'm barely scraping by as it is. But that gives me the kicker of not qualifying for tax credits for healthcare marketplace insurances. I genuinely have not taken my knee braces off for more than 20 minutes in three days, I cry nearly every night because of this shit. I feel like i have no choice or the ones i have are absolute shit. Pay \$300+ in health insurance, pay out of pocket for all healthcare costs and go into medical debt that i can't pay, or wait over six months and just let my knee issues get worse before i can enroll into my jobs health insurance again. I am 20 years old and have done no sports, nothing, absolutely nothing, to cause issues in my knees. And now, i live in constant fucking fear that i will end up screaming on the ground again and apparently can't do shit about it. What in the actual fuck is america"

— r/HealthInsurance · 614 upvotes · None

"2026 ACA prices are live on Healthcare.gov. Here's our household's official ACA pricing for next year. **Special disclaimer for 2026: Everything in this post assumes that Congress does not extend the COVID subsidy enhancements and that the default ACA subsidy rules return for 2026.** Anyone can now see the 2026 prices and plans in their area with some anonymous data (age/zip/income/etc) in about three minutes at <https://www.healthcare.gov/see-plans/#/>. If you have a local state-run exchange, then you'll be redirected. State exchanges all update on their own schedule, so 2026 prices may or may not be live just yet. For those who may not be familiar with the ACA, below is an actual real-world example of what being on the ACA can be like with the default subsidy systems. The prices below are for a married couple with an average age of 52 and with MAGI under 133% of the Federal Poverty Level (FPL), which qualifies us for the maximum possible amount of ACA subsidies from both the premium tax credit (PTC) subsidy system and cost-sharing reduction (CSR) subsidy system. We have three dependent children as well, one of which will be on our ACA policy, and we live in a non-expansion state, so expansion Medicaid does not apply to us. Keep in mind that the premiums below would be much higher for a couple if they were in their 60s rather than in their 40s/50s like us. Tobacco users can expect to pay up to 50% additional premium on top of the age-rating. If we were both 62, then the unsubsidized Bronze premium below would rise from \$19,140 to \$27,168. Prices also can vary incredibly between states. If we were both 62 and living in West Virginia instead of Texas, then our Bronze premium would rise from \$27,168 to \$49,584. If instead we were living in Minnesota, then our Bronze premium would fall from \$27,168 to \$21,696. I have also included the policy options we would likely take if we were either eligible only for premium subsidies and not also cost-sharing reductions, as well as the plan we would likely take if we were ineligible for any subsidies at all. People who are over 200% FPL should generally avoid Silver plans due to the way states have elected to deal with the loss of federal funding for the cost-sharing reduction subsidy system, so while I have provided the full market price of our Silver plan, please note that almost nobody would want to ever buy that plan at that price as better Bronze and Gold options are available. ____ Our 2026 Silver plan with subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (based purely on MAGI): * \$84 in annual premium * \$0/\$0 deductible (individual/family) * \$0 PCP * \$10 specialist * \$5 urgent care * \$0/\$15 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$2,200/\$4,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ Our 2026 Silver plan without subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (full market price): * \$26,892 in annual premium * \$6,000/\$12,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$40 PCP * \$80 specialist * \$60 urgent care * \$20/\$40 tier1/tier2 scripts * 40% ER coinsurance * \$8,900/\$17,800 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 Gold plan we would pick if our MAGI was just above 200% FPL (no meaningful CSRs): * \$2,952 in annual premium * \$2,000/\$4,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$30 PCP * \$60 specialist * \$45 urgent care * \$15/\$30 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$8,200/\$16,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 HSA-compatible Bronze plan we would pick if we qualified for zero subsidies/CSRs (MAGI above 400% FPL, factoring in max MAGI-reducing HSA contributions) * \$19,140 in annual premium * \$7,500/\$15,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$50 PCP * \$100 specialist * \$75 urgent care * \$25/\$50 tier1/tier2 scripts * 50% ER coinsurance * \$10,000/\$20,000 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____"

— r/obamacare · 571 upvotes · None

"Declined my \$10K COBRA plan – how I decided to go uninsured instead I'm 25f in NYC. When I left my previous job in March 2025 to start my own thing, I realized my health insurance premium was over \$10K a year, previously was fully covered by my employer. I decided to decline \$10K COBRA after thinking through this hypothetical scenario: >The Devil tells you there's a 0.5% chance you'll face a life-threatening event this year. If it happens, it could cost \$500K or your life – or both. Would you pay \$10K now just so if that 0.5% hits, you'd only owe \$4K (deductible)? $0.5\% \times \$500,000 - \$10,000 + \$4,000 = \$-3,500$ (P.S. Replace \$500K with whatever major medical cost you'd expect without insurance, and \$10K with your own annual premium. You can probably deduct a few basis points off that 0.5% risk if you're young, eat healthy, and exercise regularly, like me) So well well, I've been uninsured since then. This is how I get by: if you live in the big city, there're urgent cares everywhere. I've self-paid for everything – urgent care (labs, X-ray), annual physical, dental cleaning&exam, OB/GYN, flu shots, prescriptions. My primary care doctor hates insurance, dealing with insurance eats up his patients time, so it was self-paying anyway. I know the risks and I'm certainly not happy about it. But, resonating what others said here previously, I just made the most practical choice I could. We should never accept a system that makes people feel *lucky* to afford treatment for a life-threatening condition... hallelujah"

— r/HealthInsurance · 357 upvotes · None

"Help! Husband lost his job and we can't afford insurance through my employer! UPDATE: It is MUCH less expensive to insure all 3 of us instead of just me and my daughter through the marketplace! I can get insurance for all 3 for closer to 450 a month by adding him on the policy. Who knew? Thank you everyone for your suggestions! My husband lost his job yesterday. Our insurance will end on April 1. We are both 44 and we have a 13 year old daughter. He starts his new job next week BUT his new employer will not offer any benefits assistance. We live in Missouri. I checked with my employer and it will cost 840 a month on our plan. I tried Healthcare.gov and it was going to be 930 for the cheapest plan (for just me and my daughter, my husband is going to go without insurance. We are not eligible for Medicaid. Where can we find affordable insurance?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 159 upvotes · None

"Why all of the "I can't believe how much health insurance costs" comments are misguided With recent increases in both the cost of employer sponsored health insurance and ACA plans, especially for those who lose the enhanced subsidies, this sub has been flooded with people shocked and frustrated with the impact. Understandably so. But all of the comments that this is caused by the existence of health insurers or the profit model completely miss the point. Those same posters claiming that universal healthcare, single payer or Medicare for all is the solution equally miss the larger point. That point is that healthcare is and has increasingly gotten more (too) expensive. The US healthcare spend is about \$5 trillion. That equates to about \$15,000 per person per year. Or \$1250 per individual per month. Think \$2500 a month for a couple for health insurance is expensive? That's actually the average of what it costs to deliver healthcare services. So let's get rid of health insurance companies- I'm certainly not a big fan of them. By law they have to spend 85% on actual care. So 15% goes to administration (and those hated executive salaries). So get rid of that admin expense and the \$2500 for the couple drops to \$2125. Feel affordable all of the sudden? Of course not. So how about some form of universal healthcare? All that does is change who pays for it. And definitely not what's paid. We already have some universal healthcare between Medicaid and Medicare. A significant portion of the US insured population uses these programs. And guess what, costs are going up. The government hasn't demonstrated any ability to manage or control costs. Now it's fair to argue that some taxpayers should pay more so that others have to pay less for healthcare but let's at least have an honest discussion about that instead of pretending that if the government pays for it is free. Employers and ACA utilize insurance companies to manage costs. The track record of cost management there isn't really any better. The core issue is that there is a virtually unlimited demand for healthcare. And it's impossible to supply that without spending more and more. "Let the decision on treatment be between the doctors and their patients" - uh sure. Except that whoever actually pays is going to want to weigh in. Pretty logically. Even the successful universal healthcare countries are struggling to fund the efforts and the complaints are often attributed to underfunding. Because fully funding is impossible- demand is too unlimited. You will never change demand. That's human nature (though changing behaviors over time like smoking cessation can help). So someone is going to be in charge of rationing the care people get. Might be the government (Medicare/Medicaid) or might be a private insurer. Unless you are willing to pay directly for your own care, someone else is going to be in a position to say yes or no to it. Uncomfortable fact of life. So what can be done to corral the untenable rise in costs? The providers of care - physicians, facilities, pharmaceutical companies must be driven to charge less (and this may be the best argument for single payer as this best enables the government to dictate what will be paid). And perhaps some of the "innovative but costly treatments" must be foregone (rationed away). But make no mistake, unless we have the political will to pay providers less and ration care more (something the US population has never exhibited), we will continue to have this problem and have to find a new bogeyman after solving the last bogeyman."

— r/HealthInsurance · 131 upvotes · None

"A positive anecdote of using American/ACA health insurance We often hear mostly negative things regarding US health insurance online, particularly in regards to the ACA, so I thought I'd offer up a positive personal experience. Our daughter met with her new rheumatologist less than two weeks ago. Today we got the approval authorization for a year of her biologic infusion, which is off-formulary and medical exemption only. No arguing post-denial or justification to get insurance to pony up for an expensive drug that could easily make us net loss customers for them. Copay program from the manufacturer should bring our out-of-pocket cost down to \$0, but even without it our script-biased insurance would hold the drug copay to just \$300/year. This is also with a new insurer starting as a brand new patient. Took one week for her to get in to see her new PCP, took a few days for the referral to process, then three weeks for her to see the rheumatologist. This insurer and policy are also the absolute cheapest Silver in our market, meaning premium cost is significantly lower than even the benchmark plan. I appreciate more and more each year just how good of a healthcare/ACA market Austin has ended up being. Wife and I both needed to find a new PCP this year too due to switching insurance carriers and it only took a few weeks for us to get in as new patients. I hear people talk all the time about waiting months in other markets. Our new PCP was lovely too and didn't rush our new patient appointments at all despite us not really needing anything other than to establish service."

— r/obamacare · 46 upvotes · None

"Anyone considering a health share in place of ACA? We are a healthy family of 5. I am 30, my wife is 27, and our kids are all under 3. We were paying \$1181 a month this year until our 3rd born came along. Then it went up to \$1580 for the same plan. Now enrolling for next year, they want \$2800 a month for the same plan. It's just not affordable and really doesn't even make sense to buy it at that rate. I don't want to go completely uninsured because of the kids and we have a lot of assets to lose. So instead of the ACA I have been looking at health sharing companies. I know they get a lot of negative flack on here because they are not traditional insurance. But the option isn't really between the ACA. It's between that and having nothing. I have looked at a bunch, Zion health share seems fairly reputable and being that we are younger and have no pre existing conditions, I think most things would be covered. Anyone else in the same boat of looking at alternatives?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 46 upvotes · None

"Turning 26, being dropped coverage and can't do State Medicaid I'm turning 26 years old, and I'm being dropped from my parent's health plan. I live in PA and have no income. I'm still in Medical School for 1 more year, and they offer no SHIP/healthcare plans of their own. I qualify for PA State Medicaid, but I will be doing several out of state hospital rotations, and they will not accept that I only have a State Medicaid. What are my options? I went to HealthCare.gov, and as soon as I say I have no income, all they do is redirect me to sign up with State Medicaid?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 44 upvotes · None

"If I tell my doctor's office I don't have insurance, can they look up whether that's true or not? Context: I've been on Medicaid (in Illinois) for the last few years. I filled out my redetermination in September as usual, then got a letter at the very end of November that I no longer qualify (my income went up and I'm now at around ~\$25,000/year, before I was hovering right around the cut off, which is about \$21,000 I believe). So now I'm looking at Marketplace plans and man....they are all so so awful!! The deductibles are crazy, and it's basically a choice between paying hundreds a month in order to maybe pay \$20-40 each time you go to the doctor, or paying \$10-\$30 a month but paying \$100-\$300 every time to go to the doctor. I take psychiatric medications that I rely on. I've been stable on the same ones for a few years now. I only see my doctor (psychiatrist) four times a year, and it's basically just as a requirement for her to be able to approve my refills. My psychiatrist's office offers sliding scale for uninsured patients, and I would only need to pay about \$35 per visit with them (plus about \$13/month for my meds with GoodRx coupons). This is a setup I could afford, so I was leaning towards just not buying health insurance at all for the coming year and paying for my care out of pocket this way. HOWEVER. I'm 29 years old, and this year two people I know who are even younger than I am were diagnosed with cancer. My parents got in a very scary car accident about two weeks ago (they rolled down a mountain but are miraculously fine because my dad's car is basically a tank). My point being, life has been reminding me a lot recently that no one knows what's going to happen tomorrow, and I feel like having SOME kind of coverage for if things go horribly horribly wrong would probably be in my best interest. I've also read a lot of reddit horror stories of otherwise 'healthy' young people deciding to forego insurance and regretting it after developing unexpected and expensive illnesses. So. I went back to the Marketplace website to look at the plans again. Found one that's \$6/month, has a \$7500 deductible, and covers almost nothing, *but* would be an affordable fail-safe if, god forbid, something really terrible and/or expensive were to happen. My psychiatrist's office does not take this plan. I called them and basically asked, 'If I hypothetically had insurance that you all don't take, would I still be eligible for the sliding scale cash price?' They told me no, that I would have to pay the full cost of the visit, which would be \$300 each time. This finally brings me to my question (thank for for sticking with me if you've read this far lol): **is there anyway for my doctor's office to *know* whether or not I actually have insurance, if I tell them that I don't?** I don't want to come across as if I'm trying to scam the system (although the healthcare system in the US is a nightmare and tbh I wouldn't judge anyone for doing so). But I just literally can't afford to keep seeing my doctor if it's going to be \$300 an appointment. But I also don't want to forego coverage completely. My ideal way to move forward would be to buy the \$6/month plan for emergencies, and just tell my psych that I don't have coverage so I could pay the sliding scale cost for the appointments. Is this something anyone has experience with?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · None

"Health insurance Canceled Me I am seeking urgent legal assistance regarding a serious issue with my health insurance coverage through the Marketplace and Oscar Health. I maintained active health insurance coverage throughout 2025 with Oscar Health and paid all monthly premiums on time without any lapse. In May 2025, I also reported a salary change to the Marketplace, and no issues were identified at that time. On December 31, 2025, I was unexpectedly charged \$529 after already paying my premium. When I contacted the insurance company, I was told this was due to a failure to apply my premium tax credit through HealthCare.gov. I was later informed that this was an error and that my correct monthly premium should have been approximately \$35. I was told the overcharge would be refunded. Shortly after, I had a medically necessary procedure scheduled related to a prior kidney condition and surgery. During that same week, I was informed by the provider that my insurance was inactive. I immediately contacted the insurer and explained the billing error. The following day, I was instructed to pay \$157 to reinstate my coverage, which I did in good faith because I required ongoing medical care. I was told the issue had been resolved. However, shortly thereafter, I began receiving notifications that my claims including hospital care, surgery, and procedures were denied. I was then informed that my coverage for 2025 had been retroactively voided. Additionally, my Form 1095-A has been marked as voided, creating significant tax implications. I have now been dealing with this issue for nearly 30 days. I am receiving medical bills and collection calls stating that I had no insurance coverage for all of 2025, despite having paid premiums consistently and followed all instructions given to me. At no point did I provide false or misleading information. The issue appears to stem from a subsidy/tax credit error that was acknowledged and supposedly corrected. Despite this, my coverage has been retroactively terminated, and I am now facing substantial financial and medical consequences. They are saying I didn't have coverage on 2025. Speaking with marketplace and Oscar they don't know the answers...."

— r/HealthInsurance · 19 upvotes · None

"Medi-Cal vs. Covered California / Medi-Cal eligibility I am a working-age California resident. In the first quarter of last year, I left a job voluntarily. Because it was voluntary I did not bother to apply for unemployment. I did not have another job lined up. As I had coverage with Kaiser through my employer, my first call was to them to ask about Cobra. I was pretty quickly transferred to a Kaiser agent who wanted to work through a Covered California application with me. We did that, but at the end of the process they had some technical failure with regard to me verifying my SSN, so they gave up and transferred me to a Covered California agent. I did not quite know how to answer their question about income, because my answer was basically, "I expect to be employed again at some point this year, but it's hard to say when, and so anything I tell you will only be a guesstimate." So the CC agent concluded that since my total 2022 income from the job I just left fell under the limit, and since I did not have any other income, I was eligible for Medi-Cal. This seemed odd to me since my occupation pays fairly well and I did expect to be employed again at some point that year. "Can't I just get subsidies through CC and then pay them back once I'm working again?" I asked. Their answer was that with Medi-Cal, so long as I advise them of any changes to income, I don't actually have to pay anything back. I didn't really expect to use the plan anyway, i.e. I just wanted catastrophic coverage, and so I agreed to do that. So for the past 11 months, I've been on Medi-Cal. I have not used the plan in any way, have not seen a doctor, have not called anyone about anything with the exception of the initial application process. It is time to renew my eligibility, and here is my concern: When I went through the application process last year, they asked about "cash on hand." Now, at the time I did have some money in the bank, but that money was set aside for living expenses like rent and food, which I considered to be priorities that came before health insurance. It felt like the question was more about "disposable cash" and so I reported that no, I did not have cash on hand. Looking back, that was probably the wrong answer. There was zero intent to deceive on my part, however I'm now concerned that I've basically been enrolled in Medi-Cal fraudulently. As it turns out, I am still unemployed. I am very close to being out of cash, am living on credit card advances, and I have a traditional IRA that I will tap into as a last resort. So, unlike last year, I'm pretty sure that I am now legitimately eligible for Medi-Cal. (I don't think my IRA counts as an asset but please correct me if I'm wrong.) Let's say I renew and at some point thereafter I obtain services. Might they do some digging and discover that I did actually have some cash in 2022? My understanding is that if I am eligible for Medi-Cal then I am NOT eligible for CC subsidies, so even though at this point I would feel better about reversing course and getting myself on a CC plan, that may not be financially feasible for me. I would like to have a conversation with someone from Medi-Cal about this, but not sure how wise it would be for me to share what I have shared here. Maybe it would be better to just return my renewal docs and proceed as if I've been eligible all along? Does it even matter since I haven't actually obtained any services? Am I just being paranoid? Apologies for the long-winded post. Just wanted to provide some context so that hopefully someone might have some valuable insight and/or advice. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 18 upvotes · None

"Medicaid nightmare So I have Missouri Medicaid for my wife and daughter (1 year old). When my daughter was born, we decided it was best for my wife to stay home. So we needed insurance. I went to Marketplace to look, and told me I had to apply for chip/medicaid before proceeding. So I called, spent 7 hours on hold, got ahold of someone, they asked me all the questions and I gave them all our information and income info they needed. Two months later, I received a letter saying they're accepted. Fast forward to July, I get a small raise. I go to my local DSS office and report an income change within 10 days, filled it out in the buy and turned it in before leaving. Never hear anything so I assumed it was still within the limit. Get a letter a couple weeks ago saying we make too much and my wife and daughters plans were being changed. I always expected that but never understood how they qualified to begin with while I always made over \$65k/yr. Turns out when I called to get the details on their new plan, they tell me they only have 1 job out of three jobs I have, only making \$409 a month? They didn't even have any records of my full time job despite filling out an income increase form in office TWICE. Plus they only put down the first letter of my first name so identity issues was always a problem also. So now I'm scared they will think I committed fraud when I've been nothing but upfront with them from the beginning. Them over the phone and in the office haven't been documenting my info properly or at all."

— r/Medicaid · 18 upvotes · None

"NY has it's own exchange as well. One problem I have getting an estimate is, if my income is below 250% FPL (about \$39k), they don't exactly tell you what you get because instead of a subsidy for a 'qualified plan', you get put on the 'Essential Plan'....basically a co-pay version of Medicaid. But w/ the new Medicaid eligibility rules - like working 80 hrs/mo - I technically won't qualify. So not sure if that means I get a bigger subsidy towards a 'qualified plan' or what happens. It's almost like when the passed ACA - you have to apply to find out what you get. Either way, I am looking at about \$35k, so I'll just have to put it in and see what it comes up with."

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · 17 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=UgxxgNqdW1muZXeoJsaN4AaABAq>

↳ @Dave_D. (1): "@HappyonMonday If I put in \$40k, the low end where subsidies start, it will be fine, I've already played around w/ it a bunch - just drives me nuts that they can't tell you what happens below that level until you 'send it'."

↳ @HappyonMonday (0): "It's crazy how different each state is! Fingers crossed for you that you get a good deal! 🙌 "

↳ @Dave_D. (0): "@TaishaKirkendall I could just say \$40k and know what I'll pay for a qualified plan....but I think I will go lower (I can control my income so that's not a problem) and just see what happens if they put me on essential but I don't qualify due to the new medicaid qualifications. I figure worst case, it would be the same subsidy as \$40k, best case it's free w/ co-pay, or, somewhere in the middle (bigger subsidy)."

"NC - Can't find a provider through Medicaid; is it fraud to seek medical treatment as a self-pay patient?? Hi Everyone, I'm in NC and recently switched to Medicaid when the expanded coverage went into effect last year. Before that I had BCBS through the insurance marketplace. While covered under BCBS I had a birthmark removed and biopsied (Nevus Sabaceus of Jadassohn) and was advised that if the surrounding area had any changes to size/shape/color post removal to seek treatment immediately. I noticed two days ago the birthmark area had darkened and raised into a small bump. So, naturally, I called my dermatologist to schedule another consultation. When I spoke to them they let me know they don't take Medicaid, so of course my next question was if I can come in as a self-pay/cash patient just for the initial assessment. The nurse/MA I spoke to told me this was considered insurance fraud and I could lose coverage if I do this. So, I spent an hour calling every dermatologist within 50 miles (I live in western North Carolina) that accepted my insurance. ONE of them is accepting new patients, but only with a PCP referral. Okay, progress, so I call my PCP to get one. Nobody picks up. Next I decide to reach out to UHC to see if I can change PCP's since my current one (that was automatically assigned to me) was unavailable. The dude I've been on the phone with for 30 minutes, a member services advocate, and I have now called about 10 PCP's to get set up with a new patient appointment, just so I can get a referral for an issue I know exists, so I can beg the only dermatologist available within a 2 hour drive to please see me as a new patient. Even if it is illegal/fraud to pay cash for medical treatment that could prevent a more serious issue, wouldn't there be some kind of exception for a situation like this? Like, I would take out a loan if I had to since removing it now wouldn't be too crazy, but if I wait until UHC can find me a PCP to GIVE ME A REFERRAL ONLY it would be months, close to a year from now. Additionally I have no issue breaking the law if it comes down to it in the quest to not die of melanoma, I was just wondering if this is actually a thing."

— r/Medicaid · 16 upvotes · None

"My self paid insurance was \$150 a month when they started Obamacare. I have the same insurance, no medical conditions, and 5k deductible. It cost \$786 a month now. Thanks, Barry!"

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=Ugy2-KWeXwafTnN1nOd4AaABAg>

↳ @jltsowowdycjltsowowdyc1076 (4): "Oh heavens, I'm afraid you failed to understand, that thing you were paying \$150/month for was not insurance. It was a product used to make people think they had insurance, and was very affordable, but in reality, they would have simply kicked you out if you ever needed to use expensive care. You know, like cancer, a heart problem or some pre-existing condition. But after watching this video, I'm not sure why you have to pay so much? Julie seems to be paying very little. If only there was somebody out there trying to get those costs lower... the irony is thick."

↳ @jerryrichardson2799 (2): "Nope, more like thanks Trump. You might have had a legitimate gripe if you had a "Cadillac" plan, the ACA did charge a premium on those plans, but I can tell from your description you didn't have one of those."

↳ @HappyonMonday (1): "Yikes that's gone up a lot! 🤔"

"Living off Cash (for a few years) I'll be 53 next year, and would like to quit my job and live off saved cash for 3-4 years before potentially rejoining the workforce. Since my income would be \$0 for those years, how would I go about getting health insurance? When I enter estimates in the ACA, they tell me to apply for medicaid. I also own a house that has an estimated value of 500k and have over 500k in retirement, but I don't want to touch the retirement until I'm 59. Would getting health insurance for my 3-4 years "off" be problematic because of my assets? And, would I have to receive medicaid or is there a way to still get a private insurance plan even with no income? I'm not trying to get "free healthcare," but if my income is zero for a few years, do I even have a choice? Thanks,"

— r/HealthInsurance · 10 upvotes · None

"What do you do for Health Insurance? As someone who is self employed, how do you cover insurance? I have a High Deductible Health Plan through the marketplace. My plan this year is over \$1k a month and has a household out of pocket of \$11k before the insurance pays out anything. That means I pay a minimum of \$12k per year. I would have to spend \$23k before any help for medical bills would be provided. 😬 I don't have a PCP because I'm super healthy & 30 years old and almost never see a doctor. If I do have a reason to visit, I run by a walk in clinic and pay out of pocket. I keep the insurance in case of an emergency, but that is SOOO MUCH MONEY just in case of an emergency. Does anyone have any better options?"

— r/selfemployed · 10 upvotes · None

"I'm disabled. A few years ago before I qualified for Medicaid in Florida, I had a subsidized plan meant for people in transition to Medicaid. It started at just \$18 a month. By the end, I was being asked to pay \$88.75 a month. For a plan that was MEANT for unemployed disabled people who weren't working and didn't currently get disability or Medicaid. I genuinely can't imagine what some people are paying...."

— YouTube · Your health insurance may have gotten a lot more expensive I Obamacare subsidies expire · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=EYFzx3onLh4&lc=UgzLCiBRjOd3Aslths54AaABAg>

"I'm a single person, age 60, using the ACA without subsidies, because I don't "qualify"... for just medical it costs me \$1000 per month with a \$6000 annual deductible... which means, I have to spend \$18,000 a year to just utilize the insurance. Totally unsustainable and unacceptable for a "first-world" country."

— YouTube · Early Retirement Health Insurance Before Medicare: A Step-by-Step Framework · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NAYG0yvzBI8&lc=Ugzy4GSnFfdMqq7huXR4AaABAg.AVBMLSYyqO-AVBbxqPVAdU>

"Have used a broker to sign up for the last 2 years - why are his prices higher than the ones listed on the healthcare.gov site? TLDR : the copious info is below but 1) worried a broker is trying to up charge me to sign up through him for 2026 insurance (a more expensive plan I wasn't considering from gov site is actually \$50/month cheaper thru him, the cheaper plan I thought I might pick on the gov site is \$30 more a month from the broker) 2) how can I review the answers I put into my gov 2026 application before I got the info from the insurance broker because I can't seem to find a way to review that on healthcare.gov So..... 2 years ago I signed up through a local insurance broker because I was coming off Medicaid and couldn't get the healthcare.gov website to show me what I'd be getting for a subsidy. I assume it wouldn't give me that info till I was determined ineligible by my states dhhs which is a slow process. I even called them and told them to end my coverage through them on the last day of December hoping that would make it so I was able to see my subsidy but it didn't. So I went through this broker and got signed up cheap (\$45) a month on priority. Last year since he had made the process so painless I went through him again but it went up to \$120 a month which hurt a bit but he had said some program had expired making my insurance more expensive for this past year even tho my income only went up a couple thousand dollars. Looking back now I prob should have delved into that huge increase further. I called him again at the end of October and he said to call him back in a week since he didn't have access to the new numbers yet but after seeing all the people shocked by their increases I decided to fill out an application on healthcare.gov just to see what kind of increase I might be in for. My income also went up so I put in a new estimate (which I don't remember what I put) and if I keep my current plan it will go up to \$215. There's also a cheaper plan I could get instead that will likely fulfill my needs for \$159. The insurance broker sent me an email listing 2 plans neither of which is my current one. It lists one for \$208 but the gov site lists the same plan for \$186. The gov site lists another plan I wasn't even considering due to expense for \$239 but from the broker that same plan is \$183. In order to have complete info I wanted to review my gov application because I don't remember exactly what I put for my income info. For the broker I told him \$28k for the year but I either listed \$28k or \$26,600 on my gov application. I was trying to review my application details again but have been clicking round and round on the gov site and it won't let me review those details anywhere as far as I can see. I need to have those details before I can ask this broker what's up with the different prices and make a selection. Low key worried he may be pulling a fast one on me but I thought these brokers didn't charge for their services (that may have been true under Biden but who knows what rule changes Trump may have made allowing for up charging) Phew, any info appreciated 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · None

COBRA or a spouse's employer plan · 24 documents · 20 voices

"Declined my \$10K COBRA plan – how I decided to go uninsured instead I'm 25f in NYC. When I left my previous job in March 2025 to start my own thing, I realized my health insurance premium was over \$10K a year, previously was fully covered by my employer. I decided to decline \$10K COBRA after thinking through this hypothetical scenario: >The Devil tells you there's a 0.5% chance you'll face a life-threatening event this year. If it happens, it could cost \$500K or your life – or both. Would you pay \$10K now just so if that 0.5% hits, you'd only owe \$4K (deductible)? $0.5\% \times \$500,000 - \$10,000 + \$4,000 = \$-3,500$ (P.S. Replace \$500K with whatever major medical cost you'd expect without insurance, and \$10K with your own annual premium. You can probably deduct a few basis points off that 0.5% risk if you're young, eat healthy, and exercise regularly, like me) So well well, I've been uninsured since then. This is how I get by: if you live in the big city, there're urgent cares everywhere. I've self-paid for everything – urgent care (labs, X-ray), annual physical, dental cleaning&exam, OB/GYN, flu shots, prescriptions. My primary care doctor hates insurance, dealing with insurance eats up his patients time, so it was self-paying anyway. I know the risks and I'm certainly not happy about it. But, resonating what others said here previously, I just made the most practical choice I could. We should never accept a system that makes people feel *lucky* to afford treatment for a life-threatening condition... hallelujah"

— r/HealthInsurance · 357 upvotes · None

"Former employer canceled COBRA health insurance policy without notifying me I just found out my former employer in the state of Washington canceled my COBRA health insurance policy. Not because they notified me, but because my pharmacy called me and said my policy was no longer valid. WTF COBRA is supposed to be valid for 18-36 months and I am fully paid up. I just had major surgery and have PT scheduled in 4 days that has already been deferred for 2 weeks (because I was at my yearly limit of PT) if I don't make the appointment I may never correctly recover and regain full use of my arm. Apparently, my former employer is getting rid of Aetna and getting a new Health Insurance plan from a different provider. So my Aetna policy terminated at the beginning of 2025. Neither my former employer nor Aetna notified me about this, is that even legal? My COBRA provider told me over the phone that my coverage is supposed to switch to the new policy, but my former employer didn't send them the correct documents and that plan is not active for me so now I am stuck with no Health Insurance in need of immediate healthcare. What are my options? UPDATE: I contacted my former employer, who didn't have a good answer for why I wasn't notified. But did state that they had gotten a new health insurance policy with a different company. They then gave me a plan number and group number and told me to use that info to create an account on the website on the new insurance provider. I attempted to do so and the web form said that wasn't a valid policy and refused to let me create an account. After an additional back and forth with HR from my old company they said to call the new Health Insurance provider. So after 30 minutes of being on hold with them, they told me the policy number I had been given was for a different person who happened to have a different first name, same last name, different birthday and different address. Apparently that incorrect info was given to the HR lady at my company by their insurance vendor. After contacting four different companies, and spending more than an hour on the phone I am still without health insurance while needing PT to recover from a major surgery and unable to renew my prescriptions. For those that said this was a simple issue that I could clear up with a quick call to my former employer, I'm calling you on your BS. It's not, and there is incompetence up and down the chain of everyone involved here. FURTHER CONTEXT: I have accepted an offer for a new job (one with better health insurance) and should be starting at the end of the month. I only need my COBRA health plan for another month to get through all the post surgery PT, maybe get a Flu and COVID shot and get my prescriptions for this month. And however long it takes to get the new health insurance actually functional. As such it doesn't feel worth it to sign up for an ACA plan for less than a month of coverage and then have to deal with the overhead of cancelling that plan and setting up another new one. I just want the COBRA coverage they told me would be available for a whole year to actually work. UPDATE 2: I got a different (supposedly correct) policy number from my former employers HR, tried to use that to create an account on Regence's website and it still failed. I called Regence (was on hold for a whole hour) gave them the new policy number and was told over the phone I am actually in their system and I SHOULD have an active policy. I also read back the group # I had been given by HR and found out that was also incorrect (way to go former employer 0/2). I have no way to verify it's functional other than going to PT tomorrow and seeing if they can bill Regence. UPDATE 3: I filled a complaint with the state insurance commissioner, not just for the recent fiasco but also for the situation that caused me to quit my job in the first place where I believe the company may have actually acted illegally. I don't expect anything to come of it but maybe future me will be pleasantly surprised."

— r/HealthInsurance · 273 upvotes · None

"As a 59 years old retiree, I pay \$2264 per month for COBRA health insurance for me and my wife. I just checked ACA rates for us, it was over \$1000 per month more. I don't qualify for subsidies. Something is wrong with the ACA when its so much more costly without government subsidies."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 29 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgzxjuSyfTqcBbN1kp4AaABAg

↳ @beautyandplay (3): "probably better with private plans."

↳ @nata3467 (0): "how much are you and your wife making ?"

↳ @acevers (0): "That's because you were a productive person before retirement. Only bums and disabled people get deals and freebies, and your taxes pay for it. Sucks."

"Told it's fraud to have Marketplace and ACA-compliant Employer Insurance at the same time. Is this correct? I'm like a 5 year old when it comes to insurance things. So apologies if this is obvious. I currently have employer-offered health insurance. Per ACA it's considered affordable and it meets the minimum standards. I want to purchase an insurance plan through the Illinois marketplace exchange and have both at the same time. I do not qualify, nor was I trying to get, subsidies, tax credits or discounts. I would be paying whatever is considered full price on the exchange. In trying to get more details from a broker, explaining what I said above, he said that it'd be fraud to have both. A customer service agent through the chat on getcoveredillinois told me that I could only get secondary insurance. That all they offered in the marketplace was primary insurance, and since I had my employer-offered health insurance, and it met the ACA requirements, I could not take on another primary insurance, only secondary. And well they don't offer secondary. Is secondary insurance a different type of insurance? I thought what made it secondary is that I had another plan that was primary, not that it was a specific type of insurance. Is it correct that marketplace insurance plans are primary only? Can I get individual health insurance outside of the marketplace while still having my employer-provided insurance? The enrollment period ends today and have been going back and forth for weeks about this. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 28 upvotes · None

"Insurance Bill I Never Signed Up For So I just did my 2025 taxes, and when I first submitted them they got rejected for not including a 1095. I have insurance through my husband's job so this was weird, but I did check my Marketplace eligibility but never signed up for a plan. I ended up including a letter in my taxes that said I checked my eligibility but did not receive coverage from the marketplace. Fast forward to last night. I went to dinner with my mom and she brought me some mail I got from her house. They were bills and delinquency notices from the insurance company Ambetter. Somehow I was signed up for this insurance and these bills were sent to my mom's house, I have not lived there for 6 years. I did some googling and I'm not the only person that has been signed up for insurance without my consent. My question is what the hell do I do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 27 upvotes · None

"Medi-Cal vs. Covered California / Medi-Cal eligibility I am a working-age California resident. In the first quarter of last year, I left a job voluntarily. Because it was voluntary I did not bother to apply for unemployment. I did not have another job lined up. As I had coverage with Kaiser through my employer, my first call was to them to ask about Cobra. I was pretty quickly transferred to a Kaiser agent who wanted to work through a Covered California application with me. We did that, but at the end of the process they had some technical failure with regard to me verifying my SSN, so they gave up and transferred me to a Covered California agent. I did not quite know how to answer their question about income, because my answer was basically, "I expect to be employed again at some point this year, but it's hard to say when, and so anything I tell you will only be a guesstimate." So the CC agent concluded that since my total 2022 income from the job I just left fell under the limit, and since I did not have any other income, I was eligible for Medi-Cal. This seemed odd to me since my occupation pays fairly well and I did expect to be employed again at some point that year. "Can't I just get subsidies through CC and then pay them back once I'm working again?" I asked. Their answer was that with Medi-Cal, so long as I advise them of any changes to income, I don't actually have to pay anything back. I didn't really expect to use the plan anyway, i.e. I just wanted catastrophic coverage, and so I agreed to do that. So for the past 11 months, I've been on Medi-Cal. I have not used the plan in any way, have not seen a doctor, have not called anyone about anything with the exception of the initial application process. It is time to renew my eligibility, and here is my concern: When I went through the application process last year, they asked about "cash on hand." Now, at the time I did have some money in the bank, but that money was set aside for living expenses like rent and food, which I considered to be priorities that came before health insurance. It felt like the question was more about "disposable cash" and so I reported that no, I did not have cash on hand. Looking back, that was probably the wrong answer. There was zero intent to deceive on my part, however I'm now concerned that I've basically been enrolled in Medi-Cal fraudulently. As it turns out, I am still unemployed. I am very close to being out of cash, am living on credit card advances, and I have a traditional IRA that I will tap into as a last resort. So, unlike last year, I'm pretty sure that I am now legitimately eligible for Medi-Cal. (I don't think my IRA counts as an asset but please correct me if I'm wrong.) Let's say I renew and at some point thereafter I obtain services. Might they do some digging and discover that I did actually have some cash in 2022? My understanding is that if I am eligible for Medi-Cal then I am NOT eligible for CC subsidies, so even though at this point I would feel better about reversing course and getting myself on a CC plan, that may not be financially feasible for me. I would like to have a conversation with someone from Medi-Cal about this, but not sure how wise it would be for me to share what I have shared here. Maybe it would be better to just return my renewal docs and proceed as if I've been eligible all along? Does it even matter since I haven't actually obtained any services? Am I just being paranoid? Apologies for the long-winded post. Just wanted to provide some context so that hopefully someone might have some valuable insight and/or advice. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 18 upvotes · None

"ACA healthcare made it possible for me to retire. I keep my taxable income low and receive Gov subsidies on premiums. I consider the subsidies getting back some of the taxes I paid into the systems for the last 48 years. I had employer healthcare insurance for 30 years and never used one penny of it. Insurance companies made a mint off of my employer and me for decades. I never went to the Doctor until I turned 60 when I got Covid."

— YouTube · How to Get Affordable Health Insurance Before Medicare · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dVyzw5Ac7pA&lc=UgzT3TgVH2azwWzdsxx4AaABAq>

↳ @DonaldSharpe-u9o (3): "I completely relate! It's amazing how planning your income and using the ACA effectively can make early retirement feasible. I went through a similar path, keeping taxable income low while investing in a few index funds and it helped me feel secure financially while also getting affordable healthcare coverage."

↳ @drcornelius8275 (0): "Well great for you that has little income but ACA is killing my family. Not only did we pay the same or more taxes than you have over the years, now we get to pay for your insurance too because ACA sticks us with huge premiums. Do you think that's fair? Why don't I just give you some of my belongs too while we're talking Communism."

↳ @bestiefswlady5251 (0): "@drcornelius8275 I thought that depended on the states. Some states chose to expand their Medicaid, which helps supplement the tax breaks for the ACA and some states decided not to. Are you paying an insurance directly or does it come from your employer (i'm not asking for anything personal or specific. I'm just curious in the broad sense of the word). I'm open to correction if I'm wrong!!!"

"2 Month Review of Ambetter Fidelis Insurance (NY State of Health/ACA) Hey r/HealthInsurance, I wanted to leave a review of the Ambetter Fidelis Insurance, which I got through the NY State of Health marketplace (ACA). I figured this was useful, because anyone facing the daunting task of finding health insurance when not employed by a traditional employer, knows that this is a very confusing and terrible place to be in. TLDR, I expected it to be TERRIBLE, but it's just "bad". Perhaps the "least bad" among the NY ACA options. Which is actually better than I expected, and thus I'm overall pleasantly satisfied with it. Background: \- I switched from employer insurance to self-employed \~2 years ago, and have been on COBRA until \~2 months ago \- I'm on a specialty injection medication (Dupixent). And it was really important to get this covered, because it'd be \$40K/yr out of pocket otherwise. I reviewed all the available plans in NY State of Health, looking for the cheapest option that did list Dupixent in its formulary, which would be a strong positive signal that I *could* get covered under the plan. Ambetter Fidelis was the cheapest option when I considered the low monthly premium (\~\$700), plus the relatively lower max out-of-pocket (\~\$8K, which I would max out since Dupixent is expensive), and the HSA tax savings benefit (-\~\$1700), and it listed Dupixent on its [formulary](<https://www.fideliscare.org/Portals/0/Formularies/QHP-2025-formulary-Fidelis-Care.pdf>). I was a bit leery of Ambetter Fidelis, because it has [atrocious](<https://www.yelp.com/biz/fidelis-care-new-york-new-york>) [reviews](<https://www.bbb.org/us/ny/long-island-city/profile/health-insurance/ambetter-from-fidelis-care-0121-66199/customer-reviews>). But... pretty much all the insurances have atrocious reviews. So going with a different plan would be more expensive without any stronger guarantee. At first, I was pretty turned off by Ambetter Fidelis: \- their website is TERRIBLE. Slow, unintuitive, broken, down, their voice line tells you to check the website, and the website tells you to call the voice line for more information. \- when you try to call them, you're put through a ringer of TERRIBLE automated voice robots. I've done this so many times, that if you need to talk to a person, here's what you do: call 1-888-343-3547, press: 1122270 (slowly) \- none of my pre-existing doctors offices took them, so I had to pay out of pocket per visit (\$300+) \- after my doctor/pharmacy submitted the prescription request for Dupixent, of course they deny it. But even worse, it's this confusing hell, because the customer service says they have no record of a prior auth from my doctor's office. It turns out the prior auth is handled between my pharmacy and Ambetter Fidelis, but the Ambetter Fidelis reps can't see it? So I was blaming my doctor's office for awhile, when it wasn't their fault. But over time, I've actually become relatively satisfied with them: 1) I had an elbow injury, and through their terrible website I found a sports specialist doctor that is covered by Ambetter. The doctor is quite good, and the co-pay was only like \$25 per visit. The doctor wanted an MRI, but he knows ambetter requires Xrays before MRI's, which is slightly annoying, but whatever. 2) I had an X-ray done, copay was \$30 3) It was a bit of a 2 week song & dance to get ambetter to approve the MRI, but it was approved, and I got an MRI, copay was \$193 at the office. And then Fidelis charged me an additional \$675, since there's a large deductible. This kinda sucks, especially since it's already the end of the year, so this won't go towards my yearly OOP max. But I need this, so whatever. 4) Dupixent was just "approved" today. Have to complain that they called me telling me there's an important message for me, and to call them back. And I need to call them back and spend 15 minutes in a robot answering machine hell before getting to anyone. But whatever, I'm happy that Dupixent was approved. So just waiting another few days for my pharmacy to actually ship Dupixent to me, and see what the deductible will be. So... lots of friction, lots of annoyances, lots of unexpected costs. But healthcare is expensive. And this is the cheapest option I could find. And Dupixent is covered, which is like \$40K/yr on its own, and that's basically all I care about. It was a plus that I could actually find a sports specialty doctors office that is in network with them. Which gives me confidence I can find some decent other doctors that I need. Presumably I won't have such crazy copays/deductibles in the future, since I'll already be paying the max OOP. Anyway, hope that helps. Happy to answer any questions!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 14 upvotes · None

"I just talked to my Insurance broker last week (I'm on Cobra until 2/2027). FYI, the ACA only has HMO plans, no more PPO plans, she told me. I can't find any doctors who take the HMO plans, even the top tier ones."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgwScHrO5XRAM7MD7Cp4AaABAq

↳ @TracyMadsen-rx2fu (0): "I think you might need a different broker, that's not true. I have a silver plan PPO, have had it for about 7 years"

"Question about tax credit Excuse some of my ignorance because I only switched to ACA plan for my family of 3 about six months ago after switching employers. I didn't pay a lot of attention to it before because I was on a workplace health plan for 10+ years, so I've been playing catch up. My wife and I are both commission workers so I had to estimate our income when first applying. It came out to about 102k/year, and it seemed that I was told that we did not qualify for the APTC, although now I see that the limit is 106k. Our final gross income from 2025 may end up being lower than my estimation. It's possible that I was confused but I'm currently paying 700\$/mo right now, and my plan is going up to around 840\$/mo next year, but the eligibility summary is telling me that I actually am eligible for up to 247\$/mo from the APTC (as well as currently eligible, I think?). So I guess my question is, I am I think understanding now that the tax credit is only going away for those making over 400% of the federal poverty line, does that mean that I could still claim the 247\$/mo next year, as was as retroactively claim it for the previous 6 months or so when I do my taxes next year? I currently am not receiving any advanced payments. Thanks, sorry if this is a dumb basic question I should know already, but just trying to understand better."

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · None

"Well none of these work for me. 32 years in law enforcement and got great pension, but very expensive health insurance. County give me 600 a month to pay for insurance, but the plans are super expensive. My plan for a family is 2400 a month with a 6000 deduction. Tried Obamacare but I make too much on my pension. Cobra was more than the plans and I would not get the 600 a month if I used Cobra. I do use an HSA to pay for medical stuff and write all the premiums off at end of year so it's not so painful. Only choice till 65 is for me to get a job with benefits or just go without medical and use free clinic down the street. Aint America grand!"

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement - Here Are 4 Options · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pjR3wlGOZsc&lc=Ugwz-0YIBEUizzYTHRZ4AaABAq>

↳ @jadexplores2100 (2): "This is exactly why I am trying to figure out if moving abroad is the better option for me between ages 55-64."

↳ @leehamilton4459 (0): "same. Retired at 55 and health insurance was covered for two years. Now I have to pay it myself and it's 1500 per month for hubby and me. That is too much. I canceled it and am now looking for a full-time job that offers health insurance. Geez, retirement was short."

↳ @robertsmith6408 (0): "@leehamilton4459 me too! I am so happy being retired that the thought of working makes me depressed. I keep trying for six figures jobs, which I can do but may have to settle for a simple job but no point unless it has medical benefits. I take good care of myself so I look about 40 and I am 62. When they see my resume that I graduated college in 1984 the interview ends fast. Ageism is alive and well in the US! We do have some good news, the county may move the retirees back into the employee pool in 24, so it may go down some and once 65 on Medicare I won't pay anything because county pays my part B and supplemental."

"Retired at 59-3/4. Stayed on my employer's COBRA, so for about 5 years we paid \$15K per year. We used IRA distribution for two years. Then when the mortgage was paid, that stopped. Pensions cover everything else. MEDICARE then SS at 66 were bonuses. 🇺🇸 "

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=Ugxawh1OgO6LjGPkdNd4AaABAg

↳ @takeitasacompliment. (4): "I thought Cobra was 18 months max. 36 with special exceptions. But 5 years?"

↳ @takeitasacompliment. (2): "@jameschaves5723 Yes you can. Where did you hear that you can't? It's federal law. If you lose your job or leave your job or your hours get cut below the amount needed for the company to give you health insurance, then it's 18 months. The only exception to the federal law is if the company size is smaller than 20 people. But then most states have a mini Cobra law."

↳ @jameschaves5723 (1): "You can't stay on COBRA for 18 months!!"

"how much extra do u have to pay with cobra? I've aetna PPO and I pay about \$60 every 2 wks, if I stay with the same policy and cobra, what will be the increase?"

— YouTube · Health Insurance Options for the Self Employed or Are Leaving Your Job · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ceyE3F7SK1k&lc=UgxvASVR5tdpnPP54bZ4AaABAg>

↳ @MaximizingEcommerce (0): "Depends on how much your employer contributes. Likely it will be at least double the amount you pay now although I bet at that price they are paying more than half meaning you would pay cover their portion plus a 2% admin fee. Generally COBRA is paid monthly instead of every two weeks."

"Please help! Best insurance in NJ for someone disabled with chronic illness and schizophrenia ASAP!! **NJ FamilyCare, or state Medicaid, is very different from federal Medicaid and I'm looking for people who have understanding of NJ STATE resources rather than federal insurance.** I'm 25F, have a diagnosis of schizoaffective disorder, opioid use disorder on MAT injections and fibromyalgia, and I see multiple providers every month including weekly therapy, bi-weekly medication, zero to 2-3 hospitalizations or inpatient psych treatments a year, monthly suboxone injections, monthly pain management/rheumatology and physical therapy, and like 6-7 monthly medications and bloodwork every 3-6 months for those meds. My insurance migrated to a plan that doesn't have mental health care, so I'm looking for a new insurance on very short notice. I am unemployed and my income is under 23k, but my parents (who make >150k) have agreed to help me financially for the next 6-12 months, so reasonably my budget is a hundred or couple hundred dollars a month. So, I can either go NJ FamilyCare Horizon BCBS, or a private insurance like Aetna PPO or Horizon BCBS PPO or HMO. I have had private, family based top or silver tier PPOs usually Aetna or BCBS sometimes through a third-party employer plan since I was diagnosed years ago, and the provider network is large with the care excellent but it is very expensive, too expensive to reasonably use it the amount I'd like to if money wasn't an issue. Wide network, but extremely pricey, too pricey to fully utilize, and difficult to navigate when claims are denied by the company. Services known as first-line treatments for SMIs such as schizophrenia like ACT, CSC CI and ICMS, case management, day programs or psychiatric rehabilitation are generally off the table and Medicaid/NJFC only. Terrible, TERRIBLE customer service network with no case management, healthcare consolidation, or help when things go wrong with services or coverage and you try to call their phone line. I called a broker through Health Benefits 360 who recommended NJ Family Care as I am in the income bracket and said it's the best fit for my situation with chronic illness, frequent healthcare use, SMI (serious mental illness) and other mental health and substance abuse recovery resources for the most affordable price. However, I've done some research and the network seems much much smaller and I don't know if the quality of these providers is great, good or poor, I had a friend on Medicaid during college who received very poor quality of services, though they were free, and she had chronic conditions, but I don't know if she was on the state or federal coverage. Based on my situation above, can you recommend which insurance would be the best fit for me, even if it's not something that I have mentioned? More than anything, please understand I want to receive good quality care as first priority and have the financial means to not have to compromise on that. It needs to be a widely accepted insurance, either Aetna or BCBS preferably so that my current providers will migrate over, and a plan that CAN be used frequently well and not in a way that rips me off. But in terms of the exact best plan, I could really use some help and ASAP. I need to be ready to switch within this week so that I can start my coverage on October 1st. Also, feel free to recommend websites where I can get connected to a good broker that will help. I need a broker as I am too disabled to complete a long application alone. Specifically, brokers that understand my situation and do both private insurance and Medicaid. COBRA is not an option unless someone knows a cheaper way to receive it. Edit: Just spoke to broker and another option is ObamaCare or ACA-capped insurance. Thank you very much."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · None

"I am self-employed and we just lost the insurance that we had through my husband's work because he's gonna work for a business full-time. It does not make sense to get insurance by our self cobra is out of the question it's outrageous and we are a family of three we have a daughter that's in college and we told them we wanted insurance that was comparable to what we had which was United healthcare and it was a PPO, which was pretty decent insurance. The only thing I could find that was even close to that was gonna run us \$2200 a month! That is just asinine. We have decided to go without insurance and pay our Dr. bills as we go."

— YouTube · How to Get Health Insurance When Self-Employed · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G eUdFzjUKcw&lc=UgxMbjRicc5YKnjQNR4AaABAq>

"I still remember how mad I was when that stupid healthcare act passed. Prices exploded across the board the very first day it came into affect. What I had paid in cobra coverage was now less than what I paid for regular coverage at my job and all the co pays went up and suddenly instead of a 500 dollar deductible it was now 5000. And all they did was shrug and be like, oops, deal with it."

— YouTube · Millions of Americans drop Affordable Care Act coverage after premiums spike · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wakcL0IHxuA&lc=UgwatG_8BIMT8BO-A9h4AaABAq

"Joe exactly what I need. I was underwhelmed with the person connected with my own financial advisory firm. I got a year to go on cobra and 3 1/2 years till Medicare. I think you're going to find what you're providing through your affiliate relationship is serving a huge unmet need."

— YouTube · How to Get Affordable Health Insurance Before Medicare · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dVyz5Ac7pA&lc=UgzYYcCNqRgWabclPqJ4AaABAq>

↳ @tachikaze222 (0): "its an unmet need since people age 50 - 64 have huge health care bills on average but don't have the money to pay their health care expenses in this system. US per-capita healthcare expense is \$16k/yr, and I assure you the older you are the more you are above that."

"Hi. I got let go, retired age 54. I did cobra to wrap up year, but starting jan i have a private aetna subsidiary plan. It is still \$\$\$\$. I have rental income i assume that goes towards magi? Merry Christmas! ♥"

— YouTube · New Health Insurance Rules Just Created a Hack For Retirees · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MZfLaPA1bsM&lc=UgwS7ox2RH8SU1e6nNB4AaABAq>

↳ @MotionRetirement (1): "In general, rental income profits will count towards the MAGI discussed in this video. Health care is expensive, good luck! And thanks for watching!"

"@thegarageluthier there are already programs in place for the disabled and low income. My x husband was laid off work, suffered a heart attack and we paid out of pocket to COBRA medical coverage. No one is guaranteed a hand out. Look for not for profit hospitals who already have government funds for critical "care" programs for low income. These hospitals get these funds to offset their taxes, most people never know about this or ask for it. Either way, we are responsible for ourselves, our families, and pets. I paid \$16,000.00 to save my dog out of my pension money. I chose not to buy pet insurance. It's the same with people. Again, no free loaders!"

— YouTube · 'A \$43,000 health insurance premium': How the end of ACA subsidies is squeezing insurers, · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6XR9ReSskbU&lc=Ugwfe6qPPUcWgkXcQsp4AaABAq.AR2BFm2n-9sAR52I_tTnir

"I have a similar problem, but mine is my employer plan is horrible. I am 52 years old and live in NY state. I make 42k a year and next year our plan is this: \$265 a month for this plan: 11k deductible and it dies not pay, but rather goes towards your deductible if you need lab/blood work, x-ray, MRI or cat scans. All my co-pays are going up as well as cost for medication. For the marketplace here, I would only qualify if I make less than 39,125 a year, if my health insurance costs more than 9% of my income or doesn't cover enough quality of care or else you *have* to take the employer's insurance. So I am kind of stuck :/"

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1p965n4/is_it_better_to_not_have_health_insurance_or/nraozd5/

A broker or agent · 13 documents · 13 voices

"Got Cancer, and Long Time Insurance Dropped Me TLDR: Got cancer, insurance terminated, I don't know what to do. I was diagnosed with cancer in May - Chronic Myeloid Leukemia, which is very treatable with expensive meds, but 100% fatal if not treated. I've had CareFirst Blue Cross Coverage through the VA Marketplace from 2022-present. CareFirst saw my diagnosis, and promptly cancelled my coverage with a technicality. I've been digging through the bureaucracy with no success, and don't know if I have legal options to restore my coverage and resume foregone cancer treatment. On July 1st CareFirst (CF) cancelled my coverage, which I first learned of from my oncologist 23 days after termination was apparently complete. My credit card had a fraudulent charge, so I replaced it in May - but forgot my premium payments were on the card, and my premium payment didn't process in June. I received no notification or calls before the letter from CF dated July 15 (although I didn't open it until later). I overnight mailed a check on July 25, and CareFirst (CF) cashed it July 28th. The VA Marketplace sent a eligibility / reinstatement form on July 24th, which CF told me they would process. The CF agents said it was in processing with the enrollment department. I called a total of 16 times between July 23 and this writing. In the 8th-13th calls to CF agents, they repeated the reenrollment was pending with the enrollment department. In my 14th call, they told me that - actually - I have no enrollment request, and that all of the previous agents were just attaching additional notes on the termination file. All previous agents had made an error, and that I needed to restart with the VA Marketplace. The first 13 calls never even started an appeal or reinstatement request. The CareFirst agent informed me that the only way I can restore coverage is to cancel this and reapply. Finally I unenrolled with my VA State Marketplace and applied to reenroll with my same program. Then they did the first clear and quick response of this whole mess: They immediately denied my reenrollment. This doesn't just mean I lost one insurer- they now made me ineligible for other insurance without a qualifying life event. (I've been employed for 3 years employed with a decent salary by a small non-profit that offers only a health reimbursement, thus the VA Marketplace ACA coverage). I cannot access cancer treatments, and am forgoing care. The list price on the cancer drug I need, at my current pharmacy, is far higher than my salary. I found a discount pharmacy that lowers it to about my salary. I will continue paying some things out of pocket, and skipping others, hoping I survive until I can restart 2026 ACA coverage. CareFirst says they sent me one letter in June, but I never received any such letter. They also acknowledge that their billing department never called, emailed, or made any effort to contact me. They cancelled my care without ever confirming I had any notification. Then they made me run a gauntlet of impenetrable bureaucratic mess through confusion and clear, blatant errors (I don't think their agent confusion was intentional deception - just incompetence). CareFirst found I have an expensive disease, and illegally cancelled my coverage. I am at the end of my rope. I am trying every approach possible to get my coverage and cancer treatment restored. Can anyone advise on my options? I see an option to request a written appeal, but that feels like asking the executioner to reconsider, given that they clearly are not acting in good faith already. I talked with some other insurance providers, and they told me I'd be rejected unless it was a Marketplace (ACA) plan that requires acceptance. I can only imagine a few options: * I vacate my condo and move to Maryland to get a 'qualifying life event'. But for various reasons, that would be really hard to deal with while already fighting cancer and trying to keep up with a demanding job. * I have access to a large press contact list, so I could try emailing my story to ~310 reporters, but I feel like that's more vengeful than productive. And I don't have the mental energy to be fielding a ton of media interviews. * I can also get a lawyer, but I'm not sure how much that would change. I don't want to be fighting this forever, I just want to get my health care and live my life. Any advice, especially ideas specific to Virginia? Edit: corrected 'deductible' to 'premium'. Update: I'm doing well now, no thanks to 'Carefirst' Blue Cross Blue Shield. I paid out of pocket for expensive chemotherapy for little while. I also fought and fought, tried to get a lawyer, and eventually realized they had no chance of ever getting me back onto the plan. Ironically, they tried to keep my premium payment that I sent via overnight cashier's check as soon as I realized there was a gap. But restoring my coverage? They wouldn't dream of it. The only way I could get back on coverage was to get married. That was already in the works, but it accelerated a courthouse elopement before our actual wedding. I'm now on my

spouse's coverage, and I am continuing the medications I need, and am relatively healthy. I also feel more comfortable because if they try to drop again it would need to go through a large employer's HR, so theoretically they can't unilaterally drop me. I don't know if this was convenient incompetence, weaponized incompetence, or just an active, unwritten rule to get drop high cost patients however they can. I just know that CareFirst doesn't care, and the system we have in the US sucks. It's more expensive, less dependable, and more difficult to navigate than any other developed country. Thankfully, I'm no longer one of the people this system is leaving without care, but I'm more convinced than ever that this system is the worst."

— r/HealthInsurance · 119 upvotes · None

"Crazy idea - what do you think? Hi, there. Without being too wordy (happy to elaborate if needed), I wanted to ask for input on this idea I have. We make too much money to qualify for ANY subsidies next year (we're not "rich", but we're above the cutoff). Because of this, our health insurance is going to go from \$900 a month for the two of us (already outrageously expensive for the high deductible, bronze plan we have) to \$3,500 PER MONTH. Yes, per month. That comes to \$42,000 per year. And again, that's before paying for any of the actual medical expenses we may incur. I have confirmed this with an insurance agent so it's not just me miscalculating (and yes, I plan to discuss this with the agent as well, but I love the Reddit forums so here I am). I'm thinking there might be something I'm not understanding, but here's my idea - couldn't we just not have health insurance and if something catastrophic comes up (cancer diagnosis, for example), we could move (we have the option to change residency because we do own a home in another state) and then use the special enrollment period to get insurance? I mean, remember - we're talking \$42,000 per year otherwise - and that's before anything even happens. Thanks for your input."

— r/HealthInsurance · 24 upvotes · None

"Health Insurance Carrier strongly recommending that I don't purchase insurance through healthcare.gov I just got off the phone with sales agent of the largest health insurance carrier in my state. I had previously applied through healthcare.gov and confirmed that I was ineligible for any tax credits/subsidies but found a plan I like. I then contact the health insurer directly to see if there was any difference in premiums by applying directly through them. The price is identical but I was told to purchase the plan directly anyway because there could be "miscommunication" between the marketplace exchange and the insurer. That seemed odd to me. As someone who supports the ACA and wants to ensure it lasts and improves, I would like to enroll through healthcare.gov. My thinking is that the program's success is measured in part by the number of users who shop/purchase through healthcare.gov. Is there any real downside to using the marketplace exchange?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 16 upvotes · None

"I just talked to my Insurance broker last week (I'm on Cobra until 2/2027). FYI, the ACA only has HMO plans, no more PPO plans, she told me. I can't find any doctors who take the HMO plans, even the top tier ones."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgwScHrO5XRAM7MD7Cp4AaABAq

↳ @TracyMadsen-rx2fu (0): "I think you might need a different broker, that's not true. I have a silver plan PPO, have had it for about 7 years"

"Have used a broker to sign up for the last 2 years - why are his prices higher than the ones listed on the healthcare.gov site? TLDR : the copious info is below but 1) worried a broker is trying to up charge me to sign up through him for 2026 insurance (a more expensive plan I wasn't considering from gov site is actually \$50/month cheaper thru him, the cheaper plan I thought I might pick on the gov site is \$30 more a month from the broker) 2) how can I review the answers I put into my gov 2026 application before I got the info from the insurance broker because I can't seem to find a way to review that on healthcare.gov So..... 2 years ago I signed up through a local insurance broker because I was coming off Medicaid and couldn't get the healthcare.gov website to show me what I'd be getting for a subsidy. I assume it wouldn't give me that info till I was determined ineligible by my states dhhs which is a slow process. I even called them and told them to end my coverage through them on the last day of December hoping that would make it so I was able to see my subsidy but it didn't. So I went through this broker and got signed up cheap (\$45) a month on priority. Last year since he had made the process so painless I went through him again but it went up to \$120 a month which hurt a bit but he had said some program had expired making my insurance more expensive for this past year even tho my income only went up a couple thousand dollars. Looking back now I prob should have delved into that huge increase further. I called him again at the end of October and he said to call him back in a week since he didn't have access to the new numbers yet but after seeing all the people shocked by their increases I decided to fill out an application on healthcare.gov just to see what kind of increase I might be in for. My income also went up so I put in a new estimate (which I don't remember what I put) and if I keep my current plan it will go up to \$215. There's also a cheaper plan I could get instead that will likely fulfill my needs for \$159. The insurance broker sent me an email listing 2 plans neither of which is my current one. It lists one for \$208 but the gov site lists the same plan for \$186. The gov site lists another plan I wasn't even considering due to expense for \$239 but from the broker that same plan is \$183. In order to have complete info I wanted to review my gov application because I don't remember exactly what I put for my income info. For the broker I told him \$28k for the year but I either listed \$28k or \$26,600 on my gov application. I was trying to review my application details again but have been clicking round and round on the gov site and it won't let me review those details anywhere as far as I can see. I need to have those details before I can ask this broker what's up with the different prices and make a selection. Low key worried he may be pulling a fast one on me but I thought these brokers didn't charge for their services (that may have been true under Biden but who knows what rule changes Trump may have made allowing for up charging) Phew, any info appreciated 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · None

"Need clarification on underestimating income I plan on enrolling my mother in law for 2026 but not sure how to approach her income. I had spoken to broker and I was informed she should show 22k before deductions to get tax credit for 2026. Before I was able to show her income as 2400 a year and get the aca credits. I read posts saying that the repayments of credits are for those who overestimate income not underestimate. Also read the other way around. If I were to sign her up saying her income projected is 22k but let's say at end of 2026 it's 3k. Since the income was underestimated will she need to payback the subsidies? she doesnt qualify for medicaid because she been in USA 2.5 years and you need to be living 5 years to qualify for that"

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · None

"Get government OUT of healthcare and insurance! Back when Obumer first messed with it and caused premiums to start to rise (both ACA and non ACA plans as the new costs for new required benefits, legal and regulatory compliance, etc has to be absorbed via any and all health insurance plans regardless of an ACA plan or not). We went from 3 people being covered on what would be about a "silver" on the ACA or a mid plan was \$238 per month. Today for two people it is over \$1,300 per month and there are areas that are even higher than the state and county / area that we live in. On a per covered basis our health insurance premiums are up 410%. Even a few years ago when we moved from one state to another we paid around \$492 per month....four years later, just over \$1,300. thank you government. Just the insurance premiums and rent (no power, water, food, gas, car insurance or any other expenses) costs me \$40,200 per year and that gets paid with after tax dollars so you do the math. just the fixed cost of a roof and insurance with nothing else and we need to earn around \$47,000 before taxes to cover that. God forbid we want to eat, have car insurance and other insurance, fuel for the car, car repairs, clothing, phone service, etc. Again, great work to the tick in Congress for screwing everyone over rather than just helping the few that need, ACTUALLY need the help. All the fraud out there so far should give everyone some idea of the money we flush down the drain. I wager if it was totaled up it would be around \$500 billion per year or more and that is already after the gubment makes so many other things artificially expensive....college tuition anyone? Nothing my insurance agent loves more than sitting across the table from me as we review the plans that, even after I spend \$16,000 per year on premiums for I still have very high deductibles making it really cost me around \$25,000 before insurance does anything when you add premiums and deductibles together (and no I don't count \$15 off some pharma scrip as mattering). What they need to do is allow, the law prevents this for most people - that's right the government is making it illegal for you to purchase certain types of plans less you fall into a small criteria. what am I ranting about? Disaster style policies. Everyone needs to be able to get those but for most plans you have to be under a certain income or under 30 years of age or just unemployed and need a bridge. My spouse and I don't need all the "benefits" we just want emergancy coverage and disease treatment type stuff. There is so much that pad plans, even in hers (and she is almost 50!) still has all this child birthing stuff, breast feeding classes, etc. all for "free" even though she is almost 50 and also can't even have kids in the first place but, same risk pool as everyone else rather than being prices as an individual like with your car insurance."

— YouTube · \$ How MUCH ACA Marketplace PREMIUMS Are Going UP In 2027 · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hOGTkeTtK0Y&lc=UgzNhfDE0RdaDEBn28x4AaABAg>

↳ @bookmark692 (0): "The Messiah picked winners and losers with health insurance. F'D everyone, except the politicians."

"I've been in the insurance business since 2011 and remember the first open enrollment on October 1, 2013. Many agents thought they would make a lot of money enrolling entire families with full subsidies and promised compensation. But just months later, many left the market when commissions went unpaid. This happened early in my career and left a lasting impression on how I view the ACA. I don't understand why so many agents invest so much time in ACA today. I know it will eventually improve, but in the meantime, why not focus on selling Medicare plans, which offer more reliable income and better persistency than ACA? The ACA market is too volatile—caught in political power struggles—and you can lose a client simply because they got a new job with health benefits or got married. I have an ACA plan (self-employed insurance agent) with no subsidies and pay \$550 for mediocre health insurance. I just received notice that my Aetna CVS ACA plan is leaving the Texas market at the end of the year."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m2m8ak/important_aca_changes_to_know_heading_into_2026/n3xleep4/

"Please help! Best insurance in NJ for someone disabled with chronic illness and schizophrenia ASAP!! **NJ FamilyCare, or state Medicaid, is very different from federal Medicaid and I'm looking for people who have understanding of NJ STATE resources rather than federal insurance.** I'm 25F, have a diagnosis of schizoaffective disorder, opioid use disorder on MAT injections and fibromyalgia, and I see multiple providers every month including weekly therapy, bi-weekly medication, zero to 2-3 hospitalizations or inpatient psych treatments a year, monthly suboxone injections, monthly pain management/rheumatology and physical therapy, and like 6-7 monthly medications and bloodwork every 3-6 months for those meds. My insurance migrated to a plan that doesn't have mental health care, so I'm looking for a new insurance on very short notice. I am unemployed and my income is under 23k, but my parents (who make >150k) have agreed to help me financially for the next 6-12 months, so reasonably my budget is a hundred or couple hundred dollars a month. So, I can either go NJ FamilyCare Horizon BCBS, or a private insurance like Aetna PPO or Horizon BCBS PPO or HMO. I have had private, family based top or silver tier PPOs usually Aetna or BCBS sometimes through a third-party employer plan since I was diagnosed years ago, and the provider network is large with the care excellent but it is very expensive, too expensive to reasonably use it the amount I'd like to if money wasn't an issue. Wide network, but extremely pricey, too pricey to fully utilize, and difficult to navigate when claims are denied by the company. Services known as first-line treatments for SMIs such as schizophrenia like ACT, CSC CI and ICMS, case management, day programs or psychiatric rehabilitation are generally off the table and Medicaid/NJFC only. Terrible, TERRIBLE customer service network with no case management, healthcare consolidation, or help when things go wrong with services or coverage and you try to call their phone line. I called a broker through Health Benefits 360 who recommended NJ Family Care as I am in the income bracket and said it's the best fit for my situation with chronic illness, frequent healthcare use, SMI (serious mental illness) and other mental health and substance abuse recovery resources for the most affordable price. However, I've done some research and the network seems much much smaller and I don't know if the quality of these providers is great, good or poor, I had a friend on Medicaid during college who received very poor quality of services, though they were free, and she had chronic conditions, but I don't know if she was on the state or federal coverage. Based on my situation above, can you recommend which insurance would be the best fit for me, even if it's not something that I have mentioned? More than anything, please understand I want to receive good quality care as first priority and have the financial means to not have to compromise on that. It needs to be a widely accepted insurance, either Aetna or BCBS preferably so that my current providers will migrate over, and a plan that CAN be used frequently well and not in a way that rips me off. But in terms of the exact best plan, I could really use some help and ASAP. I need to be ready to switch within this week so that I can start my coverage on October 1st. Also, feel free to recommend websites where I can get connected to a good broker that will help. I need a broker as I am too disabled to complete a long application alone. Specifically, brokers that understand my situation and do both private insurance and Medicaid. COBRA is not an option unless someone knows a cheaper way to receive it. Edit: Just spoke to broker and another option is ObamaCare or ACA-capped insurance. Thank you very much."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · None

"I have a very good broker I've worked with since 2021. For 2026 I went with an Ambetter higher deductible bronze plan with a lower monthly premium then purchased a gap plan from UBA to cover the high deductible should something happen. I am generally healthy and do wellness visits that are covered. So my monthly expense went up from 7.50 a month in 2025 for my Silver plan to 40.00 per month for this selection in 2026. It also has better prescription coverage than I've had in 2025."

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=UgxjMpss4oRZv7Vk8qt4AaABAq>

↳ @HappyonMonday (0): "That's awesome! With the bronze plan you can now use an HSA too! 😊"

"Hey OP. Before you drop it — "healthy and never use it" is exactly the profile one bad day wrecks. It's not the doctor visits. It's the accident or the scan that comes back wrong. Insurance isn't for the year nothing happens; it's for the year something does. I'm 29 and a self-employed health insurance broker myself (total transparency), and that's the only reason I have it (the big what-ifs) A better question than "should I keep insurance?" is "what's the cheapest real coverage for someone healthy?" Worth knowing: **Private, medically underwritten plans** can be priced based on your actual health instead of averaging you in. Often cheaper if you're genuinely healthy. They can also decline you, so if there's anything in your history, it's usually not the route. **High-deductible plan plus an HSA**. Low premium, and the HSA money is yours — it rolls over and follows you, unlike a deductible that resets every January. **Skip health shares**. They aren't insurance, aren't regulated like it, and aren't legally required to pay anything. People find that out at the worst time. At 35 and healthy, price a bronze marketplace plan against an underwritten private one and compare. Your income decides which wins — under the subsidy threshold, the marketplace math changes completely."

— r/selfemployed · https://www.reddit.com/r/selfemployed/comments/1w2kg0j/us_how_many_of_you_are_going_without_health/p709m1e/

"That's horrible, try to see if you can get an off exchange plan, I was paying around \$1500 for a group plan with an Ichra through marketplace (no subsidies) last year got on a private plan with a United Healthcare PPO with a \$7k max out of pocket. We had to get approved with underwriting, (they basically checked prescription records) but it cut my premiums in half to \$780 ish. I used a broker "My Private Health Insurance"

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1txq1je/drowning_in_monthly_health_insurance_payments/oqcf5j2/

"We used a broker for many years and last year they found plans that we didn't even see on the marketplace. We usually get a letter in October from the broker telling us to call if needed. We didn't get that this year. We have always had good luck with brokers and I never felt like they were trying to up charge me. My husband and I have discussed how they make their money, but it wasn't through us."

— r/Obamacare · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1or1c2m/have_used_a_broker_to_sign_up_for_the_last_2/nnnwayd/

Tab 7 — Solution Soundbites

Wishing premiums matched what they can pay · 10 documents · 10 voices

"My health insurance just went to \$60,000 a year for a silver PPO Prepare for sticker shock. Just checked the IL exchange today, and my BCBS HDHP went from \$1200 a month after subsidies to \$2925 after subsidies (**the plan cost is 60k per year**) the reasons for this are two-fold 1. Expiration of enhanced subsidies 2. The site allowing junk insurers to claim SLC status (benchmark) with plans no one can use. For my area it is an OSCAR HMO which virtually no hospital system or doctor accepts. OSCAR has a 1 star rating from the BBB and dozens of lawsuits against it for failure to pay claims. so I now have to hunt around for a HMO, and my family will lose its doctors. The PPACA as originally passed prevented insurance premiums from eating up more than a certain percentage of your annual income. At 84k for a family of 4, I would pay 42% of my total income in premium payments so I will lose my doctor(s) at the very least and pay way beyond what the law said I was going to. pretty sure I am seeing why some politicians are saying we should tear up the PPACA altogether, because it clearly isn't working, and made a bad situation worse"

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,000 upvotes · None

"My income should have no relevance to the cost of my health insurance. My premiums exceed \$2000/month and I'm completely healthy. Those commercials of people saying they have a plan for \$53/month infuriates me!! This is back door redistribution of wealth and simply evil."

— YouTube · Health Insurance for Self Employed: Beyond Marketplace Insurance! · 43 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=allOvX_0uhs&lc=Ugwmv_5XeJls_p5gABt4AaABAg

↳ @iHealthBrokers (3): "Brent, have you considered a short term medical plan? If you are completely healthy, you may be able to get a plan with a MUCH lower premium that still meets your needs."

↳ @johnafagerquist8235 (1): "@iHealthBrokers You are the first person explaining health insurance options, that I've seen, who did not say to stay away from short term coverage as though it was an active serial killer. I am 55 (today 😊) and striking out on my own. I want to have health insurance for my wife and my son in college, as we move forward. That's why I'm researching."

↳ @iHealthBrokers (1): "@johnafagerquist8235 Hahaha! Yes, they have improved dramatically in the past few years. People usually have strong opinions because your experience with STM is really based on your needs. i.e. if you want to become pregnant, they are not a great option because they won't cover pregnancy! Feel free to give us a call if you'd like to discuss all of your options as you prepare to make to leap! 888-410-0344. Best of luck with your new business!"

"Health insurance Canceled Me I am seeking urgent legal assistance regarding a serious issue with my health insurance coverage through the Marketplace and Oscar Health. I maintained active health insurance coverage throughout 2025 with Oscar Health and paid all monthly premiums on time without any lapse. In May 2025, I also reported a salary change to the Marketplace, and no issues were identified at that time. On December 31, 2025, I was unexpectedly charged \$529 after already paying my premium. When I contacted the insurance company, I was told this was due to a failure to apply my premium tax credit through HealthCare.gov. I was later informed that this was an error and that my correct monthly premium should have been approximately \$35. I was told the overcharge would be refunded. Shortly after, I had a medically necessary procedure scheduled related to a prior kidney condition and surgery. During that same week, I was informed by the provider that my insurance was inactive. I immediately contacted the insurer and explained the billing error. The following day, I was instructed to pay \$157 to reinstate my coverage, which I did in good faith because I required ongoing medical care. I was told the issue had been resolved. However, shortly thereafter, I began receiving notifications that my claims including hospital care, surgery, and procedures were denied. I was then informed that my coverage for 2025 had been retroactively voided. Additionally, my Form 1095-A has been marked as voided, creating significant tax implications. I have now been dealing with this issue for nearly 30 days. I am receiving medical bills and collection calls stating that I had no insurance coverage for all of 2025, despite having paid premiums consistently and followed all instructions given to me. At no point did I provide false or misleading information. The issue appears to stem from a subsidy/tax credit error that was acknowledged and supposedly corrected. Despite this, my coverage has been retroactively terminated, and I am now facing substantial financial and medical consequences. They are saying I didn't have coverage on 2025. Speaking with marketplace and Oscar they don't know the answers...."

— r/HealthInsurance · 19 upvotes · None

"Have used a broker to sign up for the last 2 years - why are his prices higher than the ones listed on the healthcare.gov site? TLDR : the copious info is below but 1) worried a broker is trying to up charge me to sign up through him for 2026 insurance (a more expensive plan I wasn't considering from gov site is actually \$50/month cheaper thru him, the cheaper plan I thought I might pick on the gov site is \$30 more a month from the broker) 2) how can I review the answers I put into my gov 2026 application before I got the info from the insurance broker because I can't seem to find a way to review that on healthcare.gov So..... 2 years ago I signed up through a local insurance broker because I was coming off Medicaid and couldn't get the healthcare.gov website to show me what I'd be getting for a subsidy. I assume it wouldn't give me that info till I was determined ineligible by my states dhhs which is a slow process. I even called them and told them to end my coverage through them on the last day of December hoping that would make it so I was able to see my subsidy but it didn't. So I went through this broker and got signed up cheap (\$45) a month on priority. Last year since he had made the process so painless I went through him again but it went up to \$120 a month which hurt a bit but he had said some program had expired making my insurance more expensive for this past year even tho my income only went up a couple thousand dollars. Looking back now I prob should have delved into that huge increase further. I called him again at the end of October and he said to call him back in a week since he didn't have access to the new numbers yet but after seeing all the people shocked by their increases I decided to fill out an application on healthcare.gov just to see what kind of increase I might be in for. My income also went up so I put in a new estimate (which I don't remember what I put) and if I keep my current plan it will go up to \$215. There's also a cheaper plan I could get instead that will likely fulfill my needs for \$159. The insurance broker sent me an email listing 2 plans neither of which is my current one. It lists one for \$208 but the gov site lists the same plan for \$186. The gov site lists another plan I wasn't even considering due to expense for \$239 but from the broker that same plan is \$183. In order to have complete info I wanted to review my gov application because I don't remember exactly what I put for my income info. For the broker I told him \$28k for the year but I either listed \$28k or \$26,600 on my gov application. I was trying to review my application details again but have been clicking round and round on the gov site and it won't let me review those details anywhere as far as I can see. I need to have those details before I can ask this broker what's up with the different prices and make a selection. Low key worried he may be pulling a fast one on me but I thought these brokers didn't charge for their services (that may have been true under Biden but who knows what rule changes Trump may have made allowing for up charging) Phew, any info appreciated 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · None

"Plan A should be maximizing the ACA subsidy if at all possible. During our 2 lowest years the premiums were \$0/mo. This is our highest year and the premiums are \$45/mo. The insurance on our Utah marketplace has been better than anything I had during my career. The ACA subsidy has dropped over \$20K/year to our bottom line in each of the last 5 years."

— YouTube · How to Get Affordable Health Insurance Before Medicare · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dVyzw5Ac7pA&lc=UgxqiohE_W9_nnZO6o14AaABAq

"I asked for the same. I have my plan, but want to see other options I may not have thought of. For me, I plan to retire at 54 and I will have access to my 401k through the Rule of 55 at that point. I have a taxable brokerage and a smaller Roth, too. My hope is to live off of 20k or so in dividends that the brokerage kicks out, and targeted sales of other holdings in there that don't have a low cost basis. If needed, I can draw 1-2% from 401k, but will try not to. All the money I have put into my Roth is MAGI invisible and accessible, but I want it to continue to compound. So, Cash, taxable divs, small targeted brokerage sales, careful 401k draws, and Roth basis. I should be able to spend 70K without all of it being visible (only divs and cap gains) after the standard deduction and stay qualified for subsidies. I also plan to pay off the balance of my mortgage just prior to retiring to eliminate \$24k in needed spend due to mortgage payments. I could live my same lifestyle with \$24k less draw."

— YouTube · Early Retirement Health Insurance Before Medicare: A Step-by-Step Framework · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NAYG0yvbI8&lc=Ugx7ppDMreOUaE9H3JZ4AaABAq.AVEI2UZMHtEAVH3SoCOuCD>

"Lived in Florida till I was 18 years old. Then moved out of state to attend college. I am a physician and would say ... Florida isn't going to give you any healthcare breaks. No state income tax. Now talking about cutting property taxes. So sales tax is supposed to fund public services and subsidies? I am now living (Temporarily) in Cambodia with my wife and young son. We pay about \$1,000 usd for an entire year of health insurance for all 3 of us. Dental check up and routine Dr visit is \$10. Daycare: we had our son in a 5 days a week daycare for a few months and it cost \$210 per month. This doesn't help your situation. I am sorry ... wish there was an answer that made Florida more affordable. But I think the message is clear: per the economic situation, you are not welcome in Florida. They don't want you there. I would listen and look for a new place that treats you better (more affordable being one of the measuring sticks of "how well you are treated")."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1txq1je/drowning_in_monthly_health_insurance_payments/oq021v0/

"Something is not getting entered correctly. If your employer insurance is 25% of your income it meets the unaffordable category. How many people are you entering? Iowa expanded Medicaid so if you're estimated income for 2026 is less than 138% of the fpl for 2 people (\$29,187) it will send you to Medicaid. Above that you should be eligible for subsidies. I recommend you call the marketplace. Something isn't right."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pcnlsw/denied_again/nrz460d/

"The price disparity may be because one estimate may be allowing for subsidies, but the other does not. Because of the recent restrictions, I believe they may not qualify for any subsidies. You should be able to see the price on that link, specifically you could see the price for the overall premium and the amount of the subsidy. Subtract the subsidy."

— r/Obamacare · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1pbezr8/need_help_understanding_aca_subsidies/nrqkdtj/

"I wish my premiums could go exclusively to helping people like you husband get the health care they need and not shareholders and executives. My mom's cancer treatment was also absurdly expensive and if it had been pre-ACA she'd likely be dead. Congrats on your husband's remission!"

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pb2hse/cancer_is_expensive/nroj3e3/

Tab 8 — Desired Outcomes

Care that worked when it mattered · 25 documents · 20 voices

"2026 ACA prices are live on Healthcare.gov. Here's our household's official ACA pricing for next year. **Special disclaimer for 2026: Everything in this post assumes that Congress does not extend the COVID subsidy enhancements and that the default ACA subsidy rules return for 2026.** Anyone can now see the 2026 prices and plans in their area with some anonymous data (age/zip/income/etc) in about three minutes at <https://www.healthcare.gov/see-plans/#/>. If you have a local state-run exchange, then you'll be redirected. State exchanges all update on their own schedule, so 2026 prices may or may not be live just yet. For those who may not be familiar with the ACA, below is an actual real-world example of what being on the ACA can be like with the default subsidy systems. The prices below are for a married couple with an average age of 52 and with MAGI under 133% of the Federal Poverty Level (FPL), which qualifies us for the maximum possible amount of ACA subsidies from both the premium tax credit (PTC) subsidy system and cost-sharing reduction (CSR) subsidy system. We have three dependent children as well, one of which will be on our ACA policy, and we live in a non-expansion state, so expansion Medicaid does not apply to us. Keep in mind that the premiums below would be much higher for a couple if they were in their 60s rather than in their 40s/50s like us. Tobacco users can expect to pay up to 50% additional premium on top of the age-rating. If we were both 62, then the unsubsidized Bronze premium below would rise from \$19,140 to \$27,168. Prices also can vary incredibly between states. If we were both 62 and living in West Virginia instead of Texas, then our Bronze premium would rise from \$27,168 to \$49,584. If instead we were living in Minnesota, then our Bronze premium would fall from \$27,168 to \$21,696. I have also included the policy options we would likely take if we were either eligible only for premium subsidies and not also cost-sharing reductions, as well as the plan we would likely take if we were ineligible for any subsidies at all. People who are over 200% FPL should generally avoid Silver plans due to the way states have elected to deal with the loss of federal funding for the cost-sharing reduction subsidy system, so while I have provided the full market price of our Silver plan, please note that almost nobody would want to ever buy that plan at that price as better Bronze and Gold options are available. ____ Our 2026 Silver plan with subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (based purely on MAGI): * \$84 in annual premium * \$0/\$0 deductible (individual/family) * \$0 PCP * \$10 specialist * \$5 urgent care * \$0/\$15 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$2,200/\$4,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ Our 2026 Silver plan without subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (full market price): * \$26,892 in annual premium * \$6,000/\$12,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$40 PCP * \$80 specialist * \$60 urgent care * \$20/\$40 tier1/tier2 scripts * 40% ER coinsurance * \$8,900/\$17,800 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 Gold plan we would pick if our MAGI was just above 200% FPL (no meaningful CSRs): * \$2,952 in annual premium * \$2,000/\$4,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$30 PCP * \$60 specialist * \$45 urgent care * \$15/\$30 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$8,200/\$16,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 HSA-compatible Bronze plan we would pick if we qualified for zero subsidies/CSRs (MAGI above 400% FPL, factoring in max MAGI-reducing HSA contributions) * \$19,140 in annual premium * \$7,500/\$15,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$50 PCP * \$100 specialist * \$75 urgent care * \$25/\$50 tier1/tier2 scripts * 50% ER coinsurance * \$10,000/\$20,000 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____"

— r/obamacare · 571 upvotes · None

"Former employer canceled COBRA health insurance policy without notifying me I just found out my former employer in the state of Washington canceled my COBRA health insurance policy. Not because they notified me, but because my pharmacy called me and said my policy was no longer valid. WTF COBRA is supposed to be valid for 18-36 months and I am fully paid up. I just had major surgery and have PT scheduled in 4 days that has already been deferred for 2 weeks (because I was at my yearly limit of PT) if I don't make the appointment I may never correctly recover and regain full use of my arm. Apparently, my former employer is getting rid of Aetna and getting a new Health Insurance plan from a different provider. So my Aetna policy terminated at the beginning of 2025. Neither my former employer nor Aetna notified me about this, is that even legal? My COBRA provider told me over the phone that my coverage is supposed to switch to the new policy, but my former employer didn't send them the correct documents and that plan is not active for me so now I am stuck with no Health Insurance in need of immediate healthcare. What are my options? UPDATE: I contacted my former employer, who didn't have a good answer for why I wasn't notified. But did state that they had gotten a new health insurance policy with a different company. They then gave me a plan number and group number and told me to use that info to create an account on the website on the new insurance provider. I attempted to do so and the web form said that wasn't a valid policy and refused to let me create an account. After an additional back and forth with HR from my old company they said to call the new Health Insurance provider. So after 30 minutes of being on hold with them, they told me the policy number I had been given was for a different person who happened to have a different first name, same last name, different birthday and different address. Apparently that incorrect info was given to the HR lady at my company by their insurance vendor. After contacting four different companies, and spending more than an hour on the phone I am still without health insurance while needing PT to recover from a major surgery and unable to renew my prescriptions. For those that said this was a simple issue that I could clear up with a quick call to my former employer, I'm calling you on your BS. It's not, and there is incompetence up and down the chain of everyone involved here. FURTHER CONTEXT: I have accepted an offer for a new job (one with better health insurance) and should be starting at the end of the month. I only need my COBRA health plan for another month to get through all the post surgery PT, maybe get a Flu and COVID shot and get my prescriptions for this month. And however long it takes to get the new health insurance actually functional. As such it doesn't feel worth it to sign up for an ACA plan for less than a month of coverage and then have to deal with the overhead of cancelling that plan and setting up another new one. I just want the COBRA coverage they told me would be available for a whole year to actually work. UPDATE 2: I got a different (supposedly correct) policy number from my former employers HR, tried to use that to create an account on Regence's website and it still failed. I called Regence (was on hold for a whole hour) gave them the new policy number and was told over the phone I am actually in their system and I SHOULD have an active policy. I also read back the group # I had been given by HR and found out that was also incorrect (way to go former employer 0/2). I have no way to verify it's functional other than going to PT tomorrow and seeing if they can bill Regence. UPDATE 3: I filled a complaint with the state insurance commissioner, not just for the recent fiasco but also for the situation that caused me to quit my job in the first place where I believe the company may have actually acted illegally. I don't expect anything to come if it but maybe future me will be pleasantly surprised."

— r/HealthInsurance · 273 upvotes · None

"Health Insurance 101 - Start here! Hi All! We've put together the following wiki as an attempt to help out with general questions as we approach open enrollment. Topics: * What is the ACA * What is Open Enrollment? * Why Do We Have Open Enrollment? * Why Do You Need Health Insurance * What is the marketplace? * Who is in my household? * What is the APTC And who is eligible? * What is FPL? * FPL and the APTC * How do I know if my state expanded medicaid? * What happens if I don't enroll in health insurance? * What about the tax penalty? * Let's talk about plan structures * What is a Deductible? * Coinsurance? * Copayment * Out of Pocket Maximum * How to pay for your deductible * Short Term Health Plans

What is the ACA? The comprehensive health care reform law enacted in March 2010 (sometimes known as ACA, PPACA, or "Obamacare"). The law has 3 primary goals: 1) Make affordable health insurance available to more people. The law provides consumers with subsidies ("premium tax credits") that lower costs for households with incomes between 100% and 400% of the federal poverty level. 2) Expand the Medicaid program to cover all adults with income below 138% of the federal poverty level. (Not all states have expanded their Medicaid programs.) 3) Support innovative medical care delivery methods designed to lower the costs of health care generally. With regard to your employer, if your employer has over 50 employees, they are required to provide you compliant insurance that meets Minimum Essential Coverage and Minimum Value standards. Your employer also must subsidize at least 50% of the premium to enroll the employees.

What is Open Enrollment? <https://www.healthcare.gov/quick-guide/dates-and-deadlines> <https://www.healthcare.gov/glossary/open-enrollment-period/> The yearly period when people can enroll in a health insurance plan. Open Enrollment for 2021 runs from November 1 through December 15, 2020. Insurance plans elected during Open Enrollment will start as early as Jan 1, 2021. Outside the Open Enrollment Period, you generally can enroll in a health insurance plan only if you qualify for a Special Enrollment Period. You're eligible if you have certain life events, like getting married, having a baby, or losing other health coverage. The follow states have permanently adopted expanded enrollment periods: California: November 1 to January 31 Colorado: November 1 to January 15 District of Columbia: November 1 to January 31 Massachusetts: November 1, 2020 to January 23, 2021. Minnesota: November 1 to December 22, 2020. New Jersey: November 1, 2020 to January 31, 2021. New York: November 1, 2020 to January 31, 2021. Nevada: November 1, 2020, to January 15, 2021. Pennsylvania: November 1, 2020, to January 15, 2021 Rhode Island: November 1, 2020 to January 23, 2021. Washington: November 1, 2020, to January 15, 2021.

Why do we have Open Enrollment (OE)? OE is designed for anyone eligible to purchase on the marketplace to make their elections for 2021. With the introduction of the ACA legislation, you cannot buy insurance whenever you want – this prevents people from enrolling only when they know they need the health insurance, which drives up prices for everyone.

Why do you need health insurance? Medical costs are the leading cause for bankruptcy in the US, and everyone is always healthy until they are not. By enrolling in an ACA compliant healthcare plan, you receive the benefits of a provider network, contracted negotiated rates on services, an out of pocket max which caps your personal spending each year, and other state/federal protections on your healthcare experience.

What is the marketplace and who can use it? Any US citizen or qualifying immigration status (<https://www.healthcare.gov/immigrants/immigration-status/>) may purchase off of the marketplace, even if you have employer insurance.

Who is in my Household? Household = you, spouse, tax dependents. It is not necessarily who you physically live with.

What is the APTC and who is eligible? The APTC stands for Advanced Premium Tax Credit and is a subsidy provided to people with incomes between 100 – 400% FPL if your state has not expanded Medicaid or 138 – 400% FPL if your state has expanded Medicaid. You are eligible for the APTC if your income falls in this range and you have no employer insurance available. If you are Medicaid eligible, you should apply there as you will not qualify for the APTC; however, you are welcome to purchase a full price marketplace plan instead if you prefer.

What is FPL? A measure of income issued every year by the Department of Health and Human Services (HHS). Federal poverty levels are used to determine your eligibility for certain programs and benefits, including savings on Marketplace health insurance, and Medicaid and CHIP coverage. The 2020 federal poverty level (FPL) income numbers below are used to calculate eligibility for Medicaid and the Children's Health Insurance

"The "Medicaid Gap" is a joke. For context, I live in Mississippi. (And honestly that should already tell you everything you need to know.) (And yes, I already posted this but I didn't realized the rant/vent flair would lock the comments. Whoops! So let's try this again) For the past two years, I've been able to get an affordable marketplace plan with Ambetter. It was the first time I was able to get health insurance since I got knocked off my dad's when I turned 26. (I'm now 31) Without this insurance, I wouldn't have been able to get diagnosed with ADHD, get help with my anxiety and depression, treat my Hypothyroidism and Anemia. Like this has been life changing for me. I work for a small business and unfortunately, I didn't make enough money in 2025 to qualify for the tax credit towards insurance premiums like I have the past couple of years. Which means I'm now expected to pay \$650 every single month for health insurance as a single person with no children. I'm absolutely not doing that because that's not something I can afford. And because Mississippi hates poor people (despite us being the poorest state in the country, but yknow whatever I guess), I now fall into the "Medicaid Gap" as if I was ever eligible for Medicaid in the first place. And because of that, it doesn't seem like there's any kind of affordable options. God forbid we expand Medicaid so the poor people can get health care. GOD FORBID. Luckily it seems like I'll at least be able to continue to afford my thyroid medicine and antidepressants still since I was already on the generic. (Ambetter fully covered Generic and GoodRx says between those two, it shouldn't be too much out of pocket.) But now I won't be able to afford my ADHD medicine and my mental health appointments where I also get my antidepressants and it just fucking sucks, man. I just feel so defeated. I was finally taking better care of myself and now it's about to come to a screeching halt. Anyway, thanks for listening to me vent. I know I'm not the only one in this situation. I'm just hoping something changes for us in the future.



— r/HealthInsurance · 138 upvotes · None

"Rule of thumb for freelancers: if a client's first question is "what's your rate?", walk away if you can. Years ago I sold cars (don't hate me, please. I lived in the US and needed health insurance). One thing which got hammered into the salespeople again and again is that the customers who paid the most for their cars were the happiest. It's true. In economics you learn that the value of a good is whatever someone is willing to pay for it: if there's no demand, prices are low. If a customer wanted to buy a car and they just focused on the lowest possible price, they were always a pain in the rear. Those customers who *loved* the car were willing to pay more and scored us higher in customer satisfaction surveys. Every. Damn. Time. There was no significant difference in what they purchased other than the happy customers were ones who focused on the value they were getting. So I learned to sell the heck out of the car and ignore the price. Today I've worked for years with a successful consulting firm and every time we have a potential client, when their first question is "what's your best rate?", they turn out to be a lousy client. They're focused on cutting costs, not building value. When their first questions are about what we can build together, it's awesome! They're thinking about their customers, too, and the value they can provide. When their first question is about price: * Cutting costs is more important than providing value * They may have a tight budget and struggle to pay you * They tend to argue more about invoices and features * They know you're the cheapest bidder and they'll treat you like it Unless you're absolutely desperate for money, there is almost no upside to working for clients focusing on price and not value. It's an underpaid grind. **Update:** One comment I should stress more: I mean clients who open with "cost" and don't discuss value. If cost is mixed in with a discussion of value, that's fine. If cost is their opener and what they're focused on, they're almost always a waste of time unless you sell on price instead of value."

— r/freelance · 98 upvotes · None

"Going back to school for student medical insurance Many of us have increasing insurance costs, in my case it went from \$660/month last year with enhanced subsidies to \$1425/month this year with no subsidies so if retired or underemployed it becomes difficult to justify the costs. In my case I am a few years away from 65 but not wanting to work full-time (I am fortunate) due to my volunteer work I started looking for part time jobs with benefits. I was chasing a rabbit down a hole and found that as a part-time student within the UNC system I was eligible to also get student coverage. Some of the rules \-Have to be in a degree program \-Must attend on Campus \-Part-time = 6 credits Some numbers Not a student- ACA \$17,100/annual, \$2000 deductible max OOP \$8200 As a student \-Tuition/fees annually \$3872 (6 credits/semester) \-Medical insurance \$3168 (12-months) \$500 deductible max OOP \$4000 , campus clinic use unlimited with \$0 co-pay Total annual = \$7040 Additional student benefits (mandatory fees) \-Access to fitness center/pool \-Access to library \-Student discounts By going back to school I will save just under \$10k/annually So I enrolled and was accepted into a GIS program starting in Aug 26, not only will I be saving money but for me the structure of a schedule will help me fill in my week. Even if I became a full-time my annual costs would be \$11k/annual which would still be a savings over ACA only. I am fortunate to not need to work so YMMV, but thought I would share my adventure."

— r/HealthInsurance · 92 upvotes · None

"When I dropped my health insurance, the health system I use now offers me half off on visits. Why could they not do that when I had insurance? So I live in a crappy red state that doesn't support its citizens. When the ACA subsidies were dropped with the help of the clown in the White House, my health insurance went from \$200 a month to almost \$700. I ended up dropping it as work was a little slow and this was a lot of money for something that didn't help much. I had a \$8000 yearly deductible, office visits were higher than they should have been, and almost no drugs were reduced more than the discount card I used at the pharmacy. Basically a lot of money for crappy coverage. Now that I don't have insurance, doctors's visits are half off. Some other visits like urgent care and blood work are half off the full price. Why couldn't I get that price with insurance? It would have lowered the cost of insurance by (I guess) half and I may have ended up keeping it. Why are we being charged an inflated cost with insurance. I feel like I paid more in the end for doctors appointments and such with insurance when you take the high deductible in consideration. It just all sounds like a scam to be and the doctors and insurance companies are in on it together."

— r/HealthInsurance · 77 upvotes · None

"Told it's fraud to have Marketplace and ACA-compliant Employer Insurance at the same time. Is this correct? I'm like a 5 year old when it comes to insurance things. So apologies if this is obvious. I currently have employer-offered health insurance. Per ACA it's considered affordable and it meets the minimum standards. I want to purchase an insurance plan through the Illinois marketplace exchange and have both at the same time. I do not qualify, nor was I trying to get, subsidies, tax credits or discounts. I would be paying whatever is considered full price on the exchange. In trying to get more details from a broker, explaining what I said above, he said that it'd be fraud to have both. A customer service agent through the chat on getcoveredillinois told me that I could only get secondary insurance. That all they offered in the marketplace was primary insurance, and since I had my employer-offered health insurance, and it met the ACA requirements, I could not take on another primary insurance, only secondary. And well they don't offer secondary. Is secondary insurance a different type of insurance? I thought what made it secondary is that I had another plan that was primary, not that it was a specific type of insurance. Is it correct that marketplace insurance plans are primary only? Can I get individual health insurance outside of the marketplace while still having my employer-provided insurance? The enrollment period ends today and have been going back and forth for weeks about this. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 28 upvotes · None

"If I tell my doctor's office I don't have insurance, can they look up whether that's true or not? Context: I've been on Medicaid (in Illinois) for the last few years. I filled out my redetermination in September as usual, then got a letter at the very end of November that I no longer qualify (my income went up and I'm now at around ~\$25,000/year, before I was hovering right around the cut off, which is about \$21,000 I believe). So now I'm looking at Marketplace plans and man....they are all so so awful!! The deductibles are crazy, and it's basically a choice between paying hundreds a month in order to maybe pay \$20-40 each time you go to the doctor, or paying \$10-\$30 a month but paying \$100-\$300 every time to go to the doctor. I take psychiatric medications that I rely on. I've been stable on the same ones for a few years now. I only see my doctor (psychiatrist) four times a year, and it's basically just as a requirement for her to be able to approve my refills. My psychiatrist's office offers sliding scale for uninsured patients, and I would only need to pay about \$35 per visit with them (plus about \$13/month for my meds with GoodRx coupons). This is a setup I could afford, so I was leaning towards just not buying health insurance at all for the coming year and paying for my care out of pocket this way. HOWEVER. I'm 29 years old, and this year two people I know who are even younger than I am were diagnosed with cancer. My parents got in a very scary car accident about two weeks ago (they rolled down a mountain but are miraculously fine because my dad's car is basically a tank). My point being, life has been reminding me a lot recently that no one knows what's going to happen tomorrow, and I feel like having SOME kind of coverage for if things go horribly horribly wrong would probably be in my best interest. I've also read a lot of reddit horror stories of otherwise 'healthy' young people deciding to forego insurance and regretting it after developing unexpected and expensive illnesses. So. I went back to the Marketplace website to look at the plans again. Found one that's \$6/month, has a \$7500 deductible, and covers almost nothing, *but* would be an affordable fail-safe if, god forbid, something really terrible and/or expensive were to happen. My psychiatrist's office does not take this plan. I called them and basically asked, 'If I hypothetically had insurance that you all don't take, would I still be eligible for the sliding scale cash price?' They told me no, that I would have to pay the full cost of the visit, which would be \$300 each time. This finally brings me to my question (thank for for sticking with me if you've read this far lol): **is there anyway for my doctor's office to *know* whether or not I actually have insurance, if I tell them that I don't?** I don't want to come across as if I'm trying to scam the system (although the healthcare system in the US is a nightmare and tbh I wouldn't judge anyone for doing so). But I just literally can't afford to keep seeing my doctor if it's going to be \$300 an appointment. But I also don't want to forego coverage completely. My ideal way to move forward would be to buy the \$6/month plan for emergencies, and just tell my psych that I don't have coverage so I could pay the sliding scale cost for the appointments. Is this something anyone has experience with?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · None

"2 Month Review of Ambetter Fidelis Insurance (NY State of Health/ACA) Hey r/HealthInsurance, I wanted to leave a review of the Ambetter Fidelis Insurance, which I got through the NY State of Health marketplace (ACA). I figured this was useful, because anyone facing the daunting task of finding health insurance when not employed by a traditional employer, knows that this is a very confusing and terrible place to be in. TLDR, I expected it to be TERRIBLE, but it's just "bad". Perhaps the "least bad" among the NY ACA options. Which is actually better than I expected, and thus I'm overall pleasantly satisfied with it. Background: \- I switched from employer insurance to self-employed \~2 years ago, and have been on COBRA until \~2 months ago \- I'm on a specialty injection medication (Dupixent). And it was really important to get this covered, because it'd be \$40K/yr out of pocket otherwise. I reviewed all the available plans in NY State of Health, looking for the cheapest option that did list Dupixent in its formulary, which would be a strong positive signal that I *could* get covered under the plan. Ambetter Fidelis was the cheapest option when I considered the low monthly premium (\~\$700), plus the relatively lower max out-of-pocket (\~\$8K, which I would max out since Dupixent is expensive), and the HSA tax savings benefit (-\~\$1700), and it listed Dupixent on its [formulary](<https://www.fideliscare.org/Portals/0/Formularies/QHP-2025-formulary-Fidelis-Care.pdf>). I was a bit leery of Ambetter Fidelis, because it has [atrocious](<https://www.yelp.com/biz/fidelis-care-new-york-new-york>) [reviews](<https://www.bbb.org/us/ny/long-island-city/profile/health-insurance/ambetter-from-fidelis-care-0121-66199/customer-reviews>). But... pretty much all the insurances have atrocious reviews. So going with a different plan would be more expensive without any stronger guarantee. At first, I was pretty turned off by Ambetter Fidelis: \- their website is TERRIBLE. Slow, unintuitive, broken, down, their voice line tells you to check the website, and the website tells you to call the voice line for more information. \- when you try to call them, you're put through a ringer of TERRIBLE automated voice robots. I've done this so many times, that if you need to talk to a person, here's what you do: call 1-888-343-3547, press: 1122270 (slowly) \- none of my pre-existing doctors offices took them, so I had to pay out of pocket per visit (\$300+) \- after my doctor/pharmacy submitted the prescription request for Dupixent, of course they deny it. But even worse, it's this confusing hell, because the customer service says they have no record of a prior auth from my doctor's office. It turns out the prior auth is handled between my pharmacy and Ambetter Fidelis, but the Ambetter Fidelis reps can't see it? So I was blaming my doctor's office for awhile, when it wasn't their fault. But over time, I've actually become relatively satisfied with them: 1) I had an elbow injury, and through their terrible website I found a sports specialist doctor that is covered by Ambetter. The doctor is quite good, and the co-pay was only like \$25 per visit. The doctor wanted an MRI, but he knows ambetter requires Xrays before MRI's, which is slightly annoying, but whatever. 2) I had an X-ray done, copay was \$30 3) It was a bit of a 2 week song & dance to get ambetter to approve the MRI, but it was approved, and I got an MRI, copay was \$193 at the office. And then Fidelis charged me an additional \$675, since there's a large deductible. This kinda sucks, especially since it's already the end of the year, so this won't go towards my yearly OOP max. But I need this, so whatever. 4) Dupixent was just "approved" today. Have to complain that they called me telling me there's an important message for me, and to call them back. And I need to call them back and spend 15 minutes in a robot answering machine hell before getting to anyone. But whatever, I'm happy that Dupixent was approved. So just waiting another few days for my pharmacy to actually ship Dupixent to me, and see what the deductible will be. So... lots of friction, lots of annoyances, lots of unexpected costs. But healthcare is expensive. And this is the cheapest option I could find. And Dupixent is covered, which is like \$40K/yr on its own, and that's basically all I care about. It was a plus that I could actually find a sports specialty doctors office that is in network with them. Which gives me confidence I can find some decent other doctors that I need. Presumably I won't have such crazy copays/deductibles in the future, since I'll already be paying the max OOP. Anyway, hope that helps. Happy to answer any questions!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 14 upvotes · None

"Looking to possibly leave my job to start an in home daycare with my wife. The plan is to have my wife start off first while I still work and analyze if the income coming in makes sense and if leaving my current position will boost our income if I help her full time by bringing in more children. The only way I leave is if we work numbers and the amount at the end of every month is more than what I am making right now at a steady consistent rate. The biggest fear factor I have is that I have health/dental/vision insurance for all of my family. Leaving hurts my gut because while I was shopping around for healthcare for my family the least expensive one I found was around 805/month and that was just for HEALTH insurance."

— YouTube · Health Insurance Options for the Self Employed or Are Leaving Your Job · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ceyE3F7SK1k&lc=UgwaUBI9OyGnjyDellN4AaABAg>

↳ @MaximizingEcommerce (3): "Thank you for sharing your story. Depending on your beliefs (and health background), you may want to look into a cost sharing ministry as opposed to traditional health insurance. Regarding the risk, the question I would ask myself in your shoes is whether or not this opens doors to potentially additional profit/income opportunities..."

↳ @thehealthinsuranceguide (0): "Hi Manchester - How is the home daycare working out? Depending on your situation now (since it has been two years) your options may vary, and yes, health coverage can be pricey on the private side compared to a company plan that pays a lot of the cost for you. First check would be to see if you'd qualify for a significant subsidy. If not, or the subsidy is minimal, I'd check out the private underwritten plans. There are a couple that are available with lower premiums and better benefits because you have to be healthy enough to qualify to get on them. Did you get the health coverage all figured out? What did you end up going with?"

"ACA Michigan — Anyone using a high-deductible plan + drug assistance program (Ocrevus) to hit OOPM early? Hi all, We're a family of three living in Michigan, income around \$95K, and buy coverage on HealthCare.gov. **I am self-employed, wife cannot work due to disability.** My wife has **multiple sclerosis** and needs **Ocrevus infusions twice a year**, so we always max out our deductible and OOPM. To lower monthly premiums, I'm thinking of switching to a **high-deductible Bronze plan** and relying on the **Ocrevus Copay Assistance Program** to cover most of the deductible right away in January. If those assistance payments count toward our OOPM, we'd essentially reach full coverage after that first infusion. The problem is that many insurers (like BCBSM and UHC) use **copay accumulator programs**, which block manufacturer assistance from counting toward deductible/OOPM. However, **Priority Health's** 2026 SBCs don't have that clause, so they **might** still allow this. Has anyone here successfully pulled this off — using a specialty drug assistance program to hit your OOPM early under an ACA plan? Any advice on confirming with the insurer before enrolling? Appreciate any insights — this could make a big difference in how we budget for my wife's care."

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · None

"Imperial Health on ACA I just wanted to post about my experience with Imperial which I purchased on the exchange. I have used "Obamacare" since it first started. I was without insurance before that as I hired a broker to find me insurance while I was self employed and because of a medication I took at the time .. no one would cover me so ACA was a god send. Until about 2 years ago .. I never really had medical issues. I visit a doctor 4 times a year maybe and used teladoc but about 2 years ago I got very sick which required emergency room care, paddles to the chest to get my heart working right and 5 days in the hospital. Bill before insurance came to just about \$80,000. Add to that some additional aftercare added later. Insurance did their part and I averted financial catastrophe. Yay ACA!!!!!!!!!!!!!! This year selections on ACA in Arizona seemed far less than usual and the company I had been using was priced out of reach so I selected Imperial Health Gold Standard. It costs me just \$200 less than what my rent does a month but .. When you need it the cost pales in comparison to hospital costs. About a week or so after choosing the plan I got the bill. Paid on November 24. Then .. nothing. I got a receipt but didnt hear anything else From Imperial Health Insurance for weeks. Wasn't even sure I was going to have insurance since I received no confirmation. Nothing. Second week of December I start looking around on the net for information and many of their links dont work. The links that do work point you at websites that look like they haven't been updated since 1990. A little nervous but I figure "hey if removing polished (functioning) websites and extra paper helps keep the cost down cool" Finally I find a number and call only to do the phone chase through different people out of country trying to find out if I am indeed covered for the coming year. I do get my membership number and am assured I will be covered. This took about 3 hours. With it I find my online membership card. I am now HOURS into this. I discover the pcp they picked for me is 60 miles from where I live. I do not live in some remote area. I live in Mesa AZ so I know there must be closer doctors. Problem is, while my last insurance company allowed you to change PCP online .. there was no provision for doing so with Imperial health so back to the phones. A primary reason I selected Imperial Insurance is because on ACA it stated that Imperial health Insurance covered my PCP who I used for 5 years+ and the hospital my doctor was associated with. I got it changed and was told to expect a packet from them with my card and that the first card would have the Assigned PCP and a little later I would get the card with my chosen PCP. The company was a little behind and was just sending out "Packages" And I waited. it was nerve racking as I had always received at least a welcome to the company letter/email something but nothing .. just ghost. No "packet" no nothing. Comes Jan1 .. still no card. Now I already downloaded the card from the site I found but .. not everyone knows how to dig through internet garbage to get to that point and had I indeed needed doctoring on the 1st .. I would have been unable to prove I had insurance. I paid for insurance that would begin on the 1st and had no way of proving I had insurance on the 1st. On Jan 2nd .. I try to call to find out where the "Packet and card were. Automated service said would I like a call back .. Nope I will wait .. Great you are number 250 on line. I guess a bunch of other people were wondering where their card was as well!?!? The morning of the 3rd I picked up my card at the mail. There was a single sheet. at the bottom was a paper thin card. Fine we are saving money. The letter had a brief three sentences that said here is your card and if you want to know anything go to Imperial health . com. There is virtually no useful information at the site they direct you to. You will have to do long term digging from there. Personal .. here is your plan and here is what is covered is not available at that site or its links Had I not started to chase this down earlier I would have had to submit a request to change pcp and wait 24 hrs plus or use the one they gave me which was 60 miles away. No snap shot of coverage no nothing .. here is your card 2 days late and if you want to know anything .. go to our shitty website and try and find out. Luckily I take care of my health so hope to have a year like last year where I used insurance 4 times but if this is their level of organization up front .. I am very concerned what will happen if an emergency arises .. I am not two weeks into Insurance with Imperial Health, cant afford to go without insurance and cant change it but .. If your still selecting for Feb1 start .. I would look elsewhere. This company does not seem to have its shit together and trust me .. when the medical bills start flying .. you need a company that has their shit together. We learned that with my Emergency and with my wifes cancer diagnosis and treatment. I do not feel confident with Imperial health but

wont go without insurance so now I am stuck Edited to add I have been trying this website since I received my membership number so about 3 weeks. This is what I get .. a spinning wheel that says Processing and this will spin forever. Tried it in Brave, Firefox and Edge. None of them can open this page. It contains information about my plan .. I cant see it!? I have been trying for almost a month. I think the site servers are overwhelmed so I cant arrange autopay, see my policy or .. anything but that spinning circle. <https://preview.redd.it/cokxg0a9jkcg1.jpg?width=3060&format=pjpg&auto=webp&s=83258471e1a05666f536b5fd6d325b744f7507d6>";

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · None

"I retired before the ACA, very young. Males in my family don't live long lives, so I shifted "retirement" to occur earlier, before I expect to die. I "retired" before the ACA existed, so it wasn't part of any planning. OTOH, my prior health insurance was \$150/month before the ACA started making it double almost every year. I still had cash savings in the first few years after the ACA was passed, which meant my income/MAGI was below the FPL and full payment for ACA plans was the rule. After a few years of paying \$500, \$600, \$700, then \$800/month for the cheapest ACA Marketplace coverage, finally figured out that my annual income/MAGI needed to appear to be at least the poverty level and had to pick a more expensive plan. After fixing those 2 issues, health insurance became affordable again. The full monthly premium is over \$1200 now, but about \$1150 of that is paid by the Feds, because I control the MAGI. I expect to pay my fair share of taxes, but not 1 penny more. I'm not looking forward to being forced off the ACA and onto Medicare at age 65. Monthly health insurance premiums will raise about 6x, it appears now and that's not counting MediGAP insurance. Definitely need to use the ACA as part of your early retirement plans. Wish I'd realized it a few years earlier before paying tens of thousands to health insurance unnecessarily."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgyB34wMc6xvo5jGBWJ4AaABAg.ARR7yTlcvr6AUGJypnLdby

"@HowToRetire I agree.Had my " moment of clarity " (I'm Irish)as an RN in Trauma ICU one day ,after a doctor ticked me off. Put in my papers ,retired,called out the last two weeks .Received all my monies due:pension,vacation,sick,comp time,extended illness,and pretax 457 B money. Glad I left,it saved my life.Got myself healthy.Have been receiving my pension since 2014, and claimed Social Security benefits at 62 last year. I was informed that I was missed by former coworkers.It's important to know when it's time to leave as 4 former coworkers died over the last 2 years. I realize I digressed,sorry. The first year post retirement at age 55, my monthly premium was & 663/ month which rose to \$ 677/ month. They wanted to jack it up to \$ 913/month when I turned 58.Went without health insurance for 5 yrs and am fortunate nothing catastrophic happened to me. However ,I used that money saved to get out of debt. I finally obtained a decent premium price for \$ 673/month ,after turning 62 and claiming Social Security. So it's a bit of a hit,but easier to withstand."

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement - Here Are 4 Options · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pjR3wlGOZsc&lc=UgxuDqzp0nO2tXhXUNd4AaABAg.9Q3ovSLSXIZ9R1tiYo8C3j>

"Questions about how to file taxes with premium tax credits for a dependent? My taxes have always been super simple and straightforward. I work full time and have 2 kids, but I don't have employer health benefits and have had Medicaid for all 3 of us since my divorce. My 19 year old son was dropped from Medicaid coverage and I signed him up for an ACA policy through a broker who told me it wouldn't affect my taxes. My son is autistic and is a full time college student. He lives at home and I've always claimed him as a dependent. He doesn't have a job, but did have a little income from a summer internship. But since he has this policy does he have to file taxes? He didn't make enough money last year to meet the FPL for an individual and I didn't earn enough to meet the FPL for a family of 3. I think as far as the federal government is concerned he should still have Medicaid, but we live in a red state that didn't expand Medicaid, so there's no coverage for 18-24 year old students who don't have children. Do I file my taxes as usual with my children as dependents and then file taxes for him with his 1095-a and put that he can be claimed as a dependent? Do I not claim him as a dependent even though he is most definitely a dependent? He's the only one with an ACA policy and I do not know what I'm doing and I'm afraid since he didn't make enough money that he'll have to pay back thousands of dollars in subsidies. Thanks for any advice!"

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · None

"@MikeHawk-y6uThe price you see in a restaurant, hotel or shop in the EU is the price you pay,there are no surprise additions like city tax,state tax or mandatory tipping. My private health insurance costs the equivalent of \$95 a month and it includes multiple trip travel insurance(60 days per trip) We don't need to have private health insurance because the public health system is practically free, we certainly don't have to pay for an ambulance when we have an emergency. My job pays 3 months full sick pay and a further 3 months ½ pay. I get 25 days paid annual leave plus 10 paid public holidays. The USA is by far the worst country for working people"

— YouTube · How We Get ACA Health Insurance Before Age 65? · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xVHorMHIYeM&lc=Ugzwlj_dG_HCp4EXNe14AaABAg.Ab-2vp_kFKgAb0hsliliW0

"I've also got this plan, thinking it's the best option for copays. I started having some serious bleeding issues & after almost 2 months with no relief, was finally able to have surgery scheduled for a hysterectomy next week. I've activated the procedure & they told me that only the portion paid up front applies to my OOP, and the remaining payments won't. So I'll pay \$2k upfront, for the inpatient procedure, and they're going to deduct \$200x26-the \$5200 isn't applied toward my OOP, I was told, because I basically purchased additional insurance for the specific procedure. So it's like a buy-up. I work in insurance too, so I was pretty confident that all would be safe, but today my Dr's office told me that they can't verify my coverage & I need to activate it. I activated the outpatient procedure last week, per the registration department who told me it's scheduled as outpatient. My Dr wants it inpatient, just in case, so they can't verify it. I called Surest, they had to cancel the inpatient & change it to outpatient, (copay went from \$425 to \$2k, and the deductions went from \$125 to \$200.) I'm starting to believe they deliberately complicate this. "Activation" of the procedure should be left to the provider, who has the codes they're using, and every COMPLETE detail of the procedure, instead they leave it on us to guess which procedures we'll need & leave very little room for error- the words "appeal" & "escalation" have been mentioned in every conversation with the company I've had. These aren't comforting words when we're already worried about our health, now we're also worried about our financial well-being, and the insurance industry banks on members losing patience or being too naive or frustrated to appeal. My recommendation, only select this plan if you're certain you won't need major procedures, this plan design is frustratingly flawed. Away-Pizza-3218, I sincerely wish you the best in your health & recovery, and I hope you're able to get past these issues so it doesn't affect your healing. To file an appeal, you can call them & have them send you the forms. If you don't want to wait for the forms, you can just write a letter to them, but call for the right address to send it to & make sure to keep copies & include ALL the information you can. You only have 60 days if you've already had the procedure, usually, so I hope you still have time to get it resolved. <https://www.healthcare.gov/appeal-insurance-company-decision/internal-appeals/> Thanks for letting me rant, I appreciate it."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/12535jd/my_experiencereview_with_surest_bind_health/jqs6zcv/

"I don't know if it's changed, but when I was on the marketplace a decade ago, the application hard stopped if you didn't put in an SSN. So how are there applications without SSN's? Which is one problem I have with the statement they made about it. Also, if they identify problematic brokers, why not kick them off but still allow new brokers to sign up especially this close to open enrollment for the year. This is going to cause a restriction and how many agents are allowed to assist people. I feel like this is just going to hurt consumers more than the potentially fraudulent brokers. Usually, when I heard stories about fraudulent brokers signing people up for the marketplace, it wasn't people that never existed. It was people that came to them looking for plans and then they would either back out of getting a marketplace plan and then the broker still just enrolled them, especially if they qualified for a full subsidy or close to a full subsidy. Or they would encourage people to understate their income so that they would get a bigger subsidy and people would be more inclined to sign up and then get surprised at tax time."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wodklt/please_explain_the_vanceoz_announcement_yesterday/pbmia90/

"I'm so lost on how this all works and my broker/case worker doesn't seem very helpful. Could you please help? I'm a 57 year old man and my annual income is 27,500 before taxes. I live in Kentucky. I've had Caresource insurance and I pay 67 a month for a low silver plan and I'm very happy with it. But unfortunately Caresource will no longer be covering Kentucky at the end of 2025. My case worker/ broker says Anthem blue cross and blue shield is my only option for 2026 and I highly dislike Anthem I can't believe they're my only option is this true? She chose a plan for me it's not a silver, gold, bronze plan just something close to what I had with Caresource and it would cost me 53 a month starting January 1 2026 will that go up in price if so could you give me a ballpark figure. I'm sorry to ask but I'm no good with computers or navigating the Internet. I still have a hard time believing I can only choose Anthem but I have no idea how to make sure it's true. Any help would be greatly appreciated."

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=UgyfwGXozEAE1Hj4O894AaABAg>

↳ @HappyonMonday (1): "If you go to healthcare.gov click on browse plans. Then put in your zip code. That will take you to the marketplace you need to be in for where you live. There should be a browse plans or prescreening option where you can see which plans would be available to you without even putting your name in. Every zip code is different so I can't look for you! If you can't figure it out maybe you could ask a friend or family member to help you. Good luck! 😊 "

Covered and affordable for the year · 13 documents · 13 voices

"2026 ACA prices are live on Healthcare.gov. Here's our household's official ACA pricing for next year. **Special disclaimer for 2026: Everything in this post assumes that Congress does not extend the COVID subsidy enhancements and that the default ACA subsidy rules return for 2026.** Anyone can now see the 2026 prices and plans in their area with some anonymous data (age/zip/income/etc) in about three minutes at <https://www.healthcare.gov/see-plans/#/>. If you have a local state-run exchange, then you'll be redirected. State exchanges all update on their own schedule, so 2026 prices may or may not be live just yet. For those who may not be familiar with the ACA, below is an actual real-world example of what being on the ACA can be like with the default subsidy systems. The prices below are for a married couple with an average age of 52 and with MAGI under 133% of the Federal Poverty Level (FPL), which qualifies us for the maximum possible amount of ACA subsidies from both the premium tax credit (PTC) subsidy system and cost-sharing reduction (CSR) subsidy system. We have three dependent children as well, one of which will be on our ACA policy, and we live in a non-expansion state, so expansion Medicaid does not apply to us. Keep in mind that the premiums below would be much higher for a couple if they were in their 60s rather than in their 40s/50s like us. Tobacco users can expect to pay up to 50% additional premium on top of the age-rating. If we were both 62, then the unsubsidized Bronze premium below would rise from \$19,140 to \$27,168. Prices also can vary incredibly between states. If we were both 62 and living in West Virginia instead of Texas, then our Bronze premium would rise from \$27,168 to \$49,584. If instead we were living in Minnesota, then our Bronze premium would fall from \$27,168 to \$21,696. I have also included the policy options we would likely take if we were either eligible only for premium subsidies and not also cost-sharing reductions, as well as the plan we would likely take if we were ineligible for any subsidies at all. People who are over 200% FPL should generally avoid Silver plans due to the way states have elected to deal with the loss of federal funding for the cost-sharing reduction subsidy system, so while I have provided the full market price of our Silver plan, please note that almost nobody would want to ever buy that plan at that price as better Bronze and Gold options are available. ____ Our 2026 Silver plan with subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (based purely on MAGI): * \$84 in annual premium * \$0/\$0 deductible (individual/family) * \$0 PCP * \$10 specialist * \$5 urgent care * \$0/\$15 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$2,200/\$4,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ Our 2026 Silver plan without subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (full market price): * \$26,892 in annual premium * \$6,000/\$12,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$40 PCP * \$80 specialist * \$60 urgent care * \$20/\$40 tier1/tier2 scripts * 40% ER coinsurance * \$8,900/\$17,800 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 Gold plan we would pick if our MAGI was just above 200% FPL (no meaningful CSRs): * \$2,952 in annual premium * \$2,000/\$4,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$30 PCP * \$60 specialist * \$45 urgent care * \$15/\$30 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$8,200/\$16,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 HSA-compatible Bronze plan we would pick if we qualified for zero subsidies/CSRs (MAGI above 400% FPL, factoring in max MAGI-reducing HSA contributions) * \$19,140 in annual premium * \$7,500/\$15,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$50 PCP * \$100 specialist * \$75 urgent care * \$25/\$50 tier1/tier2 scripts * 50% ER coinsurance * \$10,000/\$20,000 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____"

— r/obamacare · 571 upvotes · None

"Insurance carriers increased rates on ACA plans with based off the expectation of lower enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are put back in, what happens to the now jacked up rates that were already approved by states and sold during open-enrollment? Carriers have increased full cost rates ahead of schedule because they expect a drop in enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are reinstated, what happens to the already inflated rates? Each insurance carrier must get its rate increase approved by the state annually, often months before open enrollment. This year, carriers justified rate hikes primarily by citing: 1. Lower projected enrollment numbers due to expiring ACA subsidies 2. The rising cost of GLP-1 weight loss drugs (even though most ACA marketplace plans don't cover these) I'm re-emphasizing because I fear people will still confuse the question. I am not talking about increases people are seeing based off loss of their personal subsidy, I am talking about the plan's actual cost. Aka, what someone would pay if they didn't receive subsidy. My state approved my insurance company for a 27% increase for 2026. They have again applied that increase disproportionately, increasing the individual plans more than their group plans. My personal non-subsidized cheapest HSA eligible ACA plan went up 40% on just the premium, with increases in the cost-sharing amounts as well. This is about average across my local market. Their group rate plans only went up by single digit amounts. Even if the government reinstates subsidies, I'm not hearing anyone addressing the issue of rate increases that relied on inaccurate enrollment projections. Open enrollment has already begun. Will these companies be forced to rework their approved plans retroactively? Are we going to get refunds? I don't see it happening. If they don't, the insurance companies will profit even more from this political situation. This event has allowed them to quickly raise plan costs beyond their actual expenses. If it's too late for 2026, what's the chances they'll actually lower rates even for 2027?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 229 upvotes · None

"My premium increased 590%. Is this normal? I understand without the enhanced subsidies we'd be seeing double or triple premiums next year. However, my premium skyrocketed. In 2025, I paid \$80 and my premiums are set to increase to \$552. The lowest option available was \$300 for catastrophic insurance which wouldn't work for me. I had to go with the \$450 option. I put that my income was \$730 biweekly after deductions. My take home pay is \$1200 a month. My friend in Florida makes the same as me and her premium only increased from \$11 to \$50. My coworker in Wisconsin is also getting a similar low cost option. I am so confused why my premium increased so much. Did anyone else in Illinois experience this? Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level. Edit: also, my parents are helping to pay part of my premiums for now. Otherwise, I'd be out of luck. Even though I'm grateful, it doesn't feel good having to rely on my parents for this. But knowing my health history I could end up in serious trouble if I go uninsured. Update: After a month on the marketplace plan, I was found eligible for Medicaid so it ended up working out at the end. I was worried since I'd been denied for Medicaid in the past. It looks like the increased premiums finally made me eligible."

— r/HealthInsurance · 152 upvotes · None

"Going back to school for student medical insurance Many of us have increasing insurance costs, in my case it went from \$660/month last year with enhanced subsidies to \$1425/month this year with no subsidies so if retired or underemployed it becomes difficult to justify the costs. In my case I am a few years away from 65 but not wanting to work full-time (I am fortunate) due to my volunteer work I started looking for part time jobs with benefits. I was chasing a rabbit down a hole and found that as a part-time student within the UNC system I was eligible to also get student coverage. Some of the rules \-Have to be in a degree program \-Must attend on Campus \-Part-time = 6 credits Some numbers Not a student- ACA \$17,100/annual, \$2000 deductible max OOP \$8200 As a student \-Tuition/fees annually \$3872 (6 credits/semester) \-Medical insurance \$3168 (12-months) \$500 deductible max OOP \$4000 , campus clinic use unlimited with \$0 co-pay Total annual = \$7040 Additional student benefits (mandatory fees) \-Access to fitness center/pool \-Access to library \-Student discounts By going back to school I will save just under \$10k/annually So I enrolled and was accepted into a GIS program starting in Aug 26, not only will I be saving money but for me the structure of a schedule will help me fill in my week. Even if I became a full-time my annual costs would be \$11k/annual which would still be a savings over ACA only. I am fortunate to not need to work so YMMV, but thought I would share my adventure."

— r/HealthInsurance · 92 upvotes · None

"If I tell my doctor's office I don't have insurance, can they look up whether that's true or not? Context: I've been on Medicaid (in Illinois) for the last few years. I filled out my redetermination in September as usual, then got a letter at the very end of November that I no longer qualify (my income went up and I'm now at around ~\$25,000/year, before I was hovering right around the cut off, which is about \$21,000 I believe). So now I'm looking at Marketplace plans and man....they are all so so awful!! The deductibles are crazy, and it's basically a choice between paying hundreds a month in order to maybe pay \$20-40 each time you go to the doctor, or paying \$10-\$30 a month but paying \$100-\$300 every time to go to the doctor. I take psychiatric medications that I rely on. I've been stable on the same ones for a few years now. I only see my doctor (psychiatrist) four times a year, and it's basically just as a requirement for her to be able to approve my refills. My psychiatrist's office offers sliding scale for uninsured patients, and I would only need to pay about \$35 per visit with them (plus about \$13/month for my meds with GoodRx coupons). This is a setup I could afford, so I was leaning towards just not buying health insurance at all for the coming year and paying for my care out of pocket this way. HOWEVER. I'm 29 years old, and this year two people I know who are even younger than I am were diagnosed with cancer. My parents got in a very scary car accident about two weeks ago (they rolled down a mountain but are miraculously fine because my dad's car is basically a tank). My point being, life has been reminding me a lot recently that no one knows what's going to happen tomorrow, and I feel like having SOME kind of coverage for if things go horribly horribly wrong would probably be in my best interest. I've also read a lot of reddit horror stories of otherwise 'healthy' young people deciding to forego insurance and regretting it after developing unexpected and expensive illnesses. So. I went back to the Marketplace website to look at the plans again. Found one that's \$6/month, has a \$7500 deductible, and covers almost nothing, *but* would be an affordable fail-safe if, god forbid, something really terrible and/or expensive were to happen. My psychiatrist's office does not take this plan. I called them and basically asked, 'If I hypothetically had insurance that you all don't take, would I still be eligible for the sliding scale cash price?' They told me no, that I would have to pay the full cost of the visit, which would be \$300 each time. This finally brings me to my question (thank for for sticking with me if you've read this far lol): **is there anyway for my doctor's office to *know* whether or not I actually have insurance, if I tell them that I don't?** I don't want to come across as if I'm trying to scam the system (although the healthcare system in the US is a nightmare and tbh I wouldn't judge anyone for doing so). But I just literally can't afford to keep seeing my doctor if it's going to be \$300 an appointment. But I also don't want to forego coverage completely. My ideal way to move forward would be to buy the \$6/month plan for emergencies, and just tell my psych that I don't have coverage so I could pay the sliding scale cost for the appointments. Is this something anyone has experience with?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · None

"Imperial Health on ACA I just wanted to post about my experience with Imperial which I purchased on the exchange. I have used "Obamacare" since it first started. I was without insurance before that as I hired a broker to find me insurance while I was self employed and because of a medication I took at the time .. no one would cover me so ACA was a god send. Until about 2 years ago .. I never really had medical issues. I visit a doctor 4 times a year maybe and used teladoc but about 2 years ago I got very sick which required emergency room care, paddles to the chest to get my heart working right and 5 days in the hospital. Bill before insurance came to just about \$80,000. Add to that some additional aftercare added later. Insurance did their part and I averted financial catastrophe. Yay ACA!!!!!!!!!!!!!! This year selections on ACA in Arizona seemed far less than usual and the company I had been using was priced out of reach so I selected Imperial Health Gold Standard. It costs me just \$200 less than what my rent does a month but .. When you need it the cost pales in comparison to hospital costs. About a week or so after choosing the plan I got the bill. Paid on November 24. Then .. nothing. I got a receipt but didnt hear anything else From Imperial Health Insurance for weeks. Wasn't even sure I was going to have insurance since I received no confirmation. Nothing. Second week of December I start looking around on the net for information and many of their links dont work. The links that do work point you at websites that look like they haven't been updated since 1990. A little nervous but I figure "hey if removing polished (functioning) websites and extra paper helps keep the cost down cool" Finally I find a number and call only to do the phone chase through different people out of country trying to find out if I am indeed covered for the coming year. I do get my membership number and am assured I will be covered. This took about 3 hours. With it I find my online membership card. I am now HOURS into this. I discover the pcp they picked for me is 60 miles from where I live. I do not live in some remote area. I live in Mesa AZ so I know there must be closer doctors. Problem is, while my last insurance company allowed you to change PCP online .. there was no provision for doing so with Imperial health so back to the phones. A primary reason I selected Imperial Insurance is because on ACA it stated that Imperial health Insurance covered my PCP who I used for 5 years+ and the hospital my doctor was associated with. I got it changed and was told to expect a packet from them with my card and that the first card would have the Assigned PCP and a little later I would get the card with my chosen PCP. The company was a little behind and was just sending out "Packages" And I waited. it was nerve racking as I had always received at least a welcome to the company letter/email something but nothing .. just ghost. No "packet" no nothing. Comes Jan1 .. still no card. Now I already downloaded the card from the site I found but .. not everyone knows how to dig through internet garbage to get to that point and had I indeed needed doctoring on the 1st .. I would have been unable to prove I had insurance. I paid for insurance that would begin on the 1st and had no way of proving I had insurance on the 1st. On Jan 2nd .. I try to call to find out where the "Packet and card were. Automated service said would I like a call back .. Nope I will wait .. Great you are number 250 on line. I guess a bunch of other people were wondering where their card was as well!?!? The morning of the 3rd I picked up my card at the mail. There was a single sheet. at the bottom was a paper thin card. Fine we are saving money. The letter had a brief three sentences that said here is your card and if you want to know anything go to Imperial health . com. There is virtually no useful information at the site they direct you to. You will have to do long term digging from there. Personal .. here is your plan and here is what is covered is not available at that site or its links Had I not started to chase this down earlier I would have had to submit a request to change pcp and wait 24 hrs plus or use the one they gave me which was 60 miles away. No snap shot of coverage no nothing .. here is your card 2 days late and if you want to know anything .. go to our shitty website and try and find out. Luckily I take care of my health so hope to have a year like last year where I used insurance 4 times but if this is their level of organization up front .. I am very concerned what will happen if an emergency arises .. I am not two weeks into Insurance with Imperial Health, cant afford to go without insurance and cant change it but .. If your still selecting for Feb1 start .. I would look elsewhere. This company does not seem to have its shit together and trust me .. when the medical bills start flying .. you need a company that has their shit together. We learned that with my Emergency and with my wifes cancer diagnosis and treatment. I do not feel confident with Imperial health but

wont go without insurance so now I am stuck Edited to add I have been trying this website since I received my membership number so about 3 weeks. This is what I get .. a spinning wheel that says Processing and this will spin forever. Tried it in Brave, Firefox and Edge. None of them can open this page. It contains information about my plan .. I cant see it!? I have been trying for almost a month. I think the site servers are overwhelmed so I cant arrange autopay, see my policy or .. anything but that spinning circle. <https://preview.redd.it/cokxg0a9jkcg1.jpg?width=3060&format=pjpg&auto=webp&s=83258471e1a05666f536b5fd6d325b744f7507d6>";

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · None

"I retired before the ACA, very young. Males in my family don't live long lives, so I shifted "retirement" to occur earlier, before I expect to die. I "retired" before the ACA existed, so it wasn't part of any planning. OTOH, my prior health insurance was \$150/month before the ACA started making it double almost every year. I still had cash savings in the first few years after the ACA was passed, which meant my income/MAGI was below the FPL and full payment for ACA plans was the rule. After a few years of paying \$500, \$600, \$700, then \$800/month for the cheapest ACA Marketplace coverage, finally figured out that my annual income/MAGI needed to appear to be at least the poverty level and had to pick a more expensive plan. After fixing those 2 issues, health insurance became affordable again. The full monthly premium is over \$1200 now, but about \$1150 of that is paid by the Feds, because I control the MAGI. I expect to pay my fair share of taxes, but not 1 penny more. I'm not looking forward to being forced off the ACA and onto Medicare at age 65. Monthly health insurance premiums will raise about 6x, it appears now and that's not counting MediGAP insurance. Definitely need to use the ACA as part of your early retirement plans. Wish I'd realized it a few years earlier before paying tens of thousands to health insurance unnecessarily."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgyB34wMc6xvo5jGBWJ4AaABAg.ARR7yTlcvr6AUGJypnLdby

"@HowToRetire I agree.Had my " moment of clarity " (I'm Irish)as an RN in Trauma ICU one day ,after a doctor ticked me off. Put in my papers ,retired,called out the last two weeks .Received all my monies due:pension,vacation,sick,comp time,extended illness,and pretax 457 B money. Glad I left,it saved my life.Got myself healthy.Have been receiving my pension since 2014, and claimed Social Security benefits at 62 last year. I was informed that I was missed by former coworkers.It's important to know when it's time to leave as 4 former coworkers died over the last 2 years. I realize I digressed,sorry. The first year post retirement at age 55, my monthly premium was & 663/ month which rose to \$ 677/ month. They wanted to jack it up to \$ 913/month when I turned 58.Went without health insurance for 5 yrs and am fortunate nothing catastrophic happened to me. However ,I used that money saved to get out of debt. I finally obtained a decent premium price for \$ 673/month ,after turning 62 and claiming Social Security. So it's a bit of a hit,but easier to withstand."

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement - Here Are 4 Options · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pjR3wlGOZsc&lc=UgxuDqgz0nO2tXhXUNd4AaABAg.9Q3ovSLSXIZ9R1tiYo8C3j>

"My ACA premiums will make a huge jump in '26 (percentage-wise) due to the end of extended ACA benefits - from \$4 to \$124/mo. Additionally, there are no longer plans available without co-pays or co-insurance, and the out-of-pocket max is also increasing significantly. I find it pretty much impossible to complain about that, though - incredibly grateful for this truly affordable health insurance."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=Ugyhoe7QYX42h_ByAt14AaABAg

↳ @dking1362 (0): "@robnunurbiznezz7618 Mine was a sarcastic " huge jump", but yours is for real. Ouch! Obviously a much higher income than me; maybe a private pay plan would work better? I had expected to pay about \$1k/mo. for insurance when I retired, so the ACA has been fantastic for me."

"I've been in the insurance business since 2011 and remember the first open enrollment on October 1, 2013. Many agents thought they would make a lot of money enrolling entire families with full subsidies and promised compensation. But just months later, many left the market when commissions went unpaid. This happened early in my career and left a lasting impression on how I view the ACA. I don't understand why so many agents invest so much time in ACA today. I know it will eventually improve, but in the meantime, why not focus on selling Medicare plans, which offer more reliable income and better persistency than ACA? The ACA market is too volatile—caught in political power struggles—and you can lose a client simply because they got a new job with health benefits or got married. I have an ACA plan (self-employed insurance agent) with no subsidies and pay \$550 for mediocre health insurance. I just received notice that my Aetna CVS ACA plan is leaving the Texas market at the end of the year."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m2m8ak/important_aca_changes_to_know_heading_into_2026/n3xleep4/

"Health insurance is HORRENDOUS this year. Its more dangerous than you stated, so listen up (and so far its not getting better next year): 1. The Cliffs of subsidies, oh the cliffs: Make too much (around 85k GROSS household) and you owe FULL amount of insurance (usually around 21-25k for two people. Thats 25%+ extra "tax" for health insurance!! on top of taxes!!!)... make too little and you owe the FULL amount too. As you know, self employment can be somewhat unpredictable so playing with the tiny financial window for subsidy assistance is nuts. One penny under you owe like 1200 for two for the year... one penny over? you owe 25k. make it make sense! WRITE YOUR REPS! We need at LEAST a Solo small biz option for better and more affordable group health insurance, and the subsidies NOT to have cliffs. 2) Most have access to some better group plans. Solo biz owners are not. We are expected to pay FULL employment taxes on our wages/earnings instead of just HALF if you work for the man, and we dont get access to more favorable group plans. This needs to stop as it is CUTTING to small biz working harder than most (or at least riskier). 3) Middle class is essentially subsidizing poor (ok) and ultra rich (not okay). The richer you get, the less overall cost burden you have. Don't believe me? Lets do the math for a second. if you make 100k as a couple, you'll pay around 22% as highest bracket. Then you also owe roughly 25k of health insurance. **So your overall cost burden for LOWER middle class is 47% of GROSS income.** If you make 25 million dollars a year, your highest tax bracket is around 37%... and your health insurance still costs about 25k. Same same. but that factors into being about .1%. **So ultra rich earners overall cost burden for health insurance we are basically forced to have is drumroll please. 37.1% . LOWER overall COST BURDEN THAN MIDDLE CLASS! at highest bracket. And The richer you get, the less overall cost burden in percent you have.** (Not even mentioning tax breaks and legit loopholes of course. what i said is enough) Sure you pay more dollars, but you pay LESS PERCENT of your income. 25k means very little to a person making 25 million, but it means a TON to the person making 85k. That is NOT fair. **I propose we change it with having everyone just pay a flat tax towards health care. 8%.** We can subsidize the truly poor but definitely not the ultra rich. Thats gotta end of we are essentially forced into the bad health care system we have... **the only thing not universal about our healthcare is that its not universally paid for - the middle class pay overwhelmingly more in cost percent burden than ANYONE else. Facts. WRITE YOUR REPS** 4) short term insurance fine prints: in networks, out of networks... you MUST read it. Agents overwhelmingly do not care or do not know. - or sell fraud insurance. When the rubber hits your road, you may not want an organ transplant cap of 10k, or a emergency airlift of 500 dollars. And you may not even qualify - almost any preexisting disqualifies you. Sure your agent can sign u up but they arent left picking up the pieces when things go wrong. (VERY LITTLE HEALTH AGENT ACCOUNTABILITY) Also once you get sick, you wont get renewed and youre forced back into ACA cesspool. TL:DR **Everyone in the middle class is getting very screwed around health insurance, but solo entrepreneurs are the canary in the coal mine.** We see it first hand how messed up it is, especially this year and next year. Some of us realize it early. The rest will cry at tax time (or when medical bills hit the fan). WRITE YOUR REPS! We need at LEAST 1) Solo small biz option for better and more affordable group health insurance, 2) subsidies NOT to have hard cliffs 3) Maybe most importantly long term reform: We need a fair flat rate where EVERYONE including bezos, pays a flat 8% (or something) of their income towards health insurance. **Right now, it's middle class paying 25% of their income while billionaires pay .00000001% of their income towards it** \- if they even buy our peasant insurance haha. **Effectively we all subsidize the ultra rich too, and have to play the health insurance hunger games.** Its INSANE."

— r/selfemployed · https://www.reddit.com/r/selfemployed/comments/1vk17ni/us_health_insurance_as_a_solo_small_business/p9z8x1m/

"I don't know if it's changed, but when I was on the marketplace a decade ago, the application hard stopped if you didn't put in an SSN. So how are there applications without SSN's? Which is one problem I have with the statement they made about it. Also, if they identify problematic brokers, why not kick them off but still allow new brokers to sign up especially this close to open enrollment for the year. This is going to cause a restriction and how many agents are allowed to assist people. I feel like this is just going to hurt consumers more than the potentially fraudulent brokers. Usually, when I heard stories about fraudulent brokers signing people up for the marketplace, it wasn't people that never existed. It was people that came to them looking for plans and then they would either back out of getting a marketplace plan and then the broker still just enrolled them, especially if they qualified for a full subsidy or close to a full subsidy. Or they would encourage people to understate their income so that they would get a bigger subsidy and people would be more inclined to sign up and then get surprised at tax time."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wodklt/please_explain_the_vanceoz_announcement_yesterday/pbmia90/

"We make too much for subsidies and I am a cancer survivor so our only option is full price marketplace plans. It's \$2000 a month. Disgusting."

— YouTube · How To Get Better Health Insurance If You're Self Employed | TIPS TO SAVE ON YOUR MEDICAL · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0eQnHCaWhT8&lc=UgyGdre7tccejhZ6txd4AaABAq>

Free to work for themselves or retire early · 5 documents · 5 voices

"Reasons why I love the freelancing hiring process So I just finished my first project and I'm in consideration for three more. This journey started after another round of disappointing job interviews plagued by office politics, nepotism and cheapskates. Say what you will about certain clients freelancing, but at least most are being upfront from the get go. Before freelancing I spent a good portion of the past five years applying to jobs and I believe that process is ultimately broken beyond repair. You won't get anywhere these days unless you have a network, and even if you do have an established network at some corporation, the nephew of the CEO could still get the job over you. Here are a couple of reasons I find freelancing a much better fit for me and my personality: * Things move much more quickly and everything is out in the open * You know the rate (salary) range!!!! * I was pretty aggressive applying to full time jobs and I find it quite easy to find freelancing opportunities that fit my skillset and pays well. * You don't have to wait weeks or even months to get hired * You don't have to go through skills assessments and personality exams * You set your rates and clients honor it * Clients don't try re-negotiate or go for a cheaper option like what's happened to me in the job hiring process * You generally know where you are in the hiring process and how many people you are competing against. I seem to have to pry this information out of people in the job hiring process and it always changes * Freelancing helps you build out your skills and gets you in touch with that missing network * If clients like you they will continue to give you work * If you don't fit the culture, no big deal you know the contract is temporary * You get paid for the work you do, I constantly find projects for a couple of hundred dollars that I would have done at my salary job for free just so that I can "impress the boss," these little projects around the office would not have netted a raise. I was always afraid of contract positions because I wouldn't get benefits, but even that freedom of not having health insurance tied to a corporation is pleasing to me on some level. I'm looking forward to saying sayonara to my dehumanizing and dangerous retail job by the end of the month."

— r/freelance · 68 upvotes · None

"Feel like I've failed I feel like a failure. I've been self employed with a part time job for the past couple years (the part time job is very part time and I love it too much to quit). I've recently hit a very rough point in my life and the lack of health insurance has finally become too much. I'm talking to a recruiting agency about a contract job and then I may have them find me a permanent job. I know it means giving up what I love doing and I feel like I've failed. I've made the mistake of shifting my focus as other people suggested to me. I should have stuck to what *I* know I can do and do well. I still don't know how I'd handle the lack of health insurance, but it'd be easier to figure out, at least. Anybody else hit a point like this?"

— r/freelance · 65 upvotes · None

"This is a phenomenal video as I quit my job and am going self-employed full time. I was offered COBRA for over \$1,000 a month which seems excessive. I'm 28 years old with no major health issues and live a pretty healthy lifestyle. Do you recommend the DPC + Ancillary? Or the DPC + super high deductible plan + Ancillary? Are DPC and Ancillary tax deductible for the business? Or is it just PPO plans? Ideally I'd like to save as much as possible insurance-wise. Thanks for the fantastic informative video!"

— YouTube · How To Get Better Health Insurance If You're Self Employed | TIPS TO SAVE ON YOUR MEDICAL · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0eQnHCaWhT8&lc=UgziSV3pZsrOnR-oKh4AaABAq>

↳ @7Tcfisher (2): "If you are still in this same situation I specialize in relatively healthy families/individuals as well as self employed/ small business owners as a 28 year old male you should pay no more than \$250 for a low deductible as well as a PPO network because you are a low risk. If you'd like to hear more about options tailored towards your situation to get the best possible rate and most coverage at the same time let me know!"

↳ @VictoriaDorsano (1): "Great questions! If I were in your shoes, I'd either go for DPC + Ancillary (which is a little higher risk, but lower monthly cost), or super high deductible HMO plan + ancillary (lower risk, but higher monthly cost usually). If there's an independent health insurance agent in your area - might be worth consulting with them :) I'm not 100% sure on DPC or ancillary being tax deductible, but since you're going self-employed - you will probably need an accountant anyways - so I'd check in with them on that question. Here's an article from DPC frontier on tax treatment: <https://www.dpcfrontier.com/tax-treatment> For ancillary insurance - this is what I used: <https://natgenhealth.com/individual.php#accident-and-critical-illness> . If you call them, they can advise you if it may be tax deductible as well. Hope this helps!"

↳ @YugiohTube (1): "@VictoriaDorsano This was absolutely fantastic thank you so much. Lastly, have you heard of HSAs and would you recommend I use a HSA with the super high deductible plan? I've heard a lot of good stuff regarding HSAs...again thank you so much for your help. You've definitely got my subscription!"

"I am self-employed and we just lost the insurance that we had through my husband's work because he's gonna work for a business full-time. It does not make sense to get insurance by our self cobra is out of the question it's outrageous and we are a family of three we have a daughter that's in college and we told them we wanted insurance that was comparable to what we had which was United healthcare and it was a PPO, which was pretty decent insurance. The only thing I could find that was even close to that was gonna run us \$2200 a month! That is just asinine. We have decided to go without insurance and pay our Dr. bills as we go."

— YouTube · How to Get Health Insurance When Self-Employed · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G eUdFzjUKcw&lc=UgxMbjRicce5YKnjQNR4AaABAq>

">For someone that is working full time for someone else I would love to hear your suggestions on steamrolling one's work to be able to flip from an employee to being a freelancer. Learn and read as much as you can. Ask for training courses, and study hard. Identify the areas and niches you really care about. Look for commonalities between those subjects. WRT healthcare and taxes - I hear you! For the first couple of years, the ACA was a lifeline, as I could get insurance that wasn't exorbitant. But, as income increases, discounts decrease, so now I pay full price through the business. For taxes, to get a 60K take home, you'll likely need \$80K to \$85K pre-tax."

— r/freelance · https://www.reddit.com/r/freelance/comments/k06s12/behind_the_scenes_of_a_small_freelance_editing/gdhpikx/

Tab 9 — Typical Day

Working around the coverage · 20 documents · 20 voices

"WOW! Looking at my 2026 insurance, it's half my rent! I was covered thru work previously, just looked at 2026 for California with partial subsidy and for a single person, my monthly premium is \$1300! (cheapest was \$1100 - up to \$1800) that's half my already very expensive rent! Estimated income of \$80k. It's a hit, but I don't know how people afford this! All the people getting new premiums in the mail in 2 weeks are in for a rude awakening as I was"

— r/HealthInsurance · 777 upvotes · None

"What you can do if your marketplace premiums for 2026 are too high I've seen this topic come up in recent weeks and want to offer some advice for folks on marketplace plans with premium hikes. This could also work for folks with employer group plans. I realize that this won't work for everyone in every situation but if you've come to a place where you need to consider alternative ways to approach your healthcare costs, this may be helpful. 1. switch to the least expensive marketplace ACA-compliant bronze-level high deductible HSA-eligible insurance plan to cover only catastrophic events like hospitalization. Use this the way you would use your car insurance: sparingly or not at all. Note that going without insurance is a very, very bad idea for reasons that are covered in this sub on a regular basis. 2. Open and contribute to an HSA to get tax savings on money you'll spend toward medical expenses. 3. SKIP DENTAL AND VISION INSURANCE. Honestly this applies to everyone on marketplace plans but dental and vision "insurance" are just glorified payment plans. They are not regulated the same way as ACA health insurance plans so insurers are allowed to charge premiums on those products that guarantee profit margins > 20%. Instead, work with your favorite local dentist and optometrist to pay directly for all your services, and put the money you would have spent on these premiums into your HSA. 4. If you need care: 4a. If you are someone who needs more than 1-3 office visits a year, shop around for a direct primary care provider in your area. Memberships for these are generally pretty reasonable when you factor in what you might have spent toward premiums on a silver or gold tier marketplace plan. 4b. Google specialty care options. For example, Cove offers a monthly membership for treatment of migraines that, when you add it up, is less expensive than a single trip to the neurologist plus a monthly RX from Walgreens. Companies like this exist for nearly everything. 4c. Become a smart shopper for your rxs. There are so many options outside of traditional insurance that can help you save money: GoodRx, Mark Cuban Cost Plus, LillyDirect, Hers/Hims, Nurx. 4d: Think of memberships you may already have that come with pharmacy or healthcare benefits: Costco is an obvious one but comb through other areas of your life. For example, my electric company is a co-op and offers members a discount program for dental, prescriptions, and gym memberships. 4e. Ask your current providers about direct pay arrangements. If you're paying \$200/month in premiums so that your therapist is in-network, but your therapist will happily take \$150 cash per monthly session, you'll come out \$50/month ahead by paying directly. If anyone has other suggestions, because I'm sure I've missed plenty, add them!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 372 upvotes · None

"Health Insurance 101 - Start here! Hi All! We've put together the following wiki as an attempt to help out with general questions as we approach open enrollment. Topics: * What is the ACA * What is Open Enrollment? * Why Do We Have Open Enrollment? * Why Do You Need Health Insurance * What is the marketplace? * Who is in my household? * What is the APTC And who is eligible? * What is FPL? * FPL and the APTC * How do I know if my state expanded medicaid? * What happens if I don't enroll in health insurance? * What about the tax penalty? * Let's talk about plan structures * What is a Deductible? * Coinsurance? * Copayment * Out of Pocket Maximum * How to pay for your deductible * Short Term Health Plans

What is the ACA? The comprehensive health care reform law enacted in March 2010 (sometimes known as ACA, PPACA, or "Obamacare"). The law has 3 primary goals: 1) Make affordable health insurance available to more people. The law provides consumers with subsidies ("premium tax credits") that lower costs for households with incomes between 100% and 400% of the federal poverty level. 2) Expand the Medicaid program to cover all adults with income below 138% of the federal poverty level. (Not all states have expanded their Medicaid programs.) 3) Support innovative medical care delivery methods designed to lower the costs of health care generally. With regard to your employer, if your employer has over 50 employees, they are required to provide you compliant insurance that meets Minimum Essential Coverage and Minimum Value standards. Your employer also must subsidize at least 50% of the premium to enroll the employees.

What is Open Enrollment? <https://www.healthcare.gov/quick-guide/dates-and-deadlines> <https://www.healthcare.gov/glossary/open-enrollment-period/> The yearly period when people can enroll in a health insurance plan. Open Enrollment for 2021 runs from November 1 through December 15, 2020. Insurance plans elected during Open Enrollment will start as early as Jan 1, 2021. Outside the Open Enrollment Period, you generally can enroll in a health insurance plan only if you qualify for a Special Enrollment Period. You're eligible if you have certain life events, like getting married, having a baby, or losing other health coverage. The follow states have permanently adopted expanded enrollment periods: California: November 1 to January 31 Colorado: November 1 to January 15 District of Columbia: November 1 to January 31 Massachusetts: November 1, 2020 to January 23, 2021. Minnesota: November 1 to December 22, 2020. New Jersey: November 1, 2020 to January 31, 2021. New York: November 1, 2020 to January 31, 2021. Nevada: November 1, 2020, to January 15, 2021. Pennsylvania: November 1, 2020, to January 15, 2021 Rhode Island: November 1, 2020 to January 23, 2021. Washington: November 1, 2020, to January 15, 2021.

Why do we have Open Enrollment (OE)? OE is designed for anyone eligible to purchase on the marketplace to make their elections for 2021. With the introduction of the ACA legislation, you cannot buy insurance whenever you want – this prevents people from enrolling only when they know they need the health insurance, which drives up prices for everyone.

Why do you need health insurance? Medical costs are the leading cause for bankruptcy in the US, and everyone is always healthy until they are not. By enrolling in an ACA compliant healthcare plan, you receive the benefits of a provider network, contracted negotiated rates on services, an out of pocket max which caps your personal spending each year, and other state/federal protections on your healthcare experience.

What is the marketplace and who can use it? Any US citizen or qualifying immigration status (<https://www.healthcare.gov/immigrants/immigration-status/>) may purchase off of the marketplace, even if you have employer insurance.

Who is in my Household? Household = you, spouse, tax dependents. It is not necessarily who you physically live with.

What is the APTC and who is eligible? The APTC stands for Advanced Premium Tax Credit and is a subsidy provided to people with incomes between 100 – 400% FPL if your state has not expanded Medicaid or 138 – 400% FPL if your state has expanded Medicaid. You are eligible for the APTC if your income falls in this range and you have no employer insurance available. If you are Medicaid eligible, you should apply there as you will not qualify for the APTC; however, you are welcome to purchase a full price marketplace plan instead if you prefer.

What is FPL? A measure of income issued every year by the Department of Health and Human Services (HHS). Federal poverty levels are used to determine your eligibility for certain programs and benefits, including savings on Marketplace health insurance, and Medicaid and CHIP coverage. The 2020 federal poverty level (FPL) income numbers below are used to calculate eligibility for Medicaid and the Children's Health Insurance

Program (CHIP). Household Size 100% 138% 250% 400% Income ranges: \$12,760-\$17,609 | \$31,900-\$51,040 | \$17,240-\$23,792 | \$43,100-\$68,960 | \$21,720-\$29,974 | \$54,300-\$86,880 | \$26,200-\$36,156 | \$65,500-\$104,800 | \$30,680-\$42,339 | \$76,700-\$122,720 | \$35,160-\$48,521 | \$87,900-\$140,640

FPL and the APTC: Income between 100% and 400% FPL: If your income is in this range, in all states you qualify for premium tax credits that lower your monthly premium for a Marketplace health insurance plan. Income below 138% FPL: If your income is below 138% FPL and your state has expanded Medicaid coverage, you qualify for Medicaid based only on your income. Income below 100% FPL: If your income falls below 100% FPL, you probably won't qualify for savings on a Marketplace health insurance plan or for income-based Medicaid. "Income" above refers to "modified adjusted gross income" (MAGI). For most people, it's the same or very similar to "adjusted gross income" (AGI). MAGI isn't a number on your tax return. If your income is between 100%/138% to 250%, you may qualify for additional Cost Saving Reduction credits if you enroll in a Silver Tier plan.

How do I know if my state expanded medicaid? To date, 39 states (including DC) have adopted the Medicaid expansion and 12 states have not adopted the expansion. The following states have not adopted a Medicaid expansion: Wyoming, South Dakota, Wisconsin, Kansas, Texas, Tennessee, North Carolina, South Carolina, Georgia, Alabama, Missouri, Florida.

***Special notes:**

- Wisconsin: Although Wisconsin has not expanded Medicaid under the guidelines laid out in the Affordable Care Act (ACA), the state's Medicaid program (which is called BadgerCare) does cover all legally present residents with incomes under the poverty level. Wisconsin is the only non-Medicaid-expansion state that does not have a coverage gap; all low-income residents either have access to Medicaid or subsidies to help them purchase private coverage in the exchange.
- Missouri: Missouri voters approved a ballot measure on August 4, 2020 which adds Medicaid expansion to the state's constitution. The amendment requires the state to submit all SPAs necessary to implement expansion to CMS no later than March 1, 2021 and for expansion coverage to begin July 1, 2021. Language in the amendment prohibits the imposition of any additional burdens or restrictions on eligibility or enrollment for the expansion population.
- Oklahoma: Oklahoma voters approved a ballot measure on June 30, 2020 which adds Medicaid expansion to the state's Constitution. The amendment requires the Oklahoma Health Care Authority to submit a SPA and other necessary documents to CMS within 90 days of the ballot measure's approval, and for expansion coverage to begin no later than July 1, 2021. Language in the approved measure prohibits the imposition of any additional burdens or restrictions on eligibility or enrollment for the expansion population.

What happens if I don't enroll in a plan during open enrollment? If you don't enroll in an ACA-compliant health insurance plan by the end of open enrollment (December 15 in most states), your buying options will likely be very limited for the coming year. Open enrollment won't come around again until November 2021, with coverage effective the first of the following year. But depending on the circumstances, you might still be able to get coverage after open enrollment ends:

- * Medicaid and CHIP enrollment are available year-round for those who qualify.
- * Native Americans can enroll year-round
- * Special enrollment period if you have a qualifying event

What about the tax penalty? There is no federal government penalty for being uninsured in 2021. People who are uninsured will not face a penalty, unless they're in a state that has its own individual mandate and a penalty for non-compliance. Four states and DC impose tax penalties for not having h

— r/HealthInsurance · 269 upvotes · None

"Health insurance will cost us almost \$18,000 this year. Please help! My job offers insurance via Aetna and I found out today it's going up again, to almost \$1500/mo for just me, my husband, and my infant. And they already cover 75% of my personal plan, the rest is the family portion. The problem is my husband is self-employed and receives no tax credits or help in the marketplace because a plan is offered through my work. The cheapest crappy plan wouldn't save us all that much, if he were to go get his own plan and leave me and the baby on my work plan. I don't know what to do. That's crippling, it costs more than our mortgage. Should I go down to part time and sacrifice my other job benefits so I'm "no longer eligible" and we can try to get credits/cheaper plan? Do I go without insurance and try to save the money to "cash price" at the doctor? My husband owns a small business so it's not as simple as him just getting another job for the insurance. I have to make a decision in the next two days and I'm so stressed. Location : Georgia, USA Income : \$90,000 UPDATE : if anyone would like an update - we got our health insurance cost down, thankfully. The insurance broker we were working with wasn't as helpful as I expected and told us to mark "no" for tax credits/subsidies. When I did more research (thanks everyone), if it was over 9% of our income, we were eligible for about \$350 credit plus a cheaper plan. When I reached out to the broker to confirm she acted like she didn't realize we'd be eligible 😬 It's only going to cost a little over half what we were looking at after our applications. Moral of the story - do your own research."

— r/HealthInsurance · 165 upvotes · None

"Help! Husband lost his job and we can't afford insurance through my employer! UPDATE: It is MUCH less expensive to insure all 3 of us instead of just me and my daughter through the marketplace! I can get insurance for all 3 for closer to 450 a month by adding him on the policy. Who knew? Thank you everyone for your suggestions! My husband lost his job yesterday. Our insurance will end on April 1. We are both 44 and we have a 13 year old daughter. He starts his new job next week BUT his new employer will not offer any benefits assistance. We live in Missouri. I checked with my employer and it will cost 840 a month on our plan. I tried Healthcare.gov and it was going to be 930 for the cheapest plan (for just me and my daughter, my husband is going to go without insurance. We are not eligible for Medicaid. Where can we find affordable insurance?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 159 upvotes · None

"Are everyone's premiums so high? Hello. I'm applying for insurance using healthcare.gov, and while it might just be me, the premiums I'm being offered seem very steep, around \$460 or more. I'm a student and work part time, so I'm not able to afford a \$460 monthly premium. Does anyone know if I did something wrong or if I need to continue with the process?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 142 upvotes · None

"Employer Won't Sign Me Up For Insurance Until Apr 2026 I started a new job today and I was talking to the HR rep about health insurance. She said that the OE period passed in Apr and I wouldn't be able to sign up again until next Apr. Cue me freaking out because I have conditions that need to be managed with meds. I pushed back because any job I worked at you were always allowed to enroll after the probation period. She said she has to check with I guess the insurance broker. She then told me since I'm losing my coverage at my previous job what going on COBRA, which I would think any HR rep would know how ridiculous of a question that is. I just want to make sure I'm right about them needing to allow me to enroll before Apr 2026. **UPDATE:** it is 90 days so I just have to hold out until Oct. HR rep is new and needs to learn the job better."

— r/HealthInsurance · 136 upvotes · None

"Rule of thumb for freelancers: if a client's first question is "what's your rate?", walk away if you can. Years ago I sold cars (don't hate me, please. I lived in the US and needed health insurance). One thing which got hammered into the salespeople again and again is that the customers who paid the most for their cars were the happiest. It's true. In economics you learn that the value of a good is whatever someone is willing to pay for it: if there's no demand, prices are low. If a customer wanted to buy a car and they just focused on the lowest possible price, they were always a pain in the rear. Those customers who *loved* the car were willing to pay more and scored us higher in customer satisfaction surveys. Every. Damn. Time. There was no significant difference in what they purchased other than the happy customers were ones who focused on the value they were getting. So I learned to sell the heck out of the car and ignore the price. Today I've worked for years with a successful consulting firm and every time we have a potential client, when their first question is "what's your best rate?", they turn out to be a lousy client. They're focused on cutting costs, not building value. When their first questions are about what we can build together, it's awesome! They're thinking about their customers, too, and the value they can provide. When their first question is about price: * Cutting costs is more important than providing value * They may have a tight budget and struggle to pay you * They tend to argue more about invoices and features * They know you're the cheapest bidder and they'll treat you like it Unless you're absolutely desperate for money, there is almost no upside to working for clients focusing on price and not value. It's an underpaid grind. **Update:** One comment I should stress more: I mean clients who open with "cost" and don't discuss value. If cost is mixed in with a discussion of value, that's fine. If cost is their opener and what they're focused on, they're almost always a waste of time unless you sell on price instead of value."

— r/freelance · 98 upvotes · None

"Health insurance over 30% of my income It's open enrollment for the ACA right now, and I'm not sure what to do. I applied but the cheapest policy is 200/month more than my current policy. Where's the subsidy? I'm making 17/hr (not being paid over summer - school schedule) my current insurance is over 600/month and the aca is offering over 800/month. I can't afford this. I'm generally panicking because my financial situation changed, and we have a baby on the way. We were expecting to have a higher household income but currently I'm the only one earning. I'm debating canceling the insurance altogether. It won't cover the baby regardless (international stuff - but their healthcare will be covered over there until we bring the baby back). I've got other financial fears I need help figuring out too, but mainly just trying to get my head around the insurance. We don't qualify for medicaid (wtf) we don't qualify to rent an apartment (wtf) I'm debating living in my car if I lose my current housing situation, but when baby arrives it'll need more than a back seat. If I don't have to pay health insurance, then i could do better financially. I have decent savings, but once that's gone, it's gone. If I do cancel, then if something happens where I need care, then I might have to die before the baby is here because I can't afford treatment. I wish I could format my question more directly but I'm kinda overwhelmed and it's hard to write well while I'm all stressed and panicky. I thought when open enrollment came I'd be able to get on a plan that was paid for by the fed, and so I could drop my work coverage. That's turning out not to be the case. Am I missing something? Can someone help me figure out what to do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 32 upvotes · None

"Medi-Cal vs. Covered California / Medi-Cal eligibility I am a working-age California resident. In the first quarter of last year, I left a job voluntarily. Because it was voluntary I did not bother to apply for unemployment. I did not have another job lined up. As I had coverage with Kaiser through my employer, my first call was to them to ask about Cobra. I was pretty quickly transferred to a Kaiser agent who wanted to work through a Covered California application with me. We did that, but at the end of the process they had some technical failure with regard to me verifying my SSN, so they gave up and transferred me to a Covered California agent. I did not quite know how to answer their question about income, because my answer was basically, "I expect to be employed again at some point this year, but it's hard to say when, and so anything I tell you will only be a guesstimate." So the CC agent concluded that since my total 2022 income from the job I just left fell under the limit, and since I did not have any other income, I was eligible for Medi-Cal. This seemed odd to me since my occupation pays fairly well and I did expect to be employed again at some point that year. "Can't I just get subsidies through CC and then pay them back once I'm working again?" I asked. Their answer was that with Medi-Cal, so long as I advise them of any changes to income, I don't actually have to pay anything back. I didn't really expect to use the plan anyway, i.e. I just wanted catastrophic coverage, and so I agreed to do that. So for the past 11 months, I've been on Medi-Cal. I have not used the plan in any way, have not seen a doctor, have not called anyone about anything with the exception of the initial application process. It is time to renew my eligibility, and here is my concern: When I went through the application process last year, they asked about "cash on hand." Now, at the time I did have some money in the bank, but that money was set aside for living expenses like rent and food, which I considered to be priorities that came before health insurance. It felt like the question was more about "disposable cash" and so I reported that no, I did not have cash on hand. Looking back, that was probably the wrong answer. There was zero intent to deceive on my part, however I'm now concerned that I've basically been enrolled in Medi-Cal fraudulently. As it turns out, I am still unemployed. I am very close to being out of cash, am living on credit card advances, and I have a traditional IRA that I will tap into as a last resort. So, unlike last year, I'm pretty sure that I am now legitimately eligible for Medi-Cal. (I don't think my IRA counts as an asset but please correct me if I'm wrong.) Let's say I renew and at some point thereafter I obtain services. Might they do some digging and discover that I did actually have some cash in 2022? My understanding is that if I am eligible for Medi-Cal then I am NOT eligible for CC subsidies, so even though at this point I would feel better about reversing course and getting myself on a CC plan, that may not be financially feasible for me. I would like to have a conversation with someone from Medi-Cal about this, but not sure how wise it would be for me to share what I have shared here. Maybe it would be better to just return my renewal docs and proceed as if I've been eligible all along? Does it even matter since I haven't actually obtained any services? Am I just being paranoid? Apologies for the long-winded post. Just wanted to provide some context so that hopefully someone might have some valuable insight and/or advice. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 18 upvotes · None

"Journalist seeking NYers concerned about ACA subsidies Hi I'm Caroline Lewis, a health care reporter with the NYC public radio station WNYC. I'm working on a story about how ACA insurance subsidies will be reduced if enhanced tax credits are allowed to expire at the end of this year. I'm looking to speak with NYC residents who have insurance through the state's ACA exchange (known here as New York State of Health) and who are concerned about their plans becoming less affordable. If you are interested in speaking with me, please send me a message here or email me at clewis@wnyc.org. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 14 upvotes · None

"Looking to possibly leave my job to start an in home daycare with my wife. The plan is to have my wife start off first while I still work and analyze if the income coming in makes sense and if leaving my current position will boost our income if I help her full time by bringing in more children. The only way I leave is if we work numbers and the amount at the end of every month is more than what I am making right now at a steady consistent rate. The biggest fear factor I have is that I have health/dental/vision insurance for all of my family. Leaving hurts my gut because while I was shopping around for healthcare for my family the least expensive one I found was around 805/month and that was just for HEALTH insurance."

— YouTube · Health Insurance Options for the Self Employed or Are Leaving Your Job · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ceyE3F7SK1k&lc=UgwaUBI9OyGnjyDellN4AaABAq>

↳ @MaximizingEcommerce (3): "Thank you for sharing your story. Depending on your beliefs (and health background), you may want to look into a cost sharing ministry as opposed to traditional health insurance. Regarding the risk, the question I would ask myself in your shoes is whether or not this opens doors to potentially additional profit/income opportunities..."

↳ @thehealthinsuranceguide (0): "Hi Manchester - How is the home daycare working out? Depending on your situation now (since it has been two years) your options may vary, and yes, health coverage can be pricey on the private side compared to a company plan that pays a lot of the cost for you. First check would be to see if you'd qualify for a significant subsidy. If not, or the subsidy is minimal, I'd check out the private underwritten plans. There are a couple that are available with lower premiums and better benefits because you have to be healthy enough to qualify to get on them. Did you get the health coverage all figured out? What did you end up going with?"

"I'm confused why the same plan my girlfriend and I choose went up for her, but stayed the same for me? We both signed up for Oscar Gold Elite last year and each have our incomes which are unfortunately low. Same jobs and same income for this year... But for some reason my premium for the same plan stayed at the exact same price of \$40, but hers more than doubled to \$100. We use our premium tax credits but she uses the insurance more than I do because she had asthma but does that have anything to do with it? I'm a bit confused because I don't understand this stuff very well despite watching many videos on it. Any help is greatly appreciated."

— r/HealthInsurance · 7 upvotes · None

"I've been in the insurance business since 2011 and remember the first open enrollment on October 1, 2013. Many agents thought they would make a lot of money enrolling entire families with full subsidies and promised compensation. But just months later, many left the market when commissions went unpaid. This happened early in my career and left a lasting impression on how I view the ACA. I don't understand why so many agents invest so much time in ACA today. I know it will eventually improve, but in the meantime, why not focus on selling Medicare plans, which offer more reliable income and better persistency than ACA? The ACA market is too volatile—caught in political power struggles—and you can lose a client simply because they got a new job with health benefits or got married. I have an ACA plan (self-employed insurance agent) with no subsidies and pay \$550 for mediocre health insurance. I just received notice that my Aetna CVS ACA plan is leaving the Texas market at the end of the year."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m2m8ak/important_aca_changes_to_know_heading_into_2026/n3xleep4/

"Please help! Best insurance in NJ for someone disabled with chronic illness and schizophrenia ASAP!! **NJ FamilyCare, or state Medicaid, is very different from federal Medicaid and I'm looking for people who have understanding of NJ STATE resources rather than federal insurance.** I'm 25F, have a diagnosis of schizoaffective disorder, opioid use disorder on MAT injections and fibromyalgia, and I see multiple providers every month including weekly therapy, bi-weekly medication, zero to 2-3 hospitalizations or inpatient psych treatments a year, monthly suboxone injections, monthly pain management/rheumatology and physical therapy, and like 6-7 monthly medications and bloodwork every 3-6 months for those meds. My insurance migrated to a plan that doesn't have mental health care, so I'm looking for a new insurance on very short notice. I am unemployed and my income is under 23k, but my parents (who make >150k) have agreed to help me financially for the next 6-12 months, so reasonably my budget is a hundred or couple hundred dollars a month. So, I can either go NJ FamilyCare Horizon BCBS, or a private insurance like Aetna PPO or Horizon BCBS PPO or HMO. I have had private, family based top or silver tier PPOs usually Aetna or BCBS sometimes through a third-party employer plan since I was diagnosed years ago, and the provider network is large with the care excellent but it is very expensive, too expensive to reasonably use it the amount I'd like to if money wasn't an issue. Wide network, but extremely pricey, too pricey to fully utilize, and difficult to navigate when claims are denied by the company. Services known as first-line treatments for SMIs such as schizophrenia like ACT, CSC CI and ICMS, case management, day programs or psychiatric rehabilitation are generally off the table and Medicaid/NJFC only. Terrible, TERRIBLE customer service network with no case management, healthcare consolidation, or help when things go wrong with services or coverage and you try to call their phone line. I called a broker through Health Benefits 360 who recommended NJ Family Care as I am in the income bracket and said it's the best fit for my situation with chronic illness, frequent healthcare use, SMI (serious mental illness) and other mental health and substance abuse recovery resources for the most affordable price. However, I've done some research and the network seems much much smaller and I don't know if the quality of these providers is great, good or poor, I had a friend on Medicaid during college who received very poor quality of services, though they were free, and she had chronic conditions, but I don't know if she was on the state or federal coverage. Based on my situation above, can you recommend which insurance would be the best fit for me, even if it's not something that I have mentioned? More than anything, please understand I want to receive good quality care as first priority and have the financial means to not have to compromise on that. It needs to be a widely accepted insurance, either Aetna or BCBS preferably so that my current providers will migrate over, and a plan that CAN be used frequently well and not in a way that rips me off. But in terms of the exact best plan, I could really use some help and ASAP. I need to be ready to switch within this week so that I can start my coverage on October 1st. Also, feel free to recommend websites where I can get connected to a good broker that will help. I need a broker as I am too disabled to complete a long application alone. Specifically, brokers that understand my situation and do both private insurance and Medicaid. COBRA is not an option unless someone knows a cheaper way to receive it. Edit: Just spoke to broker and another option is ObamaCare or ACA-capped insurance. Thank you very much."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · None

"We have the same problem with every type of welfare program in the US. I learned this when I was unemployed for almost a year. When you are unemployed, if you sign up for all the benefits and qualify etc, you are essentially getting a better financial situation in your life for free. You are no longer shaping the rest of your life around the ~40 hours you agree to give up for someone else to determine where you are and what you're doing. You are waking up when you want and deciding what you want to do that day until you fall asleep. A lot of people think it's an exaggeration, there's no way somebody with a full time job has less spending money when everything is said and done than a person who's relying on a fixed monthly check... but it's true. A person who doesn't have a job at all gets: - Free food (food stamps) - Free health insurance (mine was BETTER than the program I signed up for when I went back to work, and I was giving away \$60 of my check for the worse one) - Free money to spend as needed. (Even if the welfare check is less than the paycheck, the paycheck means you're going to lose the free food, lose the free insurance, you MUST spend money on commuting, you MUST deal with all the costs of needing certain items for your job, your clothes and footwear, accessories, tools and accessories, electronics, and often there are many things that come with a job and being obligated to interact with a group or network regularly: lunch, work outings, drinks, coworker's wedding, stuff you don't think of but it ends up happening) So your \$2000 from the government to be spent freely in 30 days of total freedom and complete autonomy and choice in where and when you spend it, even if that's \$2500 at a job; after gas, food, clothes, benefits, work needs, social events, you WILL come up short in leftover money vs. that free \$2,000) The reason people try to stay on these programs for as long as possible, game the system and put off getting a job, find loopholes, and just stay on the government doll and unemployed lifestyle... is because our system is built so that the unemployed person must agree to lose their free lifestyle and become somebody's worker bee to be rewarded with a worse financial situation."

— YouTube · The Pros and Cons of Obamacare · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-VR66gt_AqA&lc=Ugy4lj03D9N-wX6DCix4AaABAg

"Thanks for this video! After watching I immediately went and found my plan. Last year I worked with a broker but this year did on my own. It's so easy to do after my broker helped me year one. I was over insured last year on a silver plan (I never go to the doctor), so changed to a bronze plan for a cost of \$20 more than I paid last year. I do get dental and vision insurance from a part time job which I'm grateful for as I use those. I'm really hopeful this administration can fix our horrible medical system but I think the medical system is just too corrupt for it to be change."

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=UgyABLAHg_JE2KKUUZ94AaABAg

↳ @HappyonMonday (1): "You're welcome! That's awesome! ☺Yes it needs revamping for sure."

"I've also got this plan, thinking it's the best option for copays. I started having some serious bleeding issues & after almost 2 months with no relief, was finally able to have surgery scheduled for a hysterectomy next week. I've activated the procedure & they told me that only the portion paid up front applies to my OOP, and the remaining payments won't. So I'll pay \$2k upfront, for the inpatient procedure, and they're going to deduct \$200x26-the \$5200 isn't applied toward my OOP, I was told, because I basically purchased additional insurance for the specific procedure. So it's like a buy-up. I work in insurance too, so I was pretty confident that all would be safe, but today my Dr's office told me that they can't verify my coverage & I need to activate it. I activated the outpatient procedure last week, per the registration department who told me it's scheduled as outpatient. My Dr wants it inpatient, just in case, so they can't verify it. I called Surest, they had to cancel the inpatient & change it to outpatient, (copay went from \$425 to \$2k, and the deductions went from \$125 to \$200.) I'm starting to believe they deliberately complicate this. "Activation" of the procedure should be left to the provider, who has the codes they're using, and every COMPLETE detail of the procedure, instead they leave it on us to guess which procedures we'll need & leave very little room for error- the words "appeal" & "escalation" have been mentioned in every conversation with the company I've had. These aren't comforting words when we're already worried about our health, now we're also worried about our financial well-being, and the insurance industry banks on members losing patience or being too naive or frustrated to appeal. My recommendation, only select this plan if you're certain you won't need major procedures, this plan design is frustratingly flawed. Away-Pizza-3218, I sincerely wish you the best in your health & recovery, and I hope you're able to get past these issues so it doesn't affect your healing. To file an appeal, you can call them & have them send you the forms. If you don't want to wait for the forms, you can just write a letter to them, but call for the right address to send it to & make sure to keep copies & include ALL the information you can. You only have 60 days if you've already had the procedure, usually, so I hope you still have time to get it resolved. <https://www.healthcare.gov/appeal-insurance-company-decision/internal-appeals/> Thanks for letting me rant, I appreciate it."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/12535jd/my_experiencereview_with_surest_bind_health/jqs6zcv/

"i've been on aca for a couple years. its a bargain for us. my premium is \$900 and my credit is \$700 so i pay \$200 for a gold plan with reasonable out of pocket expenses. thats about \$30 more per month than last year but still the lowest price i have paid for hc in various jobs for probably 25 years. . the left and msm have been banging the drum making people think they are losing the whole credit and it is not the case. but you do have to plan for income, withdrawls, etc. the income cliff you are talking about is fairly high but it is ridiculous that it even exists. if the numbskulls in dc could at least fix that it would probably help a ton of people."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=Ugzapr9LRBXqvx2485p4AaABAg

"Very good point about the COBRA gap @ 15:15 , this exactly happened to me in June of this year after I left my job in mid-May. My HR did let me know ahead of time that my coverage would be effective on June 1st, but I did not get the COBRA paperwork until around June 10th."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgwBLt_m_o9mxm1LI4F4AaABAg

Checking the marketplace and doing the math · 17 documents · 17 voices

"ACA \$1,900 per month on \$5,000 per month income? Is this normal? My husband was laid off last week during the mass tech layoffs. Our insurance was through his company. I own my own business, and net after expenses and taxes \$5,000/month on average. I have variable income. I went onto the ACA marketplace today, entered all of our info, my income, his income zero, our two young children, and I was given a price of \$1,900/month for the cheapest plan with a \$16,000 deductible. How is this affordable on an income of \$5,000? I am not understanding. Should I call? Editing to add that a lot of people responding to my post seem to think I am oblivious to the political situation related to this. Yes, I did write to my representatives weeks ago (but it obviously did nothing because I live in the red state of Kansas. I vote blue and always have because I am a woman who prefers bodily autonomy to the alternative.) I am one person who has zero political power or sway. I am sharing my numbers to see what is happening with others, who are powerless to do anything as well at the federal level to make this better. Just thought I would clarify that for everyone. Also, COBRA for us would be \$3,500/month for a high deductible plan for those who thought this would be a cheaper option."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,646 upvotes · None

"Dropping our ACA plan Today is the day my family is dropping our ACA plan. Our options were to stay on our same plan and be financially strained, or switch to a different plan with an absurdly high deductible. Neither option made sense for us. Luckily, my family is healthy right now. I'm just posting this for solidarity with all the other individuals and families in the same boat. Obviously, not having health insurance comes with a risk, but for us, that risk made more sense than continuing to pay into a broken system. We found a Direct Primary Care (DPC) provider near us, so we know we'll at least have basic, and great care. We are exploring other alternatives as well. Oh, and for those of you who are also exiting the marketplace this year, you must proactively do this or you will be automatically re-enrolled. Happy last day to enroll everyone!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 763 upvotes · None

"Healthcare.gov's Cheapest option is HALF the yearly income?! [Healthcare.gov](<http://Healthcare.gov>) is quoting my partner for their cheapest monthly option being \$605 a MONTH. That comes out to almost half her yearly income. We aren't married yet, so my yearly income isn't factored. There is no way that this is something normal people are paying???"

— r/HealthInsurance · 360 upvotes · None

"Health Insurance 101 - Start here! Hi All! We've put together the following wiki as an attempt to help out with general questions as we approach open enrollment. Topics: * What is the ACA * What is Open Enrollment? * Why Do We Have Open Enrollment? * Why Do You Need Health Insurance * What is the marketplace? * Who is in my household? * What is the APTC And who is eligible? * What is FPL? * FPL and the APTC * How do I know if my state expanded medicaid? * What happens if I don't enroll in health insurance? * What about the tax penalty? * Let's talk about plan structures * What is a Deductible? * Coinsurance? * Copayment * Out of Pocket Maximum * How to pay for your deductible * Short Term Health Plans

What is the ACA? The comprehensive health care reform law enacted in March 2010 (sometimes known as ACA, PPACA, or "Obamacare"). The law has 3 primary goals: 1) Make affordable health insurance available to more people. The law provides consumers with subsidies ("premium tax credits") that lower costs for households with incomes between 100% and 400% of the federal poverty level. 2) Expand the Medicaid program to cover all adults with income below 138% of the federal poverty level. (Not all states have expanded their Medicaid programs.) 3) Support innovative medical care delivery methods designed to lower the costs of health care generally. With regard to your employer, if your employer has over 50 employees, they are required to provide you compliant insurance that meets Minimum Essential Coverage and Minimum Value standards. Your employer also must subsidize at least 50% of the premium to enroll the employees.

What is Open Enrollment? <https://www.healthcare.gov/quick-guide/dates-and-deadlines> <https://www.healthcare.gov/glossary/open-enrollment-period/> The yearly period when people can enroll in a health insurance plan. Open Enrollment for 2021 runs from November 1 through December 15, 2020. Insurance plans elected during Open Enrollment will start as early as Jan 1, 2021. Outside the Open Enrollment Period, you generally can enroll in a health insurance plan only if you qualify for a Special Enrollment Period. You're eligible if you have certain life events, like getting married, having a baby, or losing other health coverage. The follow states have permanently adopted expanded enrollment periods: California: November 1 to January 31 Colorado: November 1 to January 15 District of Columbia: November 1 to January 31 Massachusetts: November 1, 2020 to January 23, 2021. Minnesota: November 1 to December 22, 2020. New Jersey: November 1, 2020 to January 31, 2021. New York: November 1, 2020 to January 31, 2021. Nevada: November 1, 2020, to January 15, 2021. Pennsylvania: November 1, 2020, to January 15, 2021 Rhode Island: November 1, 2020 to January 23, 2021. Washington: November 1, 2020, to January 15, 2021.

Why do we have Open Enrollment (OE)? OE is designed for anyone eligible to purchase on the marketplace to make their elections for 2021. With the introduction of the ACA legislation, you cannot buy insurance whenever you want – this prevents people from enrolling only when they know they need the health insurance, which drives up prices for everyone.

Why do you need health insurance? Medical costs are the leading cause for bankruptcy in the US, and everyone is always healthy until they are not. By enrolling in an ACA compliant healthcare plan, you receive the benefits of a provider network, contracted negotiated rates on services, an out of pocket max which caps your personal spending each year, and other state/federal protections on your healthcare experience.

What is the marketplace and who can use it? Any US citizen or qualifying immigration status (<https://www.healthcare.gov/immigrants/immigration-status/>) may purchase off of the marketplace, even if you have employer insurance.

Who is in my Household? Household = you, spouse, tax dependents. It is not necessarily who you physically live with.

What is the APTC and who is eligible? The APTC stands for Advanced Premium Tax Credit and is a subsidy provided to people with incomes between 100 – 400% FPL if your state has not expanded Medicaid or 138 – 400% FPL if your state has expanded Medicaid. You are eligible for the APTC if your income falls in this range and you have no employer insurance available. If you are Medicaid eligible, you should apply there as you will not qualify for the APTC; however, you are welcome to purchase a full price marketplace plan instead if you prefer.

What is FPL? A measure of income issued every year by the Department of Health and Human Services (HHS). Federal poverty levels are used to determine your eligibility for certain programs and benefits, including savings on Marketplace health insurance, and Medicaid and CHIP coverage. The 2020 federal poverty level (FPL) income numbers below are used to calculate eligibility for Medicaid and the Children's Health Insurance

Program (CHIP). Household Size 100% 138% 250% 400% Income: \$12,760-\$176,091 \$31,900-\$51,040 \$17,240-\$23,792 \$43,100-\$68,960 \$21,720-\$29,974 \$54,300-\$86,880 \$26,200-\$36,156 \$65,500-\$104,800 \$30,680-\$42,339 \$76,700-\$122,720 \$35,160-\$48,521 \$87,900-\$140,640

FPL and the APTC: Income between 100% and 400% FPL: If your income is in this range, in all states you qualify for premium tax credits that lower your monthly premium for a Marketplace health insurance plan. Income below 138% FPL: If your income is below 138% FPL and your state has expanded Medicaid coverage, you qualify for Medicaid based only on your income. Income below 100% FPL: If your income falls below 100% FPL, you probably won't qualify for savings on a Marketplace health insurance plan or for income-based Medicaid. "Income" above refers to "modified adjusted gross income" (MAGI). For most people, it's the same or very similar to "adjusted gross income" (AGI). MAGI isn't a number on your tax return. If your income is between 100%/138% to 250%, you may qualify for additional Cost Saving Reduction credits if you enroll in a Silver Tier plan.

How do I know if my state expanded medicaid? To date, 39 states (including DC) have adopted the Medicaid expansion and 12 states have not adopted the expansion. The following states have not adopted a Medicaid expansion: Wyoming, South Dakota, Wisconsin, Kansas, Texas, Tennessee, North Carolina, South Carolina, Georgia, Alabama, Missouri, Florida.

***Special notes:**
 Wisconsin: Although Wisconsin has not expanded Medicaid under the guidelines laid out in the Affordable Care Act (ACA), the state's Medicaid program (which is called BadgerCare) does cover all legally present residents with incomes under the poverty level. Wisconsin is the only non-Medicaid-expansion state that does not have a coverage gap; all low-income residents either have access to Medicaid or subsidies to help them purchase private coverage in the exchange.
 Missouri: Missouri voters approved a ballot measure on August 4, 2020 which adds Medicaid expansion to the state's constitution. The amendment requires the state to submit all SPAs necessary to implement expansion to CMS no later than March 1, 2021 and for expansion coverage to begin July 1, 2021. Language in the amendment prohibits the imposition of any additional burdens or restrictions on eligibility or enrollment for the expansion population.
 Oklahoma: Oklahoma voters approved a ballot measure on June 30, 2020 which adds Medicaid expansion to the state's Constitution. The amendment requires the Oklahoma Health Care Authority to submit a SPA and other necessary documents to CMS within 90 days of the ballot measure's approval, and for expansion coverage to begin no later than July 1, 2021. Language in the approved measure prohibits the imposition of any additional burdens or restrictions on eligibility or enrollment for the expansion population.

What happens if I don't enroll in a plan during open enrollment? If you don't enroll in an ACA-compliant health insurance plan by the end of open enrollment (December 15 in most states), your buying options will likely be very limited for the coming year. Open enrollment won't come around again until November 2021, with coverage effective the first of the following year. But depending on the circumstances, you might still be able to get coverage after open enrollment ends: * Medicaid and CHIP enrollment are available year-round for those who qualify. * Native Americans can enroll year-round * Special enrollment period if you have a qualifying event

What about the tax penalty? There is no federal government penalty for being uninsured in 2021. People who are uninsured will not face a penalty, unless they're in a state that has its own individual mandate and a penalty for non-compliance. Four states and DC impose tax penalties for not having h"

— r/HealthInsurance · 269 upvotes · None

"My HR just asked me to willingly get marketplace insurance I'm on some very expensive medications. Without this medication I wouldn't be functional and able to work. My HR is setting up open enrollment and just called and asked me to look into marketplace insurance. I've never not had insurance through my job. I understand I'm a liability. Do I have to? How expensive will that be? Will I be able to get my medication? Talk to me like I'm 2 because I have no clue. Thank you."

— r/HealthInsurance · 238 upvotes · None

""Get Covered Illinois"--2026 premium notices sent out today. This year, Illinois switched over to its own program, rather than using Healthcare.gov. 2026 premiums hit the street today. The unsubsidized premium for me and my wife (both in our early to mid-60s) is \$2,915.99, This represents a 17% premium increase from 2025. In Illinois, my carrier, Blue Cross/Blue Shield, had gotten approved for an average 27% premium increase across all of its policy forms; I'm not sure why we got the smaller percentage increase. I had thought that people our age would have been hit with the highest percentage increase in premiums. The automatic renewal letter that I got described my projected monthly subsidy, and my "monthly premium" (in other words, the subsidized premium). I figured out the total unsubsidized premium by adding those figures together. Because of the way that the numbers were laid out in the letter, it appears that the people who run the Illinois program believe that Federal subsidies will be renewed for 2026."

— r/HealthInsurance · 131 upvotes · None

"MOD Comment on ACA and Possible Policy Changes Good Afternoon r/HealthInsurance participants, commenters and friends: While we maintain a rule of no political discussions- we feel we must address the elephant in the room. Change is inevitable, it's a part of life, it's the one thing that's constant. We appreciate your posts and concerns on this and applaud you for thinking about the future. This subreddit is here as a resource to get help with the current rules, regulations and laws. We understand that it is perfectly natural to be curious about what the future may look like for insurance, but until we have some concrete changes, we will not be discussing anything but the current parameters we have to work in. To comment on the possible changes would be purely speculation- I'm sure other subreddits are better suited for these discussions--- and we recognize that they are important ones to have--- however, this is not the place for "what ifs" until we have more direct guidance. If and when any changes do come about- you can rest assured that our dedicated team of Insurance Professionals- Brokers/Agents, Attorneys, Coding Gurus, folks who work on the carrier side, self-taught insurance warriors and educators will be here to help answer your questions and guide you through it. However, we are at a very busy time for insurance- Marketplace Open Enrollment has started, and many people are still in the middle of their employer based open enrollment. So we will ask that we not discuss speculative topics at this time and instead focus our attention and efforts in providing guidance and assistance for those operating in the current regulations. We appreciate your assistance in maintaining a welcoming and politics free zone and hope each of you are well."

— r/HealthInsurance · 95 upvotes · None

"2026 Marketplace or wait until December 14th? I apologize if this has been answered elsewhere. I'm seeking some guidance. Should I enroll now (November 14th) for 2026 marketplace insurance or wait until December 14th on the chance that the enhanced subsidy is renewed? The level of subsidy will impact medical & dental insurance choices. Is it easy to change plans before January 15th if the enhanced subsidy is renewed?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 80 upvotes · None

"Does choosing not to renew marketplace coverage count as a QLE for joining my wife's employer plan outside of open enrollment? My wife's job is a small business that offers a subsidized plan for employees and children of employees. They offer a plan for spouses as well, but it isn't subsidized, so in the past it has been a little more expensive than what I can find on the marketplace. Her open enrollment is in October and when I saw prices this year I assumed I would still be able to find it cheaper through the marketplace. However, marketplace prices were higher this time, but I didn't discover this until after open enrollment closed through her employer. So now I'm trying to figure out if choosing not to renew my marketplace plan would qualify me for a special enrollment period through her employer. I know many of the answers will be "you need to talk to her employer," which unfortunately is easier said than done. Since it is a small business, there is no HR department, there is only her boss (the general manager and one of the owners), and in the past her boss has dragged her feet on answering any insurance related questions until we were practically begging her to reach out to her agent the day before my daughter was going to lose coverage. So I'm trying to avoid asking her boss unless I absolutely need to. It is a BCBS of TN plan if that helps answer my question."

— r/HealthInsurance · 20 upvotes · None

"Imperial problems and ACA So my dermatologist has been unable to communicate with my ACA insurance (Imperial) to get the necessary approval to biopsy some spots. The doctor's office basically came back to me saying they have done all they can do and are giving up and i was "welcome to self pay". I have called imperial to get answers to other questions and have gotten false information or "We don't know and we don't have a department either we or you can talk to to find out". I requested a manager callback and received none. Any suggestions on how to deal with this? Is there some kind of oversight organization or patient advocate organization I can go to to complain? Is there a path to being able to switch insurance via marketplace mid year? I tried calling the marketplace today, but they are closed for the holiday....I intend to follow up there but wanted to also cast a net here in case people have info that can help. Thank you in advance!"

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · None

"Looking to possibly leave my job to start an in home daycare with my wife. The plan is to have my wife start off first while I still work and analyze if the income coming in makes sense and if leaving my current position will boost our income if I help her full time by bringing in more children. The only way I leave is if we work numbers and the amount at the end of every month is more than what I am making right now at a steady consistent rate. The biggest fear factor I have is that I have health/dental/vision insurance for all of my family. Leaving hurts my gut because while I was shopping around for healthcare for my family the least expensive one I found was around 805/month and that was just for HEALTH insurance."

— YouTube · Health Insurance Options for the Self Employed or Are Leaving Your Job · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ceyE3F7SK1k&lc=UgwaUBI9OyGnjyDellN4AaABAg>

↳ @MaximizingEcommerce (3): "Thank you for sharing your story. Depending on your beliefs (and health background), you may want to look into a cost sharing ministry as opposed to traditional health insurance. Regarding the risk, the question I would ask myself in your shoes is whether or not this opens doors to potentially additional profit/income opportunities..."

↳ @thehealthinsuranceguide (0): "Hi Manchester - How is the home daycare working out? Depending on your situation now (since it has been two years) your options may vary, and yes, health coverage can be pricey on the private side compared to a company plan that pays a lot of the cost for you. First check would be to see if you'd qualify for a significant subsidy. If not, or the subsidy is minimal, I'd check out the private underwritten plans. There are a couple that are available with lower premiums and better benefits because you have to be healthy enough to qualify to get on them. Did you get the health coverage all figured out? What did you end up going with?"

"Subsidy Cliff Question for 2026 I'm looking at the new guidelines for 2026 and would appreciate if someone could confirm this for me. My household size is 4, so 400% of FPL for us is \$128,600. I read that for 2026, subsidies will cover any amount over 10% of your income if you're below that. Does this mean if we make \$128,000 for example, that our monthly premium cannot be more than \$1,028/month? For the plan we are currently on, we are being quoted roughly \$2,500/month starting in January. So if we're able to bring our MAGI below \$128,000 will this drop to \$1,028? Is this right?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 2 upvotes · None

"I just found this thread after doing an online search for complaints about Imperial Insurance in Arizona. I made the mistake of signing up for Imperial through the health marketplace, effective January 1. My previous insurance, Banner Aetna, withdrew from the marketplace, so I had to find new insurance. I knew I was taking a chance with an untested insurance company, but everything else was so much more expensive. Well, you get what you pay for. I, too, never received any plan documents in the mail or even via email. Every piece of information about my plan I had to go looking for online. Well I did get a flimsy insurance card with a primary care doc I'd never seen. Changing that to my own PCP with Imperial took multiple calls. But that's not the worst of it. Please see next paragraph. Nowhere in my Imperial portal am I able to access my Explanations of Benefits, nor can I see any information about providers I've seen and what Imperial has paid or not paid for. Contrary to their claims, Imperial DOES NOT send out EOBs to its customers. At all. And they have contradicted themselves because after I complained to them, they actually admitted in an email to me that they only provide EOBs to providers! I'm flying blind here -- how do I know whether the amount on a bill from a provider is accurate and should be paid by me? I jumped through all the hoops and filed a complaint with the Arizona Department of Insurance and Financial Institutions in early March. A couple of weeks later they closed the case stating that "The information we reviewed indicates that Imperial has acknowledged your concerns, and they have communicated their finds with you in written correspondence." Ha. All Imperial did was copy some EOBs (not all of them) and mail them to me. I just hope and pray that I don't have any serious health event this year, as my trust in Imperial "Health" is nil."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1q9bscn/imperial_health_on_aca/odyfwn8/

"I'm in a "silver loaded" state (CO) and it turns out that many/most of the gold plans are both cheaper (monthly premium wise) and have lower deductible/OOP than the corresponding silver plans. Below are two examples-- compare the two blue plans (first is silver, second gold) and then the two yellow plans-- same provider for all four but the gold plans have slightly lower monthly premiums and lower deductible and OOP. So at least check the gold plans in your area to see if this oddity is occurring. Additionally see if there's a way to lower your ACA MAGI to drop below the 400% FPL <https://preview.redd.it/g00ajp8wrgzf1.png?width=2072&format=png&auto=webp&s=f723864e3be1312b28f8b25cd33541ab49abcb37>";

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1op6cfa/income_priced_me_out_of_subsidies_general_advice/nn9dgtn/

"That's horrible, try to see if you can get an off exchange plan, I was paying around \$1500 for a group plan with an Ichra through marketplace (no subsidies) last year got on a private plan with a United Healthcare PPO with a \$7k max out of pocket. We had to get approved with underwriting, (they basically checked prescription records) but it cut my premiums in half to \$780 ish. I used a broker "My Private Health Insurance"

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1txq1je/drowning_in_monthly_health_insurance_payments/oqcf5j2/

"We used a broker for many years and last year they found plans that we didn't even see on the marketplace. We usually get a letter in October from the broker telling us to call if needed. We didn't get that this year. We have always had good luck with brokers and I never felt like they were trying to up charge me. My husband and I have discussed how they make their money, but it wasn't through us."

— r/Obamacare · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1or1c2m/have_used_a_broker_to_sign_up_for_the_last_2/nnnwayd/

"Day 2 into November and I've been too scared to log into the marketplace to see the new numbers. I'm in TN and fall into the gap. FFS"

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1omwh0d/so_how_many_people_are_just_dropping_insurance/nmskfm/

Private Worries

Premiums they can't pay (subsidy loss, doubling) · 30 documents

"Just looked at ACA premiums for 2026. There's no way. My husband (28m) and I (26f) are opting to go without health insurance at this time. If by some miracle the federal government decides to extend tax credits in 2026, then we will reconsider, but with the current outlook for premiums we just can't do it. I feel like crying honestly. We both work so hard and make fine money for our age and where we live. But between a mortgage we were forced into entering (long story, had to do with a landlord going bankrupt) and just general expenses, we can't afford even a base insurance plan. The lowest we were eligible for was \$650 a month and a \$20,000 deductible. The math just doesn't work. I see everyone raising alarm bells about going without insurance, having something catastrophic happen, and then going bankrupt. But honestly? Bankruptcy doesn't sound that bad comparatively. We'd go bankrupt with or without health insurance with those deductibles. I'm trying to have a positive outlook here, and I was really banking on being able to get us a catastrophic plan, but even that is not financially feasible for us. I am honestly in disbelief at the way healthcare in this country is handled. I can't even imagine how it is for people who have it so much worse than us."

— HealthInsurance · 660 upvotes · None

"Healthcare Premiums to Skyrocket (Who Can Afford it?) Premium tax credits are set to expire at the end of 2025, which means premiums will be skyrocketing. How can anyone afford this? Premiums are already so high that so many families have trouble affording them, now they will be even higher? Who here can afford an increase in their premiums? All that this will mean is less people will be insured because they can't afford premiums. Subsidies will be reduced a great deal as well for those at or near the poverty line. The subsidies were allowing folks to be insured because premiums were discounted. Remove or reduce the discount, and those people won't be able to be insured. Healthcare is prohibitively expensive already, and it's about to become even more expensive. How can anyone afford this? My guess is that most people can't. Does the gov know what this will do to families' bottom lines? Concerned,"

— HealthInsurance · 293 upvotes · None

"Help! Husband lost his job and we can't afford insurance through my employer! UPDATE: It is MUCH less expensive to insure all 3 of us instead of just me and my daughter through the marketplace! I can get insurance for all 3 for closer to 450 a month by adding him on the policy. Who knew? Thank you everyone for your suggestions! My husband lost his job yesterday. Our insurance will end on April 1. We are both 44 and we have a 13 year old daughter. He starts his new job next week BUT his new employer will not offer any benefits assistance. We live in Missouri. I checked with my employer and it will cost 840 a month on our plan. I tried Healthcare.gov and it was going to be 930 for the cheapest plan (for just me and my daughter, my husband is going to go without insurance. We are not eligible for Medicaid. Where can we find affordable insurance?"

— HealthInsurance · 159 upvotes · None

"My premium increased 590%. Is this normal? I understand without the enhanced subsidies we'd be seeing double or triple premiums next year. However, my premium skyrocketed. In 2025, I paid \$80 and my premiums are set to increase to \$552. The lowest option available was \$300 for catastrophic insurance which wouldn't work for me. I had to go with the \$450 option. I put that my income was \$730 biweekly after deductions. My take home pay is \$1200 a month. My friend in Florida makes the same as me and her premium only increased from \$11 to \$50. My coworker in Wisconsin is also getting a similar low cost option. I am so confused why my premium increased so much. Did anyone else in Illinois experience this? Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level. Edit: also, my parents are helping to pay part of my premiums for now. Otherwise, I'd be out of luck. Even though I'm grateful, it doesn't feel good having to rely on my parents for this. But knowing my health history I could end up in serious trouble if I go uninsured. Update: After a month on the marketplace plan, I was found eligible for Medicaid so it ended up working out at the end. I was worried since I'd been denied for Medicaid in the past. It looks like the increased premiums finally made me eligible."

— HealthInsurance · 152 upvotes · None

"My healthcare.gov insurance went from \$120 a month in 2025 to \$340 in 2026 because I got a \$1/hour raise... what do I do? 27F, entry level job after graduating college, trying to buy a house and start a family. Bit of a rant here... You saw the title. My healthcare.gov insurance went from \$120 a month in 2025 to \$340 in 2026 because I got a \$1/hour raise. I am flabbergasted. I can't afford to pay over \$200/month more for my health insurance because I make an extra \$160/month?!?! In what world does that make sense?! There is a PCP in my area that does not take insurance, but provides most of the services I require for a \$90/month subscription. It's what I want to go with. They suggested I go with a catastrophic health plan in case of car wreck, etc. He said it should be about \$90/month. When I researched catastrophic health plans, the lowest premium is over \$200/month. I can't afford this AND pay rent AND pay car payment AND pay car insurance AND pay all my other bills AND save money for house/ children/ emergencies. It's safe to say I'm panicking. I payed the insurance for January but I couldn't save anything. I can't keep this plan. I'm currently feeling very defeated by a system that seems to be set up to keep the majority down... I'm so tired of this. Where is universal healthcare? What should I do? Where can I find a catastrophic health plan for around \$100 a month?"

— HealthInsurance · 137 upvotes · None

"Health insurance over 30% of my income It's open enrollment for the ACA right now, and I'm not sure what to do. I applied but the cheapest policy is 200/month more than my current policy. Where's the subsidy? I'm making 17/hr (not being paid over summer - school schedule) my current insurance is over 600/month and the aca is offering over 800/month. I can't afford this. I'm generally panicking because my financial situation changed, and we have a baby on the way. We were expecting to have a higher household income but currently I'm the only one earning. I'm debating canceling the insurance altogether. It won't cover the baby regardless (international stuff - but their healthcare will be covered over there until we bring the baby back). I've got other financial fears I need help figuring out too, but mainly just trying to get my head around the insurance. We don't qualify for medicaid (wtf) we don't qualify to rent an apartment (wtf) I'm debating living in my car if I lose my current housing situation, but when baby arrives it'll need more than a back seat. If I don't have to pay health insurance, then i could do better financially. I have decent savings, but once that's gone, it's gone. If I do cancel, then if something happens where I need care, then I might have to die before the baby is here because I can't afford treatment. I wish I could format my question more directly but I'm kinda overwhelmed and it's hard to write well while I'm all stressed and panicky. I thought when open enrollment came I'd be able to get on a plan that was paid for by the fed, and so I could drop my work coverage. That's turning out not to be the case. Am I missing something? Can someone help me figure out what to do?"

— HealthInsurance · 32 upvotes · None

"If I tell my doctor's office I don't have insurance, can they look up whether that's true or not? Context: I've been on Medicaid (in Illinois) for the last few years. I filled out my redetermination in September as usual, then got a letter at the very end of November that I no longer qualify (my income went up and I'm now at around ~\$25,000/year, before I was hovering right around the cut off, which is about \$21,000 I believe). So now I'm looking at Marketplace plans and man....they are all so so awful!! The deductibles are crazy, and it's basically a choice between paying hundreds a month in order to maybe pay \$20-40 each time you go to the doctor, or paying \$10-\$30 a month but paying \$100-\$300 every time to go to the doctor. I take psychiatric medications that I rely on. I've been stable on the same ones for a few years now. I only see my doctor (psychiatrist) four times a year, and it's basically just as a requirement for her to be able to approve my refills. My psychiatrist's office offers sliding scale for uninsured patients, and I would only need to pay about \$35 per visit with them (plus about \$13/month for my meds with GoodRx coupons). This is a setup I could afford, so I was leaning towards just not buying health insurance at all for the coming year and paying for my care out of pocket this way. HOWEVER. I'm 29 years old, and this year two people I know who are even younger than I am were diagnosed with cancer. My parents got in a very scary car accident about two weeks ago (they rolled down a mountain but are miraculously fine because my dad's car is basically a tank). My point being, life has been reminding me a lot recently that no one knows what's going to happen tomorrow, and I feel like having SOME kind of coverage for if things go horribly horribly wrong would probably be in my best interest. I've also read a lot of reddit horror stories of otherwise 'healthy' young people deciding to forego insurance and regretting it after developing unexpected and expensive illnesses. So. I went back to the Marketplace website to look at the plans again. Found one that's \$6/month, has a \$7500 deductible, and covers almost nothing, *but* would be an affordable fail-safe if, god forbid, something really terrible and/or expensive were to happen. My psychiatrist's office does not take this plan. I called them and basically asked, 'If I hypothetically had insurance that you all don't take, would I still be eligible for the sliding scale cash price?' They told me no, that I would have to pay the full cost of the visit, which would be \$300 each time. This finally brings me to my question (thank for for sticking with me if you've read this far lol): **is there anyway for my doctor's office to *know* whether or not I actually have insurance, if I tell them that I don't?** I don't want to come across as if I'm trying to scam the system (although the healthcare system in the US is a nightmare and tbh I wouldn't judge anyone for doing so). But I just literally can't afford to keep seeing my doctor if it's going to be \$300 an appointment. But I also don't want to forego coverage completely. My ideal way to move forward would be to buy the \$6/month plan for emergencies, and just tell my psych that I don't have coverage so I could pay the sliding scale cost for the appointments. Is this something anyone has experience with?"

— HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · None

"I am so thankful that I am a EU citizen and not subjected to the extortionate health insurance US citizens pay. \$366 per month for health insurance is complete extortion by EU standards"

— YouTube · How We Get ACA Health Insurance Before Age 65? · 9 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xVHorMHIYeM&lc=Ugzwlj_dG_HCp4EXNe14AaABAg

"Well this isnt the case for me. My premiums increased by \$900 a month thanks to the changes made in the new bill passed"

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=Ugw7er9470USJbsd5cx4AaABAg>

"ACA income estimation How does ACA premium tax credits work relative to income estimation? I have never had insurance through ACA. I was terminated a few months ago and unable to COBRA. We are a family of 5. Both my wife and I will try to pick up work/gigs where we can. However with uncertain times, who knows how much money will come in. So when looking at ACA income estimation for 2026, it looks like below a certain amount (for my state of SC) of 37.8k, it has our family ineligible for premium tax credits (but kids would qualify for Medicaid). If I raise income by 2,000 per year, the premium tax credit jumps to 1822 per month from zero for my wife and I. Going from 38 to 40 to 50k, it stays around 1800. Going to 60K it drops to 1656. 70k 1543, 80k 1417, then 90K jumps up to 2465, then starts trickling down again. At 150,601 it drops from 1818 to zero. Can someone ELI5 me the logic of that jump in premium tax credit when going from 80K to 90K? What happens at tax time if I overestimate the income? If I underestimate the income? What happens at re-enrollment next year in those cases? Not looking for debate in the issue, but now I hear that subsidies may not be renewed for next year. But this morning, I read it may only apply to something called a subsidy cliff, and that subsidies will be paid as before 2020. My head is spinning with trying to grasp this."

— HealthInsurance · 4 upvotes · None

"MAGI calculation help Never have had an HSA until this year and I want to make sure I understand its effect on MAGI. I'm over 55 on an ACA bronze plan so that means I can contribute \$5400 per year. To retain my subsidy I have to keep my MAGI at 400% or less of the FPL for a single person. This would be of \$62,600. Lets say my MAGI for 2026 is \$68,000. By my understanding I would take $\$68,000 - \$5400 = \$62,600$ so I would keep my subsidy. If MAGI were $\$68,001 - \$5400 = \$62,601$ and I would fall off of the subsidy cliff... Am I understanding this correctly? I ask all of this because I am shuffling around investment accounts aiming for a MAGI of \$65,000, leaving wiggle room to steer clear of the cliff if I am understanding how this works. Thanks."

— HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · None

"Imperial Health on ACA I just wanted to post about my experience with Imperial which I purchased on the exchange. I have used "Obamacare" since it first started. I was without insurance before that as I hired a broker to find me insurance while I was self employed and because of a medication I took at the time .. no one would cover me so ACA was a god send. Until about 2 years ago .. I never really had medical issues. I visit a doctor 4 times a year maybe and used teladoc but about 2 years ago I got very sick which required emergency room care, paddles to the chest to get my heart working right and 5 days in the hospital. Bill before insurance came to just about \$80,000. Add to that some additional aftercare added later. Insurance did their part and I averted financial catastrophe. Yay ACA!!!!!!!!!!!!!! This year selections on ACA in Arizona seemed far less than usual and the company I had been using was priced out of reach so I selected Imperial Health Gold Standard. It costs me just \$200 less than what my rent does a month but .. When you need it the cost pales in comparison to hospital costs. About a week or so after choosing the plan I got the bill. Paid on November 24. Then .. nothing. I got a receipt but didnt hear anything else From Imperial Health Insurance for weeks. Wasn't even sure I was going to have insurance since I received no confirmation. Nothing. Second week of December I start looking around on the net for information and many of their links dont work. The links that do work point you at websites that look like they haven't been updated since 1990. A little nervous but I figure "hey if removing polished (functioning) websites and extra paper helps keep the cost down cool" Finally I find a number and call only to do the phone chase through different people out of country trying to find out if I am indeed covered for the coming year. I do get my membership number and am assured I will be covered. This took about 3 hours. With it I find my online membership card. I am now HOURS into this. I discover the pcp they picked for me is 60 miles from where I live. I do not live in some remote area. I live in Mesa AZ so I know there must be closer doctors. Problem is, while my last insurance company allowed you to change PCP online .. there was no provision for doing so with Imperial health so back to the phones. A primary reason I selected Imperial Insurance is because on ACA it stated that Imperial health Insurance covered my PCP who I used for 5 years+ and the hospital my doctor was associated with. I got it changed and was told to expect a packet from them with my card and that the first card would have the Assigned PCP and a little later I would get the card with my chosen PCP. The company was a little behind and was just sending out "Packages" And I waited. it was nerve racking as I had always received at least a welcome to the company letter/email something but nothing .. just ghost. No "packet" no nothing. Comes Jan1 .. still no card. Now I already downloaded the card from the site I found but .. not everyone knows how to dig through internet garbage to get to that point and had I indeed needed doctoring on the 1st .. I would have been unable to prove I had insurance. I paid for insurance that would begin on the 1st and had no way of proving I had insurance on the 1st. On Jan 2nd .. I try to call to find out where the "Packet and card were. Automated service said would I like a call back .. Nope I will wait .. Great you are number 250 on line. I guess a bunch of other people were wondering where their card was as well!?!? The morning of the 3rd I picked up my card at the mail. There was a single sheet. at the bottom was a paper thin card. Fine we are saving money. The letter had a brief three sentences that said here is your card and if you want to know anything go to Imperial health . com. There is virtually no useful information at the site they direct you to. You will have to do long term digging from there. Personal .. here is your plan and here is what is covered is not available at that site or its links Had I not started to chase this down earlier I would have had to submit a request to change pcp and wait 24 hrs plus or use the one they gave me which was 60 miles away. No snap shot of coverage no nothing .. here is your card 2 days late and if you want to know anything .. go to our shitty website and try and find out. Luckily I take care of my health so hope to have a year like last year where I used insurance 4 times but if this is their level of organization up front .. I am very concerned what will happen if an emergency arises .. I am not two weeks into Insurance with Imperial Health, cant afford to go without insurance and cant change it but .. If your still selecting for Feb1 start .. I would look elsewhere. This company does not seem to have its shit together and trust me .. when the medical bills start flying .. you need a company that has their shit together. We learned that with my Emergency and with my wifes cancer diagnosis and treatment. I do not feel confident with Imperial health but

wont go without insurance so now I am stuck Edited to add I have been trying this website since I received my membership number so about 3 weeks. This is what I get .. a spinning wheel that says Processing and this will spin forever. Tried it in Brave, Firefox and Edge. None of them can open this page. It contains information about my plan .. I cant see it!? I have been trying for almost a month. I think the site servers are overwhelmed so I cant arrange autopay, see my policy or .. anything but that spinning circle. <https://preview.redd.it/cokxg0a9jkcg1.jpg?width=3060&format=pjpg&auto=webp&s=83258471e1a05666f536b5fd6d325b744f7507d6>";

— HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · None

"Subsidy Cliff Question for 2026 I'm looking at the new guidelines for 2026 and would appreciate if someone could confirm this for me. My household size is 4, so 400% of FPL for us is \$128,600. I read that for 2026, subsidies will cover any amount over 10% of your income if you're below that. Does this mean if we make \$128,000 for example, that our monthly premium cannot be more than \$1,028/month? For the plan we are currently on, we are being quoted roughly \$2,500/month starting in January. So if we're able to bring our MAGI below \$128,000 will this drop to \$1,028? Is this right?"

— HealthInsurance · 2 upvotes · None

"We have been looking at this problem with the subsidy cliff for over 6 months. What would be useful to mention is that if you use an HSA Plan you can contribute 5k3 (including catchup over 55) to this. Remembering an HSA does not have to all be used for Health it can rollover like a Trad IRA. Also Trad IRA contributions can also be used to play with the MAGI (8k6 with catch-up per person). These are great Tools to work for you in determining where you get your income. This now also gives you a problem if you want to convert to a ROTH and have ACA, workout the maths before doing so!"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=Ugwl9ETjMPpxmllBEa54AaABAg

"Please help! Best insurance in NJ for someone disabled with chronic illness and schizophrenia ASAP!! ***NJ FamilyCare, or state Medicaid, is very different from federal Medicaid and I'm looking for people who have understanding of NJ STATE resources rather than federal insurance.*** I'm 25F, have a diagnosis of schizoaffective disorder, opioid use disorder on MAT injections and fibromyalgia, and I see multiple providers every month including weekly therapy, bi-weekly medication, zero to 2-3 hospitalizations or inpatient psych treatments a year, monthly suboxone injections, monthly pain management/rheumatology and physical therapy, and like 6-7 monthly medications and bloodwork every 3-6 months for those meds. My insurance migrated to a plan that doesn't have mental health care, so I'm looking for a new insurance on very short notice. I am unemployed and my income is under 23k, but my parents (who make >150k) have agreed to help me financially for the next 6-12 months, so reasonably my budget is a hundred or couple hundred dollars a month. So, I can either go NJ FamilyCare Horizon BCBS, or a private insurance like Aetna PPO or Horizon BCBS PPO or HMO. I have had private, family based top or silver tier PPOs usually Aetna or BCBS sometimes through a third-party employer plan since I was diagnosed years ago, and the provider network is large with the care excellent but it is very expensive, too expensive to reasonably use it the amount I'd like to if money wasn't an issue. Wide network, but extremely pricey, too pricey to fully utilize, and difficult to navigate when claims are denied by the company. Services known as first-line treatments for SMIs such as schizophrenia like ACT, CSC CI and ICMS, case management, day programs or psychiatric rehabilitation are generally off the table and Medicaid/NJFC only. Terrible, TERRIBLE customer service network with no case management, healthcare consolidation, or help when things go wrong with services or coverage and you try to call their phone line. I called a broker through Health Benefits 360 who recommended NJ Family Care as I am in the income bracket and said it's the best fit for my situation with chronic illness, frequent healthcare use, SMI (serious mental illness) and other mental health and substance abuse recovery resources for the most affordable price. However, I've done some research and the network seems much much smaller and I don't know if the quality of these providers is great, good or poor, I had a friend on Medicaid during college who received very poor quality of services, though they were free, and she had chronic conditions, but I don't know if she was on the state or federal coverage. Based on my situation above, can you recommend which insurance would be the best fit for me, even if it's not something that I have mentioned? More than anything, please understand I want to receive good quality care as first priority and have the financial means to not have to compromise on that. It needs to be a widely accepted insurance, either Aetna or BCBS preferably so that my current providers will migrate over, and a plan that CAN be used frequently well and not in a way that rips me off. But in terms of the exact best plan, I could really use some help and ASAP. I need to be ready to switch within this week so that I can start my coverage on October 1st. Also, feel free to recommend websites where I can get connected to a good broker that will help. I need a broker as I am too disabled to complete a long application alone. Specifically, brokers that understand my situation and do both private insurance and Medicaid. COBRA is not an option unless someone knows a cheaper way to receive it. Edit: Just spoke to broker and another option is ObamaCare or ACA-capped insurance. Thank you very much."

— HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · None

"I would like to drop Medicare all together. My premium went up 80%. I am not getting good Healthcare anyway, so why not keep the money so I can keep a roof over my head."

— YouTube · Health insurance premiums set to soar as ACA subsidies expire · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zWP4luZpu4&lc=UgyE7-6jRJM8rcIf5kt4AaABAg>

"Yes, my Silver plan for my wife and me went from \$561 to \$2314. Even the Bronze would be over \$1800. Can't afford that... 😞 "

— HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pdykti/well_it_happened/ns8u5wp/

"I don't understand why Republicans couldn't improve on the ACA. The parts they claimed weren't working. People can't afford private insurance. Companies aren't paying 100% of the costs of full time employees anymore. For example, individuals pay for their basic coverage and families pay \$700 a month to cover their families at my company. Employees in the lower pay bands qualify for Medicaid for their children or go without."
— Obamacare · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1l9yhzz/while_everyones_watching_medicaid_the_aca_is/n0k7avo/

".... I'm trying very hard not to erupt. 20k. I assume that your husband's plan is an employer plan based on how you framed this. So they are also paying thousands. I guess maybe it is reasonable if you have 50 kids. You do have 50 kids don't you? My ACA which is a decent hmo is \$6k a year for just me. Deductible is 12k and I can reasonably expect to hit it every year. After MUCH consternation they couldn't find a way to avoid paying for an rx for me that runs about 90k a year. I was on it with great results keeping me out of the hospital (mostly) for a year. Then they decided they approved it by mistake and canceled the approval. I got really sick after that and wound up hospitalized repeatedly which they paid tens of thousands for. So that was dumb. My dr did not like seeing me hospitalized repeatedly just to prove to insurance I'm sick so he started giving me pharma samples. We did that for 6 months. So 45k of shots. Eventually the rep said they couldn't keep doing it, which was my greatest fear. I knew it would happen I just didn't know when. It took another few months to get approved for the pharma's 'charity' program. So now they give me the drug for free. I live in constant fear of losing access. There is something very strange that I experienced when they first yanked the approvals where I knew I was going to get very sick and there was not much I could do because the drug was out of reach. I was literally planning to be much sicker. Family wants to see me for Tday and I'm like, well I'm probably going to be a whole lot sicker then, probably not doable to get on a plane. I don't spend much time feeling sorry for myself but I ABSOLUTELY think about a parent that has a child that needs a drug they simply can't afford, and so instead having to watch them struggle. The drug exists. We paid to develop it with tax dollars. We sell it abroad at a competitive price. But it's too expensive for a child in the US to benefit. This disgusts me. At some point, we will decide we have had enough of this system. But I wish we were a lot closer to that point than I think we are."
— HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1jkr7v3/health_insurance_will_cost_us_almost_18000_this/mjzd9dd/

"That's my question too. I get no subsidies. My premium went up 37.5%. I had heard that insurers filed 2 sets of rates, 1 with subsidies, 1 without. But I don't know if that's true."
— HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oonov2/insurance_carriers_increased_rates_on_aca_plans/nn5n7tr/

Paying the subsidy back at tax time · 8 documents

"Paying for ACA (Obamacare) We're about to go on ACA with no subsidies, it'll be about \$20k a year, \$1600 a month. [Healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov/>) hands the billing off to the insurance carrier (e.g., Blue Cross, Oscar, United, Kaiser). Does anyone have experience using a credit card for full yearly prepayment, or split monthly payments (for example using multiple cards to split the monthly payment) with specific carriers?"
— HealthInsurance · 13 upvotes · None

"Need clarification on underestimating income I plan on enrolling my mother in law for 2026 but not sure how to approach her income. I had spoken to broker and I was informed she should show 22k before deductions to get tax credit for 2026. Before I was able to show her income as 2400 a year and get the aca credits. I read posts saying that the repayments of credits are for those who overestimate income not underestimate. Also read the other way around. If I were to sign her up saying her income projected is 22k but let's say at end of 2026 it's 3k. Since the income was underestimated will she need to payback the subsidies? she doesn't qualify for medicaid because she been in USA 2.5 years and you need to be living 5 years to qualify for that"

— obamacare · 5 upvotes · None

"Questions about how to file taxes with premium tax credits for a dependent? My taxes have always been super simple and straightforward. I work full time and have 2 kids, but I don't have employer health benefits and have had Medicaid for all 3 of us since my divorce. My 19 year old son was dropped from Medicaid coverage and I signed him up for an ACA policy through a broker who told me it wouldn't affect my taxes. My son is autistic and is a full time college student. He lives at home and I've always claimed him as a dependent. He doesn't have a job, but did have a little income from a summer internship. But since he has this policy does he have to file taxes? He didn't make enough money last year to meet the FPL for an individual and I didn't earn enough to meet the FPL for a family of 3. I think as far as the federal government is concerned he should still have Medicaid, but we live in a red state that didn't expand Medicaid, so there's no coverage for 18-24 year old students who don't have children. Do I file my taxes as usual with my children as dependents and then file taxes for him with his 1095-a and put that he can be claimed as a dependent? Do I not claim him as a dependent even though he is most definitely a dependent? He's the only one with an ACA policy and I do not know what I'm doing and I'm afraid since he didn't make enough money that he'll have to pay back thousands of dollars in subsidies. Thanks for any advice!"

— obamacare · 1 upvotes · None

"Also self-employed and just dealt with our health insurance today. We are trying to maximize expenses to keep our income under the \$106,000 limit that allows us to qualify for the ACA subsidy. If we happen to make more than that, we will have to pay back the difference. For example, our new plan costs \$2400 out of pocket. The subsidy covers all but \$800. So we pay \$800 monthly out of pocket unless we make more than \$106,000 in which case we have to pay it all back after we file our 2026 taxes. We chose to sign up for an HSA eligible plan to be able to deduct the HSA contributions of \$8750 for the year. It is a ridiculous game that we Americans are forced to play. I am firmly in the "Medicare for All" camp. But our leadership can't seem to do anything to make that happen."

— selfemployed · https://www.reddit.com/r/selfemployed/comments/1pn63ub/us_my_health_insurance_just_doubled_curious_how/nu8wxja/

"Keep in mind if you underestimate your income and then end up above 400% FPL, not only will you have to pay back your subsidies but you might get hit with a tax underpayment penalty. Unless you're going to keep really close track of your income all year, I'd probably just forgo the subsidies. If you end up eligible, you'll get a nice refund when you file your taxes."

— HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1psdio2/if_they_extend_the_subsidies_and_get_rid_of_the/nvad2oz/

"If you are young and making \$40k you will likely get a decent subsidy. Accountants do have an "extra" step when you use the ACA, but it's their job to help you not waste money. I usually give an estimate for my salary and then set aside the subsidy in a saving account should I have to repay the subsidy come tax season. If I get a \$200/mo credit then I'll put that amount in savings. Private plans often require underwriting and this can effect your premiums. The ACA does offer some protection w/preexisting cond for as long as it lasts. Also, many states have laws in place where private ins plans must meet the aca requirements, so many brokers will use the aca when quoting plans. good luck!"

— HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1or63n2/aca_plans_versus_just_enrol ling_through_private/nnpiwd7/

"Thanks! I've always just used TurboTax since 1998, but there was never any situation I was unsure about before. 😂 Fingers crossed I don't have to pay back the subsidy for being too poor."

— Obamacare · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1r5uq2v/questions_about_how_to_file_taxes_wi th_premium/o5lrym8/

"my understanding is regardless of your intent, if you underestimate your income and the actual income would change the subsidy, you have to repay it."

— Obamacare · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1q2sa59/need_clarification_on_underestimating_income/nxgc0si/

Going without coverage and hoping nothing happens · 32 documents

"My family's health insurance is set to go from \$170 per month in 2025 to \$1560 in 2026 due to expiring ACA credits. A few clarifying points: - I earn approx \$125k as the sole provider for my family of 4 - I am self employed - This is the cheapest possible plan I could find anywhere - Coverage for this plan is terrible and helps me exactly \$0 with our family's actual health expenses I don't even know how I'm supposed to form thoughts around this. I can barely breathe let alone wrap my mind around this. How the hell am I supposed to survive in this country the way it is now? It seems like the world is actively punishing people who have families, or anyone who is not a multimillionaire. This is just one problem in a cornucopia of financial disasters handed to me as a millennial parent. This is not even mentioning how the new student loan rulings will add hundreds of dollars per month of financial burden, nor how I will forever be priced out of the housing market and am doomed to ever increasing rent month after month, or how food costs have practically doubled for my family over the past 5 years. How bad is it to go without health insurance in the new year? I literally have no idea what else to do..."

— HealthInsurance · 776 upvotes · None

"Just looked at ACA premiums for 2026. There's no way. My husband (28m) and I (26f) are opting to go without health insurance at this time. If by some miracle the federal government decides to extend tax credits in 2026, then we will reconsider, but with the current outlook for premiums we just can't do it. I feel like crying honestly. We both work so hard and make fine money for our age and where we live. But between a mortgage we were forced into entering (long story, had to do with a landlord going bankrupt) and just general expenses, we can't afford even a base insurance plan. The lowest we were eligible for was \$650 a month and a \$20,000 deductible. The math just doesn't work. I see everyone raising alarm bells about going without insurance, having something catastrophic happen, and then going bankrupt. But honestly? Bankruptcy doesn't sound that bad comparatively. We'd go bankrupt with or without health insurance with those deductibles. I'm trying to have a positive outlook here, and I was really banking on being able to get us a catastrophic plan, but even that is not financially feasible for us. I am honestly in disbelief at the way healthcare in this country is handled. I can't even imagine how it is for people who have it so much worse than us."

— HealthInsurance · 660 upvotes · None

"What you can do if your marketplace premiums for 2026 are too high I've seen this topic come up in recent weeks and want to offer some advice for folks on marketplace plans with premium hikes. This could also work for folks with employer group plans. I realize that this won't work for everyone in every situation but if you've come to a place where you need to consider alternative ways to approach your healthcare costs, this may be helpful. 1. switch to the least expensive marketplace ACA-compliant bronze-level high deductible HSA-eligible insurance plan to cover only catastrophic events like hospitalization. Use this the way you would use your car insurance: sparingly or not at all. Note that going without insurance is a very, very bad idea for reasons that are covered in this sub on a regular basis. 2. Open and contribute to an HSA to get tax savings on money you'll spend toward medical expenses. 3. SKIP DENTAL AND VISION INSURANCE. Honestly this applies to everyone on marketplace plans but dental and vision "insurance" are just glorified payment plans. They are not regulated the same way as ACA health insurance plans so insurers are allowed to charge premiums on those products that guarantee profit margins > 20%. Instead, work with your favorite local dentist and optometrist to pay directly for all your services, and put the money you would have spent on these premiums into your HSA. 4. If you need care: 4a. If you are someone who needs more than 1-3 office visits a year, shop around for a direct primary care provider in your area. Memberships for these are generally pretty reasonable when you factor in what you might have spent toward premiums on a silver or gold tier marketplace plan. 4b. Google specialty care options. For example, Cove offers a monthly membership for treatment of migraines that, when you add it up, is less expensive than a single trip to the neurologist plus a monthly RX from Walgreens. Companies like this exist for nearly everything. 4c. Become a smart shopper for your rxs. There are so many options outside of traditional insurance that can help you save money: GoodRx, Mark Cuban Cost Plus, LillyDirect, Hers/Hims, Nurx. 4d: Think of memberships you may already have that come with pharmacy or healthcare benefits: Costco is an obvious one but comb through other areas of your life. For example, my electric company is a co-op and offers members a discount program for dental, prescriptions, and gym memberships. 4e. Ask your current providers about direct pay arrangements. If you're paying \$200/month in premiums so that your therapist is in-network, but your therapist will happily take \$150 cash per monthly session, you'll come out \$50/month ahead by paying directly. If anyone has other suggestions, because I'm sure I've missed plenty, add them!"

— HealthInsurance · 372 upvotes · None

"Declined my \$10K COBRA plan – how I decided to go uninsured instead I'm 25f in NYC. When I left my previous job in March 2025 to start my own thing, I realized my health insurance premium was over \$10K a year, previously was fully covered by my employer. I decided to decline \$10K COBRA after thinking through this hypothetical scenario: >The Devil tells you there's a 0.5% chance you'll face a life-threatening event this year. If it happens, it could cost \$500K or your life – or both. Would you pay \$10K now just so if that 0.5% hits, you'd only owe \$4K (deductible)? $0.5\% \times \$500,000 - \$10,000 + \$4,000 = \$-3,500$ (P.S. Replace \$500K with whatever major medical cost you'd expect without insurance, and \$10K with your own annual premium. You can probably deduct a few basis points off that 0.5% risk if you're young, eat healthy, and exercise regularly, like me) So well well, I've been uninsured since then. This is how I get by: if you live in the big city, there're urgent cares everywhere. I've self-paid for everything – urgent care (labs, X-ray), annual physical, dental cleaning&exam, OB/GYN, flu shots, prescriptions. My primary care doctor hates insurance, dealing with insurance eats up his patients time, so it was self-paying anyway. I know the risks and I'm certainly not happy about it. But, resonating what others said here previously, I just made the most practical choice I could. We should never accept a system that makes people feel *lucky* to afford treatment for a life-threatening condition... hallelujah"

— HealthInsurance · 357 upvotes · None

"Former employer canceled COBRA health insurance policy without notifying me I just found out my former employer in the state of Washington canceled my COBRA health insurance policy. Not because they notified me, but because my pharmacy called me and said my policy was no longer valid. WTF COBRA is supposed to be valid for 18-36 months and I am fully paid up. I just had major surgery and have PT scheduled in 4 days that has already been deferred for 2 weeks (because I was at my yearly limit of PT) if I don't make the appointment I may never correctly recover and regain full use of my arm. Apparently, my former employer is getting rid of Aetna and getting a new Health Insurance plan from a different provider. So my Aetna policy terminated at the beginning of 2025. Neither my former employer nor Aetna notified me about this, is that even legal? My COBRA provider told me over the phone that my coverage is supposed to switch to the new policy, but my former employer didn't send them the correct documents and that plan is not active for me so now I am stuck with no Health Insurance in need of immediate healthcare. What are my options? UPDATE: I contacted my former employer, who didn't have a good answer for why I wasn't notified. But did state that they had gotten a new health insurance policy with a different company. They then gave me a plan number and group number and told me to use that info to create an account on the website on the new insurance provider. I attempted to do so and the web form said that wasn't a valid policy and refused to let me create an account. After an additional back and forth with HR from my old company they said to call the new Health Insurance provider. So after 30 minutes of being on hold with them, they told me the policy number I had been given was for a different person who happened to have a different first name, same last name, different birthday and different address. Apparently that incorrect info was given to the HR lady at my company by their insurance vendor. After contacting four different companies, and spending more than an hour on the phone I am still without health insurance while needing PT to recover from a major surgery and unable to renew my prescriptions. For those that said this was a simple issue that I could clear up with a quick call to my former employer, I'm calling you on your BS. It's not, and there is incompetence up and down the chain of everyone involved here. FURTHER CONTEXT: I have accepted an offer for a new job (one with better health insurance) and should be starting at the end of the month. I only need my COBRA health plan for another month to get through all the post surgery PT, maybe get a Flu and COVID shot and get my prescriptions for this month. And however long it takes to get the new health insurance actually functional. As such it doesn't feel worth it to sign up for an ACA plan for less than a month of coverage and then have to deal with the overhead of cancelling that plan and setting up another new one. I just want the COBRA coverage they told me would be available for a whole year to actually work. UPDATE 2: I got a different (supposedly correct) policy number from my former employers HR, tried to use that to create an account on Regence's website and it still failed. I called Regence (was on hold for a whole hour) gave them the new policy number and was told over the phone I am actually in their system and I SHOULD have an active policy. I also read back the group # I had been given by HR and found out that was also incorrect (way to go former employer 0/2). I have no way to verify it's functional other than going to PT tomorrow and seeing if they can bill Regence. UPDATE 3: I filled a complaint with the state insurance commissioner, not just for the recent fiasco but also for the situation that caused me to quit my job in the first place where I believe the company may have actually acted illegally. I don't expect anything to come if it but maybe future me will be pleasantly surprised."

— HealthInsurance · 273 upvotes · None

"Health Insurance 101 - Start here! Hi All! We've put together the following wiki as an attempt to help out with general questions as we approach open enrollment. Topics: * What is the ACA * What is Open Enrollment? * Why Do We Have Open Enrollment? * Why Do You Need Health Insurance * What is the marketplace? * Who is in my household? * What is the APTC And who is eligible? * What is FPL? * FPL and the APTC * How do I know if my state expanded medicaid? * What happens if I don't enroll in health insurance? * What about the tax penalty? * Let's talk about plan structures * What is a Deductible? * Coinsurance? * Copayment * Out of Pocket Maximum * How to pay for your deductible * Short Term Health Plans

What is the ACA? The comprehensive health care reform law enacted in March 2010 (sometimes known as ACA, PPACA, or "Obamacare"). The law has 3 primary goals: 1) Make affordable health insurance available to more people. The law provides consumers with subsidies ("premium tax credits") that lower costs for households with incomes between 100% and 400% of the federal poverty level. 2) Expand the Medicaid program to cover all adults with income below 138% of the federal poverty level. (Not all states have expanded their Medicaid programs.) 3) Support innovative medical care delivery methods designed to lower the costs of health care generally. With regard to your employer, if your employer has over 50 employees, they are required to provide you compliant insurance that meets Minimum Essential Coverage and Minimum Value standards. Your employer also must subsidize at least 50% of the premium to enroll the employees.

What is Open Enrollment? <https://www.healthcare.gov/quick-guide/dates-and-deadlines> <https://www.healthcare.gov/glossary/open-enrollment-period/> The yearly period when people can enroll in a health insurance plan. Open Enrollment for 2021 runs from November 1 through December 15, 2020. Insurance plans elected during Open Enrollment will start as early as Jan 1, 2021. Outside the Open Enrollment Period, you generally can enroll in a health insurance plan only if you qualify for a Special Enrollment Period. You're eligible if you have certain life events, like getting married, having a baby, or losing other health coverage. The follow states have permanently adopted expanded enrollment periods: California: November 1 to January 31 Colorado: November 1 to January 15 District of Columbia: November 1 to January 31 Massachusetts: November 1, 2020 to January 23, 2021. Minnesota: November 1 to December 22, 2020. New Jersey: November 1, 2020 to January 31, 2021. New York: November 1, 2020 to January 31, 2021. Nevada: November 1, 2020, to January 15, 2021. Pennsylvania: November 1, 2020, to January 15, 2021 Rhode Island: November 1, 2020 to January 23, 2021. Washington: November 1, 2020, to January 15, 2021.

Why do we have Open Enrollment (OE)? OE is designed for anyone eligible to purchase on the marketplace to make their elections for 2021. With the introduction of the ACA legislation, you cannot buy insurance whenever you want – this prevents people from enrolling only when they know they need the health insurance, which drives up prices for everyone.

Why do you need health insurance? Medical costs are the leading cause for bankruptcy in the US, and everyone is always healthy until they are not. By enrolling in an ACA compliant healthcare plan, you receive the benefits of a provider network, contracted negotiated rates on services, an out of pocket max which caps your personal spending each year, and other state/federal protections on your healthcare experience.

What is the marketplace and who can use it? Any US citizen or qualifying immigration status (<https://www.healthcare.gov/immigrants/immigration-status/>) may purchase off of the marketplace, even if you have employer insurance.

Who is in my Household? Household = you, spouse, tax dependents. It is not necessarily who you physically live with.

What is the APTC and who is eligible? The APTC stands for Advanced Premium Tax Credit and is a subsidy provided to people with incomes between 100 – 400% FPL if your state has not expanded Medicaid or 138 – 400% FPL if your state has expanded Medicaid. You are eligible for the APTC if your income falls in this range and you have no employer insurance available. If you are Medicaid eligible, you should apply there as you will not qualify for the APTC; however, you are welcome to purchase a full price marketplace plan instead if you prefer.

What is FPL? A measure of income issued every year by the Department of Health and Human Services (HHS). Federal poverty levels are used to determine your eligibility for certain programs and benefits, including savings on Marketplace health insurance, and Medicaid and CHIP coverage. The 2020 federal poverty level (FPL) income numbers below are used to calculate eligibility for Medicaid and the Children's Health Insurance

"Thinking of going uninsured for 2026 and paying the penalty.. Thoughts? Im 26 in California, I qualified for medical with my previous job but with this new job I make too much so I was looking at Covered California. For 2026 the CHEAPEST BRONZE plan I could qualify for will cost me \$340 with subsidies included and an insane deductible of \$7000. I think its ridiculous that a healthy 26 year old that eats right and goes to the doctors once a year just for consultation will pay that. Im Seriously considering going uninsured and I understand the potential risks. One bad injury or emergency hospital trip could cost me thousands. But if I get a high hospital bill I could work it out with their financial services department. based on my obligatory expenses I could justify I dont have money to pay this hypothetical bill. My question is: What do you guys recommend? Am I doing the math right? How much would I pay in tax penalties if I make 52k year. Edit*** Thank you guys for all the advice — a lot of you were right to point out how easy it is to underestimate how expensive and financially destructive a single hospital visit can be. That's exactly why I made this post, and I really appreciate the reality check. I ended up finding a catastrophic plan that meets California's standards and has zero deductible, which honestly feels like the best of the worst options right now. This doesn't mean I'm happy about it — I just made the most practical choice I could. We should never have to accept a system that makes people feel lucky just to afford to get sick. But we already normalized this."

— HealthInsurance · 222 upvotes · None

"HDHPs suck if you actually need them. Because our subsidy expired, we are now paying \$1200 a month for 2 people for a bronze plan with an \$8000 deductible per person. CO, both 52, \$160k income. We went from \$1200 buying us great gold coverage to \$1200 and paying for our own care literally overnight. As it happens, for a bit of uterine bleeding, I actually need the insurance this year. All of the procedures I need — ultrasound, biopsy, and hysteroscopy — are subject to the deductible. And after the deductible, they're only covered at 40% by Select Health. What kind of insurance is this? We're basically paying high premiums for the privilege of paying for our own healthcare. This was the cheapest Obamacare option we could find. Where are all the HDHPs with lower premiums? We worked with a broker, and there weren't any. The contract company that employs my husband had an HDHP where the premium was even higher. At these prices, we can't even afford to fund an HSA. We didn't see any HDHPs on the exchange with premium is less than \$1000 a month. How are people affording this? HDHPs are not a bargain anymore, it seems. We make well over six figures, but since so much of our income is going to healthcare premiums, we have to drain our savings over any healthcare we need. And if you have HDHP insurance, you can't even pay a lower cash price to the facility. You have to pay the higher insurance negotiated price, even if you're paying 100% of the cost. And if I want sedation for these procedures (don't even get me started about how painful in office gynecology is), it's even more expensive. So basically, anything between a well-woman visit (free) and cancer (chemo meets that deductible pretty quick) is going to give you medical debt. This is indescribably unbelievable. Wow, this sucks."

— HealthInsurance · 199 upvotes · None

"Have you had ACA coverage before and have to go uninsured now? We're a team of reporters at NBC News curious about those who are on Affordable Care Act coverage and whether they plan to choose to go uninsured with changes in prices to the marketplace. Any responses here won't be included in our work on the topic. We're hoping to speak with folks after their initial comments. We posted previously on cost of denials and appreciate the feedback we received on that front too."

— HealthInsurance · 174 upvotes · None

"Health insurance will cost us almost \$18,000 this year. Please help! My job offers insurance via Aetna and I found out today it's going up again, to almost \$1500/mo for just me, my husband, and my infant. And they already cover 75% of my personal plan, the rest is the family portion. The problem is my husband is self-employed and receives no tax credits or help in the marketplace because a plan is offered through my work. The cheapest crappy plan wouldn't save us all that much, if he were to go get his own plan and leave me and the baby on my work plan. I don't know what to do. That's crippling, it costs more than our mortgage. Should I go down to part time and sacrifice my other job benefits so I'm "no longer eligible" and we can try to get credits/cheaper plan? Do I go without insurance and try to save the money to "cash price" at the doctor? My husband owns a small business so it's not as simple as him just getting another job for the insurance. I have to make a decision in the next two days and I'm so stressed. Location : Georgia, USA Income : \$90,000 UPDATE : if anyone would like an update - we got our health insurance cost down, thankfully. The insurance broker we were working with wasn't as helpful as I expected and told us to mark "no" for tax credits/subsidies. When I did more research (thanks everyone), if it was over 9% of our income, we were eligible for about \$350 credit plus a cheaper plan. When I reached out to the broker to confirm she acted like she didn't realize we'd be eligible 😊 It's only going to cost a little over half what we were looking at after our applications. Moral of the story - do your own research."

— HealthInsurance · 165 upvotes · None

"Help! Husband lost his job and we can't afford insurance through my employer! UPDATE: It is MUCH less expensive to insure all 3 of us instead of just me and my daughter through the marketplace! I can get insurance for all 3 for closer to 450 a month by adding him on the policy. Who knew? Thank you everyone for your suggestions! My husband lost his job yesterday. Our insurance will end on April 1. We are both 44 and we have a 13 year old daughter. He starts his new job next week BUT his new employer will not offer any benefits assistance. We live in Missouri. I checked with my employer and it will cost 840 a month on our plan. I tried Healthcare.gov and it was going to be 930 for the cheapest plan (for just me and my daughter, my husband is going to go without insurance. We are not eligible for Medicaid. Where can we find affordable insurance?"

— HealthInsurance · 159 upvotes · None

"My premium increased 590%. Is this normal? I understand without the enhanced subsidies we'd be seeing double or triple premiums next year. However, my premium skyrocketed. In 2025, I paid \$80 and my premiums are set to increase to \$552. The lowest option available was \$300 for catastrophic insurance which wouldn't work for me. I had to go with the \$450 option. I put that my income was \$730 biweekly after deductions. My take home pay is \$1200 a month. My friend in Florida makes the same as me and her premium only increased from \$11 to \$50. My coworker in Wisconsin is also getting a similar low cost option. I am so confused why my premium increased so much. Did anyone else in Illinois experience this? Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level. Edit: also, my parents are helping to pay part of my premiums for now. Otherwise, I'd be out of luck. Even though I'm grateful, it doesn't feel good having to rely on my parents for this. But knowing my health history I could end up in serious trouble if I go uninsured. Update: After a month on the marketplace plan, I was found eligible for Medicaid so it ended up working out at the end. I was worried since I'd been denied for Medicaid in the past. It looks like the increased premiums finally made me eligible."

— HealthInsurance · 152 upvotes · None

"When I dropped my health insurance, the health system I use now offers me half off on visits. Why could they not do that when I had insurance? So I live in a crappy red state that doesn't support its citizens. When the ACA subsidies were dropped with the help of the clown in the White House, my health insurance went from \$200 a month to almost \$700. I ended up dropping it as work was a little slow and this was a lot of money for something that didn't help much. I had a \$8000 yearly deductible, office visits were higher than they should have been, and almost no drugs were reduced more than the discount card I used at the pharmacy. Basically a lot of money for crappy coverage. Now that I don't have insurance, doctors's visits are half off. Some other visits like urgent care and blood work are half off the full price. Why couldn't I get that price with insurance? It would have lowered the cost of insurance by (I guess) half and I may have ended up keeping it. Why are we being charged an inflated cost with insurance. I feel like I paid more in the end for doctors appointments and such with insurance when you take the high deductible in consideration. It just all sounds like a scam to be and the doctors and insurance companies are in on it together."

— HealthInsurance · 77 upvotes · None

"Is It Better to not Have Health Insurance or Choose a Very Expensive Plan? So these are the issues that we're facing if we have to choose a marketplace plan. Would you guys rather risk it and go without, or pay a lot for a plan? Here's my potential plan with a 50k income: BCBS PPO, 700/month, 9800 deductible, 11000 max oop. It would eat up my income, but if I don't have any major surgeries or a trip to the ER, then I'd be fine without. However, I'd hate to be uninsured if something happens. Realistically, what would you do? Can hospitals negotiate the price down if a bill is very expensive?"

— HealthInsurance · 47 upvotes · None

"Anyone considering a health share in place of ACA? We are a healthy family of 5. I am 30, my wife is 27, and our kids are all under 3. We were paying \$1181 a month this year until our 3rd born came along. Then it went up to \$1580 for the same plan. Now enrolling for next year, they want \$2800 a month for the same plan. It's just not affordable and really doesn't even make sense to buy it at that rate. I don't want to go completely uninsured because of the kids and we have a lot of assets to lose. So instead of the ACA I have been looking at health sharing companies. I know they get a lot of negative flack on here because they are not traditional insurance. But the option isn't really between the ACA. It's between that and having nothing. I have looked at a bunch, Zion health share seems fairly reputable and being that we are younger and have no pre existing conditions, I think most things would be covered. Anyone else in the same boat of looking at alternatives?"

— HealthInsurance · 46 upvotes · None

"[US] How many of you are going without health insurance? Like everybody else my health insurance almost doubled this year, and I'm honestly not sure I can take another (probably) 20% increase next year. It's to the point where I'm sacrificing contributing to retirement to pay for health insurance (I'm 35, healthy, single and literally have never used my insurance) Are there any options out there other than marketplace for those who are self employed?"

— selfemployed · 23 upvotes · None

"If I tell my doctor's office I don't have insurance, can they look up whether that's true or not? Context: I've been on Medicaid (in Illinois) for the last few years. I filled out my redetermination in September as usual, then got a letter at the very end of November that I no longer qualify (my income went up and I'm now at around ~\$25,000/year, before I was hovering right around the cut off, which is about \$21,000 I believe). So now I'm looking at Marketplace plans and man....they are all so so awful!! The deductibles are crazy, and it's basically a choice between paying hundreds a month in order to maybe pay \$20-40 each time you go to the doctor, or paying \$10-\$30 a month but paying \$100-\$300 every time to go to the doctor. I take psychiatric medications that I rely on. I've been stable on the same ones for a few years now. I only see my doctor (psychiatrist) four times a year, and it's basically just as a requirement for her to be able to approve my refills. My psychiatrist's office offers sliding scale for uninsured patients, and I would only need to pay about \$35 per visit with them (plus about \$13/month for my meds with GoodRx coupons). This is a setup I could afford, so I was leaning towards just not buying health insurance at all for the coming year and paying for my care out of pocket this way. HOWEVER. I'm 29 years old, and this year two people I know who are even younger than I am were diagnosed with cancer. My parents got in a very scary car accident about two weeks ago (they rolled down a mountain but are miraculously fine because my dad's car is basically a tank). My point being, life has been reminding me a lot recently that no one knows what's going to happen tomorrow, and I feel like having SOME kind of coverage for if things go horribly horribly wrong would probably be in my best interest. I've also read a lot of reddit horror stories of otherwise 'healthy' young people deciding to forego insurance and regretting it after developing unexpected and expensive illnesses. So. I went back to the Marketplace website to look at the plans again. Found one that's \$6/month, has a \$7500 deductible, and covers almost nothing, *but* would be an affordable fail-safe if, god forbid, something really terrible and/or expensive were to happen. My psychiatrist's office does not take this plan. I called them and basically asked, 'If I hypothetically had insurance that you all don't take, would I still be eligible for the sliding scale cash price?' They told me no, that I would have to pay the full cost of the visit, which would be \$300 each time. This finally brings me to my question (thank for for sticking with me if you've read this far lol): **is there anyway for my doctor's office to *know* whether or not I actually have insurance, if I tell them that I don't?** I don't want to come across as if I'm trying to scam the system (although the healthcare system in the US is a nightmare and tbh I wouldn't judge anyone for doing so). But I just literally can't afford to keep seeing my doctor if it's going to be \$300 an appointment. But I also don't want to forego coverage completely. My ideal way to move forward would be to buy the \$6/month plan for emergencies, and just tell my psych that I don't have coverage so I could pay the sliding scale cost for the appointments. Is this something anyone has experience with?"

— HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · None

"Health insurance Canceled Me I am seeking urgent legal assistance regarding a serious issue with my health insurance coverage through the Marketplace and Oscar Health. I maintained active health insurance coverage throughout 2025 with Oscar Health and paid all monthly premiums on time without any lapse. In May 2025, I also reported a salary change to the Marketplace, and no issues were identified at that time. On December 31, 2025, I was unexpectedly charged \$529 after already paying my premium. When I contacted the insurance company, I was told this was due to a failure to apply my premium tax credit through HealthCare.gov. I was later informed that this was an error and that my correct monthly premium should have been approximately \$35. I was told the overcharge would be refunded. Shortly after, I had a medically necessary procedure scheduled related to a prior kidney condition and surgery. During that same week, I was informed by the provider that my insurance was inactive. I immediately contacted the insurer and explained the billing error. The following day, I was instructed to pay \$157 to reinstate my coverage, which I did in good faith because I required ongoing medical care. I was told the issue had been resolved. However, shortly thereafter, I began receiving notifications that my claims including hospital care, surgery, and procedures were denied. I was then informed that my coverage for 2025 had been retroactively voided. Additionally, my Form 1095-A has been marked as voided, creating significant tax implications. I have now been dealing with this issue for nearly 30 days. I am receiving medical bills and collection calls stating that I had no insurance coverage for all of 2025, despite having paid premiums consistently and followed all instructions given to me. At no point did I provide false or misleading information. The issue appears to stem from a subsidy/tax credit error that was acknowledged and supposedly corrected. Despite this, my coverage has been retroactively terminated, and I am now facing substantial financial and medical consequences. They are saying I didn't have coverage on 2025. Speaking with marketplace and Oscar they don't know the answers...."

— HealthInsurance · 19 upvotes · None

"NC - Can't find a provider through Medicaid; is it fraud to seek medical treatment as a self-pay patient?? Hi Everyone, I'm in NC and recently switched to Medicaid when the expanded coverage went into effect last year. Before that I had BCBS through the insurance marketplace. While covered under BCBS I had a birthmark removed and biopsied (Nevus Sabaceus of Jadassohn) and was advised that if the surrounding area had any changes to size/shape/color post removal to seek treatment immediately. I noticed two days ago the birthmark area had darkened and raised into a small bump. So, naturally, I called my dermatologist to schedule another consultation. When I spoke to them they let me know they don't take Medicaid, so of course my next question was if I can come in as a self-pay/cash patient just for the initial assessment. The nurse/MA I spoke to told me this was considered insurance fraud and I could lose coverage if I do this. So, I spent an hour calling every dermatologist within 50 miles (I live in western North Carolina) that accepted my insurance. ONE of them is accepting new patients, but only with a PCP referral. Okay, progress, so I call my PCP to get one. Nobody picks up. Next I decide to reach out to UHC to see if I can change PCP's since my current one (that was automatically assigned to me) was unavailable. The dude I've been on the phone with for 30 minutes, a member services advocate, and I have now called about 10 PCP's to get set up with a new patient appointment, just so I can get a referral for an issue I know exists, so I can beg the only dermatologist available within a 2 hour drive to please see me as a new patient. Even if it is illegal/fraud to pay cash for medical treatment that could prevent a more serious issue, wouldn't there be some kind of exception for a situation like this? Like, I would take out a loan if I had to since removing it now wouldn't be too crazy, but if I wait until UHC can find me a PCP to GIVE ME A REFERRAL ONLY it would be months, close to a year from now. Additionally I have no issue breaking the law if it comes down to it in the quest to not die of melanoma, I was just wondering if this is actually a thing."

— Medicaid · 16 upvotes · None

"I'm a USA citizen living in Taiwan. I pay ~\$25USD/month for Health Insurance in TW. Crazy part: Out of pocket/no health insurance costs are extremely cheap still with the quality of care being equivalent to care given in USA. (I'm a licensed Healthcare provider in the USA) Example: I had no insurance. Got hurt. Went to the emergency room on a Saturday night to get X-Rays, medicine, physician assessment...it cost me ~\$60USD without health insurance. Conclusion: insurance and administration jobs are rolling in the money at the cost of Healthcare providers & patients."

— YouTube · Health Insurance for Self Employed: Beyond Marketplace Insurance! · 9 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=allOvX_0uhs&lc=Ugy2N2nS-gX2UhhkOMI4AaABAg_9OgzM45MfRL9QZqfF_SlyO

Plan switched or enrolled without consent · 4 documents

"My employer fired me after I challenged them of taking me off the health care insurance Hey everyone. I don't normally post stuff like this, but this whole situation has been insane and I could really use some outside perspective. I also want people to know how easily something like this can happen to them and the. The outcome of having health issues later. I worked for a company called Diamond Blade Warehouse (main office in Vernon Hills, IL, with multiple locations around the country). I was with them for almost three years. I left a different job to work there because I thought it'd be a good fit. Like any job, there were parts I liked good people on the sales side, some solid customers, but behind the curtain, it was a mess. I was a commission-based W-2 employee, meaning if I didn't hit commissions, I didn't get paid. No hourly, no base, no nothing. Just straight commission on a W-2... which already didn't sit right, but I needed the income. Earlier this year, out of nowhere, I was told I'd be switched to 1099. No paperwork, no conversation, no explanation. Just "you're 1099. "They just wanted the "benefits" of a contractor without actually making me one. Then on September 3rd, 2025, I got an email from accounting saying my health insurance coverage would end because they weren't applying my wages to the premium anymore. I replied, politely, that I wanted to keep my coverage and would pay out of pocket. I even jokingly said "I think you'd have to fire me to take away my benefits like that." Within ONE HOUR, my company email was disabled and I got a text message saying I was being terminated for "low sales." Convenient timing, right? And here's where it gets even worse. That same day, the COBRA plan administrator sent me a COBRA election notice that looked like it was printed off Google Images, wrong dates, wrong termination info, wrong deadlines. I tried responding, but their spam blocker was set so strict that my replies bounced. I literally had to switch email accounts just to contact them. They sent me a second COBRA notice the same day, also wrong. I asked for a corrected one and the administrator replied in ALL CAPS, basically yelling at me, demanding multiple months of payment upfront... even though the dates were wrong. Instead of fixing the spam blocker so I could communicate normally, management started relaying messages through my sales manager via text. It was like a weird game of corporate telephone. Completely unprofessional and honestly, absolutely ridiculous. Then comes the cherry on top: Months earlier, my manager texted me saying that the CFO, Bronwyn Jacobson, "didn't want me on the company's insurance" and was sweating him about it. In mid-August, she asked again if it was "ok to take me off." I never agreed. Two weeks later... terminated. I've already filed a complaint with the U.S. Department of Labor (EBSA) for COBRA violations, ERISA interference, retaliation, and misclassification. They're reviewing everything. I'm physically exhausted, financially strained, and emotionally worn down from dealing with this, but I'm speaking up because people deserve to know what companies pull when they think no one's looking. If any Redditors have advice, legal, emotional, or just practical, on navigating this, please drop it below. And if anyone's been through something similar, you're not alone. This one messed me up, and I don't want it happening to someone else."

— HealthInsurance · 105 upvotes · None

"Insurance Bill I Never Signed Up For So I just did my 2025 taxes, and when I first submitted them they got rejected for not including a 1095. I have insurance through my husband's job so this was weird, but I did check my Marketplace eligibility but never signed up for a plan. I ended up including a letter in my taxes that said I checked my eligibility but did not receive coverage from the marketplace. Fast forward to last night. I went to dinner with my mom and she brought me some mail I got from her house. They were bills and delinquency notices from the insurance company Ambetter. Somehow I was signed up for this insurance and these bills were sent to my mom's house, I have not lived there for 6 years. I did some googling and I'm not the only person that has been signed up for insurance without my consent. My question is what the hell do I do?"

— HealthInsurance · 27 upvotes · None

"There are a few parts of this that will cause issues. 1. There were clearly fraudulent brokers who enrolled "fake" people in order to get commissions. It seems like they identified policies that were submitted without a SSN, had never filed a claim, and did not respond to communication. 2. Because of this they are not allowing new brokers/agent to register and enroll people. This is going to cause a massive bottleneck in people who need help enrolling 3. They are adding more hoops to jump through in order to be someones agent and submit applications for them My theory....they are adding hoops and removing resources in order to cause issues with the federal marketplace in hopes to destroy the program or reduce enrollments."

— HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wodklt/please_explain_the_vanceoz_announcement_yesterday/pbm67px/

"I don't know if it's changed, but when I was on the marketplace a decade ago, the application hard stopped if you didn't put in an SSN. So how are there applications without SSN's? Which is one problem I have with the statement they made about it. Also, if they identify problematic brokers, why not kick them off but still allow new brokers to sign up especially this close to open enrollment for the year. This is going to cause a restriction and how many agents are allowed to assist people. I feel like this is just going to hurt consumers more than the potentially fraudulent brokers. Usually, when I heard stories about fraudulent brokers signing people up for the marketplace, it wasn't people that never existed. It was people that came to them looking for plans and then they would either back out of getting a marketplace plan and then the broker still just enrolled them, especially if they qualified for a full subsidy or close to a full subsidy. Or they would encourage people to understate their income so that they would get a bigger subsidy and people would be more inclined to sign up and then get surprised at tax time."

— HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wodklt/please_explain_the_vanceoz_announcement_yesterday/pbmia90/

A plan they can't use: deductibles and networks · 27 documents

"ACA \$1,900 per month on \$5,000 per month income? Is this normal? My husband was laid off last week during the mass tech layoffs. Our insurance was through his company. I own my own business, and net after expenses and taxes \$5,000/month on average. I have variable income. I went onto the ACA marketplace today, entered all of our info, my income, his income zero, our two young children, and I was given a price of \$1,900/month for the cheapest plan with a \$16,000 deductible. How is this affordable on an income of \$5,000? I am not understanding. Should I call? Editing to add that a lot of people responding to my post seem to think I am oblivious to the political situation related to this. Yes, I did write to my representatives weeks ago (but it obviously did nothing because I live in the red state of Kansas. I vote blue and always have because I am a woman who prefers bodily autonomy to the alternative.) I am one person who has zero political power or sway. I am sharing my numbers to see what is happening with others, who are powerless to do anything as well at the federal level to make this better. Just thought I would clarify that for everyone. Also, COBRA for us would be \$3,500/month for a high deductible plan for those who thought this would be a cheaper option."

— HealthInsurance · 1,646 upvotes · None

"Dropping our ACA plan Today is the day my family is dropping our ACA plan. Our options were to stay on our same plan and be financially strained, or switch to a different plan with an absurdly high deductible. Neither option made sense for us. Luckily, my family is healthy right now. I'm just posting this for solidarity with all the other individuals and families in the same boat. Obviously, not having health insurance comes with a risk, but for us, that risk made more sense than continuing to pay into a broken system. We found a Direct Primary Care (DPC) provider near us, so we know we'll at least have basic, and great care. We are exploring other alternatives as well. Oh, and for those of you who are also exiting the marketplace this year, you must proactively do this or you will be automatically re-enrolled. Happy last day to enroll everyone!"

— HealthInsurance · 763 upvotes · None

"Virginia ACA Rates Posted Today: Share Your Increase In Virginia and rates came up today. Self employed couple 59 & 61. This year our premium was \$1187/month. Same plan next year \$2,109/month. This is more than my mortgage payment and a \$922/month increase brings the total yearly cost to \$50,616. We will have to switch to a high deductible low quality Bronze plan with a \$7,500 deductible EACH with a monthly premium of \$1452/month. This is beyond belief. Continue contacting your elected officials people 🙄 "

— obamacare · 584 upvotes · None

"What you can do if your marketplace premiums for 2026 are too high I've seen this topic come up in recent weeks and want to offer some advice for folks on marketplace plans with premium hikes. This could also work for folks with employer group plans. I realize that this won't work for everyone in every situation but if you've come to a place where you need to consider alternative ways to approach your healthcare costs, this may be helpful. 1. switch to the least expensive marketplace ACA-compliant bronze-level high deductible HSA-eligible insurance plan to cover only catastrophic events like hospitalization. Use this the way you would use your car insurance: sparingly or not at all. Note that going without insurance is a very, very bad idea for reasons that are covered in this sub on a regular basis. 2. Open and contribute to an HSA to get tax savings on money you'll spend toward medical expenses. 3. SKIP DENTAL AND VISION INSURANCE. Honestly this applies to everyone on marketplace plans but dental and vision "insurance" are just glorified payment plans. They are not regulated the same way as ACA health insurance plans so insurers are allowed to charge premiums on those products that guarantee profit margins > 20%. Instead, work with your favorite local dentist and optometrist to pay directly for all your services, and put the money you would have spent on these premiums into your HSA. 4. If you need care: 4a. If you are someone who needs more than 1-3 office visits a year, shop around for a direct primary care provider in your area. Memberships for these are generally pretty reasonable when you factor in what you might have spent toward premiums on a silver or gold tier marketplace plan. 4b. Google specialty care options. For example, Cove offers a monthly membership for treatment of migraines that, when you add it up, is less expensive than a single trip to the neurologist plus a monthly RX from Walgreens. Companies like this exist for nearly everything. 4c. Become a smart shopper for your rxs. There are so many options outside of traditional insurance that can help you save money: GoodRx, Mark Cuban Cost Plus, LillyDirect, Hers/Hims, Nurx. 4d: Think of memberships you may already have that come with pharmacy or healthcare benefits: Costco is an obvious one but comb through other areas of your life. For example, my electric company is a co-op and offers members a discount program for dental, prescriptions, and gym memberships. 4e. Ask your current providers about direct pay arrangements. If you're paying \$200/month in premiums so that your therapist is in-network, but your therapist will happily take \$150 cash per monthly session, you'll come out \$50/month ahead by paying directly. If anyone has other suggestions, because I'm sure I've missed plenty, add them!"

— HealthInsurance · 372 upvotes · None

"Turns out my ACA compliant plan is a phantom/shell company Canceling my family health insurance today- turns out it was a total scam Imperial Health Insurance It turns out the insurance provider I have is essentially a ghost network, a shell plan, a phantom policy. 15,000 deductible. Bought through the official marketplace, supposedly fully 'ACA compliant', a bronze plan. First I discovered the doctors that are listed on our cards do not take our insurance. They said I have to call around and try to convince a doctor for husband and I or a pediatrician to take it. NONE have offered or even entertained this. I cannot take my children to get seen at a pediatrician. They both have ADHD. They had ONE provider listed as a child psychiatrist in their network and it essentially does not exist except on a screen. They have three numbers that all route to a voicemail that never calls back. I looked the doctor up and the practice does not exist. The 'cherry on top'? My son broke his arm and they refused to pay for a dime of it because it turns out there are no emergency providers in my county that take our insurance. WTF?! I asked if there were perhaps some in another county? They said no that would be out of network. WTF again?! The hospital/ER took our insurance card and looked at us like we were trying to pull a fast one or something. Like we were presenting a Monopoly or UNO card perhaps. NO medications are covered, except through a supposed online pharmacy that does not answer phones and has a PO Box for a physical address. Why the HELL was I paying \$600 a month for NOTHING? I feel so STUPID. I feel I have failed my family for making such a stupid decision, but I thought it was the RIGHT thing to do. I could've been saving all that and paying out of pocket for services. I want my money back, can I sue them?! TLDR; it turns out my ACA plan is a complete shell plan, a phantom policy, a ghost network that does NOT exist except to collect premiums. Canceling it TODAY. I WISH our employer covered healthcare. Any advice on how to report these fraudsters? It CAN'T be legal what they are doing. It just can't."

— HealthInsurance · 299 upvotes · None

"Thinking of going uninsured for 2026 and paying the penalty.. Thoughts? Im 26 in California, I qualified for medical with my previous job but with this new job I make too much so I was looking at Covered California. For 2026 the CHEAPEST BRONZE plan I could qualify for will cost me \$340 with subsidies included and an insane deductible of \$7000. I think its ridiculous that a healthy 26 year old that eats right and goes to the doctors once a year just for consultation will pay that. Im Seriously considering going uninsured and I understand the potential risks. One bad injury or emergency hospital trip could cost me thousands. But if I get a high hospital bill I could work it out with their financial services department. based on my obligatory expenses I could justify I dont have money to pay this hypothetical bill. My question is: What do you guys recommend? Am I doing the math right? How much would I pay in tax penalties if I make 52k year. Edit*** Thank you guys for all the advice — a lot of you were right to point out how easy it is to underestimate how expensive and financially destructive a single hospital visit can be. That's exactly why I made this post, and I really appreciate the reality check. I ended up finding a catastrophic plan that meets California's standards and has zero deductible, which honestly feels like the best of the worst options right now. This doesn't mean I'm happy about it — I just made the most practical choice I could. We should never have to accept a system that makes people feel lucky just to afford to get sick. But we already normalized this."

— HealthInsurance · 222 upvotes · None

"Income priced me out of subsidies. General advice requested. I'm 61 and recently retired. My income now prices me out of subsidies. Last year my BCBS Silver plan was \$568/month. Next year this plan would be \$1702/month. I'm 61 with pre-existing conditions. I take 7 prescription drugs. I see my PCP once a year, rheumatologist twice a year, and the occasional orthopedist if needed. Last year I spent \$1489 of my \$5000 deductible. Out of pocket expenses were \$2790 out of \$8000. The marketplace yields 52 total plans for consideration. Given my info above, what general advice would you give to me in selecting a plan. Ex — may as well choose a high deductible plan given my past usage. Any guidance is appreciated. I really liked it when I was employed and had two group plan options!"

— HealthInsurance · 186 upvotes · None

"Why isn't there an inexpensive very high deductible plan? So I've seen "catastrophic" plans on the marketplace and the cost is roughly the same as all the other plans which itself doesn't make sense to me. But why isn't there like a \$50k deductible plan that covers nothing until that amount and costs relatively little? It seems unlikely that one would need 20 days in the ICU or be put back together from a car accident. I realize there are ACA regulations that require preventative care but in theory this could be offered as non-ACA."

— HealthInsurance · 169 upvotes · None

"When I dropped my health insurance, the health system I use now offers me half off on visits. Why could they not do that when I had insurance? So I live in a crappy red state that doesn't support its citizens. When the ACA subsidies were dropped with the help of the clown in the White House, my health insurance went from \$200 a month to almost \$700. I ended up dropping it as work was a little slow and this was a lot of money for something that didn't help much. I had a \$8000 yearly deductible, office visits were higher than they should have been, and almost no drugs were reduced more than the discount card I used at the pharmacy. Basically a lot of money for crappy coverage. Now that I don't have insurance, doctors's visits are half off. Some other visits like urgent care and blood work are half off the full price. Why couldn't I get that price with insurance? It would have lowered the cost of insurance by (I guess) half and I may have ended up keeping it. Why are we being charged an inflated cost with insurance. I feel like I paid more in the end for doctors appointments and such with insurance when you take the high deductible in consideration. It just all sounds like a scam to be and the doctors and insurance companies are in on it together."

— HealthInsurance · 77 upvotes · None

"What do you do for Health Insurance? As someone who is self employed, how do you cover insurance? I have a High Deductible Health Plan through the marketplace. My plan this year is over \$1k a month and has a household out of pocket of \$11k before the insurance pays out anything. That means I pay a minimum of \$12k per year. I would have to spend \$23k before any help for medical bills would be provided. 😬 I don't have a PCP because I'm super healthy & 30 years old and almost never see a doctor. If I do have a reason to visit, I run by a walk in clinic and pay out of pocket. I keep the insurance in case of an emergency, but that is SOOO MUCH MONEY just in case of an emergency. Does anyone have any better options?"

— selfemployed · 10 upvotes · None

"This is a phenomenal video as I quit my job and am going self-employed full time. I was offered COBRA for over \$1,000 a month which seems excessive. I'm 28 years old with no major health issues and live a pretty healthy lifestyle. Do you recommend the DPC + Ancillary? Or the DPC + super high deductible plan + Ancillary? Are DPC and Ancillary tax deductible for the business? Or is it just PPO plans? Ideally I'd like to save as much as possible insurance-wise. Thanks for the fantastic informative video!"

— YouTube · How To Get Better Health Insurance If You're Self Employed | TIPS TO SAVE ON YOUR MEDICAL
· 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0eQnHCaWhT8&lc=UgziSV3pZsrOnR-oKh4AaABAg>

"Get government OUT of healthcare and insurance! Back when Obumer first messed with it and caused premiums to start to rise (both ACA and non ACA plans as the new costs for new required benefits, legal and regulatory compliance, etc has to be absorbed via any and all health insurance plans regardless of an ACA plan or not). We went from 3 people being covered on what would be about a "silver" on the ACA or a mid plan was \$238 per month. Today for two people it is over \$1,300 per month and there are areas that are even higher than the state and county / area that we live in. On a per covered basis our health insurance premiums are up 410%. Even a few years ago when we moved from one state to another we paid around \$492 per month....four years later, just over \$1,300. thank you government. Just the insurance premiums and rent (no power, water, food, gas, car insurance or any other expenses) costs me \$40,200 per year and that gets paid with after tax dollars so you do the math. just the fixed cost of a roof and insurance with nothing else and we need to earn around \$47,000 before taxes to cover that. God forbid we want to eat, have car insurance and other insurance, fuel for the car, car repairs, clothing, phone service, etc. Again, great work to the tick in Congress for screwing everyone over rather than just helping the few that need, ACTUALLY need the help. All the fraud out there so far should give everyone some idea of the money we flush down the drain. I wager if it was totaled up it would be around \$500 billion per year or more and that is already after the gubment makes so many other things artificially expensive....college tuition anyone? Nothing my insurance agent loves more than sitting across the table from me as we review the plans that, even after I spend \$16,000 per year on premiums for I still have very high deductibles making it really cost me around \$25,000 before insurance does anything when you add premiums and deductibles together (and no I don't count \$15 off some pharma scrip as mattering). What they need to do is allow, the law prevents this for most people - that's right the government is making it illegal for you to purchase certain types of plans less you fall into a small criteria. what am I ranting about? Disaster style policies. Everyone needs to be able to get those but for most plans you have to be under a certain income or under 30 years of age or just unemployed and need a bridge. My spouse and I don't need all the "benefits" we just want emergency coverage and disease treatment type stuff. There is so much that pad plans, even in hers (and she is almost 50!) still has all this child birthing stuff, breast feeding classes, etc. all for "free" even though she is almost 50 and also can't even have kids in the first place but, same risk pool as everyone else rather than being prices as an individual like with your car insurance."

— YouTube · \$ How MUCH ACA Marketplace PREMIUMS Are Going UP In 2027 · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hOGTkeTtK0Y&lc=UgzNhfDE0RdaDEBn28x4AaABAg>

"What about employer marketplaces? My premium is \$489, my deductible is \$5000, and my out of pocket maximum is \$6550."

— YouTube · Health care premiums expected to rise for Affordable Care Act enrollees · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Bpict0tiNg&lc=UgxGESnkCcsxQ2uipFJ4AaABAg>

"I have an ACA Bronze plan. My deductible is 10k. Since my income is so low I don't have a premium. I save for the deductible. Thos year i was treated for cancer. I paid out my deductible. Its a matter of planning."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgyQuxsBPHJn-s6V9vJ4AaABAg.ARNSP1cymbbsARSGhYOR_ib

"I have a very good broker I've worked with since 2021. For 2026 I went with an Ambetter higher deductible bronze plan with a lower monthly premium then purchased a gap plan from UBA to cover the high deductible should something happen. I am generally healthy and do wellness visits that are covered. So my monthly expense went up from 7.50 a month in 2025 for my Silver plan to 40.00 per month for this selection in 2026. It also has better prescription coverage than I've had in 2025."

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=UgxjMpss4oRZv7Vk8qt4AaABAg>

"Started my LLC a few weeks ago and just signed up for private insurance for 2024. It's not HSA-eligible because it's a PPO, but the deductible is \$7,500. This whole HSA concept was started to help with high deductibles, so I don't see why it matters whether it's a PPO/HDHP/HMO/whatever. My deductible is HIGH, I should be allowed to contribute to an HSA."

— YouTube · How to Get Health Insurance When Self-Employed · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G_eUdFzjUKcw&lc=UgxrOfxKc0RkKNA8xo54AaABAg

"This, exactly this 🍌 . And it's not just the ACA portal, I've been seeing some business paid premiums more than doubling and with ridiculously high deductibles. I keep reading that it's just a subsidy thing and it absolutely is NOT, it's a combination of a shit show of greed. The premiums have skyrocketed since the extended subsidies were put in place, taking those extra subsidies away makes health insurance unattainable for many since they will have rates so high that it just isn't affordable. This entire health care situation, both ACA and employer supported, is completely unsustainable. Any halfassed system we did have is completely and irreparably broken. There is only so much money the working class has left, the billionaires have the majority and still want more but there's nothing left to give."

— HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1onppcm/the_healthcare_system_in_this_us_is_an_abomination/nmz0ucv/

"We're in a similar situation. We pay over 20,000 a year for a high deductible plan on my husband's policy. We've explored alternatives, including purchasing coverage for me through the Marketplace; but our most "affordable" option is to stay on his plan because it is based on pre-taxed income. We've also tried the pay out of pocket approach, and I had a minor health emergency, which cost several thousand. We decided that going uninsured with little children is too risky."

— HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1jkr7v3/health_insurance_will_cost_us_almost_18000_this/mjy0vel/

".... I'm trying very hard not to erupt. 20k. I assume that your husband's plan is an employer plan based on how you framed this. So they are also paying thousands. I guess maybe it is reasonable if you have 50 kids. You do have 50 kids don't you? My ACA which is a decent hmo is \$6k a year for just me. Deductible is 12k and I can reasonably expect to hit it every year. After MUCH consternation they couldn't find a way to avoid paying for an rx for me that runs about 90k a year. I was on it with great results keeping me out of the hospital (mostly) for a year. Then they decided they approved it by mistake and canceled the approval. I got really sick after that and wound up hospitalized repeatedly which they paid tens of thousands for. So that was dumb. My dr did not like seeing me hospitalized repeatedly just to prove to insurance I'm sick so he started giving me pharma samples. We did that for 6 months. So 45k of shots. Eventually the rep said they couldn't keep doing it, which was my greatest fear. I knew it would happen I just didn't know when. It took another few months to get approved for the pharma's 'charity' program. So now they give me the drug for free. I live in constant fear of losing access. There is something very strange that I experienced when they first yanked the approvals where I knew I was going to get very sick and there was not much I could do because the drug was out of reach. I was literally planning to be much sicker. Family wants to see me for Tday and I'm like, well I'm probably going to be a whole lot sicker then, probably not doable to get on a plane. I don't spend much time feeling sorry for myself but I ABSOLUTELY think about a parent that has a child that needs a drug they simply can't afford, and so instead having to watch them struggle. The drug exists. We paid to develop it with tax dollars. We sell it abroad at a competitive price. But it's too expensive for a child in the US to benefit. This disgusts me. At some point, we will decide we have had enough of this system. But I wish we were a lot closer to that point than I think we are."

— HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1jkr7v3/health_insurance_will_cost_us_almost_18000_this/mjzd9dd/

"Hey OP. Before you drop it — "healthy and never use it" is exactly the profile one bad day wrecks. It's not the doctor visits. It's the accident or the scan that comes back wrong. Insurance isn't for the year nothing happens; it's for the year something does. I'm 29 and a self-employed health insurance broker myself (total transparency), and that's the only reason I have it (the big what-ifs) A better question than "should I keep insurance?" is "what's the cheapest real coverage for someone healthy?" Worth knowing: **Private, medically underwritten plans** can be priced based on your actual health instead of averaging you in. Often cheaper if you're genuinely healthy. They can also decline you, so if there's anything in your history, it's usually not the route. **High-deductible plan plus an HSA**. Low premium, and the HSA money is yours — it rolls over and follows you, unlike a deductible that resets every January. **Skip health shares**. They aren't insurance, aren't regulated like it, and aren't legally required to pay anything. People find that out at the worst time. At 35 and healthy, price a bronze marketplace plan against an underwritten private one and compare. Your income decides which wins — under the subsidy threshold, the marketplace math changes completely."

— selfemployed · https://www.reddit.com/r/selfemployed/comments/1w2kg0j/us_how_many_of_you_are_going_without_health/p709m1e/

Lost Medicaid or earn too much for it · 3 documents

"Girlfriend had \$0 monthly premium; now will be \$890. She doesn't make \$700 a month... We're in Alabama. She has BCBS Blue Standardized Silver EPO. I'm not knowledgeable enough to know why, but I'm assuming her premium shot up because of the ACA subsidy cuts. Apparently she is in the "Medicaid gap"... Not entirely sure what to do except tell her to drop it until we can find a better solution, as much as I hate saying that. We weren't planning on getting married, but I'm beginning to consider it so my employer can get her on family coverage under my policy... Next November...."

— HealthInsurance · 780 upvotes · None

"The "Medicaid Gap" is a joke. For context, I live in Mississippi. (And honestly that should already tell you everything you need to know.) (And yes, I already posted this but I didn't realized the rant/vent flair would lock the comments. Whoops! So let's try this again) For the past two years, I've been able to get an affordable marketplace plan with Ambetter. It was the first time I was able to get health insurance since I got knocked off my dad's when I turned 26. (I'm now 31) Without this insurance, I wouldn't have been able to get diagnosed with ADHD, get help with my anxiety and depression, treat my Hypothyroidism and Anemia. Like this has been life changing for me. I work for a small business and unfortunately, I didn't make enough money in 2025 to qualify for the tax credit towards insurance premiums like I have the past couple of years. Which means I'm now expected to pay \$650 every single month for health insurance as a single person with no children. I'm absolutely not doing that because that's not something I can afford. And because Mississippi hates poor people (despite us being the poorest state in the country, but yknow whatever I guess), I now fall into the "Medicaid Gap" as if I was ever eligible for Medicaid in the first place. And because of that, it doesn't seem like there's any kind of affordable options. God forbid we expand Medicaid so the poor people can get health care. GOD FORBID. Luckily it seems like I'll at least be able to continue to afford my thyroid medicine and antidepressants still since I was already on the generic. (Ambetter fully covered Generic and GoodRx says between those two, it shouldn't be too much out of pocket.) But now I won't be able to afford my ADHD medicine and my mental health appointments where I also get my antidepressants and it just fucking sucks, man. I just feel so defeated. I was finally taking better care of myself and now it's about to come to a screeching halt. Anyway, thanks for listening to me vent. I know I'm not the only one in this situation. I'm just hoping something changes for us in the future.



— HealthInsurance · 138 upvotes · None

"Questions about how to file taxes with premium tax credits for a dependent? My taxes have always been super simple and straightforward. I work full time and have 2 kids, but I don't have employer health benefits and have had Medicaid for all 3 of us since my divorce. My 19 year old son was dropped from Medicaid coverage and I signed him up for an ACA policy through a broker who told me it wouldn't affect my taxes. My son is autistic and is a full time college student. He lives at home and I've always claimed him as a dependent. He doesn't have a job, but did have a little income from a summer internship. But since he has this policy does he have to file taxes? He didn't make enough money last year to meet the FPL for an individual and I didn't earn enough to meet the FPL for a family of 3. I think as far as the federal government is concerned he should still have Medicaid, but we live in a red state that didn't expand Medicaid, so there's no coverage for 18-24 year old students who don't have children. Do I file my taxes as usual with my children as dependents and then file taxes for him with his 1095-a and put that he can be claimed as a dependent? Do I not claim him as a dependent even though he is most definitely a dependent? He's the only one with an ACA policy and I do not know what I'm doing and I'm afraid since he didn't make enough money that he'll have to pay back thousands of dollars in subsidies. Thanks for any advice!"

— obamacare · 1 upvotes · None

Lost the job, COBRA too expensive, early retirement · 28 documents

"ACA \$1,900 per month on \$5,000 per month income? Is this normal? My husband was laid off last week during the mass tech layoffs. Our insurance was through his company. I own my own business, and net after expenses and taxes \$5,000/month on average. I have variable income. I went onto the ACA marketplace today, entered all of our info, my income, his income zero, our two young children, and I was given a price of \$1,900/month for the cheapest plan with a \$16,000 deductible. How is this affordable on an income of \$5,000? I am not understanding. Should I call? Editing to add that a lot of people responding to my post seem to think I am oblivious to the political situation related to this. Yes, I did write to my representatives weeks ago (but it obviously did nothing because I live in the red state of Kansas. I vote blue and always have because I am a woman who prefers bodily autonomy to the alternative.) I am one person who has zero political power or sway. I am sharing my numbers to see what is happening with others, who are powerless to do anything as well at the federal level to make this better. Just thought I would clarify that for everyone. Also, COBRA for us would be \$3,500/month for a high deductible plan for those who thought this would be a cheaper option."

— HealthInsurance · 1,646 upvotes · None

"Former employer canceled COBRA health insurance policy without notifying me I just found out my former employer in the state of Washington canceled my COBRA health insurance policy. Not because they notified me, but because my pharmacy called me and said my policy was no longer valid. WTF COBRA is supposed to be valid for 18-36 months and I am fully paid up. I just had major surgery and have PT scheduled in 4 days that has already been deferred for 2 weeks (because I was at my yearly limit of PT) if I don't make the appointment I may never correctly recover and regain full use of my arm. Apparently, my former employer is getting rid of Aetna and getting a new Health Insurance plan from a different provider. So my Aetna policy terminated at the beginning of 2025. Neither my former employer nor Aetna notified me about this, is that even legal? My COBRA provider told me over the phone that my coverage is supposed to switch to the new policy, but my former employer didn't send them the correct documents and that plan is not active for me so now I am stuck with no Health Insurance in need of immediate healthcare. What are my options? UPDATE: I contacted my former employer, who didn't have a good answer for why I wasn't notified. But did state that they had gotten a new health insurance policy with a different company. They then gave me a plan number and group number and told me to use that info to create an account on the website on the new insurance provider. I attempted to do so and the web form said that wasn't a valid policy and refused to let me create an account. After an additional back and forth with HR from my old company they said to call the new Health Insurance provider. So after 30 minutes of being on hold with them, they told me the policy number I had been given was for a different person who happened to have a different first name, same last name, different birthday and different address. Apparently that incorrect info was given to the HR lady at my company by their insurance vendor. After contacting four different companies, and spending more than an hour on the phone I am still without health insurance while needing PT to recover from a major surgery and unable to renew my prescriptions. For those that said this was a simple issue that I could clear up with a quick call to my former employer, I'm calling you on your BS. It's not, and there is incompetence up and down the chain of everyone involved here. FURTHER CONTEXT: I have accepted an offer for a new job (one with better health insurance) and should be starting at the end of the month. I only need my COBRA health plan for another month to get through all the post surgery PT, maybe get a Flu and COVID shot and get my prescriptions for this month. And however long it takes to get the new health insurance actually functional. As such it doesn't feel worth it to sign up for an ACA plan for less than a month of coverage and then have to deal with the overhead of cancelling that plan and setting up another new one. I just want the COBRA coverage they told me would be available for a whole year to actually work. UPDATE 2: I got a different (supposedly correct) policy number from my former employers HR, tried to use that to create an account on Regence's website and it still failed. I called Regence (was on hold for a whole hour) gave them the new policy number and was told over the phone I am actually in their system and I SHOULD have an active policy. I also read back the group # I had been given by HR and found out that was also incorrect (way to go former employer 0/2). I have no way to verify it's functional other than going to PT tomorrow and seeing if they can bill Regence. UPDATE 3: I filled a complaint with the state insurance commissioner, not just for the recent fiasco but also for the situation that caused me to quit my job in the first place where I believe the company may have actually acted illegally. I don't expect anything to come if it but maybe future me will be pleasantly surprised."

— HealthInsurance · 273 upvotes · None

"No longer eligible for medicaid I've (26m) had illinois medicaid for the past 3/4ish years. My redetermination period was to be completed by Aug 2025. I've submitted the redetermination letter through mail last month and called the automated number today to check the status for them to tell my benefits have ended because of exceeding income. I've always done the medicaid application/redetermination including my parents in my household with their income (retirement, neither of them work anymore). Prior to this year, only my father had income through retirement. However, this/last year my mother also started getting retirement benefits which apparently pushed the household income past the medicaid income cap for 3 people. So now I am no longer eligible for medicaid. Have I been fucking up this whole time when doing the redetermination including them in my household? They don't have to file taxes because their total income from unemployment benefits is still low enough where they don't have to so I'm not claimed as a dependent or anything. What do I do moving forward? Do I start an entirely new application on the website with only my information and none of my parents'? Or am I screwed now and have to buy health insurance through marketplace now? Edit: Thanks for the replies/help; I'll reapply without their information. Also, I guess I didn't really specify my financial situation in the original post like I thought I did. I left my job a couple months prior to this whole thing. I then moved back in with my parents shortly after and have been living very modestly though my savings. I don't have an income as of this very moment."

— Medicaid · 30 upvotes · None

"Yep; retired at 61 and controlled my MAGI such that I paid \$0 for a Silver plan. Benefit of being conservative over many years and having enough in brokerage / savings to cover expenses, vacations, etc. for four years before Medicare kicked in. (So now I actually pay more (~\$300/mo) for Medicare + plan premium than when on ACA. 🤔)"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 12 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgyB34wMc6xvo5jGBWJ4AaABAg

"Living off Cash (for a few years) I'll be 53 next year, and would like to quit my job and live off saved cash for 3-4 years before potentially rejoining the workforce. Since my income would be \$0 for those years, how would I go about getting health insurance? When I enter estimates in the ACA, they tell me to apply for medicaid. I also own a house that has an estimated value of 500k and have over 500k in retirement, but I don't want to touch the retirement until I'm 59. Would getting health insurance for my 3-4 years "off" be problematic because of my assets? And, would I have to receive medicaid or is there a way to still get a private insurance plan even with no income? I'm not trying to get "free healthcare," but if my income is zero for a few years, do I even have a choice? Thanks,"

— HealthInsurance · 10 upvotes · None

"Ambetter admitting to missing three P2P's and recording inaccurate data I have Ambetter through the ACA marketplace and have been trying since March to get ivabradine (Corlanor) 5 mg approved for Inappropriate Sinus Tachycardia (IST). The medication was denied, so my cardiologist and I started the appeal process. We submitted multiple documents and were repeatedly told some variation of, "We just need one more document and you should be approved." Over the next few months, I received conflicting information from different representatives. One rep told me my doctor never submitted an appeal, while another confirmed that the appeal had been received. I was also repeatedly transferred to an offshore team that often couldn't locate my account or case information and could only read from a script. Eventually, Ambetter told us a peer-to-peer (P2P) review was needed. My doctor scheduled and waited for three separate P2P calls. On each occasion, they reserved two hours of their time and never received a call from Ambetter. When I questioned this, I was initially told that my physician likely missed the calls. After pushing for escalation, I was given a complaint number and promised a callback. No one ever called. I later reached someone on the escalation team who seemed genuinely helpful. He reviewed the case notes and stated that he could see all three missed P2P reviews. He also found documentation indicating that my physician's office had supposedly been contacted before a P2P had even been approved, which didn't make sense chronologically. He told me he had rarely seen a case file this disorganized and said he would immediately contact the pharmacy medical director. After I was on hold for approximately 90 minutes, the call disconnected. The next day, I called back with all of my reference numbers and complaint information. The escalation team transferred me back to the main customer service line. Pharmacy transferred me back to escalation. Escalation then sent me back to the main line again. At one point, the pharmacy representative called for me and was literally transferred back into his own department. To make matters worse, I ended up in the ER during this process and nearly lost my job because my symptoms remained uncontrolled while I fought through these delays. At this point, I'm preparing to file a complaint with my states Department of Insurance. My physician's office has documentation of the missed P2P appointments. Has anyone dealt with anything similar with their insurance? Beyond filing with the state and pursuing external review, is there anything else I should be doing? I pay \$550 a month for just me. TL:DR: My insurance has no internal workflow/communication, recorded inaccurate data, and has no actual escalation team. I'm at a loss of how to navigate other than filing with the state."

— HealthInsurance · 8 upvotes · None

"I wasn't anticipating making a lot when I quit my job. So I got the government subsidized health insurance and then towards the end of the year I got a new client and made a lot of money and did not make any changes. Low and behold, I owe the government approximately \$2500 back when I filed my taxes"

— YouTube · How To Get Better Health Insurance If You're Self Employed I TIPS TO SAVE ON YOUR MEDICAL · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0eQnHCaWhT8&lc=UgwC9G5F_HnwoQXN6lh4AaABAg

"The ACA was not ever intended for early retirement, so the pain of the enhanced subsidies going away is really self inflicted. Having said that I was really hoping the enhanced subsidies would be extended for the current early retirees but also the ACA was my plan. Now I will just think of another way!"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgzNb723lBr-pBKrcyJ4AaABAg

"Lost my job, I can likely qualify for Medicaid but wondering if it will have bad implications at tax time So I lost my main job this week. I do have a second little 1099 side hustle that's good for about \$400 a month which is only a little over half my mortgage cost and I have some savings I can dip into. My ACA premium ended up being my second highest monthly bill because I estimated my income higher and because of Trump screwing those of us that use the program. My question is can I switch to Medicaid halfway through the without having to worry about paying back the subsidy? I'm applying for Medicaid today but obviously won't have an approval decision before my premium is due on July 1st, so I will probably have to pay my July premium. It would hurt financially to have to keep paying this inflated amount for the premium till the end of the year when I'm no longer making anywhere near that but I don't want to create an even bigger financial headache come tax time. Any insight appreciated thanks 🙏 "

— obamacare · 4 upvotes · None

"I am surprised you didn't come talk to me about this. I think I was on the bleeding edge of this back in 2017 when I retired. Not many knew about this but I did and took it as my early retirement wild card. I budgeted \$1000/month for health insurance back then. I paid under \$100/month for the past 8 years. That's \$900/month budgeted for and available for cruises ;) Retirement is good. Now that the cat is out of the bag I hope it doesn't go away too soon. 4 more years is all I need to get to 65 and Medicare :D Lotsa cruises I can do between now and then on that \$900/month!"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgzByKtz9xl1dgh1A6h4AaABAg

"This is a phenomenal video as I quit my job and am going self-employed full time. I was offered COBRA for over \$1,000 a month which seems excessive. I'm 28 years old with no major health issues and live a pretty healthy lifestyle. Do you recommend the DPC + Ancillary? Or the DPC + super high deductible plan + Ancillary? Are DPC and Ancillary tax deductible for the business? Or is it just PPO plans? Ideally I'd like to save as much as possible insurance-wise. Thanks for the fantastic informative video!"

— YouTube · How To Get Better Health Insurance If You're Self Employed I TIPS TO SAVE ON YOUR MEDICAL · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0eQnHCaWhT8&lc=UgziSV3pZsrOnR-oKh4AaABAg>

"I retired before the ACA, very young. Males in my family don't live long lives, so I shifted "retirement" to occur earlier, before I expect to die. I "retired" before the ACA existed, so it wasn't part of any planning. OTOH, my prior health insurance was \$150/month before the ACA started making it double almost every year. I still had cash savings in the first few years after the ACA was passed, which meant my income/MAGI was below the FPL and full payment for ACA plans was the rule. After a few years of paying \$500, \$600, \$700, then \$800/month for the cheapest ACA Marketplace coverage, finally figured out that my annual income/MAGI needed to appear to be at least the poverty level and had to pick a more expensive plan. After fixing those 2 issues, health insurance became affordable again. The full monthly premium is over \$1200 now, but about \$1150 of that is paid by the Feds, because I control the MAGI. I expect to pay my fair share of taxes, but not 1 penny more. I'm not looking forward to being forced off the ACA and onto Medicare at age 65. Monthly health insurance premiums will raise about 6x, it appears now and that's not counting MediGAP insurance. Definitely need to use the ACA as part of your early retirement plans. Wish I'd realized it a few years earlier before paying tens of thousands to health insurance unnecessarily."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgyB34wMc6xvo5jGBWJ4AaABAg.ARR7yTlcvr6AUGJypnLdby

"Well none of these work for me. 32 years in law enforcement and got great pension, but very expensive health insurance. County give me 600 a month to pay for insurance, but the plans are super expensive. My plan for a family is 2400 a month with a 6000 deduction. Tried Obamacare but I make to much on my pension. Cobra was more then the plans and I would not get the 600 a month if I used Cobra. I do use an HSA to pay for medical stuff and write all the premiums off at end of year so its not so painful. Only choice till 65 is for me to get a job with benefits or just go without medical and use free clinic down the street. Aint America grand!"

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement - Here Are 4 Options · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pjR3wlGOZsc&lc=Ugwz-0YIBEUizzYTHRZ4AaABAg>

"We had to look at this after getting laid off. Private insurance would have cost about \$1200 per month in TX. With ACA insurance was \$2700. We got a subsidy and it will cost us \$0 with a bronze plan costing \$2100. So we left some on the table. I like Trumps idea of giving everyone \$2000 to spend on a plan as we see fit. In our case it would have saved the govt money."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgxKznSrWvTJQXZO4Gd4AaABAg

"We are early retirees.....multiple buckets for income so we are only taxed at \$60,000 level. We pay under \$400.00 a month for Florida Blue HMO with ACA subsidies.....not that hard."

— YouTube · How to Get Affordable Health Insurance Before Medicare · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dVyzw5Ac7pA&lc=UgwMcou1-AaTNPj7HRR4AaABAg>

"My cobra is \$809/mo for health, vision and dental. The unaffordable care act was over \$1200 just for health. To make it even more unaffordable, the deductible was almost twice as high and the out of pocket maximum was also twice as high. I didn't qualify for subsidies but if I did, and got a new job or passed the subsidy income limit, I'd have to payback all the subsidies backdated to the beginning of the year. The unaffordable care act is a joke and is holding Americans back."

— YouTube · Early Retirement Health Insurance Before Medicare: A Step-by-Step Framework · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NAYG0yvvzBI8&lc=UgwK9AXqESWLWO9-PyN4AaABAg>

"Please help! Best insurance in NJ for someone disabled with chronic illness and schizophrenia ASAP!! **NJ FamilyCare, or state Medicaid, is very different from federal Medicaid and I'm looking for people who have understanding of NJ STATE resources rather than federal insurance.** I'm 25F, have a diagnosis of schizoaffective disorder, opioid use disorder on MAT injections and fibromyalgia, and I see multiple providers every month including weekly therapy, bi-weekly medication, zero to 2-3 hospitalizations or inpatient psych treatments a year, monthly suboxone injections, monthly pain management/rheumatology and physical therapy, and like 6-7 monthly medications and bloodwork every 3-6 months for those meds. My insurance migrated to a plan that doesn't have mental health care, so I'm looking for a new insurance on very short notice. I am unemployed and my income is under 23k, but my parents (who make >150k) have agreed to help me financially for the next 6-12 months, so reasonably my budget is a hundred or couple hundred dollars a month. So, I can either go NJ FamilyCare Horizon BCBS, or a private insurance like Aetna PPO or Horizon BCBS PPO or HMO. I have had private, family based top or silver tier PPOs usually Aetna or BCBS sometimes through a third-party employer plan since I was diagnosed years ago, and the provider network is large with the care excellent but it is very expensive, too expensive to reasonably use it the amount I'd like to if money wasn't an issue. Wide network, but extremely pricey, too pricey to fully utilize, and difficult to navigate when claims are denied by the company. Services known as first-line treatments for SMIs such as schizophrenia like ACT, CSC CI and ICMS, case management, day programs or psychiatric rehabilitation are generally off the table and Medicaid/NJFC only. Terrible, TERRIBLE customer service network with no case management, healthcare consolidation, or help when things go wrong with services or coverage and you try to call their phone line. I called a broker through Health Benefits 360 who recommended NJ Family Care as I am in the income bracket and said it's the best fit for my situation with chronic illness, frequent healthcare use, SMI (serious mental illness) and other mental health and substance abuse recovery resources for the most affordable price. However, I've done some research and the network seems much much smaller and I don't know if the quality of these providers is great, good or poor, I had a friend on Medicaid during college who received very poor quality of services, though they were free, and she had chronic conditions, but I don't know if she was on the state or federal coverage. Based on my situation above, can you recommend which insurance would be the best fit for me, even if it's not something that I have mentioned? More than anything, please understand I want to receive good quality care as first priority and have the financial means to not have to compromise on that. It needs to be a widely accepted insurance, either Aetna or BCBS preferably so that my current providers will migrate over, and a plan that CAN be used frequently well and not in a way that rips me off. But in terms of the exact best plan, I could really use some help and ASAP. I need to be ready to switch within this week so that I can start my coverage on October 1st. Also, feel free to recommend websites where I can get connected to a good broker that will help. I need a broker as I am too disabled to complete a long application alone. Specifically, brokers that understand my situation and do both private insurance and Medicaid. COBRA is not an option unless someone knows a cheaper way to receive it. Edit: Just spoke to broker and another option is ObamaCare or ACA-capped insurance. Thank you very much."

— HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · None

"I'm an early retiree and HAD a great plan, until my Mom passed away. She had a chunk of money in Traditional IRA/401k which became an Inherited IRA for me. The "Secure Act" requiring this to be liquidated within 10 yrs along with annual RMD, was not part of my plan. To add, at the 10yr mark I will hit 64, so all the added MAGI will take place prior to Medicare. So now it's a decision between 3 paths 1) Liquidate it all in 1yr. Major tax and health insurance hit for that year. But could keep low ACA for (or even Medicaid) the remaining years. Additional bonus is growth after move (if simply doing "in kind" move for liquidation) is now capital gains instead of income. Also taking it early minimizes likelihood of having IRMA for 2 yrs once on Medicare. 2) Spread it out over remaining years, being careful to not hit the ACA cliff. Will still pay more for ACA, but keeps taxes on Inherited IRA in lower brackets. 3) Some combo of the above. Especially since ACA and Healthcare options may change over the next 8 years. Of course my Roth conversion plans are on hold as of now."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgzszM-kZkW4HY0w2Ox4AaABAg

"I am self-employed and we just lost the insurance that we had through my husband's work because he's gonna work for a business full-time. It does not make sense to get insurance by our self cobra is out of the question it's outrageous and we are a family of three we have a daughter that's in college and we told them we wanted insurance that was comparable to what we had which was United healthcare and it was a PPO, which was pretty decent insurance. The only thing I could find that was even close to that was gonna run us \$2200 a month! That is just asinine. We have decided to go without insurance and pay our Dr. bills as we go."

— YouTube · How to Get Health Insurance When Self-Employed · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G_eUdFzjUKcw&lc=UgxMbjRicce5YKnjQNR4AaABAg

"Obamacare is MUCH cheaper than the group insurance plan I am currently on and has better coverage. I plan to retire at 50 or so depending on how the market performs and the ACA is part of my plan. By weighting my early retirement funds to come from taxable accounts, I lower my income and qualify for nice subsidies."

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement - Here Are 4 Options · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pjR3wlGOZsc&lc=Ugw0XmXuG9A6Z9qjEvZ4AaABAg>

Lead Sources

HealthCare.gov or the state exchange · 20 documents

"ACA \$1,900 per month on \$5,000 per month income? Is this normal? My husband was laid off last week during the mass tech layoffs. Our insurance was through his company. I own my own business, and net after expenses and taxes \$5,000/month on average. I have variable income. I went onto the ACA marketplace today, entered all of our info, my income, his income zero, our two young children, and I was given a price of \$1,900/month for the cheapest plan with a \$16,000 deductible. How is this affordable on an income of \$5,000? I am not understanding. Should I call? Editing to add that a lot of people responding to my post seem to think I am oblivious to the political situation related to this. Yes, I did write to my representatives weeks ago (but it obviously did nothing because I live in the red state of Kansas. I vote blue and always have because I am a woman who prefers bodily autonomy to the alternative.) I am one person who has zero political power or sway. I am sharing my numbers to see what is happening with others, who are powerless to do anything as well at the federal level to make this better. Just thought I would clarify that for everyone. Also, COBRA for us would be \$3,500/month for a high deductible plan for those who thought this would be a cheaper option."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,646 upvotes · None

"My premium increased 590%. Is this normal? I understand without the enhanced subsidies we'd be seeing double or triple premiums next year. However, my premium skyrocketed. In 2025, I paid \$80 and my premiums are set to increase to \$552. The lowest option available was \$300 for catastrophic insurance which wouldn't work for me. I had to go with the \$450 option. I put that my income was \$730 biweekly after deductions. My take home pay is \$1200 a month. My friend in Florida makes the same as me and her premium only increased from \$11 to \$50. My coworker in Wisconsin is also getting a similar low cost option. I am so confused why my premium increased so much. Did anyone else in Illinois experience this? Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level. Edit: also, my parents are helping to pay part of my premiums for now. Otherwise, I'd be out of luck. Even though I'm grateful, it doesn't feel good having to rely on my parents for this. But knowing my health history I could end up in serious trouble if I go uninsured. Update: After a month on the marketplace plan, I was found eligible for Medicaid so it ended up working out at the end. I was worried since I'd been denied for Medicaid in the past. It looks like the increased premiums finally made me eligible."

— r/HealthInsurance · 152 upvotes · None

"My healthcare.gov insurance went from \$120 a month in 2025 to \$340 in 2026 because I got a \$1/hour raise... what do I do? 27F, entry level job after graduating college, trying to buy a house and start a family. Bit of a rant here... You saw the title. My healthcare.gov insurance went from \$120 a month in 2025 to \$340 in 2026 because I got a \$1/hour raise. I am flabbergasted. I can't afford to pay over \$200/month more for my health insurance because I make an extra \$160/month?!?! In what world does that make sense?! There is a PCP in my area that does not take insurance, but provides most of the services I require for a \$90/month subscription. It's what I want to go with. They suggested I go with a catastrophic health plan in case of car wreck, etc. He said it should be about \$90/month. When I researched catastrophic health plans, the lowest premium is over \$200/month. I can't afford this AND pay rent AND pay car payment AND pay car insurance AND pay all my other bills AND save money for house/ children/ emergencies. It's safe to say I'm panicking. I payed the insurance for January but I couldn't save anything. I can't keep this plan. I'm currently feeling very defeated by a system that seems to be set up to keep the majority down... I'm so tired of this. Where is universal healthcare? What should I do? Where can I find a catastrophic health plan for around \$100 a month?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 137 upvotes · None

"Got Cancer, and Long Time Insurance Dropped Me TLDR: Got cancer, insurance terminated, I don't know what to do. I was diagnosed with cancer in May - Chronic Myeloid Leukemia, which is very treatable with expensive meds, but 100% fatal if not treated. I've had CareFirst Blue Cross Coverage through the VA Marketplace from 2022-present. CareFirst saw my diagnosis, and promptly cancelled my coverage with a technicality. I've been digging through the bureaucracy with no success, and don't know if I have legal options to restore my coverage and resume foregone cancer treatment. On July 1st CareFirst (CF) cancelled my coverage, which I first learned of from my oncologist 23 days after termination was apparently complete. My credit card had a fraudulent charge, so I replaced it in May - but forgot my premium payments were on the card, and my premium payment didn't process in June. I received no notification or calls before the letter from CF dated July 15 (although I didn't open it until later). I overnight mailed a check on July 25, and CareFirst (CF) cashed it July 28th. The VA Marketplace sent a eligibility / reinstatement form on July 24th, which CF told me they would process. The CF agents said it was in processing with the enrollment department. I called a total of 16 times between July 23 and this writing. In the 8th-13th calls to CF agents, they repeated the reenrollment was pending with the enrollment department. In my 14th call, they told me that - actually - I have no enrollment request, and that all of the previous agents were just attaching additional notes on the termination file. All previous agents had made an error, and that I needed to restart with the VA Marketplace. The first 13 calls never even started an appeal or reinstatement request. The CareFirst agent informed me that the only way I can restore coverage is to cancel this and reapply. Finally I unenrolled with my VA State Marketplace and applied to reenroll with my same program. Then they did the first clear and quick response of this whole mess: They immediately denied my reenrollment. This doesn't just mean I lost one insurer- they now made me ineligible for other insurance without a qualifying life event. (I've been employed for 3 years employed with a decent salary by a small non-profit that offers only a health reimbursement, thus the VA Marketplace ACA coverage). I cannot access cancer treatments, and am forgoing care. The list price on the cancer drug I need, at my current pharmacy, is far higher than my salary. I found a discount pharmacy that lowers it to about my salary. I will continue paying some things out of pocket, and skipping others, hoping I survive until I can restart 2026 ACA coverage. CareFirst says they sent me one letter in June, but I never received any such letter. They also acknowledge that their billing department never called, emailed, or made any effort to contact me. They cancelled my care without ever confirming I had any notification. Then they made me run a gauntlet of impenetrable bureaucratic mess through confusion and clear, blatant errors (I don't think their agent confusion was intentional deception - just incompetence). CareFirst found I have an expensive disease, and illegally cancelled my coverage. I am at the end of my rope. I am trying every approach possible to get my coverage and cancer treatment restored. Can anyone advise on my options? I see an option to request a written appeal, but that feels like asking the executioner to reconsider, given that they clearly are not acting in good faith already. I talked with some other insurance providers, and they told me I'd be rejected unless it was a Marketplace (ACA) plan that requires acceptance. I can only imagine a few options: * I vacate my condo and move to Maryland to get a 'qualifying life event'. But for various reasons, that would be really hard to deal with while already fighting cancer and trying to keep up with a demanding job. * I have access to a large press contact list, so I could try emailing my story to ~310 reporters, but I feel like that's more vengeful than productive. And I don't have the mental energy to be fielding a ton of media interviews. * I can also get a lawyer, but I'm not sure how much that would change. I don't want to be fighting this forever, I just want to get my health care and live my life. Any advice, especially ideas specific to Virginia? Edit: corrected 'deductible' to 'premium'. Update: I'm doing well now, no thanks to 'Carefirst' Blue Cross Blue Shield. I paid out of pocket for expensive chemotherapy for little while. I also fought and fought, tried to get a lawyer, and eventually realized they had no chance of ever getting me back onto the plan. Ironically, they tried to keep my premium payment that I sent via overnight cashier's check as soon as I realized there was a gap. But restoring my coverage? They wouldn't dream of it. The only way I could get back on coverage was to get married. That was already in the works, but it accelerated a courthouse elopement before our actual wedding. I'm now on my

spouse's coverage, and I am continuing the medications I need, and am relatively healthy. I also feel more comfortable because if they try to drop again it would need to go through a large employer's HR, so theoretically they can't unilaterally drop me. I don't know if this was convenient incompetence, weaponized incompetence, or just an active, unwritten rule to get drop high cost patients however they can. I just know that CareFirst doesn't care, and the system we have in the US sucks. It's more expensive, less dependable, and more difficult to navigate than any other developed country. Thankfully, I'm no longer one of the people this system is leaving without care, but I'm more convinced than ever that this system is the worst."

— r/HealthInsurance · 119 upvotes · None

"Turning 26, being dropped coverage and can't do State Medicaid I'm turning 26 years old, and I'm being dropped from my parent's health plan. I live in PA and have no income. I'm still in Medical School for 1 more year, and they offer no SHIP/healthcare plans of their own. I qualify for PA State Medicaid, but I will be doing several out of state hospital rotations, and they will not accept that I only have a State Medicaid. What are my options? I went to HealthCare.gov, and as soon as I say I have no income, all they do is redirect me to sign up with State Medicaid?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 44 upvotes · None

"ACA rates went down for us?? My wife and I have used healthcare.gov for 4 years now. This past year our rates were \$620 a month. We just Checked and according to healthcare.gov our new rates for the same insurance (ambetter gold tier) is \$295 a month. I was expecting it to rise substantially. We are in Arkansas, 63 and 61 yrs old. Anyone else see a decrease???"

— r/HealthInsurance · 30 upvotes · None

"Insurance Bill I Never Signed Up For So I just did my 2025 taxes, and when I first submitted them they got rejected for not including a 1095. I have insurance through my husband's job so this was weird, but I did check my Marketplace eligibility but never signed up for a plan. I ended up including a letter in my taxes that said I checked my eligibility but did not receive coverage from the marketplace. Fast forward to last night. I went to dinner with my mom and she brought me some mail I got from her house. They were bills and delinquency notices from the insurance company Ambetter. Somehow I was signed up for this insurance and these bills were sent to my mom's house, I have not lived there for 6 years. I did some googling and I'm not the only person that has been signed up for insurance without my consent. My question is what the hell do I do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 27 upvotes · None

"Total healthcare coverage for everyone would be simple. Just switch everyone to Medicare with Plan G. Charge a flat rate and the money would be there and the insurance companies would be cut off at the knees from their current theivery of our money and our tax money thru subsidies. They currently get BILLIONS of dollars in subsidies to cover people. Thru the ACA AND thru the Medicare Advantage plans. That money would be better spent just covering everyone and cut out the damn middle man. The flat fee could be something very small like maybe 50 dollars. Or if that sounds too simple, put it on a sliding scale. or Use the IRMA rule. But this has been so obvious to me since I started getting coverage thru the marketplace and found out that my subsidy is about 1400 a MONTH that taxes are being paid to these scammers. And I have to jump thru all sorts of hoops to just get a damn test."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 25 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgwKReZ8eEKFhxX5ehx4AaABAq>

"If I tell my doctor's office I don't have insurance, can they look up whether that's true or not? Context: I've been on Medicaid (in Illinois) for the last few years. I filled out my redetermination in September as usual, then got a letter at the very end of November that I no longer qualify (my income went up and I'm now at around ~\$25,000/year, before I was hovering right around the cut off, which is about \$21,000 I believe). So now I'm looking at Marketplace plans and man....they are all so so awful!! The deductibles are crazy, and it's basically a choice between paying hundreds a month in order to maybe pay \$20-40 each time you go to the doctor, or paying \$10-\$30 a month but paying \$100-\$300 every time to go to the doctor. I take psychiatric medications that I rely on. I've been stable on the same ones for a few years now. I only see my doctor (psychiatrist) four times a year, and it's basically just as a requirement for her to be able to approve my refills. My psychiatrist's office offers sliding scale for uninsured patients, and I would only need to pay about \$35 per visit with them (plus about \$13/month for my meds with GoodRx coupons). This is a setup I could afford, so I was leaning towards just not buying health insurance at all for the coming year and paying for my care out of pocket this way. HOWEVER. I'm 29 years old, and this year two people I know who are even younger than I am were diagnosed with cancer. My parents got in a very scary car accident about two weeks ago (they rolled down a mountain but are miraculously fine because my dad's car is basically a tank). My point being, life has been reminding me a lot recently that no one knows what's going to happen tomorrow, and I feel like having SOME kind of coverage for if things go horribly horribly wrong would probably be in my best interest. I've also read a lot of reddit horror stories of otherwise 'healthy' young people deciding to forego insurance and regretting it after developing unexpected and expensive illnesses. So. I went back to the Marketplace website to look at the plans again. Found one that's \$6/month, has a \$7500 deductible, and covers almost nothing, *but* would be an affordable fail-safe if, god forbid, something really terrible and/or expensive were to happen. My psychiatrist's office does not take this plan. I called them and basically asked, 'If I hypothetically had insurance that you all don't take, would I still be eligible for the sliding scale cash price?' They told me no, that I would have to pay the full cost of the visit, which would be \$300 each time. This finally brings me to my question (thank for for sticking with me if you've read this far lol): **is there anyway for my doctor's office to *know* whether or not I actually have insurance, if I tell them that I don't?** I don't want to come across as if I'm trying to scam the system (although the healthcare system in the US is a nightmare and tbh I wouldn't judge anyone for doing so). But I just literally can't afford to keep seeing my doctor if it's going to be \$300 an appointment. But I also don't want to forego coverage completely. My ideal way to move forward would be to buy the \$6/month plan for emergencies, and just tell my psych that I don't have coverage so I could pay the sliding scale cost for the appointments. Is this something anyone has experience with?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · None

"Health insurance Canceled Me I am seeking urgent legal assistance regarding a serious issue with my health insurance coverage through the Marketplace and Oscar Health. I maintained active health insurance coverage throughout 2025 with Oscar Health and paid all monthly premiums on time without any lapse. In May 2025, I also reported a salary change to the Marketplace, and no issues were identified at that time. On December 31, 2025, I was unexpectedly charged \$529 after already paying my premium. When I contacted the insurance company, I was told this was due to a failure to apply my premium tax credit through HealthCare.gov. I was later informed that this was an error and that my correct monthly premium should have been approximately \$35. I was told the overcharge would be refunded. Shortly after, I had a medically necessary procedure scheduled related to a prior kidney condition and surgery. During that same week, I was informed by the provider that my insurance was inactive. I immediately contacted the insurer and explained the billing error. The following day, I was instructed to pay \$157 to reinstate my coverage, which I did in good faith because I required ongoing medical care. I was told the issue had been resolved. However, shortly thereafter, I began receiving notifications that my claims including hospital care, surgery, and procedures were denied. I was then informed that my coverage for 2025 had been retroactively voided. Additionally, my Form 1095-A has been marked as voided, creating significant tax implications. I have now been dealing with this issue for nearly 30 days. I am receiving medical bills and collection calls stating that I had no insurance coverage for all of 2025, despite having paid premiums consistently and followed all instructions given to me. At no point did I provide false or misleading information. The issue appears to stem from a subsidy/tax credit error that was acknowledged and supposedly corrected. Despite this, my coverage has been retroactively terminated, and I am now facing substantial financial and medical consequences. They are saying I didn't have coverage on 2025. Speaking with marketplace and Oscar they don't know the answers...."

— r/HealthInsurance · 19 upvotes · None

"Medicaid nightmare So I have Missouri Medicaid for my wife and daughter (1 year old). When my daughter was born, we decided it was best for my wife to stay home. So we needed insurance. I went to Marketplace to look, and told me I had to apply for chip/medicaid before proceeding. So I called, spent 7 hours on hold, got ahold of someone, they asked me all the questions and I gave them all our information and income info they needed. Two months later, I received a letter saying they're accepted. Fast forward to July, I get a small raise. I go to my local DSS office and report an income change within 10 days, filled it out in the buy and turned it in before leaving. Never hear anything so I assumed it was still within the limit. Get a letter a couple weeks ago saying we make too much and my wife and daughters plans were being changed. I always expected that but never understood how they qualified to begin with while I always made over \$65k/yr. Turns out when I called to get the details on their new plan, they tell me they only have 1 job out of three jobs I have, only making \$409 a month? They didn't even have any records of my full time job despite filling out an income increase form in office TWICE. Plus they only put down the first letter of my first name so identity issues was always a problem also. So now I'm scared they will think I committed fraud when I've been nothing but upfront with them from the beginning. Them over the phone and in the office haven't been documenting my info properly or at all."

— r/Medicaid · 18 upvotes · None

"Health Insurance Carrier strongly recommending that I don't purchase insurance through healthcare.gov I just got off the phone with sales agent of the largest health insurance carrier in my state. I had previously applied through healthcare.gov and confirmed that I was ineligible for any tax credits/subsidies but found a plan I like. I then contact the health insurer directly to see if there was any difference in premiums by applying directly through them. The price is identical but I was told to purchase the plan directly anyway because there could be "miscommunication" between the marketplace exchange and the insurer. That seemed odd to me. As someone who supports the ACA and wants to ensure it lasts and improves, I would like to enroll through healthcare.gov. My thinking is that the program's success is measured in part by the number of users who shop/purchase through healthcare.gov. Is there any real downside to using the marketplace exchange?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 16 upvotes · None

The carrier directly (Ambetter, Oscar, BCBS...) · 11 documents

"Health insurance will cost us almost \$18,000 this year. Please help! My job offers insurance via Aetna and I found out today it's going up again, to almost \$1500/mo for just me, my husband, and my infant. And they already cover 75% of my personal plan, the rest is the family portion. The problem is my husband is self-employed and receives no tax credits or help in the marketplace because a plan is offered through my work. The cheapest crappy plan wouldn't save us all that much, if he were to go get his own plan and leave me and the baby on my work plan. I don't know what to do. That's crippling, it costs more than our mortgage. Should I go down to part time and sacrifice my other job benefits so I'm "no longer eligible" and we can try to get credits/cheaper plan? Do I go without insurance and try to save the money to "cash price" at the doctor? My husband owns a small business so it's not as simple as him just getting another job for the insurance. I have to make a decision in the next two days and I'm so stressed. Location : Georgia, USA Income : \$90,000 UPDATE : if anyone would like an update - we got our health insurance cost down, thankfully. The insurance broker we were working with wasn't as helpful as I expected and told us to mark "no" for tax credits/subsidies. When I did more research (thanks everyone), if it was over 9% of our income, we were eligible for about \$350 credit plus a cheaper plan. When I reached out to the broker to confirm she acted like she didn't realize we'd be eligible 😊 It's only going to cost a little over half what we were looking at after our applications. Moral of the story - do your own research."

— r/HealthInsurance · 165 upvotes · None

""Get Covered Illinois"--2026 premium notices sent out today. This year, Illinois switched over to its own program, rather than using Healthcare.gov. 2026 premiums hit the street today. The unsubsidized premium for me and my wife (both in our early to mid-60s) is \$2,915.99, This represents a 17% premium increase from 2025. In Illinois, my carrier, Blue Cross/Blue Shield, had gotten approved for an average 27% premium increase across all of its policy forms; I'm not sure why we got the smaller percentage increase. I had thought that people our age would have been hit with the highest percentage increase in premiums. The automatic renewal letter that I got described my projected monthly subsidy, and my "monthly premium" (in other words, the subsidized premium). I figured out the total unsubsidized premium by adding those figures together. Because of the way that the numbers were laid out in the letter, it appears that the people who run the Illinois program believe that Federal subsidies will be renewed for 2026."

— r/HealthInsurance · 131 upvotes · None

"Is my therapist scamming me? (updated below) First of all I am in therapy partly for trust issues and paranoia with women. So keep that in mind. I have Anthem bronze pathway epo in California. (I just chose the cheapest possible plan. \$741 😬) The insurance only covers in network providers. I met my out of pocket max and the EOBs say I owe \$0 now. I just realized that my credit card has also been getting charged \$200 per session by the therapist. Based on the emails I agreed to her billing plan. I wasn't absorbing it though. I was thinking sure, whatever, I'll meet my OOPM soon and then it will be \$0, like everything else. I chose her because she's in network. This situation fits what I've read about balance billing. I have a hard time believing that my 50+ yo therapist would do something illegal like this. I can't believe she wouldn't know the laws. I don't trust her but she's smart. Rationally this seems far fetched. From anthem: "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secure message. We understand how concerning it is to be billed when your Explanation of Benefits (EOB) shows no member responsibility, and we appreciate you bringing this to our attention. Upon reviewing your 2026 claims submitted by x, most of the claims indicate no member responsibility, which means you should not owe anything for those services. We found only two claims where a member responsibility was applied: Claim number x (Date of Service: 03/05/2026-03/09/2026) Member responsibility: \$180.00 Claim number x (Date of Service: 02/24/2026) - Member responsibility: \$60.00 If you have already made payments that correspond to these two claims, then any additional charges from this provider may not be accurate. For the other claims that show \$0.00 member responsibility, we recommend that you share a copy of your EOB with your provider, as it reflects how the claims were processed. Sincerely, Elaine S. Customer Service Representative" What should I do? We are supposed to meet on Tuesday. **UPDATE:** I cancelled our appointment and asked for a breakdown of charges, in a neutral way, implying anthem must have messed up. Anthem again confirmed she should not be charging me. Her stated rate is \$235. Anthem has been giving her \$97.87 per session. So she's taking home \$297.87?? she wants me to believe that anthem only gives her \$35, and that balance billing is ok? I can't believe this. does she think I'm dumb and rich? is she dumb, or a thief? she was kind of a decent therapist! My claims history shows that she has submitted 10claims. Each claim shows multiple sessions each day. totaling 19 sessions. She charged me \$198 the first 3 charges and \$200 the last 2. 5 total charges to my credit card which aligns with the number of times I remember seeing her. I have not seen her 19times and I've definitely never seen her 3x in one day. I never got any kind of receipt with the charges. I just noticed them. Is it common to not send a receipt? **UPDATE 2:** a lot of her claims were on dates I was gone on a trip for a month taking care of a dying family member. The very first claim for a 60 minute therapy session for which Anthem paid her \$97.87 was actually our 14m48s introductory phone consult (she had flaked twice. She was 9th on my list and no one else was available. Should I just keep seeing her...? 😬) **UPDATE 3:** I sent Anthem screenshots of texts, emails, and phone history showing her first claim was a lie, and that I was out of the country during a majority of her other claims. I cannot believe I was out of the country with my dying mother, with no return date, and this woman was using my name to make hundreds of dollars. What the flipping fuck. I want to be HER therapist and analyze her pathology. Also, she gave away my time slot while I was gone with no conversation, and I was hurt but I decided to respect that I couldn't expect her to hold a spot for me when I left and stopped communicating. Ha! I wonder if I had never reached back out, how long she would have kept pretending we were having sessions. **UPDATE 4:** Sent by: Anthem Support "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secured message. I'm really sorry you're going through this, it can be very upsetting and confusing to see charges and visit records that don't match your recollection, especially when it involves multiple charges to your card. We understand your concern, and we appreciate you bringing this to our attention. Please be advised that we process claims exactly as they are billed and submitted by your provider. Claims are reviewed based on the information received, your plan benefits, and the provider's network status. Anthem also follows the provider's contract to determine the allowed amount and how much is applied to your responsibility, such as deductible, copayment, or coinsurance. For specific details about the billing codes used and the charges submitted, we recommend contacting your provider or facility directly, as they can explain how the claim was filed and the

amounts billed for each service. If you believe your claims were not processed correctly, you have the right to request a review by filing an appeal, and we'll be happy to guide you through that process. Appeals must be submitted within 180 calendar days of the last processing date. Please include your member identification number, the claim number in question, the details of your appeal and any additional medical information or documentation supporting your appeal. For a standard appeal, a decision will be made within 30 calendar days after the receipt of the documentation. You can send appeals by mail to the following address:..." Sounds like Anthem wants me to do a load of paperwork when I've already submitted evidence of fraud. :(I asked them to forward to their fraud department. TBD. **UPDATE 6** From therapist responding to me asking for a breakdown of her charges: "Hi x, Thank you for sending this, and thank you for following up with Anthem. Yes, it's completely fine to skip tomorrow. I'm going to look into the insurance issue on my end and see what I can find out about why Anthem is showing \$0. Once I have more clarity, I'll get back to you. Warmly, x" 😊 me: "Thanks x. Can you send me a superbill today explaining the details of the \$198 and \$200 charges?" I just read her reflections email on our last session and it was so insightful and helpful. Maybe we can both compartmentalize her fraud... 😊 **UPDATE 7** Sent by: Anthem Support "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secure message. I'm really sorry you're going through this—what you're describing sounds incredibly frustrating and concerning. Thank you for clearly outlining the dates and your experience, especially noting when you were out of the country and had no communication or sessions with X. I completely understand why this situation doesn't feel right. To help ensure this is properly reviewed and investigated, the best next step is to report the situation directly to our Special Investigations Unit (SIU). They are specifically trained to handle cases like this and can take the appropriate actions to protect you and review any questionable billing activity. You may contact the Special Investigations Unit (SIU) at 888-231-5044 to report the concern. Reaching out to them will allow a dedicated team to look into the details you've shared and work toward a resolution. If you have any supporting documents—such as dates of service, billing statements, or records of your absence—having those ready can also be helpful during the review." I'm waiting to see whether the therapist will send the requested breakdown of the costs. kind of for sick entertainment purposes at this point tbh. She didn't send yesterday as requested. I keep thinking about the good parts of our dynamic and thinking about maybe making things work. A bit like the toxic relationships I wanted her to help me with, actually ... I'm back to sending a hundred exhausting , failed emails to therapists on psychology today, like the good old days. **UPDATE 8** From therapist: "Hi x, Thank you for your patience on this. I've been talking with Anthem and it turns out there was coverage confusion on their side that made your benefits show up in a really confusing way on my end. Bottom line: I overcharged you. Your copay is \$60 per session, and you should only have been paying \$60 each time. Based on the payments showing on your end (5 sessions: \$200, \$200, \$198, \$198, \$198), you paid a total of \$994. You should have paid \$300 total (\$60 x 5). That means I owe you a refund of \$694. I'm really sorry for the confusion. I appreciate you catching this; it would have turned into a big accounting discrepancy for my books too. Whew! Can you tell me what you prefer for the refund, Zelle or Venmo? Once you confirm, I can send it right away. Warmly, x" I actually met my deductible after 3 sessions. She's still lying. Wow. I said yes an"

— r/HealthInsurance · 122 upvotes · None

"2 Month Review of Ambetter Fidelis Insurance (NY State of Health/ACA) Hey r/HealthInsurance, I wanted to leave a review of the Ambetter Fidelis Insurance, which I got through the NY State of Health marketplace (ACA). I figured this was useful, because anyone facing the daunting task of finding health insurance when not employed by a traditional employer, knows that this is a very confusing and terrible place to be in. TLDR, I expected it to be TERRIBLE, but it's just "bad". Perhaps the "least bad" among the NY ACA options. Which is actually better than I expected, and thus I'm overall pleasantly satisfied with it. Background: \- I switched from employer insurance to self-employed \~2 years ago, and have been on COBRA until \~2 months ago \- I'm on a specialty injection medication (Dupixent). And it was really important to get this covered, because it'd be \$40K/yr out of pocket otherwise. I reviewed all the available plans in NY State of Health, looking for the cheapest option that did list Dupixent in its formulary, which would be a strong positive signal that I *could* get covered under the plan. Ambetter Fidelis was the cheapest option when I considered the low monthly premium (\~\$700), plus the relatively lower max out-of-pocket (\~\$8K, which I would max out since Dupixent is expensive), and the HSA tax savings benefit (-\~\$1700), and it listed Dupixent on its [formulary](<https://www.fideliscare.org/Portals/0/Formularies/QHP-2025-formulary-Fidelis-Care.pdf>). I was a bit leery of Ambetter Fidelis, because it has [atrocious](<https://www.yelp.com/biz/fidelis-care-new-york-new-york>) [reviews](<https://www.bbb.org/us/ny/long-island-city/profile/health-insurance/ambetter-from-fidelis-care-0121-66199/customer-reviews>). But... pretty much all the insurances have atrocious reviews. So going with a different plan would be more expensive without any stronger guarantee. At first, I was pretty turned off by Ambetter Fidelis: \- their website is TERRIBLE. Slow, unintuitive, broken, down, their voice line tells you to check the website, and the website tells you to call the voice line for more information. \- when you try to call them, you're put through a ringer of TERRIBLE automated voice robots. I've done this so many times, that if you need to talk to a person, here's what you do: call 1-888-343-3547, press: 1122270 (slowly) \- none of my pre-existing doctors offices took them, so I had to pay out of pocket per visit (\$300+) \- after my doctor/pharmacy submitted the prescription request for Dupixent, of course they deny it. But even worse, it's this confusing hell, because the customer service says they have no record of a prior auth from my doctor's office. It turns out the prior auth is handled between my pharmacy and Ambetter Fidelis, but the Ambetter Fidelis reps can't see it? So I was blaming my doctor's office for awhile, when it wasn't their fault. But over time, I've actually become relatively satisfied with them: 1) I had an elbow injury, and through their terrible website I found a sports specialist doctor that is covered by Ambetter. The doctor is quite good, and the co-pay was only like \$25 per visit. The doctor wanted an MRI, but he knows ambetter requires Xrays before MRI's, which is slightly annoying, but whatever. 2) I had an X-ray done, copay was \$30 3) It was a bit of a 2 week song & dance to get ambetter to approve the MRI, but it was approved, and I got an MRI, copay was \$193 at the office. And then Fidelis charged me an additional \$675, since there's a large deductible. This kinda sucks, especially since it's already the end of the year, so this won't go towards my yearly OOP max. But I need this, so whatever. 4) Dupixent was just "approved" today. Have to complain that they called me telling me there's an important message for me, and to call them back. And I need to call them back and spend 15 minutes in a robot answering machine hell before getting to anyone. But whatever, I'm happy that Dupixent was approved. So just waiting another few days for my pharmacy to actually ship Dupixent to me, and see what the deductible will be. So... lots of friction, lots of annoyances, lots of unexpected costs. But healthcare is expensive. And this is the cheapest option I could find. And Dupixent is covered, which is like \$40K/yr on its own, and that's basically all I care about. It was a plus that I could actually find a sports specialty doctors office that is in network with them. Which gives me confidence I can find some decent other doctors that I need. Presumably I won't have such crazy copays/deductibles in the future, since I'll already be paying the max OOP. Anyway, hope that helps. Happy to answer any questions!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 14 upvotes · None

"I'm confused why the same plan my girlfriend and I choose went up for her, but stayed the same for me? We both signed up for Oscar Gold Elite last year and each have our incomes which are unfortunately low. Same jobs and same income for this year... But for some reason my premium for the same plan stayed at the exact same price of \$40, but hers more than doubled to \$100. We use our premium tax credits but she uses the insurance more than I do because she had asthma but does that have anything to do with it? I'm a bit confused because I don't understand this stuff very well despite watching many videos on it. Any help is greatly appreciated."

— r/HealthInsurance · 7 upvotes · None

"Im 33, my job doesmt offer health insurance. I bought a plan for \$130 a month directly through blue cross blue shield"

— YouTube · 9 Health Insurance Options for Early Retirement · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qt0r9YBsUzM&lc=Ugxt9DMCwoEBE4QubuF4AaABAg>

"I have a very good broker I've worked with since 2021. For 2026 I went with an Ambetter higher deductible bronze plan with a lower monthly premium then purchased a gap plan from UBA to cover the high deductible should something happen. I am generally healthy and do wellness visits that are covered. So my monthly expense went up from 7.50 a month in 2025 for my Silver plan to 40.00 per month for this selection in 2026. It also has better prescription coverage than I've had in 2025."

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=UgxjMpss4oRZv7Vk8qt4AaABAg>

"I went with Ambetter, myself. My ACA insurance went up, but I can't complain. I live in Texas. ACA enrollment is ongoing until January 15th."

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=UgzyyCe4PekLOIb7WA14AaABAg>

"I went to a TedX event once where a surgeon started his talk by saying "I can tell you everything about the Whipple procedure... except for how much it costs." I also once had a situation where my employer eliminated platinum plans from their benefit offering and the best plan was a gold plan with a \$2K deductible. There were several different options and I'd heard a lot of negative things about Cigna, which was the most affordable, in the brain tumor community. I have to have regular MRIs regularly due to a hx of a low grade brain tumor so I called Cigna to ask what their contracted rate for an MRI at the facility I go to is attempting to make an informed decision and they refused to tell me."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1hy926d/how_is_it_legal_that_you_have_to_use_the_service/m6hr2om/

"That's funny - I literally called Blue Cross yesterday to ask that very question! They said yes, I need to re-do it. I suspect that their system looks to see if a pre-authorization is in place for a specific member ID. It's not going to try to match your name or Social Security number. You're a different person under the new plan, in their eyes. They did say that I can do it in advance, even before my ACA plan goes into effect. That said, your insurer may have different rules, so I would check with them, but I think you will need to do it again."

— r/Obamacare · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ou2shp/switching_from_employer_plan_to_a_ca_plan_same/no9fmk8/

"Ugh, I chose Oscar this year. I am new to ACA plans. I only chose it because it was the only plan that covered the meds my son is on and one of the few the specialist he sees is contracted with."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pt9kud/oscar_health_horrible/nvjf3u4/

An agent or broker · 10 documents

"HDHPs suck if you actually need them. Because our subsidy expired, we are now paying \$1200 a month for 2 people for a bronze plan with an \$8000 deductible per person. CO, both 52, \$160k income. We went from \$1200 buying us great gold coverage to \$1200 and paying for our own care literally overnight. As it happens, for a bit of uterine bleeding, I actually need the insurance this year. All of the procedures I need – ultrasound, biopsy, and hysteroscopy – are subject to the deductible. And after the deductible, they're only covered at 40% by Select Health. What kind of insurance is this? We're basically paying high premiums for the privilege of paying for our own healthcare. This was the cheapest Obamacare option we could find. Where are all the HDHPs with lower premiums? We worked with a broker, and there weren't any. The contract company that employs my husband had an HDHP where the premium was even higher. At these prices, we can't even afford to fund an HSA. We didn't see any HDHPs on the exchange with premium is less than \$1000 a month. How are people affording this? HDHPs are not a bargain anymore, it seems. We make well over six figures, but since so much of our income is going to healthcare premiums, we have to drain our savings over any healthcare we need. And if you have HDHP insurance, you can't even pay a lower cash price to the facility. You have to pay the higher insurance negotiated price, even if you're paying 100% of the cost. And if I want sedation for these procedures (don't even get me started about how painful in office gynecology is), it's even more expensive. So basically, anything between a well-woman visit (free) and cancer (chemo meets that deductible pretty quick) is going to give you medical debt. This is indescribably unbelievable. Wow, this sucks."

— r/HealthInsurance · 199 upvotes · None

"Health Insurance Carrier strongly recommending that I don't purchase insurance through healthcare.gov I just got off the phone with sales agent of the largest health insurance carrier in my state. I had previously applied through healthcare.gov and confirmed that I was ineligible for any tax credits/subsidies but found a plan I like. I then contact the health insurer directly to see if there was any difference in premiums by applying directly through them. The price is identical but I was told to purchase the plan directly anyway because there could be "miscommunication" between the marketplace exchange and the insurer. That seemed odd to me. As someone who supports the ACA and wants to ensure it lasts and improves, I would like to enroll through healthcare.gov. My thinking is that the program's success is measured in part by the number of users who shop/purchase through healthcare.gov. Is there any real downside to using the marketplace exchange?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 16 upvotes · None

"I just talked to my Insurance broker last week (I'm on Cobra until 2/2027). FYI, the ACA only has HMO plans, no more PPO plans, she told me. I can't find any doctors who take the HMO plans, even the top tier ones."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgwScHrO5XRAM7MD7Cp4AaABAq

"Have used a broker to sign up for the last 2 years - why are his prices higher than the ones listed on the healthcare.gov site? TLDR : the copious info is below but 1) worried a broker is trying to up charge me to sign up through him for 2026 insurance (a more expensive plan I wasn't considering from gov site is actually \$50/month cheaper thru him, the cheaper plan I thought I might pick on the gov site is \$30 more a month from the broker) 2) how can I review the answers I put into my gov 2026 application before I got the info from the insurance broker because I can't seem to find a way to review that on healthcare.gov So..... 2 years ago I signed up through a local insurance broker because I was coming off Medicaid and couldn't get the healthcare.gov website to show me what I'd be getting for a subsidy. I assume it wouldn't give me that info till I was determined ineligible by my states dhhs which is a slow process. I even called them and told them to end my coverage through them on the last day of December hoping that would make it so I was able to see my subsidy but it didn't. So I went through this broker and got signed up cheap (\$45) a month on priority. Last year since he had made the process so painless I went through him again but it went up to \$120 a month which hurt a bit but he had said some program had expired making my insurance more expensive for this past year even tho my income only went up a couple thousand dollars. Looking back now I prob should have delved into that huge increase further. I called him again at the end of October and he said to call him back in a week since he didn't have access to the new numbers yet but after seeing all the people shocked by their increases I decided to fill out an application on healthcare.gov just to see what kind of increase I might be in for. My income also went up so I put in a new estimate (which I don't remember what I put) and if I keep my current plan it will go up to \$215. There's also a cheaper plan I could get instead that will likely fulfill my needs for \$159. The insurance broker sent me an email listing 2 plans neither of which is my current one. It lists one for \$208 but the gov site lists the same plan for \$186. The gov site lists another plan I wasn't even considering due to expense for \$239 but from the broker that same plan is \$183. In order to have complete info I wanted to review my gov application because I don't remember exactly what I put for my income info. For the broker I told him \$28k for the year but I either listed \$28k or \$26,600 on my gov application. I was trying to review my application details again but have been clicking round and round on the gov site and it won't let me review those details anywhere as far as I can see. I need to have those details before I can ask this broker what's up with the different prices and make a selection. Low key worried he may be pulling a fast one on me but I thought these brokers didn't charge for their services (that may have been true under Biden but who knows what rule changes Trump may have made allowing for up charging) Phew, any info appreciated 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · None

"Please help! Best insurance in NJ for someone disabled with chronic illness and schizophrenia ASAP!! **NJ FamilyCare, or state Medicaid, is very different from federal Medicaid and I'm looking for people who have understanding of NJ STATE resources rather than federal insurance.** I'm 25F, have a diagnosis of schizoaffective disorder, opioid use disorder on MAT injections and fibromyalgia, and I see multiple providers every month including weekly therapy, bi-weekly medication, zero to 2-3 hospitalizations or inpatient psych treatments a year, monthly suboxone injections, monthly pain management/rheumatology and physical therapy, and like 6-7 monthly medications and bloodwork every 3-6 months for those meds. My insurance migrated to a plan that doesn't have mental health care, so I'm looking for a new insurance on very short notice. I am unemployed and my income is under 23k, but my parents (who make >150k) have agreed to help me financially for the next 6-12 months, so reasonably my budget is a hundred or couple hundred dollars a month. So, I can either go NJ FamilyCare Horizon BCBS, or a private insurance like Aetna PPO or Horizon BCBS PPO or HMO. I have had private, family based top or silver tier PPOs usually Aetna or BCBS sometimes through a third-party employer plan since I was diagnosed years ago, and the provider network is large with the care excellent but it is very expensive, too expensive to reasonably use it the amount I'd like to if money wasn't an issue. Wide network, but extremely pricey, too pricey to fully utilize, and difficult to navigate when claims are denied by the company. Services known as first-line treatments for SMIs such as schizophrenia like ACT, CSC CI and ICMS, case management, day programs or psychiatric rehabilitation are generally off the table and Medicaid/NJFC only. Terrible, TERRIBLE customer service network with no case management, healthcare consolidation, or help when things go wrong with services or coverage and you try to call their phone line. I called a broker through Health Benefits 360 who recommended NJ Family Care as I am in the income bracket and said it's the best fit for my situation with chronic illness, frequent healthcare use, SMI (serious mental illness) and other mental health and substance abuse recovery resources for the most affordable price. However, I've done some research and the network seems much much smaller and I don't know if the quality of these providers is great, good or poor, I had a friend on Medicaid during college who received very poor quality of services, though they were free, and she had chronic conditions, but I don't know if she was on the state or federal coverage. Based on my situation above, can you recommend which insurance would be the best fit for me, even if it's not something that I have mentioned? More than anything, please understand I want to receive good quality care as first priority and have the financial means to not have to compromise on that. It needs to be a widely accepted insurance, either Aetna or BCBS preferably so that my current providers will migrate over, and a plan that CAN be used frequently well and not in a way that rips me off. But in terms of the exact best plan, I could really use some help and ASAP. I need to be ready to switch within this week so that I can start my coverage on October 1st. Also, feel free to recommend websites where I can get connected to a good broker that will help. I need a broker as I am too disabled to complete a long application alone. Specifically, brokers that understand my situation and do both private insurance and Medicaid. COBRA is not an option unless someone knows a cheaper way to receive it. Edit: Just spoke to broker and another option is ObamaCare or ACA-capped insurance. Thank you very much."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · None

"Questions about how to file taxes with premium tax credits for a dependent? My taxes have always been super simple and straightforward. I work full time and have 2 kids, but I don't have employer health benefits and have had Medicaid for all 3 of us since my divorce. My 19 year old son was dropped from Medicaid coverage and I signed him up for an ACA policy through a broker who told me it wouldn't affect my taxes. My son is autistic and is a full time college student. He lives at home and I've always claimed him as a dependent. He doesn't have a job, but did have a little income from a summer internship. But since he has this policy does he have to file taxes? He didn't make enough money last year to meet the FPL for an individual and I didn't earn enough to meet the FPL for a family of 3. I think as far as the federal government is concerned he should still have Medicaid, but we live in a red state that didn't expand Medicaid, so there's no coverage for 18-24 year old students who don't have children. Do I file my taxes as usual with my children as dependents and then file taxes for him with his 1095-a and put that he can be claimed as a dependent? Do I not claim him as a dependent even though he is most definitely a dependent? He's the only one with an ACA policy and I do not know what I'm doing and I'm afraid since he didn't make enough money that he'll have to pay back thousands of dollars in subsidies. Thanks for any advice!"

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · None

"Thanks for this video! After watching I immediately went and found my plan. Last year I worked with a broker but this year did on my own. It's so easy to do after my broker helped me year one. I was over insured last year on a silver plan (I never go to the doctor), so changed to a bronze plan for a cost of \$20 more than I paid last year. I do get dental and vision insurance from a part time job which I'm grateful for as I use those. I'm really hopeful this administration can fix our horrible medical system but I think the medical system is just too corrupt for it to be change."

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=UgyABLAHg_JE2KKUUZ94AaABAg

"I have a very good broker I've worked with since 2021. For 2026 I went with an Ambetter higher deductible bronze plan with a lower monthly premium then purchased a gap plan from UBA to cover the high deductible should something happen. I am generally healthy and do wellness visits that are covered. So my monthly expense went up from 7.50 a month in 2025 for my Silver plan to 40.00 per month for this selection in 2026. It also has better prescription coverage than I've had in 2025."

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=UgxjMpss4oRZv7Vk8qt4AaABAg>

"That's horrible, try to see if you can get an off exchange plan, I was paying around \$1500 for a group plan with an Ichra through marketplace (no subsidies) last year got on a private plan with a United Healthcare PPO with a \$7k max out of pocket. We had to get approved with underwriting, (they basically checked prescription records) but it cut my premiums in half to \$780 ish. I used a broker "My Private Health Insurance"

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1txq1je/drowning_in_monthly_health_insurance_payments/oqcf5j2/

"We used a broker for many years and last year they found plans that we didn't even see on the marketplace. We usually get a letter in October from the broker telling us to call if needed. We didn't get that this year. We have always had good luck with brokers and I never felt like they were trying to up charge me. My husband and I have discussed how they make their money, but it wasn't through us."

— r/Obamacare · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1or1c2m/have_used_a_broker_to_sign_up_for_the_last_2/nnnwayd/

Employer / COBRA / spouse's plan · 10 documents

"Former employer canceled COBRA health insurance policy without notifying me I just found out my former employer in the state of Washington canceled my COBRA health insurance policy. Not because they notified me, but because my pharmacy called me and said my policy was no longer valid. WTF COBRA is supposed to be valid for 18-36 months and I am fully paid up. I just had major surgery and have PT scheduled in 4 days that has already been deferred for 2 weeks (because I was at my yearly limit of PT) if I don't make the appointment I may never correctly recover and regain full use of my arm. Apparently, my former employer is getting rid of Aetna and getting a new Health Insurance plan from a different provider. So my Aetna policy terminated at the beginning of 2025. Neither my former employer nor Aetna notified me about this, is that even legal? My COBRA provider told me over the phone that my coverage is supposed to switch to the new policy, but my former employer didn't send them the correct documents and that plan is not active for me so now I am stuck with no Health Insurance in need of immediate healthcare. What are my options? UPDATE: I contacted my former employer, who didn't have a good answer for why I wasn't notified. But did state that they had gotten a new health insurance policy with a different company. They then gave me a plan number and group number and told me to use that info to create an account on the website on the new insurance provider. I attempted to do so and the web form said that wasn't a valid policy and refused to let me create an account. After an additional back and forth with HR from my old company they said to call the new Health Insurance provider. So after 30 minutes of being on hold with them, they told me the policy number I had been given was for a different person who happened to have a different first name, same last name, different birthday and different address. Apparently that incorrect info was given to the HR lady at my company by their insurance vendor. After contacting four different companies, and spending more than an hour on the phone I am still without health insurance while needing PT to recover from a major surgery and unable to renew my prescriptions. For those that said this was a simple issue that I could clear up with a quick call to my former employer, I'm calling you on your BS. It's not, and there is incompetence up and down the chain of everyone involved here. FURTHER CONTEXT: I have accepted an offer for a new job (one with better health insurance) and should be starting at the end of the month. I only need my COBRA health plan for another month to get through all the post surgery PT, maybe get a Flu and COVID shot and get my prescriptions for this month. And however long it takes to get the new health insurance actually functional. As such it doesn't feel worth it to sign up for an ACA plan for less than a month of coverage and then have to deal with the overhead of cancelling that plan and setting up another new one. I just want the COBRA coverage they told me would be available for a whole year to actually work. UPDATE 2: I got a different (supposedly correct) policy number from my former employers HR, tried to use that to create an account on Regence's website and it still failed. I called Regence (was on hold for a whole hour) gave them the new policy number and was told over the phone I am actually in their system and I SHOULD have an active policy. I also read back the group # I had been given by HR and found out that was also incorrect (way to go former employer 0/2). I have no way to verify it's functional other than going to PT tomorrow and seeing if they can bill Regence. UPDATE 3: I filled a complaint with the state insurance commissioner, not just for the recent fiasco but also for the situation that caused me to quit my job in the first place where I believe the company may have actually acted illegally. I don't expect anything to come if it but maybe future me will be pleasantly surprised."

— r/HealthInsurance · 273 upvotes · None

"Insurance Bill I Never Signed Up For So I just did my 2025 taxes, and when I first submitted them they got rejected for not including a 1095. I have insurance through my husband's job so this was weird, but I did check my Marketplace eligibility but never signed up for a plan. I ended up including a letter in my taxes that said I checked my eligibility but did not receive coverage from the marketplace. Fast forward to last night. I went to dinner with my mom and she brought me some mail I got from her house. They were bills and delinquency notices from the insurance company Ambetter. Somehow I was signed up for this insurance and these bills were sent to my mom's house, I have not lived there for 6 years. I did some googling and I'm not the only person that has been signed up for insurance without my consent. My question is what the hell do I do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 27 upvotes · None

"ACA healthcare made it possible for me to retire. I keep my taxable income low and receive Gov subsidies on premiums. I consider the subsidies getting back some of the taxes I paid into the systems for the last 48 years. I had employer healthcare insurance for 30 years and never used one penny of it. Insurance companies made a mint off of my employer and me for decades. I never went to the Doctor until I turned 60 when I got Covid."

— YouTube · How to Get Affordable Health Insurance Before Medicare · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dVyzw5Ac7pA&lc=UgzT3TgVH2azwWzdsxx4AaABAq>

"2 Month Review of Ambetter Fidelis Insurance (NY State of Health/ACA) Hey r/HealthInsurance, I wanted to leave a review of the Ambetter Fidelis Insurance, which I got through the NY State of Health marketplace (ACA). I figured this was useful, because anyone facing the daunting task of finding health insurance when not employed by a traditional employer, knows that this is a very confusing and terrible place to be in. TLDR, I expected it to be TERRIBLE, but it's just "bad". Perhaps the "least bad" among the NY ACA options. Which is actually better than I expected, and thus I'm overall pleasantly satisfied with it. Background: \- I switched from employer insurance to self-employed \~2 years ago, and have been on COBRA until \~2 months ago \- I'm on a specialty injection medication (Dupixent). And it was really important to get this covered, because it'd be \$40K/yr out of pocket otherwise. I reviewed all the available plans in NY State of Health, looking for the cheapest option that did list Dupixent in its formulary, which would be a strong positive signal that I *could* get covered under the plan. Ambetter Fidelis was the cheapest option when I considered the low monthly premium (\~\$700), plus the relatively lower max out-of-pocket (\~\$8K, which I would max out since Dupixent is expensive), and the HSA tax savings benefit (-\~\$1700), and it listed Dupixent on its [formulary](<https://www.fideliscare.org/Portals/0/Formularies/QHP-2025-formulary-Fidelis-Care.pdf>). I was a bit leery of Ambetter Fidelis, because it has [atrocious](<https://www.yelp.com/biz/fidelis-care-new-york-new-york>) [reviews](<https://www.bbb.org/us/ny/long-island-city/profile/health-insurance/ambetter-from-fidelis-care-0121-66199/customer-reviews>). But... pretty much all the insurances have atrocious reviews. So going with a different plan would be more expensive without any stronger guarantee. At first, I was pretty turned off by Ambetter Fidelis: \- their website is TERRIBLE. Slow, unintuitive, broken, down, their voice line tells you to check the website, and the website tells you to call the voice line for more information. \- when you try to call them, you're put through a ringer of TERRIBLE automated voice robots. I've done this so many times, that if you need to talk to a person, here's what you do: call 1-888-343-3547, press: 1122270 (slowly) \- none of my pre-existing doctors offices took them, so I had to pay out of pocket per visit (\$300+) \- after my doctor/pharmacy submitted the prescription request for Dupixent, of course they deny it. But even worse, it's this confusing hell, because the customer service says they have no record of a prior auth from my doctor's office. It turns out the prior auth is handled between my pharmacy and Ambetter Fidelis, but the Ambetter Fidelis reps can't see it? So I was blaming my doctor's office for awhile, when it wasn't their fault. But over time, I've actually become relatively satisfied with them: 1) I had an elbow injury, and through their terrible website I found a sports specialist doctor that is covered by Ambetter. The doctor is quite good, and the co-pay was only like \$25 per visit. The doctor wanted an MRI, but he knows ambetter requires Xrays before MRI's, which is slightly annoying, but whatever. 2) I had an X-ray done, copay was \$30 3) It was a bit of a 2 week song & dance to get ambetter to approve the MRI, but it was approved, and I got an MRI, copay was \$193 at the office. And then Fidelis charged me an additional \$675, since there's a large deductible. This kinda sucks, especially since it's already the end of the year, so this won't go towards my yearly OOP max. But I need this, so whatever. 4) Dupixent was just "approved" today. Have to complain that they called me telling me there's an important message for me, and to call them back. And I need to call them back and spend 15 minutes in a robot answering machine hell before getting to anyone. But whatever, I'm happy that Dupixent was approved. So just waiting another few days for my pharmacy to actually ship Dupixent to me, and see what the deductible will be. So... lots of friction, lots of annoyances, lots of unexpected costs. But healthcare is expensive. And this is the cheapest option I could find. And Dupixent is covered, which is like \$40K/yr on its own, and that's basically all I care about. It was a plus that I could actually find a sports specialty doctors office that is in network with them. Which gives me confidence I can find some decent other doctors that I need. Presumably I won't have such crazy copays/deductibles in the future, since I'll already be paying the max OOP. Anyway, hope that helps. Happy to answer any questions!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 14 upvotes · None

"I just talked to my Insurance broker last week (I'm on Cobra until 2/2027). FYI, the ACA only has HMO plans, no more PPO plans, she told me. I can't find any doctors who take the HMO plans, even the top tier ones."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgwScHrO5XRAM7MD7Cp4AaABAq

"Question about tax credit Excuse some of my ignorance because I only switched to ACA plan for my family of 3 about six months ago after switching employers. I didn't pay a lot of attention to it before because I was on a workplace health plan for 10+ years, so I've been playing catch up. My wife and I are both commission workers so I had to estimate our income when first applying. It came out to about 102k/year, and it seemed that I was told that we did not qualify for the APTC, although now I see that the limit is 106k. Our final gross income from 2025 may end up being lower than my estimation. It's possible that I was confused but I'm currently paying 700\$/mo right now, and my plan is going up to around 840\$/mo next year, but the eligibility summary is telling me that I actually am eligible for up to 247\$/mo from the APTC (as well as currently eligible, I think?). So I guess my question is, I am I think understanding now that the tax credit is only going away for those making over 400% of the federal poverty line, does that mean that I could still claim the 247\$/mo next year, as was as retroactively claim it for the previous 6 months or so when I do my taxes next year? I currently am not receiving any advanced payments. Thanks, sorry if this is a dumb basic question I should know already, but just trying to understand better."

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · None

"Well none of these work for me. 32 years in law enforcement and got great pension, but very expensive health insurance. County give me 600 a month to pay for insurance, but the plans are super expensive. My plan for a family is 2400 a month with a 6000 deduction. Tried Obamacare but I make too much on my pension. Cobra was more than the plans and I would not get the 600 a month if I used Cobra. I do use an HSA to pay for medical stuff and write all the premiums off at end of year so it's not so painful. Only choice till 65 is for me to get a job with benefits or just go without medical and use free clinic down the street. Ain't America grand!"

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement - Here Are 4 Options · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pjR3wlGOZsc&lc=Ugwz-0YIBEUizzYTHRZ4AaABAq>

"I still remember how mad I was when that stupid healthcare act passed. Prices exploded across the board the very first day it came into affect. What I had paid in cobra coverage was now less than what I paid for regular coverage at my job and all the co pays went up and suddenly instead of a 500 dollar deductible it was now 5000. And all they did was shrug and be like, oops, deal with it."

— YouTube · Millions of Americans drop Affordable Care Act coverage after premiums spike · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wakcL0IHxuA&lc=UgwatG_8BIMT8BO-A9h4AaABAq

"Joe exactly what I need. I was underwhelmed with the person connected with my own financial advisory firm. I got a year to go on cobra and 3 1/2 years till Medicare. I think you're going to find what you're providing through your affiliate relationship is serving a huge unmet need."

— YouTube · How to Get Affordable Health Insurance Before Medicare · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dVyz5Ac7pA&lc=UgzYYcCNqRgWabclPqJ4AaABAq>

"This 100% Pre-ACA, every entrepreneur or small business owner who I knew was a married dude who got health insurance through his wife's employer. I met a married couple that were both entrepreneurs from Maine in the 2000's. Maine was not a "guaranteed issue" state, so they were only able to buy medically underwritten policies with a lot of exclusions. He got cancer, so she had to shutter her healthy and growing business and go get a corporate job with benefits. It's absolutely better than it used to be."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1hh4ydg/health_insurance_costs_are_killing/m2ozc8z/

Medicaid / CHIP · 8 documents

"My premium increased 590%. Is this normal? I understand without the enhanced subsidies we'd be seeing double or triple premiums next year. However, my premium skyrocketed. In 2025, I paid \$80 and my premiums are set to increase to \$552. The lowest option available was \$300 for catastrophic insurance which wouldn't work for me. I had to go with the \$450 option. I put that my income was \$730 biweekly after deductions. My take home pay is \$1200 a month. My friend in Florida makes the same as me and her premium only increased from \$11 to \$50. My coworker in Wisconsin is also getting a similar low cost option. I am so confused why my premium increased so much. Did anyone else in Illinois experience this? Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level. Edit: also, my parents are helping to pay part of my premiums for now. Otherwise, I'd be out of luck. Even though I'm grateful, it doesn't feel good having to rely on my parents for this. But knowing my health history I could end up in serious trouble if I go uninsured. Update: After a month on the marketplace plan, I was found eligible for Medicaid so it ended up working out at the end. I was worried since I'd been denied for Medicaid in the past. It looks like the increased premiums finally made me eligible."

— r/HealthInsurance · 152 upvotes · None

"A positive anecdote of using American/ACA health insurance We often hear mostly negative things regarding US health insurance online, particularly in regards to the ACA, so I thought I'd offer up a positive personal experience. Our daughter met with her new rheumatologist less than two weeks ago. Today we got the approval authorization for a year of her biologic infusion, which is off-formulary and medical exemption only. No arguing post-denial or justification to get insurance to pony up for an expensive drug that could easily make us net loss customers for them. Copay program from the manufacturer should bring our out-of-pocket cost down to \$0, but even without it our script-biased insurance would hold the drug copay to just \$300/year. This is also with a new insurer starting as a brand new patient. Took one week for her to get in to see her new PCP, took a few days for the referral to process, then three weeks for her to see the rheumatologist. This insurer and policy are also the absolute cheapest Silver in our market, meaning premium cost is significantly lower than even the benchmark plan. I appreciate more and more each year just how good of a healthcare/ACA market Austin has ended up being. Wife and I both needed to find a new PCP this year too due to switching insurance carriers and it only took a few weeks for us to get in as new patients. I hear people talk all the time about waiting months in other markets. Our new PCP was lovely too and didn't rush our new patient appointments at all despite us not really needing anything other than to establish service."

— r/obamacare · 46 upvotes · None

"Turning 26, being dropped coverage and can't do State Medicaid I'm turning 26 years old, and I'm being dropped from my parent's health plan. I live in PA and have no income. I'm still in Medical School for 1 more year, and they offer no SHIP/healthcare plans of their own. I qualify for PA State Medicaid, but I will be doing several out of state hospital rotations, and they will not accept that I only have a State Medicaid. What are my options? I went to HealthCare.gov, and as soon as I say I have no income, all they do is redirect me to sign up with State Medicaid?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 44 upvotes · None

"Medi-Cal vs. Covered California / Medi-Cal eligibility I am a working-age California resident. In the first quarter of last year, I left a job voluntarily. Because it was voluntary I did not bother to apply for unemployment. I did not have another job lined up. As I had coverage with Kaiser through my employer, my first call was to them to ask about Cobra. I was pretty quickly transferred to a Kaiser agent who wanted to work through a Covered California application with me. We did that, but at the end of the process they had some technical failure with regard to me verifying my SSN, so they gave up and transferred me to a Covered California agent. I did not quite know how to answer their question about income, because my answer was basically, "I expect to be employed again at some point this year, but it's hard to say when, and so anything I tell you will only be a guesstimate." So the CC agent concluded that since my total 2022 income from the job I just left fell under the limit, and since I did not have any other income, I was eligible for Medi-Cal. This seemed odd to me since my occupation pays fairly well and I did expect to be employed again at some point that year. "Can't I just get subsidies through CC and then pay them back once I'm working again?" I asked. Their answer was that with Medi-Cal, so long as I advise them of any changes to income, I don't actually have to pay anything back. I didn't really expect to use the plan anyway, i.e. I just wanted catastrophic coverage, and so I agreed to do that. So for the past 11 months, I've been on Medi-Cal. I have not used the plan in any way, have not seen a doctor, have not called anyone about anything with the exception of the initial application process. It is time to renew my eligibility, and here is my concern: When I went through the application process last year, they asked about "cash on hand." Now, at the time I did have some money in the bank, but that money was set aside for living expenses like rent and food, which I considered to be priorities that came before health insurance. It felt like the question was more about "disposable cash" and so I reported that no, I did not have cash on hand. Looking back, that was probably the wrong answer. There was zero intent to deceive on my part, however I'm now concerned that I've basically been enrolled in Medi-Cal fraudulently. As it turns out, I am still unemployed. I am very close to being out of cash, am living on credit card advances, and I have a traditional IRA that I will tap into as a last resort. So, unlike last year, I'm pretty sure that I am now legitimately eligible for Medi-Cal. (I don't think my IRA counts as an asset but please correct me if I'm wrong.) Let's say I renew and at some point thereafter I obtain services. Might they do some digging and discover that I did actually have some cash in 2022? My understanding is that if I am eligible for Medi-Cal then I am NOT eligible for CC subsidies, so even though at this point I would feel better about reversing course and getting myself on a CC plan, that may not be financially feasible for me. I would like to have a conversation with someone from Medi-Cal about this, but not sure how wise it would be for me to share what I have shared here. Maybe it would be better to just return my renewal docs and proceed as if I've been eligible all along? Does it even matter since I haven't actually obtained any services? Am I just being paranoid? Apologies for the long-winded post. Just wanted to provide some context so that hopefully someone might have some valuable insight and/or advice. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 18 upvotes · None

"Medicaid nightmare So I have Missouri Medicaid for my wife and daughter (1 year old). When my daughter was born, we decided it was best for my wife to stay home. So we needed insurance. I went to Marketplace to look, and told me I had to apply for chip/medicaid before proceeding. So I called, spent 7 hours on hold, got ahold of someone, they asked me all the questions and I gave them all our information and income info they needed. Two months later, I received a letter saying they're accepted. Fast forward to July, I get a small raise. I go to my local DSS office and report an income change within 10 days, filled it out in the buy and turned it in before leaving. Never hear anything so I assumed it was still within the limit. Get a letter a couple weeks ago saying we make too much and my wife and daughters plans were being changed. I always expected that but never understood how they qualified to begin with while I always made over \$65k/yr. Turns out when I called to get the details on their new plan, they tell me they only have 1 job out of three jobs I have, only making \$409 a month? They didn't even have any records of my full time job despite filling out an income increase form in office TWICE. Plus they only put down the first letter of my first name so identity issues was always a problem also. So now I'm scared they will think I committed fraud when I've been nothing but upfront with them from the beginning. Them over the phone and in the office haven't been documenting my info properly or at all."

— r/Medicaid · 18 upvotes · None

"NC - Can't find a provider through Medicaid; is it fraud to seek medical treatment as a self-pay patient?? Hi Everyone, I'm in NC and recently switched to Medicaid when the expanded coverage went into effect last year. Before that I had BCBS through the insurance marketplace. While covered under BCBS I had a birthmark removed and biopsied (Nevus Sabaceous of Jadassohn) and was advised that if the surrounding area had any changes to size/shape/color post removal to seek treatment immediately. I noticed two days ago the birthmark area had darkened and raised into a small bump. So, naturally, I called my dermatologist to schedule another consultation. When I spoke to them they let me know they don't take Medicaid, so of course my next question was if I can come in as a self-pay/cash patient just for the initial assessment. The nurse/MA I spoke to told me this was considered insurance fraud and I could lose coverage if I do this. So, I spent an hour calling every dermatologist within 50 miles (I live in western North Carolina) that accepted my insurance. ONE of them is accepting new patients, but only with a PCP referral. Okay, progress, so I call my PCP to get one. Nobody picks up. Next I decide to reach out to UHC to see if I can change PCP's since my current one (that was automatically assigned to me) was unavailable. The dude I've been on the phone with for 30 minutes, a member services advocate, and I have now called about 10 PCP's to get set up with a new patient appointment, just so I can get a referral for an issue I know exists, so I can beg the only dermatologist available within a 2 hour drive to please see me as a new patient. Even if it is illegal/fraud to pay cash for medical treatment that could prevent a more serious issue, wouldn't there be some kind of exception for a situation like this? Like, I would take out a loan if I had to since removing it now wouldn't be too crazy, but if I wait until UHC can find me a PCP to GIVE ME A REFERRAL ONLY it would be months, close to a year from now. Additionally I have no issue breaking the law if it comes down to it in the quest to not die of melanoma, I was just wondering if this is actually a thing."

— r/Medicaid · 16 upvotes · None

"Have used a broker to sign up for the last 2 years - why are his prices higher than the ones listed on the healthcare.gov site? TLDR : the copious info is below but 1) worried a broker is trying to up charge me to sign up through him for 2026 insurance (a more expensive plan I wasn't considering from gov site is actually \$50/month cheaper thru him, the cheaper plan I thought I might pick on the gov site is \$30 more a month from the broker) 2) how can I review the answers I put into my gov 2026 application before I got the info from the insurance broker because I can't seem to find a way to review that on healthcare.gov So..... 2 years ago I signed up through a local insurance broker because I was coming off Medicaid and couldn't get the healthcare.gov website to show me what I'd be getting for a subsidy. I assume it wouldn't give me that info till I was determined ineligible by my states dhhs which is a slow process. I even called them and told them to end my coverage through them on the last day of December hoping that would make it so I was able to see my subsidy but it didn't. So I went through this broker and got signed up cheap (\$45) a month on priority. Last year since he had made the process so painless I went through him again but it went up to \$120 a month which hurt a bit but he had said some program had expired making my insurance more expensive for this past year even tho my income only went up a couple thousand dollars. Looking back now I prob should have delved into that huge increase further. I called him again at the end of October and he said to call him back in a week since he didn't have access to the new numbers yet but after seeing all the people shocked by their increases I decided to fill out an application on healthcare.gov just to see what kind of increase I might be in for. My income also went up so I put in a new estimate (which I don't remember what I put) and if I keep my current plan it will go up to \$215. There's also a cheaper plan I could get instead that will likely fulfill my needs for \$159. The insurance broker sent me an email listing 2 plans neither of which is my current one. It lists one for \$208 but the gov site lists the same plan for \$186. The gov site lists another plan I wasn't even considering due to expense for \$239 but from the broker that same plan is \$183. In order to have complete info I wanted to review my gov application because I don't remember exactly what I put for my income info. For the broker I told him \$28k for the year but I either listed \$28k or \$26,600 on my gov application. I was trying to review my application details again but have been clicking round and round on the gov site and it won't let me review those details anywhere as far as I can see. I need to have those details before I can ask this broker what's up with the different prices and make a selection. Low key worried he may be pulling a fast one on me but I thought these brokers didn't charge for their services (that may have been true under Biden but who knows what rule changes Trump may have made allowing for up charging) Phew, any info appreciated 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · None

"Questions about how to file taxes with premium tax credits for a dependent? My taxes have always been super simple and straightforward. I work full time and have 2 kids, but I don't have employer health benefits and have had Medicaid for all 3 of us since my divorce. My 19 year old son was dropped from Medicaid coverage and I signed him up for an ACA policy through a broker who told me it wouldn't affect my taxes. My son is autistic and is a full time college student. He lives at home and I've always claimed him as a dependent. He doesn't have a job, but did have a little income from a summer internship. But since he has this policy does he have to file taxes? He didn't make enough money last year to meet the FPL for an individual and I didn't earn enough to meet the FPL for a family of 3. I think as far as the federal government is concerned he should still have Medicaid, but we live in a red state that didn't expand Medicaid, so there's no coverage for 18-24 year old students who don't have children. Do I file my taxes as usual with my children as dependents and then file taxes for him with his 1095-a and put that he can be claimed as a dependent? Do I not claim him as a dependent even though he is most definitely a dependent? He's the only one with an ACA policy and I do not know what I'm doing and I'm afraid since he didn't make enough money that he'll have to pay back thousands of dollars in subsidies. Thanks for any advice!"

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · None

Health sharing ministries and short-term plans · 3 documents

"Anyone considering a health share in place of ACA? We are a healthy family of 5. I am 30, my wife is 27, and our kids are all under 3. We were paying \$1181 a month this year until our 3rd born came along. Then it went up to \$1580 for the same plan. Now enrolling for next year, they want \$2800 a month for the same plan. It's just not affordable and really doesn't even make sense to buy it at that rate. I don't want to go completely uninsured because of the kids and we have a lot of assets to lose. So instead of the ACA I have been looking at health sharing companies. I know they get a lot of negative flack on here because they are not traditional insurance. But the option isn't really between the ACA. It's between that and having nothing. I have looked at a bunch, Zion health share seems fairly reputable and being that we are younger and have no pre existing conditions, I think most things would be covered. Anyone else in the same boat of looking at alternatives?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 46 upvotes · None

"Finally found a decent deal this year at age 62 . I had health insurance first two years after retiring in 2014 (am a retired RN). Paid \$ 663/ month for health insurance the first year and \$ 677/ month the following year.They wanted to jack it up to \$ 913 /month when I turned 58.I said no,went without for 5 years.In the meantime I was able to get out of debt.Thank God,nothing catastrophic happened to me . This month I was able to obtain some decent health insurance at \$ 673/ month ,which includes some supplements to defray some out of pocket costs. Sounds expensive,but trust me in South Florida \$ 673/month is a deal. Since my RN pension is now supplemented by Social Security benefits,the premium hit is easier to take. Medicare in two years."

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement - Here Are 4 Options · 22 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pjR3wlGOZsc&lc=Ugwp_Ute8re04Vpyk8d4AaABAq

"[US] Health insurance as a solo small business owner is killing me financially, how are you handling it? Running a small boutique for a few years now and the one thing that never gets easier is health insurance. Coming from a corporate background where HR handled everything, I had no idea how brutal the individual market was until I was actually in it. Right now I'm paying more per month for my own coverage than I used to pay toward rent. And the deductibles aren't even that good. I looked at marketplace plans, looked at shortterm options, even went down the health sharing ministry rabbit hole for a while before deciding it felt too risky for my situation. What I keep running into is that the options are either expensive and okay, or cheaper and kind of terrifying. There's no middle ground that actually makes sense. For those of you running smaller operations, especially retail or service businesses where you're the only employee or close to it, what have you actually landed on? Did you find something through a professional association or a local chamber? Did you just accept the high premium and build it into your pricing? I track my finances pretty obsessively so I know exactly what this is costing me each year, and it's genuinely one of my biggest line items. Curious what other people have figured out."

— r/selfemployed · 10 upvotes · None

Google and online research · 1 documents

"I just found this thread after doing an online search for complaints about Imperial Insurance in Arizona. I made the mistake of signing up for Imperial through the health marketplace, effective January 1. My previous insurance, Banner Aetna, withdrew from the marketplace, so I had to find new insurance. I knew I was taking a chance with an untested insurance company, but everything else was so much more expensive. Well, you get what you pay for. I, too, never received any plan documents in the mail or even via email. Every piece of information about my plan I had to go looking for online. Well I did get a flimsy insurance card with a primary care doc I'd never seen. Changing that to my own PCP with Imperial took multiple calls. But that's not the worst of it. Please see next paragraph. Nowhere in my Imperial portal am I able to access my Explanations of Benefits, nor can I see any information about providers I've seen and what Imperial has paid or not paid for. Contrary to their claims, Imperial DOES NOT send out EOBs to its customers. At all. And they have contradicted themselves because after I complained to them, they actually admitted in an email to me that they only provide EOBs to providers! I'm flying blind here -- how do I know whether the amount on a bill from a provider is accurate and should be paid by me? I jumped through all the hoops and filed a complaint with the Arizona Department of Insurance and Financial Institutions in early March. A couple of weeks later they closed the case stating that "The information we reviewed indicates that Imperial has acknowledged your concerns, and they have communicated their finds with you in written correspondence." Ha. All Imperial did was copy some EOBs (not all of them) and mail them to me. I just hope and pray that I don't have any serious health event this year, as my trust in Imperial "Health" is nil."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1q9bscn/imperial_health_on_aca/odyfwn8/

Dislikes

Premiums they can't pay after the subsidy loss

"The scariest part... from someone who works at a health insurance company I work at a large health insurance company, and lately all I hear about is the potential end of ACA subsidies, rising premiums, and skyrocketing healthcare costs. But the part no one's talking about? This could become the new normal. When has any industry ever raised prices and then actually brought them back down once people got used to paying more? Even if healthcare costs drop (and that's a big if), what incentive do insurers have to lower premiums when people are already paying the higher rates? It's like gas... people used to complain about \$2.50 a gallon. Now we celebrate it. That's the scary part. Prices rise, we adapt, and eventually we forget what "reasonable" even looked like. Unless wages start catching up, we're all in serious trouble."

— r/HealthInsurance · 2,664 upvotes · None

"Virginia ACA Rates Posted Today: Share Your Increase In Virginia and rates came up today. Self employed couple 59 & 61. This year our premium was \$1187/month. Same plan next year \$2,109/month. This is more than my mortgage payment and a \$922/month increase brings the total yearly cost to \$50,616. We will have to switch to a high deductible low quality Bronze plan with a \$7,500 deductible EACH with a monthly premium of \$1452/month. This is beyond belief. Continue contacting your elected officials people 🙄"

— r/obamacare · 584 upvotes · None

"Healthcare Premiums to Skyrocket (Who Can Afford it?) Premium tax credits are set to expire at the end of 2025, which means premiums will be skyrocketing. How can anyone afford this? Premiums are already so high that so many families have trouble affording them, now they will be even higher? Who here can afford an increase in their premiums? All that this will mean is less people will be insured because they can't afford premiums. Subsidies will be reduced a great deal as well for those at or near the poverty line. The subsidies were allowing folks to be insured because premiums were discounted. Remove or reduce the discount, and those people won't be able to be insured. Healthcare is prohibitively expensive already, and it's about to become even more expensive. How can anyone afford this? My guess is that most people can't. Does the gov know what this will do to families' bottom lines? Concerned,"

— r/HealthInsurance · 293 upvotes · None

"Insurance carriers increased rates on ACA plans with based off the expectation of lower enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are put back in, what happens to the now jacked up rates that were already approved by states and sold during open-enrollment? Carriers have increased full cost rates ahead of schedule because they expect a drop in enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are reinstated, what happens to the already inflated rates? Each insurance carrier must get its rate increase approved by the state annually, often months before open enrollment. This year, carriers justified rate hikes primarily by citing: 1. Lower projected enrollment numbers due to expiring ACA subsidies 2. The rising cost of GLP-1 weight loss drugs (even though most ACA marketplace plans don't cover these) I'm re-emphasizing because I fear people will still confuse the question. I am not talking about increases people are seeing based off loss of their personal subsidy, I am talking about the plan's actual cost. Aka, what someone would pay if they didn't receive subsidy. My state approved my insurance company for a 27% increase for 2026. They have again applied that increase disproportionately, increasing the individual plans more than their group plans. My personal non-subsidized cheapest HSA eligible ACA plan went up 40% on just the premium, with increases in the cost-sharing amounts as well. This is about average across my local market. Their group rate plans only went up by single digit amounts. Even if the government reinstates subsidies, I'm not hearing anyone addressing the issue of rate increases that relied on inaccurate enrollment projections. Open enrollment has already begun. Will these companies be forced to rework their approved plans retroactively? Are we going to get refunds? I don't see it happening. If they don't, the insurance companies will profit even more from this political situation. This event has allowed them to quickly raise plan costs beyond their actual expenses. If it's too late for 2026, what's the chances they'll actually lower rates even for 2027?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 229 upvotes · None

"My premium increased 590%. Is this normal? I understand without the enhanced subsidies we'd be seeing double or triple premiums next year. However, my premium skyrocketed. In 2025, I paid \$80 and my premiums are set to increase to \$552. The lowest option available was \$300 for catastrophic insurance which wouldn't work for me. I had to go with the \$450 option. I put that my income was \$730 biweekly after deductions. My take home pay is \$1200 a month. My friend in Florida makes the same as me and her premium only increased from \$11 to \$50. My coworker in Wisconsin is also getting a similar low cost option. I am so confused why my premium increased so much. Did anyone else in Illinois experience this? Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level. Edit: also, my parents are helping to pay part of my premiums for now. Otherwise, I'd be out of luck. Even though I'm grateful, it doesn't feel good having to rely on my parents for this. But knowing my health history I could end up in serious trouble if I go uninsured. Update: After a month on the marketplace plan, I was found eligible for Medicaid so it ended up working out at the end. I was worried since I'd been denied for Medicaid in the past. It looks like the increased premiums finally made me eligible."

— r/HealthInsurance · 152 upvotes · None

""Get Covered Illinois"--2026 premium notices sent out today. This year, Illinois switched over to its own program, rather than using Healthcare.gov. 2026 premiums hit the street today. The unsubsidized premium for me and my wife (both in our early to mid-60s) is \$2,915.99, This represents a 17% premium increase from 2025. In Illinois, my carrier, Blue Cross/Blue Shield, had gotten approved for an average 27% premium increase across all of its policy forms; I'm not sure why we got the smaller percentage increase. I had thought that people our age would have been hit with the highest percentage increase in premiums. The automatic renewal letter that I got described my projected monthly subsidy, and my "monthly premium" (in other words, the subsidized premium). I figured out the total unsubsidized premium by adding those figures together. Because of the way that the numbers were laid out in the letter, it appears that the people who run the Illinois program believe that Federal subsidies will be renewed for 2026."

— r/HealthInsurance · 131 upvotes · None

"Well this isnt the case for me. My premiums increased by \$900 a month thanks to the changes made in the new bill passed"

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=Ugw7er9470USJbsd5cx4AaABAq>

"ACA income estimation How does ACA premium tax credits work relative to income estimation? I have never had insurance through ACA. I was terminated a few months ago and unable to COBRA. We are a family of 5. Both my wife and I will try to pick up work/gigs where we can. However with uncertain times, who knows how much money will come in. So when looking at ACA income estimation for 2026, it looks like below a certain amount (for my state of SC) of 37.8k, it has our family ineligible for premium tax credits (but kids would qualify for Medicaid). If I raise income by 2,000 per year, the premium tax credit jumps to 1822 per month from zero for my wife and I. Going from 38 to 40 to 50k, it stays around 1800. Going to 60K it drops to 1656. 70k 1543, 80k 1417, then 90K jumps up to 2465, then starts trickling down again. At 150,601 it drops from 1818 to zero. Can someone ELI5 me the logic of that jump in premium tax credit when going from 80K to 90K? What happens at tax time if I overestimate the income? If I underestimate the income? What happens at re-enrollment next year in those cases? Not looking for debate in the issue, but now I hear that subsidies may not be renewed for next year. But this morning, I read it may only apply to something called a subsidy cliff, and that subsidies will be paid as before 2020. My head is spinning with trying to grasp this."

— r/HealthInsurance · 4 upvotes · None

"MAGI calculation help Never have had an HSA until this year and I want to make sure I understand its effect on MAGI. I'm over 55 on an ACA bronze plan so that means I can contribute \$5400 per year. To retain my subsidy I have to keep my MAGI at 400% or less of the FPL for a single person. This would be of \$62,600. Lets say my MAGI for 2026 is \$68,000. By my understanding I would take $\$68,000 - \$5400 = \$62,600$ so I would keep my subsidy. If MAGI were $\$68,001 - \$5400 = \$62,601$ and I would fall off of the subsidy cliff... Am I understanding this correctly? I ask all of this because I am shuffling around investment accounts aiming for a MAGI of \$65,000, leaving wiggle room to steer clear of the cliff if I am understanding how this works. Thanks."

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · None

"Thanks Joe. Been retired for 1.5 years now and went on the ACA in California. Was paying \$900/month for Kaiser HSA plan. Looks like our premiums are going to jump to \$2000/month on the same plan with the ACA subsidies going away. Definitely going to check out Move Health and see if they may have something that will work for us. Appreciate the information you provide and I hope you get that affiliate link! :)"

— YouTube · How to Get Affordable Health Insurance Before Medicare · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dVyzw5Ac7pA&lc=UgxM5fBHJOEY45zQLv54AaABAg>

"My ACA premiums will make a huge jump in '26 (percentage-wise) due to the end of extended ACA benefits - from \$4 to \$124/mo. Additionally, there are no longer plans available without co-pays or co-insurance, and the out-of-pocket max is also increasing significantly. I find it pretty much impossible to complain about that, though - incredibly grateful for this truly affordable health insurance."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=Ugyhoe7QYX42h_ByAt14AaABAg

"Subsidy Cliff Question for 2026 I'm looking at the new guidelines for 2026 and would appreciate if someone could confirm this for me. My household size is 4, so 400% of FPL for us is \$128,600. I read that for 2026, subsidies will cover any amount over 10% of your income if you're below that. Does this mean if we make \$128,000 for example, that our monthly premium cannot be more than \$1,028/month? For the plan we are currently on, we are being quoted roughly \$2,500/month starting in January. So if we're able to bring our MAGI below \$128,000 will this drop to \$1,028? Is this right?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 2 upvotes · None

Deductibles too high to use the plan

"Husband brings home \$5400 a month, health insurance costs \$1300...family of 4. What the hell. It was \$900 a month and I already felt like we were being stretched thin. I am a stay at home mom to two young children, daycare cost more than my paycheck, and I didn't have a career worth staying in. My husband and I both intend on picking up a side gig, probably DoorDash or something, just to get by. But how can we ever get ahead if health insurance keeps rising like crazy? My husbands job does offer health insurance but it's basically the same price with a higher deductible. The plan we are looking at on the Marketplace has a \$0 health deductible and a \$1500 drug deductible, with max OOP of \$19500 for my family. His health insurance as a \$6000 deductible per person, \$12000 for family and the max OOP is the same. So really the biggest question is do we want a lower deductible or lower max OOP, since the premiums are roughly the same...and we think we want the lower deductible. If 96K a year isn't enough for a family of 4 in Ohio now....then the middle class is fuckin dead."

— r/HealthInsurance · 664 upvotes · None

"Virginia ACA Rates Posted Today: Share Your Increase In Virginia and rates came up today. Self employed couple 59 & 61. This year our premium was \$1187/month. Same plan next year \$2,109/month. This is more than my mortgage payment and a \$922/month increase brings the total yearly cost to \$50,616. We will have to switch to a high deductible low quality Bronze plan with a \$7,500 deductible EACH with a monthly premium of \$1452/month. This is beyond belief. Continue contacting your elected officials people 🙄"

— r/obamacare · 584 upvotes · None

"My new ACA premiums and deductible - considering just not having health insurance for a few years. So I had a life event last month that required me to get ACA. My monthly premium was \$485 and my deductible was \$7600. Just got an email saying my current health insurance will not be offered next year. Instead my new premium will be about \$560 and my deductible will be about \$11000. Also it seems many of my co-insurance will be higher by about \$70. And I'm not sure what else has changed for the worse. At this point I'm seriously considering not having health insurance for a few years. It seems cheaper to just plan a 3-week trip overseas and get better healthcare for much cheaper. You heard me - better! I just don't want to enable this defunct healthcare system anymore. If I'm in an accident I hope EMTALA saves my broke behind - in both senses of the phrase. I'll pay what I can then declare bankruptcy. If not life threatening, I'll take it overseas. A roundtrip ticket to India costs \$1500, \$1000 if you wait a month or so. That's less than three months premium. Over a year I can save up \$7000 in premiums. Saving up for one year buys me a full check up and a vacation trip. What do you think? Anyone considering the same thing? For those with kids - you have my sympathies."

— r/HealthInsurance · 574 upvotes · None

"\$2600/mth, \$6k deductible for wife and I Blue Shield Bronze HSA PPO w/ \$6k deductible is looking like \$2650/mth for 2026, for wife and I (middle aged, in good health). This is a CoveredCA ACA plan, and I'm self-employed. This is completely unaffordable. Having already cut all our costs to the bone, I only have one option, which is to raise my rates, and hope that my competitors will also be raising theirs too so mine aren't extortionate. The only other thing I could do it seems is to become younger, which I'll try and organize, but seems to have some complex issues. This is going to massively, massively spike inflation."

— r/HealthInsurance · 357 upvotes · None

"Thinking of going uninsured for 2026 and paying the penalty.. Thoughts? Im 26 in California, I qualified for medical with my previous job but with this new job I make too much so I was looking at Covered California. For 2026 the CHEAPEST BRONZE plan I could qualify for will cost me \$340 with subsidies included and an insane deductible of \$7000. I think its ridiculous that a healthy 26 year old that eats right and goes to the doctors once a year just for consultation will pay that. Im Seriously considering going uninsured and I understand the potential risks. One bad injury or emergency hospital trip could cost me thousands. But if I get a high hospital bill I could work it out with their financial services department. based on my obligatory expenses I could justify I dont have money to pay this hypothetical bill. My question is: What do you guys recommend? Am I doing the math right? How much would I pay in tax penalties if I make 52k year. Edit*** Thank you guys for all the advice — a lot of you were right to point out how easy it is to underestimate how expensive and financially destructive a single hospital visit can be. That's exactly why I made this post, and I really appreciate the reality check. I ended up finding a catastrophic plan that meets California's standards and has zero deductible, which honestly feels like the best of the worst options right now. This doesn't mean I'm happy about it — I just made the most practical choice I could. We should never have to accept a system that makes people feel lucky just to afford to get sick. But we already normalized this."

— r/HealthInsurance · 222 upvotes · None

"Going back to school for student medical insurance Many of us have increasing insurance costs, in my case it went from \$660/month last year with enhanced subsidies to \$1425/month this year with no subsidies so if retired or underemployed it becomes difficult to justify the costs. In my case I am a few years away from 65 but not wanting to work full-time (I am fortunate) due to my volunteer work I started looking for part time jobs with benefits. I was chasing a rabbit down a hole and found that as a part-time student within the UNC system I was eligible to also get student coverage. Some of the rules \-Have to be in a degree program \-Must attend on Campus \-Part-time = 6 credits Some numbers Not a student- ACA \$17,100/annual, \$2000 deductible max OOP \$8200 As a student \-Tuition/fees annually \$3872 (6 credits/semester) \-Medical insurance \$3168 (12-months) \$500 deductible max OOP \$4000 , campus clinic use unlimited with \$0 co-pay Total annual = \$7040 Additional student benefits (mandatory fees) \-Access to fitness center/pool \-Access to library \-Student discounts By going back to school I will save just under \$10k/annually So I enrolled and was accepted into a GIS program starting in Aug 26, not only will I be saving money but for me the structure of a schedule will help me fill in my week. Even if I became a full-time my annual costs would be \$11k/annual which would still be a savings over ACA only. I am fortunate to not need to work so YMMV, but thought I would share my adventure."

— r/HealthInsurance · 92 upvotes · None

"If I tell my doctor's office I don't have insurance, can they look up whether that's true or not? Context: I've been on Medicaid (in Illinois) for the last few years. I filled out my redetermination in September as usual, then got a letter at the very end of November that I no longer qualify (my income went up and I'm now at around ~\$25,000/year, before I was hovering right around the cut off, which is about \$21,000 I believe). So now I'm looking at Marketplace plans and man....they are all so so awful!! The deductibles are crazy, and it's basically a choice between paying hundreds a month in order to maybe pay \$20-40 each time you go to the doctor, or paying \$10-\$30 a month but paying \$100-\$300 every time to go to the doctor. I take psychiatric medications that I rely on. I've been stable on the same ones for a few years now. I only see my doctor (psychiatrist) four times a year, and it's basically just as a requirement for her to be able to approve my refills. My psychiatrist's office offers sliding scale for uninsured patients, and I would only need to pay about \$35 per visit with them (plus about \$13/month for my meds with GoodRx coupons). This is a setup I could afford, so I was leaning towards just not buying health insurance at all for the coming year and paying for my care out of pocket this way. HOWEVER. I'm 29 years old, and this year two people I know who are even younger than I am were diagnosed with cancer. My parents got in a very scary car accident about two weeks ago (they rolled down a mountain but are miraculously fine because my dad's car is basically a tank). My point being, life has been reminding me a lot recently that no one knows what's going to happen tomorrow, and I feel like having SOME kind of coverage for if things go horribly horribly wrong would probably be in my best interest. I've also read a lot of reddit horror stories of otherwise 'healthy' young people deciding to forego insurance and regretting it after developing unexpected and expensive illnesses. So. I went back to the Marketplace website to look at the plans again. Found one that's \$6/month, has a \$7500 deductible, and covers almost nothing, *but* would be an affordable fail-safe if, god forbid, something really terrible and/or expensive were to happen. My psychiatrist's office does not take this plan. I called them and basically asked, 'If I hypothetically had insurance that you all don't take, would I still be eligible for the sliding scale cash price?' They told me no, that I would have to pay the full cost of the visit, which would be \$300 each time. This finally brings me to my question (thank for for sticking with me if you've read this far lol): **is there anyway for my doctor's office to *know* whether or not I actually have insurance, if I tell them that I don't?** I don't want to come across as if I'm trying to scam the system (although the healthcare system in the US is a nightmare and tbh I wouldn't judge anyone for doing so). But I just literally can't afford to keep seeing my doctor if it's going to be \$300 an appointment. But I also don't want to forego coverage completely. My ideal way to move forward would be to buy the \$6/month plan for emergencies, and just tell my psych that I don't have coverage so I could pay the sliding scale cost for the appointments. Is this something anyone has experience with?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · None

"I'm a single person, age 60, using the ACA without subsidies, because I don't "qualify"... for just medical it costs me \$1000 per month with a \$6000 annual deductible... which means, I have to spend \$18,000 a year to just utilize the insurance. Totally unsustainable and unacceptable for a "first-world" country."

— YouTube · Early Retirement Health Insurance Before Medicare: A Step-by-Step Framework · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NAYG0yvzBI8&lc=Ugzy4GSnFfdMqg7huXR4AaABAq.AVBMLSYyqO-AVBbxqPVAdU>

"Get government OUT of healthcare and insurance! Back when Obumer first messed with it and caused premiums to start to rise (both ACA and non ACA plans as the new costs for new required benefits, legal and regulatory compliance, etc has to be absorbed via any and all health insurance plans regardless of an ACA plan or not). We went from 3 people being covered on what would be about a "silver" on the ACA or a mid plan was \$238 per month. Today for two people it is over \$1,300 per month and there are areas that are even higher than the state and county / area that we live in. On a per covered basis our health insurance premiums are up 410%. Even a few years ago when we moved from one state to another we paid around \$492 per month....four years later, just over \$1,300. thank you government. Just the insurance premiums and rent (no power, water, food, gas, car insurance or any other expenses) costs me \$40,200 per year and that gets paid with after tax dollars so you do the math. just the fixed cost of a roof and insurance with nothing else and we need to earn around \$47,000 before taxes to cover that. God forbid we want to eat, have car insurance and other insurance, fuel for the car, car repairs, clothing, phone service, etc. Again, great work to the tick in Congress for screwing everyone over rather than just helping the few that need, ACTUALLY need the help. All the fraud out there so far should give everyone some idea of the money we flush down the drain. I wager if it was totaled up it would be around \$500 billion per year or more and that is already after the gubment makes so many other things artificially expensive....college tuition anyone? Nothing my insurance agent loves more than sitting across the table from me as we review the plans that, even after I spend \$16,000 per year on premiums for I still have very high deductibles making it really cost me around \$25,000 before insurance does anything when you add premiums and deductibles together (and no I don't count \$15 off some pharma scrip as mattering). What they need to do is allow, the law prevents this for most people - that's right the government is making it illegal for you to purchase certain types of plans less you fall into a small criteria. what am I ranting about? Disaster style policies. Everyone needs to be able to get those but for most plans you have to be under a certain income or under 30 years of age or just unemployed and need a bridge. My spouse and I don't need all the "benefits" we just want emergancy coverage and disease treatment type stuff. There is so much that pad plans, even in hers (and she is almost 50!) still has all this child birthing stuff, breast feeding classes, etc. all for "free" even though she is almost 50 and also can't even have kids in the first place but, same risk pool as everyone else rather than being prices as an individual like with your car insurance."

— YouTube · \$ How MUCH ACA Marketplace PREMIUMS Are Going UP In 2027 · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hOGTkeTtK0Y&lc=UgzNhfDE0RdaDEBn28x4AaABAg>

"What about employer marketplaces? My premium is \$489, my deductible is \$5000, and my out of pocket maximum is \$6550."

— YouTube · Health care premiums expected to rise for Affordable Care Act enrollees · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Bpict0tiNg&lc=UgxGESnkCcsxQ2uipFJ4AaABAg>

"Started my LLC a few weeks ago and just signed up for private insurance for 2024. It's not HSA-eligible because it's a PPO, but the deductible is \$7,500. This whole HSA concept was started to help with high deductibles, so I don't see why it matters whether it's a PPO/HDHP/HMO/whatever. My deductible is HIGH, I should be allowed to contribute to an HSA."

— YouTube · How to Get Health Insurance When Self-Employed · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G eUdFzjUKcw&lc=UgxOfxKc0RkKNA8xo54AaABAg>

"If you're a woman - do NOT get Ambetter. . I'm self-employed and paying for Ambetter from the marketplace, which is commercial insurance and supposed to be decent for the co-pay about \$400. Everything about this insurance is bad. 1. ZocDoc, the largest online scheduling system for doctors, doesn't even recognise Ambetter in my state and I can't use the convenient website to schedule any of the appointments. I can't overstate how inconvenient that is. 2. Impossible to find providers - the website doesn't update them frequently, you have to call multiple times to find someone who actual is in network. The number of providers is so tiny you have to wait for weeks to get an appointment. 3. Does't cover anything! Refused to cover my yearly mammograms (prescribed by my doctor based on my personal medical history!) and covers literary ZERO of anything fertility-related. Not a single fertility test is covered. This insurance is a punishment for women, please stay away. I'm leaving 2 stars because customer service actually was trying to help me and I was able to reach a human being relative easy."

— TrustPilot · ambetterhealth.com · 2★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/69039842f7718f8c00735d85>

"I had used e health before but never.... I had used e health before but never again. They advised me to take a policy that had absolutely zero help to me. They then apologize and fit me with a different policy. One again zero benefit. I went over all my providers etc over and over again to make sure i was covered. Now I find out my doctors and hospitals aren't in network! I am now stuck with this policy I pay for and can't use. I would never use again or recommend to anyone."

— TrustPilot · eHealth Insurance · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/67f12fdfa96111d20f324a40>

"I receive \$85.00 a month for over the.... I receive \$85.00 a month for over the counter products I might need. I was saving the \$85.00 dollars to put with the next month and buy something that cost \$139.00. Went to do it and found I lost that first months \$85.00. You HAVE to use the entire amount monthly or you lose it for that month. Secondly, they give you an online catalog to shop from. The prices are ridiculous. Many times they don't have a product you need. By the way you can use your monthly \$85.00 at CVS, WALMART, and a few others. Notice I said at. You can't use your benefits online with any other stores YOU MUST GO IN TO THE STORE. I'm disabled and can't get to the closest Walmart unless a neighbor is available. Before you go with EHEALTH consider the hassles. I hope this helps with your decision."

— TrustPilot · eHealth Insurance · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/66be3b5eb4e4754b27bfb97a>

"False representation. First of all they call me and they ring my phone off the hook and get me to take one of their plans and tell me that I'm going to have free medical and dental and vision and I have to talk to three people on the phone before that happens and when I finally do find out what I qualify for none of it I don't get free dental and vision I just get the medical and I'm promised a benefit card where I can buy food and gas That's the biggest lie I have ever heard in my life I've had this insurance three times and the card is not accepted anywhere and you have to do tutorials online to even earn money and you don't earn as much money as you lately people to believe. And you take my insurance away from me after telling me it's free after about 3 months you take it away and then a month later you calling me back again trying to get me back on it so what is the point in the purpose? I do not want any part of this company it's a scam from the get-go. You people lie about benefit cards and they're not worth deadly squat. And today I got a call from a lady trying to get sell me this insurance and I told her I said look I've already had this card in this insurance three times three times and all three times the card wasn't accepted anywhere. I said it's no good it's it's a light I can't use it why would I want something that I couldn't use? And that woman paused for a minute and she said you're right she said you are right. Then she puts me on the phone with another person which is a man and he asked me the same stupid questions that she did and says I'm going to have free dental and vision along with free medical care then he wants to put me on the phone with somebody else I mean that's ridiculous why why three people what is going on with that and by the time you get to the third person who tells you what you're qualified for you're not qualified for any of that stuff at all so why do you guys have to scheme to get people to sign up are you getting a cut for it or what"

— TrustPilot · ambetterhealth.com · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a6bc5e0b6e698f6a00f2097>

"If you're a woman - do NOT get Ambetter. . I'm self-employed and paying for Ambetter from the marketplace, which is commercial insurance and supposed to be decent for the co-pay about \$400. Everything about this insurance is bad. 1. ZocDoc, the largest online scheduling system for doctors, doesn't even recognise Ambetter in my state and I can't use the convenient website to schedule any of the appointments. I can't overstate how inconvenient that is. 2. Impossible to find providers - the website doesn't update them frequently, you have to call multiple times to find someone who actual is in network. The number of providers is so tiny you have to wait for weeks to get an appointment. 3. Doesn't cover anything! Refused to cover my yearly mammograms (prescribed by my doctor based on my personal medical history!) and covers literary ZERO of anything fertility-related. Not a single fertility test is covered. This insurance is a punishment for women, please stay away. I'm leaving 2 stars because customer service actually was trying to help me and I was able to reach a human being relative easy."

— TrustPilot · ambetterhealth.com · 2★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/69039842f7718f8c00735d85>

Owing money back at tax time

"Paying for ACA (Obamacare) We're about to go on ACA with no subsidies, it'll be about \$20k a year, \$1600 a month. [Healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov/>) hands the billing off to the insurance carrier (e.g., Blue Cross, Oscar, United, Kaiser). Does anyone have experience using a credit card for full yearly prepayment, or split monthly payments (for example using multiple cards to split the monthly payment) with specific carriers?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 13 upvotes · None

"Need clarification on underestimating income I plan on enrolling my mother in law for 2026 but not sure how to approach her income. I had spoken to broker and I was informed she should show 22k before deductions to get tax credit for 2026. Before I was able to show her income as 2400 a year and get the aca credits. I read posts saying that the repayments of credits are for those who overestimate income not underestimate. Also read the other way around. If I were to sign her up saying her income projected is 22k but let's say at end of 2026 it's 3k. Since the income was underestimated will she need to payback the subsidies? she doesn't qualify for medicaid because she been in USA 2.5 years and you need to be living 5 years to qualify for that"

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · None

"Questions about how to file taxes with premium tax credits for a dependent? My taxes have always been super simple and straightforward. I work full time and have 2 kids, but I don't have employer health benefits and have had Medicaid for all 3 of us since my divorce. My 19 year old son was dropped from Medicaid coverage and I signed him up for an ACA policy through a broker who told me it wouldn't affect my taxes. My son is autistic and is a full time college student. He lives at home and I've always claimed him as a dependent. He doesn't have a job, but did have a little income from a summer internship. But since he has this policy does he have to file taxes? He didn't make enough money last year to meet the FPL for an individual and I didn't earn enough to meet the FPL for a family of 3. I think as far as the federal government is concerned he should still have Medicaid, but we live in a red state that didn't expand Medicaid, so there's no coverage for 18-24 year old students who don't have children. Do I file my taxes as usual with my children as dependents and then file taxes for him with his 1095-a and put that he can be claimed as a dependent? Do I not claim him as a dependent even though he is most definitely a dependent? He's the only one with an ACA policy and I do not know what I'm doing and I'm afraid since he didn't make enough money that he'll have to pay back thousands of dollars in subsidies. Thanks for any advice!"

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · None

"Also self-employed and just dealt with our health insurance today. We are trying to maximize expenses to keep our income under the \$106,000 limit that allows us to qualify for the ACA subsidy. If we happen to make more than that, we will have to pay back the difference. For example, our new plan costs \$2400 out of pocket. The subsidy covers all but \$800. So we pay \$800 monthly out of pocket unless we make more than \$106,000 in which case we have to pay it all back after we file our 2026 taxes. We chose to sign up for an HSA eligible plan to be able to deduct the HSA contributions of \$8750 for the year. It is a ridiculous game that we Americans are forced to play. I am firmly in the "Medicare for All" camp. But our leadership can't seem to do anything to make that happen."

— r/selfemployed · https://www.reddit.com/r/selfemployed/comments/1pn63ub/us_my_health_insurance_just_doubled_curious_how/nu8wxja/

"If you are young and making \$40k you will likely get a decent subsidy. Accountants do have an "extra" step when you use the ACA, but it's their job to help you not waste money. I usually give an estimate for my salary and then set aside the subsidy in a saving account should I have to repay the subsidy come tax season. If I get a \$200/mo credit then I'll put that amount in savings. Private plans often require underwriting and this can effect your premiums. The ACA does offer some protection w/preexisting cond for as long as it lasts. Also, many states have laws in place where private ins plans must meet the aca requirements, so many brokers will use the aca when quoting plans. good luck!"

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1or63n2/aca_plans_versus_just_enrolling_through_private/nnpwd7/

"Keep in mind if you underestimate your income and then end up above 400% FPL, not only will you have to pay back your subsidies but you might get hit with a tax underpayment penalty. Unless you're going to keep really close track of your income all year, I'd probably just forgo the subsidies. If you end up eligible, you'll get a nice refund when you file your taxes."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1psdio2/if_they_extend_the_subsidies_and_get_rid_of_the_nvad2oz/

"Thanks! I've always just used TurboTax since 1998, but there was never any situation I was unsure about before. 😊 Fingers crossed I don't have to pay back the subsidy for being too poor."

— r/Obamacare · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1r5uq2v/questions_about_how_to_file_taxes_with_premium/o5lrym8/

"my understanding is regardless of your intent, if you underestimate your income and the actual income would change the subsidy, you have to repay it."

— r/Obamacare · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1q2sa59/need_clarification_on_underestimating_income/nxgc0si/

"Devoted Health is engaging in bad-faith.... Devoted Health is engaging in bad-faith claims adjudication by intentionally weaponizing administrative obstacles to systematically withhold mandated Medicare benefits under National Coverage Determination (NCD) 150.3. Detailed Description: I am escalating this dispute because Devoted Health is utilizing intentional administrative barrier tactics to evade its federal statutory obligations under my Devoted Choice Giveback ("Pay Back") PPO plan. The plan explicitly affirmed my clinical eligibility for chronic low back pain acupuncture in a formal postal letter and established a precedent by successfully reimbursing session one. Their subsequent withholding of payments for five identical, consecutive sessions is not an operational oversight; it is a calculated non-delivery of baseline federal Medicare benefits. Devoted's out-of-state corporate management team is exploiting its remote structure to issue repetitive, bad-faith demands for "insufficient information". Because the billing codes, clinician credentials, and clinical documentation submitted for the unpaid sessions are completely identical to the approved first session, these demands constitute an intentional strategy to create a cycle of administrative exhaustion. By forcing a local Hawaii senior to finance a federally protected benefit out-of-pocket, Devoted Health is in direct, willful breach of its CMS contract. I request that CMS bypass the plan's failed internal grievance metrics, launch an immediate compliance audit into Devoted's Hawaii PPO reimbursement protocols, and compel immediate restitution. Devoted Health formally established eligibility criteria and authorized coverage for the chronic low back pain acupuncture treatments via written postal correspondence. Under established Medicare Advantage guidelines, an insurer cannot arbitrarily revoke or obstruct an active, written authorization when the subsequent medical claims present identical clinical indicators and treatment modalities. Arbitrary and Capricious Claims Processing: The plan's administrative team has acted inconsistently by successfully reimbursing the initial acupuncture session, yet denying or withholding payment for the subsequent 5 identical sessions. Because the exact same provider information, billing codes, and clinical documentation were submitted across all claims, the plan's repeated assertion that there is "insufficient information" constitutes an arbitrary administrative barrier. Improper Adjudication and Unreasonable Administrative Burden: By demanding additional, unspecified information for ongoing sessions that identical documentation already sufficed to cover, Devoted Health is creating an uncertified administrative hurdle. This violates CMS expectations for fair claims processing, shifting an unlawful financial and administrative burden onto the beneficiary after prior approval was secured. Violation of CMS Chronic Low Back Pain Coverage Mandates: National Coverage Determination (NCD) 150.3 dictates that Medicare covers up to 12 initial acupuncture sessions within a 90-day window for chronic low back pain. By withholding payment for 5 consecutive sessions within this approved window, Devoted Health is failing to deliver the baseline federal benefits mandated under its Medicare Advantage contract. Demand for Prompt Equitable Estoppel and Immediate Reimbursement: Because the beneficiary reasonably relied on Devoted Health's explicit written assurances and the initial successful reimbursement to continue necessary medical treatments, the plan is legally and equitably estopped from denying coverage. Devoted Health must immediately resolve this internal processing error, honor their written commitment, and issue full reimbursement for the 5 outstanding sessions to prevent further financial injury to the beneficiary. On top of it all, they have escalated the excessive stress on MY HEALTH."

— TrustPilot · Devoted Health · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a8d09f0594549203e916983>

"This company seems scammer on pay back program to be a scammer for.... This company seems to be a scammer for sure. The pay back program is a scam. RUN from this company as fast as you can run. Customer service is great, but don't have a claim."

— TrustPilot · Devoted Health · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/69eea91c7998fc3575de2684>

"In 2025 I signed up for health care.... In 2025 I signed up for health care from Ambetter for the months April thru August as I was going on Medicare on Sept 1, 2025. I missed a payment in July (my debit card had been hacked and it had to be investigated to issue me a new card #) for the month of August, in August I made up the payment. In late 2025 I received refunds from Ambetter of my premium payments. I did not understand but didn't think anything of it as I was now on Medicare. In June 2026 I received a bill from my Primary Care doctor for three visits I had made in June, July and August 2025. When looking into this I found that Ambetter had canceled my membership, due to the 1 missed payment, all the way back to the beginning (April 2025) so in June, July, August I had no health coverage. In July 2026 I contacted Ambetter. I sent them proof that I had made all the necessary payments and was told that they can re-instate me to September 2025. In mid-August 2026 I received another bill from my PCP. I contacted Ambetter again and was told that I needed to repay my premiums that had been refunded (\$239.21) by August 8 and it was now August 24. I had never received communication that I was supposed to pay this by August 8 and they have never given me proof that they had told me this. I was told I could make the payment and see what happens. Well my reinstatement was denied because I had not made the payment by August 8. AGAIN I WAS NEVER TOLD THAT I NEEDED TO PAY BY AUGUST 8. I have filed a grievance with them over this affair. If that fails I will have to pay almost \$500 to my PCP through no fault of my own."

— TrustPilot · ambetterhealth.com · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a9c3c2750b54069d8dcfd95>

Narrow networks and doctors who don't take the plan

"There is at least one major flaw in ACA. The idea behind ACA was to provide affordable access to healthcare. Unfortunately, it provides just affordable access to insurance, and that insurance is not accepted by many physicians. Seriously. I live in a major metro with a huge base of primary care physicians as well as specialists. And my experience has been that most doctors don't accept my ACA policy. I have to drive 45 minutes to get to my primary care physician, simply because he was the only doctor I could find who accepted my coverage. So when politicians pat themselves on the back for ACA, I submit that they haven't improved healthcare at all. They've just made it easy for us to find insurance."

— YouTube · Early Retirement Health Insurance Before Medicare: A Step-by-Step Framework · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NAYG0yvzBI8&lc=Ugwov4rykJWpFucCV-B4AaABAg>

"Health insurance is HORRENDOUS this year. Its more dangerous than you stated, so listen up (and so far its not getting better next year): 1. The Cliffs of subsidies, oh the cliffs: Make too much (around 85k GROSS household) and you owe FULL amount of insurance (usually around 21-25k for two people. Thats 25%+ extra "tax" for health insurance!! on top of taxes!!!)... make too little and you owe the FULL amount too. As you know, self employment can be somewhat unpredictable so playing with the tiny financial window for subsidy assistance is nuts. One penny under you owe like 1200 for two for the year... one penny over? you owe 25k. make it make sense! WRITE YOUR REPS! We need at LEAST a Solo small biz option for better and more affordable group health insurance, and the subsidies NOT to have cliffs. 2) Most have access to some better group plans. Solo biz owners are not. We are expected to pay FULL employment taxes on our wages/earnings instead of just HALF if you work for the man, and we dont get access to more favorable group plans. This needs to stop as it is CUTTING to small biz working harder than most (or at least riskier). 3) Middle class is essentially subsidizing poor (ok) and ultra rich (not okay). The richer you get, the less overall cost burden you have. Don't believe me? Lets do the math for a second. if you make 100k as a couple, you'll pay around 22% as highest bracket. Then you also owe roughly 25k of health insurance. **So your overall cost burden for LOWER middle class is 47% of GROSS income.** If you make 25 million dollars a year, your highest tax bracket is around 37%... and your health insurance still costs about 25k. Same same. but that factors into being about .1%. **So ultra rich earners overall cost burden for health insurance we are basically forced to have is drumroll please. 37.1% . LOWER overall COST BURDEN THAN MIDDLE CLASS! at highest bracket. And The richer you get, the less overall cost burden in percent you have.** (Not even mentioning tax breaks and legit loopholes of course. what i said is enough) Sure you pay more dollars, but you pay LESS PERCENT of your income. 25k means very little to a person making 25 million, but it means a TON to the person making 85k. That is NOT fair. **I propose we change it with having everyone just pay a flat tax towards health care. 8%.** We can subsidize the truly poor but definitely not the ultra rich. Thats gotta end of we are essentially forced into the bad health care system we have... **the only thing not universal about our healthcare is that its not universally paid for - the middle class pay overwhelmingly more in cost percent burden than ANYONE else. Facts. WRITE YOUR REPS** 4) short term insurance fine prints: in networks, out of networks... you MUST read it. Agents overwhelmingly do not care or do not know. - or sell fraud insurance. When the rubber hits your road, you may not want an organ transplant cap of 10k, or a emergency airlift of 500 dollars. And you may not even qualify - almost any preexisting disqualifies you. Sure your agent can sign u up but they arent left picking up the pieces when things go wrong. (VERY LITTLE HEALTH AGENT ACCOUNTABILITY) Also once you get sick, you wont get renewed and youre forced back into ACA cesspool. TL:DR **Everyone in the middle class is getting very screwed around health insurance, but solo entrepreneurs are the canary in the coal mine.** We see it first hand how messed up it is, especially this year and next year. Some of us realize it early. The rest will cry at tax time (or when medical bills hit the fan). WRITE YOUR REPS! We need at LEAST 1) Solo small biz option for better and more affordable group health insurance, 2) subsidies NOT to have hard cliffs 3) Maybe most importantly long term reform: We need a fair flat rate where EVERYONE including bezos, pays a flat 8% (or something) of their income towards health insurance. **Right now, it's middle class paying 25% of their income while billionaires pay .00000001% of their income towards it** \- if they even buy our peasant insurance haha. **Effectively we all subsidize the ultra rich too, and have to play the health insurance hunger games.** Its INSANE."

— r/selfemployed · https://www.reddit.com/r/selfemployed/comments/1vk17ni/us_health_insurance_as_a_solo_small_business/p9z8x1m/

"I've gotten 400 calls and texts in a week. And thats for fake insurance. Not ACA Iowa. I've been unemployed to take care of my sick dad. I'm 59 I never thought I wouldn't be not not get a job I guess I won't get insurance and use Good RX for my meds. I'm literally crying and devastated. Ageism it real. The non ACA is still \$500 plus most of medication not covered. MY doctors wont accept non ACA ll the way. I don't trust non ACA. I'm gonna have a heart attack if i can't find a web site where I don't get 40 calls and texts. I've been on cobra \$1000 per month so burnt \$18k I'm healthy."

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=UgzSolhmdmdGTu0UPvF4AaABAq>

"Claims are a nightmare, reps need training, website needs to provide understandable informaiton. I have been calling in for EIGHT MONTHS about a claim that was double billed. Instead of fixing the claim, they split it into two claims and moved around random amounts of money so that neither I nor their own representatives can figure out what happened. THEIR ONLINE CLAIMS PAGE IS A NIGHMARE! So, I'm supposed to just "shut up" and pay whatever the hospital bills me. I had Aetna Medicare before and never had a problem. One of my providers that I really like won't take Aetna anymore, that's the only reason I switched. I'm going back to Aetna next year and I'll find a new provider. The reps are nice, but they struggle to be helpful, as each person I talk to tells me something different. I ask the right questions in the most basic way and still can't get a straight answer. It's just not worth it to have to call over and over and over again for months to try and get it figured out."

— TrustPilot · Humana · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a9b1821f755b887a714df2e>

"Medicare Advantage plan sucks. Medicare Advantage plan sucks. Very limited doctor choice that narrowed during the year, overwhelming paperwork, extreme hassles over required referrals to specialists, no customer service. Can't wait to escape from this hell."

— TrustPilot · UnitedHealthcare · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a9950f04670b34ee49383d8>

"I deal with devoted health here in.... I deal with devoted health here in Louisiana it's a new company I am in network with lcmc health I'm having no problems with devoted accepting my in-network doctors with lcmc health however when I am sent to a specialty doctor nobody wants to deal with them then they send you a list of doctors they deal with that is out of network lcmc then when you go see there out of network doctors and they send you to a specialty clinic not in especially clinics want to deal with the devoted health insurance plan I have a book written on this that I have sent to devoted health that I have archived to prove what I am saying I went to see a gastrologist Dr David Treen he is a well-known doctor with very high credentials however when Dr train sent me to a clinic that he was working with to have imaging done the clinic he works with does not want anything to do with devoted out matter of fact medical clinics that these doctors have set me too what to deal with devoted health if you had time to read a book I would let you read my text messages back and forth with devoted health how they say is we're sorry you're going through this I'm having to do the work that devoted out in my doctors should be doing because nobody wants to accept the voted Health here in Louisiana yes personal care providers in network with lcmc they accept devoted health and yes a couple of there specialty clinics deal with devoted out truly changed my life but when the specialty Clinic send you to another clinic you're running into a dead end Street the clinics that the doctors deal with does not accept the devoted Health Plan all you have to do is call Miss Sylvia at Dr bastian's office lcmc Health oakwood Clinic and she will let you know the problem she having trying to doctors especially clinics that will accept devoted health devoted health is a new broken insurance company that ask you to keep things in network which I tried to do until they pull me out of network sending any the doctors that they want me to deal with that a too damn far to travel especially at my age however I got there the doctor saw me Dr train then the clinic he sent me to send me back and says they do not accept devoted health insurance yes they are out of network however devoted pulled me out of lcmc network to go to the doctors they want me to go see however the doctors that I went to see that they wanted me to go see they sent me to the doctors in the clinic that they deal with and none of their associates want to deal with devoted health explain this to me all I can say come open enrollment I may be going back to People's Health devoted is dragging elderly people in with their perks oh yes they have good freebies and perks they even pay you to do a health assessment which is no problem because you do it on the phone then they give you a decent over the counter allowance and with the elderly people barely scraping by this sounds good however when it comes to medical specialty clinics nobody wants to deal with devoted health quit selling your plans with your perks I'll elderly people that are barely scraping by the perks look good a lot of people sign on to devoted health because of the perks however the healthcare part of devoted health sucks as stated your regular personal care providers except devoted but none of the specialty clinics they deal with except devoted health insurance if I could send you the text messages that has been sent to devoted already you would understand I promise you I have over 20 pages of responses to devoted out the dressing this problem and all they can say is we're sorry that I am going through this devoted needs to get on track because they suck thank you"

— TrustPilot · Devoted Health · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a21c05fc83eec34fdcd42d6>

Marketplace and Medicaid paperwork, verification, errors

"My broker Carlos R Hernandez. My broker Carlos R. Hernandez signed me up for Cigna health insurance. At least I thought he did. After months of waiting and multiple phone calls, I never received ID cards. I could not log into mycigna.com. I could not log into the Colorado marketplace at connectforhealthco.com. Turns out Carlos entered my information incorrectly. My zip code was wrong. My address was wrong. My email was wrong. After multiple phone calls to Cigna and the Colorado Marketplace, I was finally able to track down all of these errors. I told Carlos. He invited me to find another broker. That is the only good advice Carlos provided!"

— TrustPilot · HealthMarkets · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/65bc12c06eb9707ce31b6ad1>